

Reading



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[CONNECTIONS.]

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Reading



Consultant:

Dr. Brandon Abdon
ELA Consultant and Coach
Owensboro, Kentucky
Affiliate Faculty
Murray State University
Murray, Kentucky

Dr. Erika Bruening
English and Reading Intervention
Seward Public Schools
Seward, Nebraska
Visiting Instructor in Education
Nebraska Wesleyan University
Lincoln, Nebraska

Reviewers:

Robert D. Shepherd
Callisto School Publishing
Tampa, Florida

Rebecca Zavala
ESOL, Remedial, College Prep, and
Honors English
Woodstock High School
Cherokee County School District, Georgia

Carmel McDonald
Instructional Coach
Paragon Charter Academy
Jackson, Michigan

Lauri Garbo, M.Ed.
English Department
Gulf Coast High School
Collier County School District, Florida

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Synthesize multiple short excerpts from the unit to answer the Essential Question

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Read Discuss Discover

Welcome to *Connections Reading*! Think about an amazing movie you have seen—one you couldn't stop thinking about after you left the theater. Did you talk about the movie with your family or friends? Did you watch the movie again after first seeing it in the theater? Do you see something new each time you watch it? Do you enjoy it and understand it better each time you view it? Reading is a bit like watching a movie. Each time you read or discuss a text, you'll discover something new and develop a deeper understanding.

With *Connections Reading*, you'll find deeper meaning in what you read as you enjoy a text more than once. Whether you are reading the text, listening to it, or reading it with someone else, you'll be surprised at the new understandings you uncover each time you interact with the text and engage in discussion with others about the text. You'll move from key ideas and details to discovering how authors create meaning by using special types of language to communicate their thoughts.

Read for Understanding Focus on *What?*

What is this mostly about?

Ask: What is happening? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important?

What am I wondering about as I read? What confuses me? What connections can I make to what I know?

First Focus Focus on *What?*

What are the key ideas?

Ask: What does the text say? What are the relevant details? How does the plot develop?

Who is writing and why are they writing?

Second Focus Focus on *How?*

How does the writer support their purpose?

Ask: How do details develop the central idea? What special types of language (figurative language, repetition, rhyme) does the writer use to create meaning?

How do the sentences/paragraphs in the text relate, or fit together? How does the structure of the text emphasize the ideas? Do I see causes/effects? problems/solutions? claims/reasons?

Third Focus Focus on *Why or Why Not?*

Why is this text important or meaningful to me—or to others?

Ask: What can I learn from this text that will help me understand the world? What can I learn that will make me a better writer? Why is (or why isn't) this nonfiction text convincing? Why is (or why isn't) this work of literature meaningful?

How does this text connect to other texts? Where have I seen this theme before? How do other presentations of this text (movie, artwork, etc.) or ideas in this text communicate the theme in similar or different ways.

Annotating a Fiction Text

Annotating a text means “marking a text as you read.” Annotating keeps you focused and improves your understanding of the main ideas. Think of annotating a text as talking to the text as you read. You might agree with some points the author makes, you might have questions about the meanings of words, or you might connect the writer’s ideas with your own experiences.

Mark fiction/literature by:

- underlining words and phrases that describe the characters
- circling repeated ideas (motifs)
- starring (*) important scenes or dialogue
- marking imagery or interesting figurative language
- placing an exclamation point (!) by something that affects you
- marking confusing parts or unfamiliar words with a question mark (?) so you can return to them later
- writing questions about what you read in the margin
- writing personal connections to the text (This reminds me of . . .)
- writing a short summary of what happens on a page or in a chapter

Directions: As you read this excerpt, underline phrases that show how Okonkwo’s past relationship with his father affects his current attitudes and actions.

Things Fall Apart

by Chinua Achebe

1 With a father like Unoka, Okonkwo did not have the start in life which many young men had. He neither inherited a barn nor a title, nor even a young wife. But in spite of these disadvantages, he had begun even in his father’s lifetime to lay the foundations of a prosperous future. It was
5 slow and painful. But he threw himself into it like one possessed. And indeed he was possessed by the fear of his father’s contemptible life and shameful death.

There was a wealthy man in Okonkwo’s village who had three huge barns, nine wives and thirty children. His name was Nwakibie and he had taken the highest but one title which a man could take in the clan. It was for this man that Okonkwo worked to earn his first seed yams. . . .

10 “I have come to you for help,” he said. “Perhaps you can already guess what it is. I have cleared a farm but have no yams to sow. I know what it is to ask a man to trust another with his yams, especially these days when young men are afraid of hard work. I am not afraid of work. The lizard that jumped from the high iroko tree to the ground said he would praise himself if no one else did. I began to fend for myself at an age when most people still suck at their mothers’ breasts. If you give me some yam seeds I shall not fail you.”

If you give me some yam seeds I shall not fail you.”

Annotating an Informational Text

Mark nonfiction/informational text by:

- underlining main ideas
- circling key words and ideas that repeat throughout the text
- drawing arrows to show relationships between ideas (cause and effect/problem and solution)
- marking confusing parts or unfamiliar words with a question mark (?) so you can return to them later
- placing an exclamation point (!) by something that affects you
- writing questions in the margin
- writing personal connections to the text (This reminds me of . . .)

Directions: Read and underline the text that explains why we don't stop eating when we feel full.

The Omnivore's Dilemma

The Consumer: A Republic of Fat

by Michael Pollan

1 One might think that people would stop eating and drinking these gargantuan portions as soon as they felt full, but it turns out hunger doesn't work that way. . . . Human appetite, it turns out, is surprisingly elastic, which makes excellent evolutionary sense; it behooved our hunter-gatherer ancestors to feast whenever the opportunity to feast presented itself, 5 allowing them to build up reserves of fat against future famine. Obesity researchers call this trait the "thrifty gene." And while the gene represents a useful adaptation in an environment of food scarcity and unpredictability, it's a disaster in an environment of food abundance, when the opportunity to feast presents itself 24/7. Our bodies are storing reserves of fat against a famine that never comes. . . .

10 Natural selection predisposed us to the taste of sugar and fat (its texture as well as taste) because sugars and fats offer the most energy (which is what a calorie is) per bite. Yet in nature—in whole foods—we seldom encounter these nutrients in the concentrations we now find them in processed foods: You won't find a fruit with anywhere near the amount of fructose in a soda, or a piece of animal flesh with quite as much fat as a chicken nugget.

Unit 1

Essential Question

Is the journey more important than the destination?

What kind of traveler are you? Do you just want to get where you're going as fast as you can? Or do you agree with the old adage that says "getting there is half the fun"?

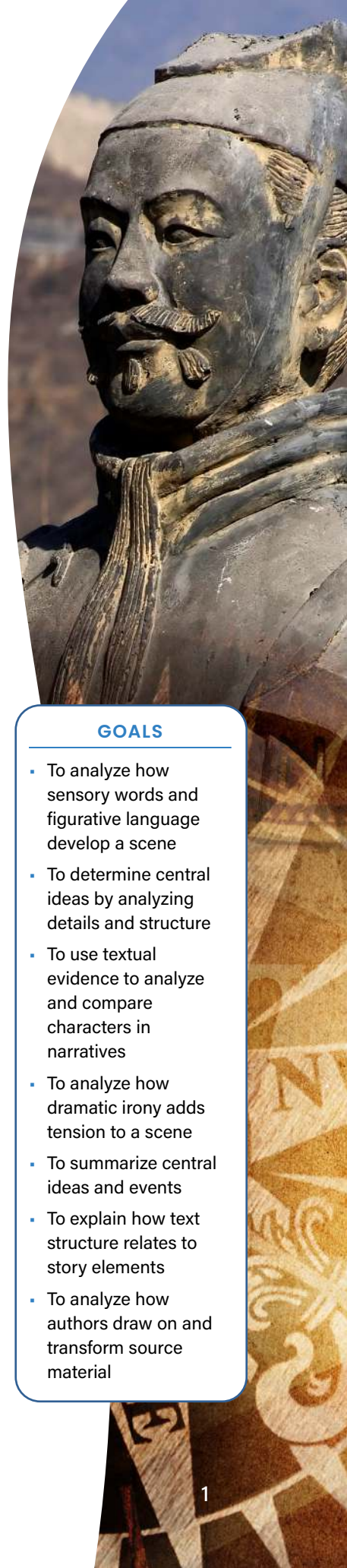
Think back to trips you've taken with your friends and family. You've probably seen extreme examples of people with both viewpoints. Some travelers would skip the trip altogether, dreaming of stepping into a Star Trek-type teleporter and arriving instantly at their destination. For them, it's all about *being* somewhere else, not *getting* somewhere else. Then there are others who savor all the experiences in between here and there. They love roaming the open road—taking in the scenery, the weather, the sights and sounds—and stopping in never-before-visited towns where everything is new: the streets, the parks, the stores, the restaurants, the people. They can't resist detouring to offbeat roadside attractions that feature rusted out cars arranged to look like Stonehenge, palaces made of corn, or the world's largest ball of twine.

Our personalities, experiences, and interests certainly influence our attitudes about travel. And for most people, the nature of the trip determines whether they want to get there *now* or enjoy the ride. However, most readers will agree about one thing: when it comes to stories about journeys, getting there is way more than half the fun. In fact, often the barriers and problems that result in *not* getting there provide excitement and valuable life experiences.

What makes a journey worth the trip on the printed page? How do stories about travel keep us riding along with the characters? Unit 1 will explore key elements of journey stories by examining the language, themes, and subject matter of the genre. Activities will provide opportunities to write about, discuss, and debate what makes a good travel story. You'll also write your own narrative about a journey. As you work through this unit, make connections between imaginary journeys in literature and the trips you have taken (or hope to take) in real life.

GOALS

- To analyze how sensory words and figurative language develop a scene
- To determine central ideas by analyzing details and structure
- To use textual evidence to analyze and compare characters in narratives
- To analyze how dramatic irony adds tension to a scene
- To summarize central ideas and events
- To explain how text structure relates to story elements
- To analyze how authors draw on and transform source material





Chapter 1

Analyzing Narrative Details

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- draw conclusions about a character's reactions.
- support conclusions with textual evidence.
- analyze how writers use sensory details and figurative language to create vivid descriptions.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **character development:** ways in which an author reveals the personality of a character.
- **metaphor:** a figurative comparison between two unlike people, objects, or things in which one thing is said to be the other.
- **point of view:** a narrator's position in relation to the story he or she is telling.
- **sensory details:** any details that appeal to one of the five senses.
- **simile:** a figurative comparison of two unlike things that uses like or as.
- **textual evidence:** words or phrases from a passage that support a conclusion or inference.

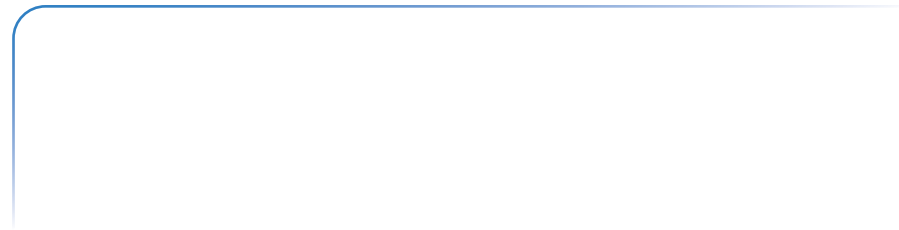
Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. Before you make a claim that the main character is dishonest, you must cite _____ that shows that she is.
2. The poem was full of _____ representing sights, sounds, and smells, some of which were a bit obscure.
3. "My father is like a big brown bear" is a _____ I wrote to describe my dad.
4. The politician used a _____ to speak about a difficult time for Americans when she said, "We will weather this storm together."
5. To determine the _____ of a story, look at the pronouns used.
6. Our literature teacher reminded us to pay attention to the dialogue in the selection to analyze the author's _____ of the protagonist.

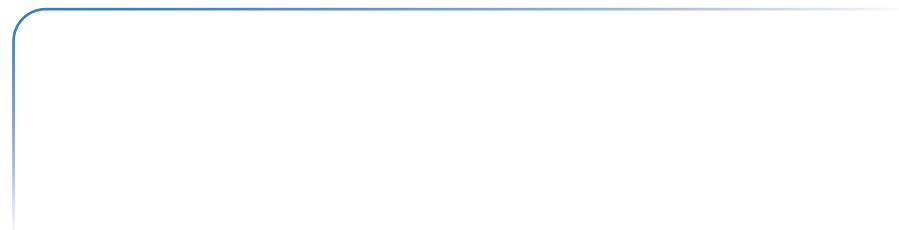
Preview Concepts

What is the difference between a *journey* and a *trip*?

Think about a book you read or a movie you saw recently that was about a journey. What elements made it interesting or memorable? Write a response below. Use the following key words to focus your writing: *setting*, *characters*, *description*, *plot*.



Share your answers with a partner. In the space below, summarize the conclusions from your discussion.



Read for Understanding

The following excerpt is from *The Journeyer* by Gary Jennings, a fictionalized account of the travels of the famed adventurer and trader Marco Polo, who narrates the story. In 1271, Marco Polo set out with his father Niccolo for the capital of China, the home of the Mongol leader, Kublai Khan.

As you read, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

The Journeyer

by Gary Jennings

1 To my surprise, when we entered **Khanbalik**¹—that is to
say, when we came in the twilight of a fading day to the
place where the dusty road became a broad, paved, clean
avenue leading into the city—our little train was met by a
5 considerable reception party.

First there was waiting a band of Mongol foot soldiers
wearing dress armor of highly polished metal and gleaming
oiled leathers. They did not step out to **impede** our way, as
Kaidu's road guards at Kashgar had done. With unanimous
10 precision, they presented their glittering lances at a slant
of salute, then formed a hollow square about our train and
marched with us along the avenue, between crowds of the
city's everyday inhabitants, who paused in their occupations
to **ogle** us curiously.

15 The next waiting greeters were a number of distinguished-
looking, elderly gentlemen—some Mongols, some Han, some
evidently Arab and Persian—wearing long silk robes of
various vivid colors, each man attended by a servant holding
over him a fringed canopy on a tall pole. The elders strode

Notes:

¹ **Khanbalik:** capital city of Kublai Khan's Mongol empire

Notes:

- 20 out to march on our either flank, their servants scurrying to keep the canopies in place over them, and all smiled at us and made **sedate** gestures of welcome and called in their several languages: "Mendul Ying-jiel Salaam!"—though those words were quickly drowned out by a troop of
- 25 musicians joining the procession with an unearthly screech and **clangor** of horns and cymbals. My father and uncle smiled and nodded and bowed from their saddles, appearing to have expected this extravagant reception, but **Nostril and Ussu and Donduk²** looked as astonished as I was.
- 30 Ussu said to me, over the noise, "Of course, your party has been watched all along the road, as is every traveler, and post riders will have kept the Khanbalik authorities informed of your approach. No one arrives at the City of the Khan unobserved."
- 35 "But," said Donduk, in a newly respectful voice, "usually it is only the city's **Wang³** who keeps account of visitors' comings and goings. You **Ferenghi⁴**"—he pronounced the word **benignly** for a change—"seem to be known to the very palace, and warmly awaited, and exceptionally welcome.
- 40 Those elders marching alongside, I believe they are courtiers of the Khakhan himself."
- I was looking from side to side of the avenue, eager to get some idea of the city's appearance, but suddenly the view was obscured and my attention diverted elsewhere.
- 45 There came a noise like a crack of thunder and a light like a lightning flash, not high in the sky but frighteningly close overhead. It made me start and made my horse shy, so

2 **Nostril and Ussu and Donduk:** Nostril is Marco's slave. Ussu and Donduk are Mongols traveling with Polo's group.

3 **Wang:** chief city officer or magistrate

4 **Ferenghi:** a Westerner, a European trader

violently that I lost my stirrups. I curbed the animal before he could bolt and held him to a skittish dance, while the

50 terrific noise banged again and again, each time with a flare of light. I saw that all our other horses had also shied, and all our party were occupied in keeping them under control. I would have expected every one of the city folk in the avenue to be running for cover, but all seemed not only composed

55 but actually to be enjoying the **tumult** and the brightening of the dusk. My father and uncle and the two Mongols were equally **tranquil**; they even grinned broadly as they sawed on the reins of the plunging horses. It seemed that the flicker and the racket were a bewilderment only to me

60 and to Nostril—I could see his eyeballs protruding whitely from his head as he looked wildly about for the source of the commotion.

It came from the curly-eaved rooftops along both sides of the avenue. Blobs of bright light, like great sparks—or more

65 like the desert's mysterious "beads of Heaven"—went lofting upward from those roofs and arcing into the air overhead.

Directly above us, they burst **asunder**, making that ear-clapping thump of sound, and became whole constellations of different-colored sprinkles and streaks and splinters of

70 light that drifted down and dwindled and died before they reached the street pavement, leaving a trail of sharp-smelling blue smoke. So many were going up from the roofs and bursting at such close intervals that their flares made an almost constant glow, abolishing the natural twilight, and

75 their bangs concerted in such a roar that our accompanying band was inaudible. . . .

It may be that my own eyes were bulging at the sight of

Notes:

that strange and unaccountable flying fire. For, when we had
proceeded farther along the avenue, and the smoke and
80 the artificial lightning storm were behind us, Ussu again brought
his horse close beside mine and spoke loudly to be heard
above the again rambunctious band music:

"You never saw such a show before, Ferenghi? It is a toy
devised by the childish Han people. They call it *huo-shu yin-*
85 *hua*—fiery trees and sparkling flowers."

I shook my head and said, "Toy, indeed!" but managed to
smile as if I too had enjoyed it. Then I resumed my glancing
about to see what the fabled city of Khanbalik looked like.

Notes:



A close up of Chinese writing on the Great Wall of China.

First Focus: Understanding Narrative Details

Discover

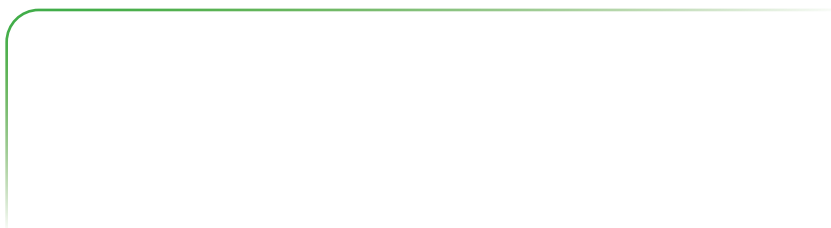
Skill Focus: Visualizing narrative event details while reading is important for comprehending and engaging with a literary work. Successful readers create mental images of the events, characters, settings, and other elements described in the text. When you visualize narrative events, you activate your imagination and bring the written words to life.

Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and focus on Marco Polo's reactions to the strange new world he has entered. Visualize the events taking place; draw illustrations to help you focus. Record thoughts, comments, or questions in the Notes column. Place brackets around one sentence that you feel best describes his thoughts and emotions as he encounters unfamiliar sights, sounds, and situations.

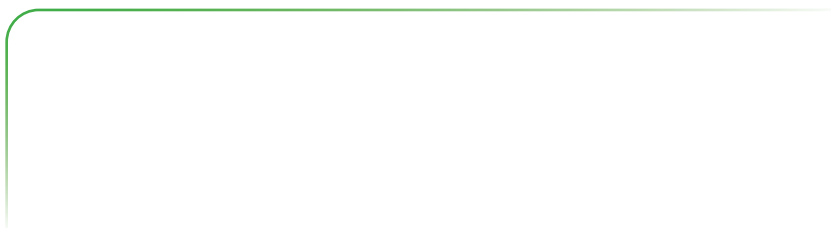
Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. In the first paragraph, what sense is primarily appealed to by the details “in the twilight of a fading day,” “dusty road,” and “broad, paved, clean avenue”?



2. What overall impression does Jennings paint of the elderly gentlemen in paragraph 3? What narrative details contribute to this impression?



3. Use the narrative details in lines 45–82 to summarize what the narrator sees in the sky.

4. Use descriptions from the text to explain the narrator’s reactions to the events that occur.

Demonstrate

As you draw conclusions about Polo’s reactions to entering Khanbalik, return to the text and find quotations that support your inferences. The following chart will help you draw conclusions and support those conclusions with textual evidence. The first row has been completed for you. Fill in the following rows with your own examples.

What is Polo experiencing?	What are Polo’s reactions? (Support with textual evidence.)
A reception party greeted Polo and his companions.	Polo is astonished to be greeted by and escorted into the city by a battalion of foot soldiers. <i>To my surprise</i> (line 1)

continued on next page

What is Polo experiencing?	What are Polo's reactions? (Support with textual evidence.)

Exit Ticket

Write a paragraph explaining Marco Polo's reactions to the new world he has entered. Include textual evidence, such as quotations of specific phrases that convey Marco Polo's wonder or fear. Draw conclusions about why he is experiencing these emotions.

Second Focus: Analyzing Sensory Details and Figurative Language

Discover

Skill Focus: In the excerpt, author Gary Jennings uses vivid descriptions and comparisons to describe sights, sounds, and situations that are new to Marco Polo. A large section describes Polo's first experience of fireworks. Since he has never seen them before, he cannot even name what he is seeing—he can only describe them by using sensory details and by comparing them to things he knows.

In the excerpt, author Gary Jennings uses vivid descriptions and comparisons to describe sights, sounds, and situations that are new to Marco Polo. A large section describes Polo's first experience of fireworks. Since he has never seen them before, he cannot even name what he is seeing—he can only describe them by using sensory details and by comparing them to things he knows. Study this chart to learn more about sensory details and types of comparisons.

Sources of Sensory Details	Sight is the most common sense used in narrative descriptions, probably because we rely on it the most. Colors, shapes, intensity of light and darkness, and motion are some of the many things we perceive with our eyes.
	Sound includes anything perceived by our sense of hearing. Our hearing can tell us whether an object is near or far, whether a person or object is coming or going. It can even tell us the mood of a person by the tone of his or her voice.
Types of Comparisons	A simile is a comparison that says that one thing is <i>like</i> another: <i>She moved like lightning on the court.</i>
	A metaphor is a type of comparison that says that one thing <i>is</i> another, without using connective words such as <i>like</i> or <i>as</i> : <i>She is lightning on the court.</i>

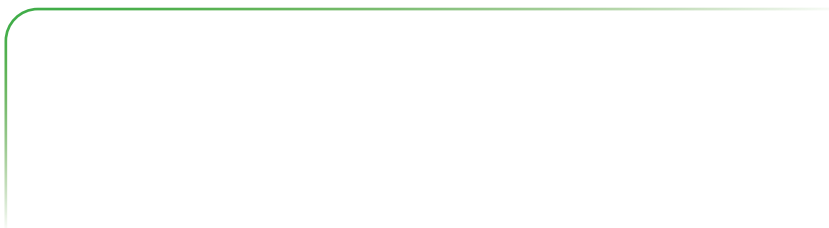


Reread the story. Label sensory details that relate to sights and sounds. Identify a simile and a metaphor that Marco Polo uses to describe fireworks.

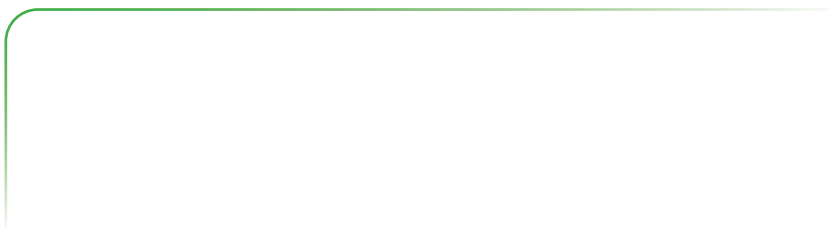
Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

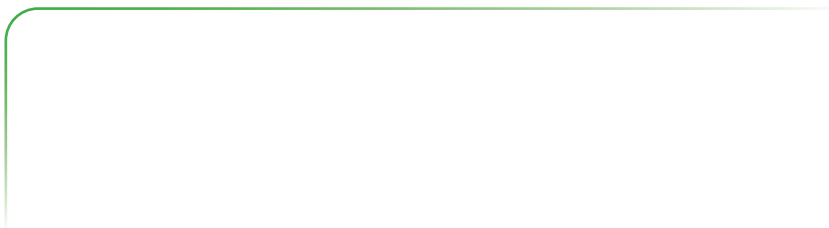
1. What does “beads of Heaven” mean in line 65?



2. What single sensory detail in the excerpt do you find the most compelling or powerful? Why?



3. What do you think the narrator is thinking when he says, “Toy, indeed!” in the last paragraph?



Demonstrate

Figurative language and sensory language are important tools that writers use to set the mood of a work of literature. The mood of a work of literature is the feeling the setting, events, and language evoke in the reader. Adjectives used to describe a text's mood include suspenseful, upbeat, sorrowful, mysterious, romantic, bittersweet, or humorous. To determine the mood of a story, analyze how the author uses figurative language. Consider how the following similes create totally different moods:

- The sun, like a ball of light, warmed the earth with its gentle glow.
- The sun, like the monstrous eye of a cyclops, seared the earth with its burning gaze.

What feelings does each sentence create?

What words create these different moods?

Fill in the following table with the details you labeled during your last read of the excerpt.

Sense	Detail from Passage that Describes the Fireworks
Sound	
Sight	
Simile	
Metaphor	

Exit Ticket

1 Write a paragraph in which you analyze how the author uses descriptive techniques to convey Polo's amazement at seeing fireworks for the first time.

2 In groups of three or four, conduct a peer review of your paragraph analyzing the descriptive techniques of the passage. Follow these steps.

Steps for Peer Review

1. Select a timekeeper. Stick to the time. Each writer gets 5 minutes.
2. One person begins by reading aloud his or her paragraph while other members listen actively.
3. Pause. The same reader reads the paragraph aloud a second time. (Don't skip this step.)
4. Group members listen and write comments or notes.
5. Writer asks, "What part was most clear to you?" Each member responds. Writer jots notes on draft.
6. Writer asks, "Was there any part that confused you?" Each member responds. Writer jots notes on draft.
7. Go to next writer in the group and repeat steps.

As soon as possible after the peer review, revise your draft based on your peers' questions and comments.

Third Focus: Drawing Conclusions

Discover

Skill Focus: As you read, you actively make inferences and draw conclusions beyond the literal meanings of the words on the page. This process involves synthesizing information from different parts of the text, connecting ideas, and combining the textual details with your own background knowledge and experiences.

As you read the passage again, think about how the author contrasts Marco's reactions to events with the reactions of other characters. Do other characters express Marco's amazement, surprise, and confusion at the events in the story? Or have they seen it all before? In the Notes column, write a few sentences to explain your conclusions.

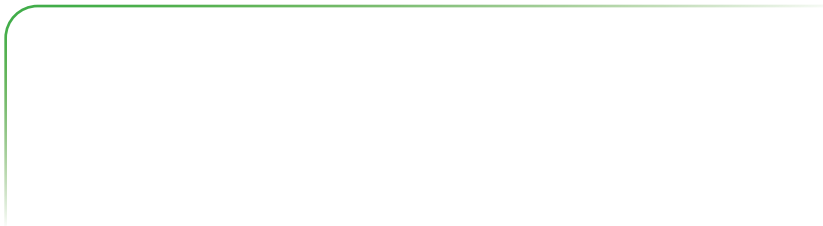
Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What conclusions can you draw about the city of Khanbalik based on evidence in the text?



2. What conclusions can you draw about early fireworks based on evidence in the text?



Demonstrate

When writing stories, authors *show* what's happening and then let readers draw their own inferences and conclusions about the many things that are left unsaid. This approach engages readers more deeply in the story. In *The Journeyer*, for example, readers share in Marco's efforts to understand what's going on around him by observing the reactions of others. Because the story is written in first-person point of view, the reader experiences the same emotions and reactions as Polo.

Read the first example in the chart below, which draws a conclusion about Marco Polo's character and the situation he is in and provides textual evidence to support the conclusion. Then complete the chart with four of your own conclusions and the supporting textual evidence from the text.

Conclusions About Marco Polo's Character and the Situation He Is Encountering	Evidence from Text
The leaders of Khanbalik were expecting Marco and his group.	<i>our little train was met by a considerable reception party</i> (line 5)

Exit Ticket

Look at the evidence in the graphic organizer. Think about how the author contrasts Marco's experiences with those of the people around him. How does this contrast deepen the reader's understanding of Marco?

1 Write a paragraph explaining how the writer adds to our understanding of Marco's experiences by contrasting him with others.

2 Working with a partner, read your paragraph, pause, and read it again. The listening partner should give specific feedback on the paragraph by explaining what the writer communicated well and what could be expressed more clearly. After sharing, revise your paragraph based on the feedback you received.

Review

The Review sections throughout this book provide practice questions on skills learned in each chapter. The goal is to help you feel more comfortable with the format of the test questions and teach you strategies to successfully answer different types of questions.

In this chapter, you practiced using evidence from a reading passage to support your conclusions about characters and events in the story. You were asked to point to specific words and sentences in the text that supported your ideas. When you take assessments, many questions will include two parts. Part A will ask you to make an inference about the text. Part B will ask you to identify sections of the text that support your answer.

1. Toward the end of the excerpt, Ussu asks Marco the following question:
“You never saw such a show before, Ferenghi?”

Part A: What makes Ussu suspect that Marco has never seen fireworks before?

- A. Ussu sees that Marco cannot control his horse.
- B. Ussu knows it is Marco’s first visit to the city.
- C. Ussu has to catch up with Marco on the avenue.
- D. Ussu notices that Marco appears rather alarmed.

Explanation

- To answer two-part questions like this, first decide what you think is the best answer to Part A and then read Part B and find textual evidence to support your answer.
- For Part A, choices A, B, and C all have some truth to them. Marco has trouble controlling his horse (A), it is his first visit to the city (B), and he is heading away from the display, down the avenue (C). But none of these things alone could explain the inference made by Ussu that Marco has never seen fireworks. Choice D, on the other hand, would be reason enough alone for Ussu to ask his question, and it is the correct answer.

Part B: Choose the sentence from the excerpt that best supports your answer to the previous question.

- A. *I curbed the animal before he could bolt, and held him to a skittish dance, while the terrific noise banged again and again, each time with a flare of light.*
- B. *I saw that all our other horses had also shied, and all our party were occupied in keeping them under control.*
- C. *It may be that my own eyes were bulging at the sight of that strange and unaccountable flying fire.*
- D. *I shook my head and said, “Toy, indeed!” but managed to smile as if I too had enjoyed it.*

Explanation

- To answer Part B, you must find the sentence from the story that supports that choice. The sentences in choices A and B do relate back to answer choices A and B in Part A, but those were incorrect choices. The sentence in choice D tells us that Marco is only pretending to have enjoyed the fireworks. Choice C, however, tells us his “eyes were bulging at the sight” of the fireworks, which expresses alarm or astonishment. Based upon Marco’s facial expression, Ussu suspects that Marco had never seen fireworks before.

Many tests ask vocabulary questions about the meaning of words or phrases, and some will also ask you to identify context clues that help you determine the meaning. Answer the following two-part question.

2. Read the following excerpt from the passage.

It seemed that the flicker and the racket were a bewilderment only to me
and to Nostril . . .

Part A: Which of the following is closest in meaning to the word *bewilderment*?

- A. a source of confusion
- B. an amazing sight
- C. a wild display
- D. an annoying event

Part B: Which lines from the passage best support the answer to Part A?

- A. *There came a noise like a crack of thunder and a light like a lightning flash . . .*
- B. *I saw that all our other horses had also shied, and all our party were occupied in keeping them under control.*
- C. *I could see his eyeballs protruding whitely from his head as he looked wildly about for the source of the commotion*
- D. *It came from the curly-eaved rooftops along both sides of the avenue.*



Chapter 2

Determining Central Ideas

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- explore how details support central ideas.
- analyze how writers use text structure to emphasize central ideas.
- compare and synthesize information from a text and a map.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **dialogue:** words spoken among characters in a text, play, or film.
- **supporting details:** details that contribute to, uphold, or prove the central ideas of a text.
- **text features:** the components of a story or article that are not the main body of text, including the table of contents, headings, bold words, sidebars, and pictures and captions.
- **text structure:** the method of organization used to organize information in a text. Examples include chronology, comparison, and cause and effect.
- **textual evidence:** facts, imagery, examples, data, and other details that support a conclusion about a text.

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. Remember to include _____ to support your conclusion that the main character is at fault.
2. The candidate made some impressive promises in her speech, but the lack of _____ made it difficult to believe they would actually happen.
3. She couldn't decide between problem and solution or comparison and contrast for the _____ of her research paper.
4. The short story was almost entirely _____ between the two main characters and minimal description or exposition.
5. Previewing _____ such as headings and subheadings will help you comprehend difficult texts.

Preview Concepts

How would you define the word *incredible*? Research the origins of the word and its parts. Summarize what you find out below.

Imagine you went back in time to the year 1900. You try to explain the internet to people from the past. How would you describe it in terms they would understand and in a way that would be believable? Write your explanation below.

Share your answers with a partner. Then discuss the following questions: Do you think people would believe your descriptions of the internet? Why or why not? Summarize your discussion in the space below.

Read for Understanding

This account of the famed trader and adventurer Marco Polo is by Will Durant, a famous historian who wrote an eleven-volume history of Western civilization. Even in Marco Polo's time, people doubted Polo's dramatic stories of his travels and adventures.

As you read the following excerpt, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

The Story of Civilization Our Oriental Heritage (Volume I)

by Will Durant

Chapter XXVI: The People and the State

Marco Polo Visits Kublai Khan

1 In the golden age of Venice, about the year 1295, two old
men and a man of middle age, worn with hardship, laden
with bundles, dressed in rags, and covered with the dust
of many roads, begged and then forced their way into the
5 home from which, they claimed, they had set forth twenty-
six years before. They had (they said) sailed many dangerous
seas, scaled high mountains and plateaus, crossed bandit-
ridden deserts, and passed four times through the Great
Wall; they had stayed twenty years in **Cathay**¹ and had served
10 the mightiest monarch in the world. They told of an empire
vaster, of cities more **populous**, and of a ruler far richer, than
any known to Europe; of stones that were used for heating,
of paper accepted in place of gold, and of nuts larger than a
man's head . . . No man would believe them; and the people
15 of Venice gave to the youngest and most **garrulous** of them
the nickname "Marco Millions," because his tale was full of
numbers large and marvelous.

¹ **Cathay**: the name once used for northern China

Notes:

Marco and his father and uncle accepted this fate with good cheer, for they had brought back with them many precious stones from the distant capital, and these gave them such wealth as maintained them in high place in their city. When Venice went to war with Genoa in 1298, Marco Polo received command of a galley; and when his ship was captured, and he was kept for a year in a Genoese jail, he consoled himself by dictating to an **amenuensis**² the most famous travel-book in literature. He told with the charm of a simple and straightforward style how he, father Nicolo and uncle Maffeo had left Acre when Mark was but a boy of seventeen; how they had climbed over the Lebanon ranges and found their way through Mesopotamia to the Persian Gulf, and thence through Persia, Khorassan and Balkh to the Plateau of Pamir; how they had joined caravans that slowly marched to Kashgar and Khotan, and across the Gobi Desert to Tangut, and through the Wall to Shangtu, where the Great Khan received them as humble **emissaries** from the youthful West. . . .

Peking³ (or, as it was then called, Cambaluc) impressed Polo even more than Hangchow; his millions fail him in describing its wealth and population. The twelve suburbs were yet more beautiful than the city; for there the business class had built many handsome homes. In the city proper there were numerous hotels, and thousands of shops and booths. Food of all kinds abounded, and every day a thousand loads of raw silk entered the gates to be turned into clothing for the inhabitants. Though the Khan had residences at Hangchow, Shangtu and other places, the most extensive of his palaces

² **amenuensis**: a literary assistant, especially one who takes dictation

³ **Peking**: former English name for Beijing, China

Notes:

was at Peking. A marble wall surrounded it, and marble steps led up to it; the main building was so large that “dinners could be served there to great multitudes of people.” Marco
50 admired the arrangement of the chambers, the delicate and transparent **glazing** of the windows, and the variety of colored tiles in the roof. He had never seen so **opulent** a city, or so magnificent a king. . . .

After remaining in China for twenty years, Marco
55 Polo, with his father and his uncle, took advantage of an embassy sent by the Khan to Persia, to return to their native city with a minimum of danger and expense. Kublai gave them a message to the Pope, and fitted them out with every comfort then known to travelers. The voyage
60 around the Malay Peninsula to India and Persia, the overland journey to Trebizond on the Black Sea, and the final voyage to Venice took them three years; and when they reached Europe they learned that both the Khan and the Pope were dead. Marco himself, with characteristic
65 obstinacy, lived to the age of seventy. On his deathbed his friends pleaded with him for the **salvation** of his soul to retract the obviously dishonest statements that he had made in his book; but he answered, stoutly: “I have not told half of what I saw.” Soon after his death a new comic
70 figure became popular at the Venetian carnivals. He was dressed like a clown and amused the **populace** by his gross exaggerations. His name was Marco Millions.

Notes:

First Focus: Finding Details That Support Central Ideas

Discover

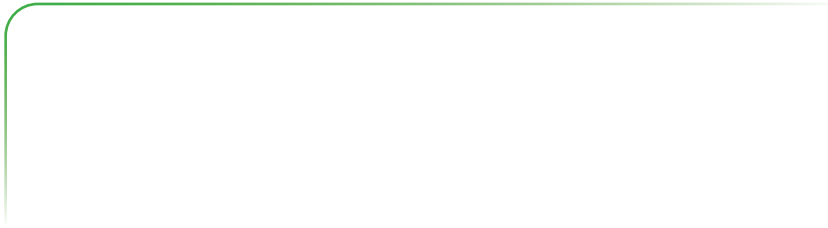
Skill Focus: In informational writing, details support and reinforce the central ideas presented by the author. The details provide depth, context, and evidence, allowing readers to determine the central ideas.

Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and underline details that you think describe something people might have had a hard time believing. Quickly scan the text before reading and write questions you have in the Notes column.

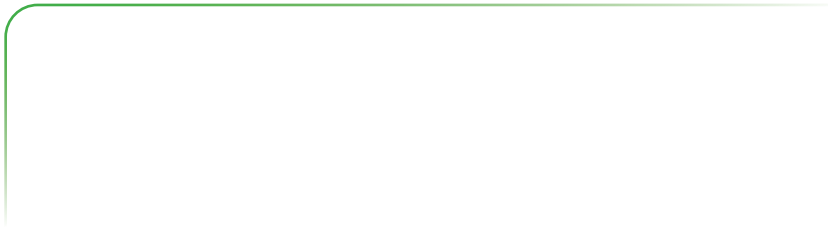
Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

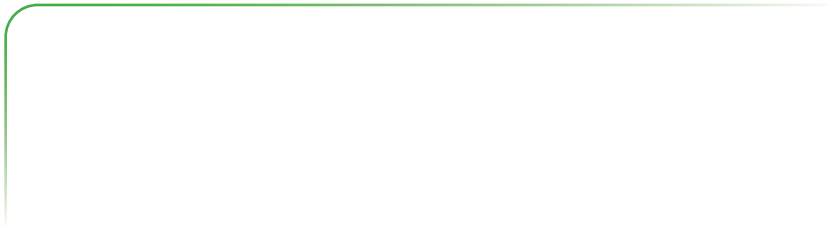
1. What details support the idea that Marco Polo returned to Europe in poor physical shape?



2. What central idea about the Khan does the text support?



3. What events led up to Marco Polo dictating his story to an assistant?



Demonstrate

The doubt expressed by Marco Polo's contemporaries—even his friends—about the truth of his adventures is one of the central ideas in the Durant excerpt. But Durant also supports the idea that Polo's stories were based on an actual epic journey. Complete the chart below by filling in details that support the idea that Polo did actually make the trip and with details that support the idea that Polo exaggerated the tales of his travels.

Evidence That Polo's Tales Were True	Evidence That Polo's Tales Were Exaggerated

Exit Ticket

Write a short paragraph explaining why people might have doubted Marco Polo's stories. Support your conclusions with examples from the excerpt.



Map of Polo's travels

Second Focus: Analyzing Text Structure

Discover

Skill Focus: Authors use text structure to organize and present information in a logical, coherent manner that supports comprehension. Types of text structure include description, chronological, and sequence. Paying attention to text structure can help the reader

- more easily identify main ideas and supporting details.
- mentally organize information and retain important concepts.
- analyze and evaluate the author's purpose.

Read the text again, this time with a classmate. Take turns reading paragraphs aloud.

As you read, place a star by two places where the author discusses skeptical responses to Marco Polo's tales of the East.

Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. Locate a third example of the writer repeating the detail of "Marco Millions" in the middle of the text. Is this detail effective? Why or why not?

2. How does Marco Polo defend himself, even on his deathbed?

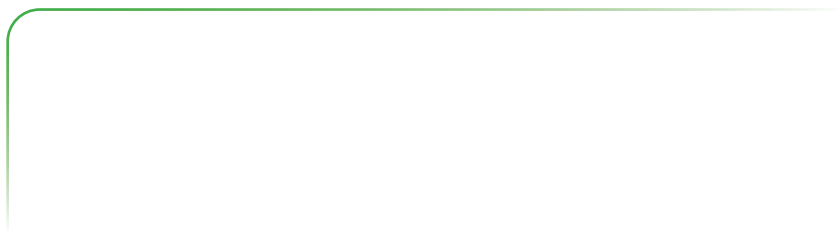
3. How would you describe the structure of the excerpt? Is this effective?

Demonstrate

Authors sometimes bookend a piece of writing by beginning and ending with the same idea or event. Read these sentences from the first and last paragraph of the text.

From the First Paragraph:	From the Last Paragraph:
<i>No man would believe them; and the people of Venice gave to the youngest and most garrulous of them the nickname "Marco Millions," because his tale was full of numbers large and marvelous.</i>	<i>On his deathbed his friends pleaded with him for the salvation of his soul to retract the obviously dishonest statements that he had made in his book; but he answered, stoutly: "I have not told half of what I saw." Soon after his death a new comic figure became popular at the Venetian carnivals. He was dressed like a clown and amused the populace by his gross exaggerations. His name was Marco Millions.</i>

1. How do these sentences relate to one another? Write your answer below.



Writers develop central, or main, ideas by giving examples, descriptive details, and reasons. They often use multiple text structures depending on the purpose they are trying to achieve. Some common text structures include the following:

- description: describing details about a person or place
- chronological: ordering events
- compare and contrast: showing similarities and differences
- sequence: explaining steps in a process

Think about how the writer develops the central ideas throughout the passage in this chapter. Complete the chart on the next page for paragraphs 2, 3, and 4. Look for transitional words and phrases that will help you infer the text structure.

Paragraph	Main Topic of Paragraph	How is the main idea developed?
2		
3		
4		

2. Why does the author choose to include references to people doubting Marco Polo's stories at the beginning and end of the text?

Third Focus: Integrating Information from Text Features

Discover

Skill Focus: Most nonfiction books include text features that help readers understand information and how it is communicated. Some of these text features are sections of the entire book: table of contents, appendix, and glossary. Others are placed within the text (charts, graphs, maps, footnotes, and photographs) to explain complex ideas in visual ways. The following table defines and explains how to use key text features.

Text Feature	Explanation	Use this to . . .
Table of Contents	Found in the beginning of a book, this lists the titles and page numbers of major sections of the text	get an overview of the entire book. locate specific information quickly
Headings/ Subheadings	Titles and subtitles that organize sections of text by topic	understand the central ideas in each section and how sections relate to each other.
Captions	Brief descriptions that accompany visuals	clarify what graphs, photos, and other visual elements communicate.
Photographs, maps, and Illustrations	Visual representations of people, places, or things	visualize concepts. gain more context about ideas.
Graphs	Visual displays of data	better understand information that appears in the text. visualize abstract concepts.
Charts	Visual organizers that arrange information into categories	compare/contrast and see relationships.
Glossary	List of key terms with definitions that appears in the back of the book	look up unfamiliar vocabulary.
Footnotes	Explanatory notes at the bottom of a page	learn additional details or source information.
Annotations	Explanatory notes added to the text itself	check for clarification of concepts.
Appendix	Supplemental information at the end of a text	further information related to the main text.

During this Third Focus read of the text, draw brackets around the details of the route Marco Polo took to reach Peking and of the route he took to return home to Venice. Later when you have finished this reading, you will have a chance to view a map of the Silk Roads. When reading an informational text and viewing a related map, use active comprehension strategies to synthesize the textual and visual information. Analyzing both sources links the factual content with physical places.

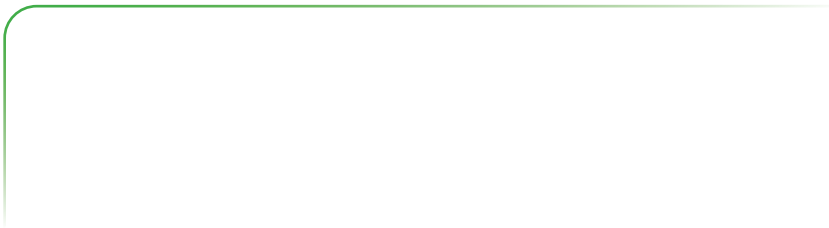
Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

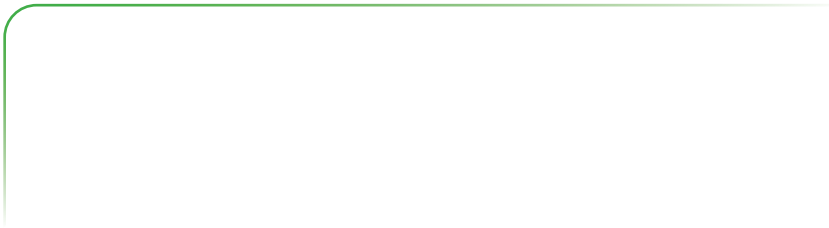
1. Why do you think the trade routes extended as far south as Somalia and Java?



2. What happens when trade routes extend through so many different countries and terrains?



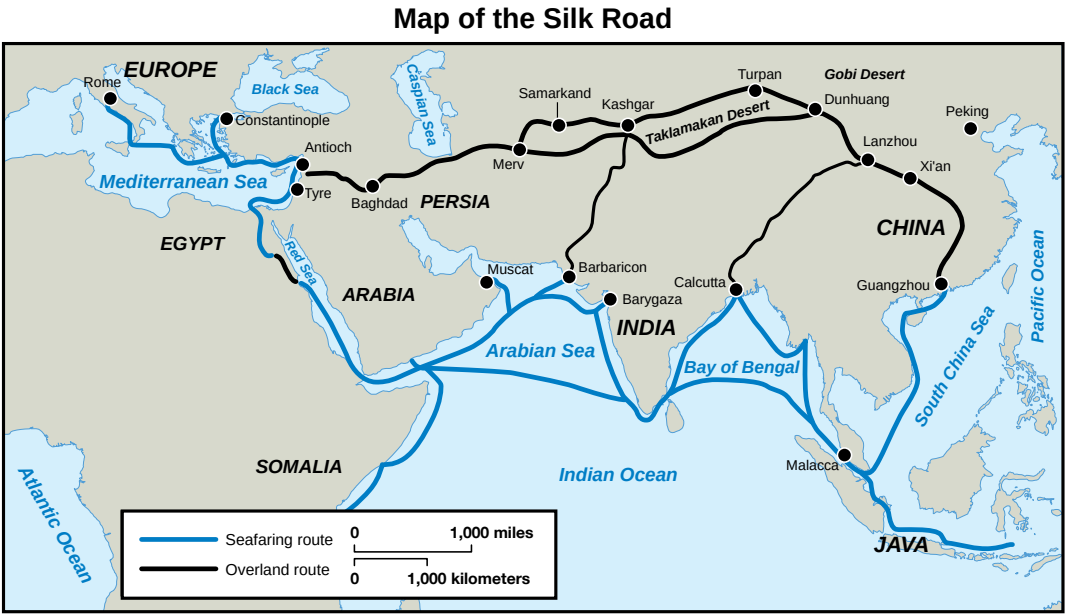
3. What information did you learn about the cultures and socioeconomic conditions of the places Marco Polo traveled? Cite textual evidence to support your answers.



Demonstrate

Visual text features such as maps, photos, illustrations, tables, and graphs can help readers understand complex ideas. Study the map of the Silk Roads below. It shows the network of trade routes connecting the West and the East from the Mediterranean Sea to China from around 100 B.C.E. to the 1450s C.E.

Think about how the map helps you understand places and distances explained in the text. Remember to compare the information in the text with the information in the map. This will provide a more complete understanding of the information.



Complete the chart by writing details from the selection that describe Marco Polo's journey to Peking and his journey back to Venice. You may need to research the names of places.

Marco Polo's Journeys	Description from Text
From Venice to Peking	

continued on next page

Marco Polo's Journeys	Description from Text
From Peking to Venice	

Use the map on the previous page to help you answer the following questions.
Use online resources to research any differences in the names of cities.

1. How did Polo's trip to Peking differ from his trip home?

2. How does the map of the Silk Road support the descriptions in the text about Polo's travels to Peking and back to Venice?

3. Why does the author include specific details about Polo's travels?

Exit Ticket

1 Use your answers to the previous questions to write a paragraph to address the following question: How do the text and map support Polo's claim that he actually traveled to Peking?

2 Working with a partner, read your paragraph, pause, and read it again. (It is important to read it two times.) The listening partner should give specific feedback on the paragraph by explaining what the writer communicated well and what could be expressed more clearly. As soon as both partners have shared, revise your paragraph based on the feedback from your partner.

Review

On a test, you may be asked to identify how supporting details support the main ideas of a text or of a paragraph within a text. Answer the following question.

1. Which of the following quotations from the passage best supports the conclusion that the author, Will Durant, doubts that the stories told by Marco Polo are true?
 - A. *They had (they said) sailed many dangerous seas, scaled high mountains and plateaus, crossed bandit-ridden deserts, and passed four times through the Great Wall. . . .*
 - B. *He told with the charm of a simple and straightforward style how he, father Nicolo and uncle Maffeo had left Acre when Mark was but a boy of seventeen. . . .*
 - C. *Peking (or, as it was then called, Cambaluc) impressed Polo even more than Hangchow; his millions fail him in describing its wealth and population.*
 - D. *On his deathbed his friends pleaded with him, for the salvation of his soul, to retract the obviously dishonest statements that he had made in his book; but he answered, stoutly: "I have not told half of what I saw."*

Explanation

- A central idea of the passage is that many people in Polo's time doubted the truth of his stories. But the question asks you to look for evidence that the author himself doubted Polo's accounts.
- Choices B and C touch on, respectively, the book Polo wrote and how much the sights he saw astounded him, but they do not get at Durant's opinion, and hence are not the right answer.
- Choice D looks tempting because it mentions Polo's "obviously dishonest statements." But that is a view held by his friends, so it's not a good answer.
- Choice A is the correct answer. When Durant writes, "They had (they said)," he is implying that he himself doubts the truth of all the stories told.

For further practice identifying how details support main ideas, answer the following questions.

2. How are the details about Polo's nickname "Marco Millions" important to the development of a central theme in the passage?
 - A. They emphasize the importance of telling the truth.
 - B. They provide an example of how Polo was not believed by the people of Venice.
 - C. They offer evidence for the claim that Polo actually traveled to China and back.
 - D. They provide proof that the people of Venice had already heard about the wonders of the Far East.
3. The fact that Marco and his father brought back precious stones that made them wealthy implies that
 - A. the gems were stolen during their travels.
 - B. Marco and his father had hidden the gems in Venice before they left for China.
 - C. Marco and his father traveled far and perhaps even to China.
 - D. the route Marco and his father took to China was accurate.
4. Could the map of the Silk Roads be used to support Polo's claim that he traveled to China?
 - A. No, because the Silk Road wasn't being used during Polo's lifetime.
 - B. No, because the road doesn't go all the way to Peking.
 - C. Yes, because it provides evidence that the Polos followed a route already being used by traders.
 - D. Yes, because it shows how isolated China was from the rest of the world.
5. Which of the following details best supports the conclusions that doubts about Polo's stories continued on after his death?
 - A. *They told of an empire vaster, of cities more populous, and of a ruler far richer, than any known to Europe; of stones that were used for heating, of paper accepted in place of gold, and of nuts larger than a man's head . . .*
 - B. *the people of Venice gave to the youngest and most garrulous of them the nickname "Marco Millions," because his tale was full of numbers large and marvelous.*
 - C. *He told with the charm of a simple and straightforward style how he, father Nicolo and uncle Maffeo had left Acre when Mark was but a boy of seventeen;*
 - D. *a new comic figure became popular at the Venetian carnivals. He was dressed like a clown, and amused the populace by his gross exaggerations. His name was Marco Millions.*

A photograph of the Great Pyramids of Giza in Egypt, showing three large pyramids under a clear sky. The pyramids are made of golden-brown stone blocks.

Chapter 3

Analyzing and Comparing Themes

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- analyze characters in nonfiction and fiction narratives.
- support analyses of characters with evidence from the text.
- compare and contrast characters, themes, and ideas.
- analyze how stories communicate a culture's values and beliefs.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **character:** a person, animal, or figure represented in a literary work.
- **dialogue:** spoken words between characters in a text, play, or film.
- **frame story:** a story set within a story.
- **narrative:** a spoken or written account of a series of connected events.
- **oral tradition:** culture and history that is passed from generation to generation in spoken, not written, format.
- **textual evidence:** facts, examples, data, and other details that support a conclusion about a text.
- **theme:** the central message or insight of a text.

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. The novel had so many _____ that I had to make a list to remember who was who.
2. Remember to include _____ to support your claim about the evil intentions of the main character.
3. The recurring _____ of love and loss resonated throughout the novel as the characters struggled to pick up the pieces of their lives.
4. The speaker's _____ was a fascinating account, explaining how he overcame hardship and achieved fame.
5. The _____ between the two main characters told the whole story.

6. When a group of pilgrims share their tales while journeying to the shrine of Thomas Becket in *The Canterbury Tales*, Chaucer is using the technique called a _____.
7. The stories of my great-grandma's criminal exploits were infamous, but they were part of an _____ that no one shared outside our family.

Preview Concepts

In what way does good fortune open the way for misfortune? Can the opposite be true: can misfortune open the way for good fortune?

Think about a book you read or a movie or TV show you saw recently that was about a reversal in fortune—good to bad or bad to good. Was the story compelling? Why or why not? Write a response below. Use the following key words to focus your writing: *characters, motivation, choices, events, plot, fate*.

Share your answers with a partner. In the space below, summarize the conclusions from your discussion.

Read for Understanding

The following excerpt is based on an ancient Egyptian story. In 1325, 20-year-old Ibn Battuta set off on a pilgrimage to Mecca (also known as a Hajj) from his home in Tangier, Morocco. Battuta, a Muslim scholar, went on to travel for 29 years, covering 75,000 miles and visiting 44 modern countries. Much of the excerpt focuses on an Egyptian story that traces the rise and fall of the slave Khasib.

As you read, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

The Travels of Ibn Battuta

by Ibn Battuta

Chapter 3

1 The traveler continues: I then left Cairo, with the intention
to go on the **pilgrimage** by way of Upper Egypt, and came to
the Der El Tin (or monastery of clay). From this place I went
to Baush, then to Dilas, then to Bibi, then to Bahnasa, then
5 to the Minyet of Ibn Khasib, which was formerly attached
to the government of Cairo. It is said, that one of the **Califs**⁴
of the house of Abbas was displeased with the people of
Egypt, and took it into his head to place over them one of
the meanest of his slaves, by way of punishment, and that
10 he might afford an example to others. At this time Khasib
was the lowest slave in the palace, and his business was to
get the baths warmed. He was accordingly appointed to
the government, with the hope that he would sufficiently
punish them by his **tyranny**, as it is usual with those who have
15 not been brought up for such a station. But when Khasib
was established in Egypt, his conduct was **exemplary** in the
extreme; and, for this, his fame was spread far and wide: the
consequence was, he was visited by the relations of the Calif,

⁴ **Califs:** spiritual leaders of Islam

Notes:

and other persons attached to the court, and these he loaded
20 with presents. Upon one of these occasions the Calif missed
some of his relations, and upon inquiry found, that one of
them had absented himself. After a time this man presented
himself to the Calif, who **interrogated** him as to his absence.
The man replied, that he had been paying a visit to Khasib in
25 Egypt: he then told him of the gifts he had received, which
were indeed of great value. This enraged the Calif so that
he ordered the eyes of Khasib to be put out, that he should
be **expelled** from Egypt, and cast out into one of the streets
of Bagdad. When the order for his apprehension arrived, it
30 was served upon him by an **artifice**⁵, at some distance from
his palace. He had with him, however, a large ruby, which he
had hidden by sewing it up in his shirt during the night. His
eyes were then put out, and he was thrown out in a street
of Bagdad. Upon this occasion a poet happened to pass
35 by, who said, O Khasib, it was my intention to visit thee in
Egypt, in order to recite thy praises: but thy coming hither
is the more suitable to me. Will you then allow me to recite
my poem? How, said Khasib, shall I hear it? You know what
circumstances I am in. The poet replied, my only wish is that
40 you should hear it: but as to reward—may God reward you,
as you have others! Khasib then said, go on with your verse.

The poet proceeded:

Thy bounties like the swelling Nile,
Made the plains of Egypt smile.

45 When he had got to the end of the poem Khasib said, Open
this seam. He did so. Khasib then said, Take this ruby. The poet
refused; but being **adjured** to do so, he complied; he then

Notes:

5 **artifice**: a clever deception or strategy

went to the street of the jewellers, and offered it for sale. He was told that such a stone could belong to none but the Calif.

50 The account of it was accordingly carried to him, who ordered the poet to be brought into his presence. When he came there, he was interrogated on the subject, and his answers developed the whole matter. The Calif was then sorry for what he had done to Khasib, and ordered that he should be
55 brought before him. When he came, the Calif gave him some splendid presents, and ordered that he should have whatever he might wish. Khasib requested to have this **Minyet**⁶ given to him, which was done; and he resided there till the time of his death. After this his descendants held it, until the family
60 became extinct.—I then proceeded to the city of Manlawi, then to Manfalut, then to Esoyut, then to Ekhhim, and then to Hawwa. Here I visited the Sheikh, Sayyud Abu Mohammed Obaid Allah El Hasani, who was one of the great saints. When he asked me what my object was, I told him, that it was my
65 wish to perform the pilgrimage by way of Judda. He replied, you will not succeed in this, upon this occasion; you had better return, therefore: for, the first pilgrimage you will perform, will be by the plain of Syria. When I left him, I made no effort to follow his advice, but proceeded on my way till I arrived
70 at Aidhab, and found that I could not go on. I then returned to Cairo, and after that to Syria (or Damascus); and the way I took, in my first pilgrimage, was just as the **Sherif**⁷ had told me, by the plain of Syria.

Notes:

6 **Minyet**: probably a house or place to live

7 **Sherif**: an Arab chief, ruler, or prince

First Focus: Analyzing Characters

Discover

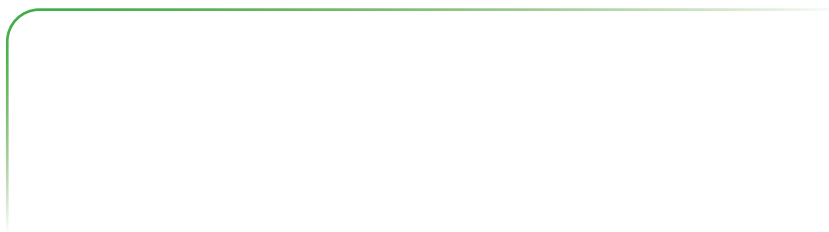
Skill Focus: Readers analyze characters by studying their dialogue, thoughts, actions, and interactions with others. Studying how characters respond to problems and make choices helps you understand and predict characters' behavior throughout the text.

Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and draw vertical lines to indicate where the story of Khasib begins and ends. Underline words or sentences that help you infer what the characters of Khasib and the Calif are like. Record any thoughts, comments, or questions you have in the Notes column.

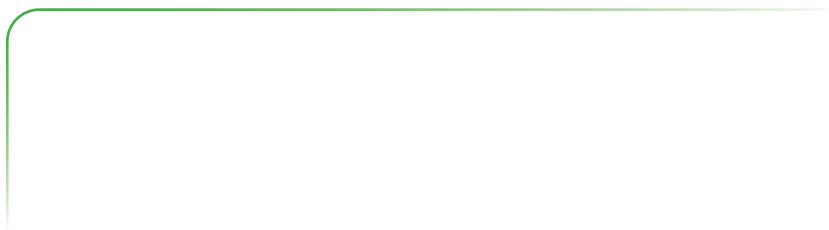
Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

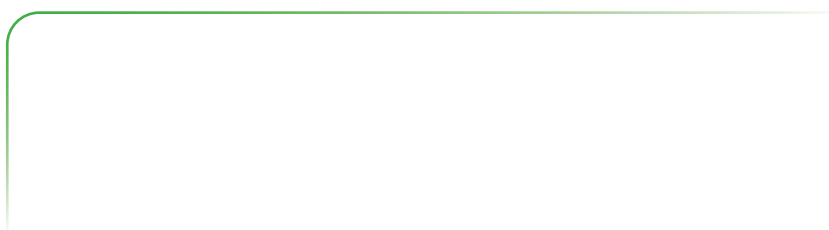
1. What theme may be suggested by words like *displeased*, *meanest*, *punishment*, and *example* in lines 7–10?



2. Why is the Calif so enraged in line 26?



3. Why does the Calif change his feeling toward Khasib so dramatically in line 53?



Demonstrate

When analyzing a character, consider what the character says and does. You can infer a character's traits based on their words and actions and how they are viewed by others. But remember that other characters' viewpoints are not always accurate. Complete the graphic organizer to analyze the characters of Khasib and the Calif.

Qualities of Khasib	Evidence from the Narrative that Demonstrates this Quality (Include line number.)
respected	Important people come to Egypt to visit him. (line 18)
Qualities of the Calif	Evidence from the Narrative that Demonstrates this Quality (Include line number.)

Exit Ticket

Share your answers to the chart with a partner. If you disagree with any of your partner's conclusions, respectfully explain why, using the text to support your opinion.

Finally, discuss the following question and write your answer in the space below:

- How does the Calif's character change during the story? What brings about this character change?



Second Focus: Analyzing Theme

Discover

Skill Focus: The *theme* of a story is the main idea about life that the author wants to communicate. To determine a story's theme, analyze key elements of the story including characters, plot, and point of view.

Read the excerpt again. Write *change* next to details that indicate a change in the Calif's character. Circle the event that causes this change.

Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What plot twist suggests that making Khasib ruler was not a good form of punishment?

2. What role does the large ruby play in the narrative?

3. Do you think the gift of a house is enough to compensate Khasib? Why or why not?

Demonstrate

In this story, how the characters change—or do not change—in response to the events communicates the theme. In the spaces in the boxes below, record events for the exposition, rising action, climax, falling action, and resolution.

Rising Action: events, problems, and conflict that build suspense or increase complications in the story.

Climax: the turning point of the story—the point of greatest conflict or intensity.

Falling Action: events that wrap up the story.

Climax

Falling Action

Rising Action

Exposition: beginning events that set up setting, situation, and characters.

Resolution: end of conflict.

Exit Ticket

1 Share your plot diagram with a partner. Did you have similar answers? Discuss any differences in where you placed the events.

Then discuss the following questions.

- What is the theme or central idea of the story?
- In what way is the poet crucial to communicating the theme of the story?

2 Write a paragraph explaining the theme of the story. Explain how the characters and events reveal the theme. In your paragraph, use direct quotations from the story to support your conclusions.

Third Focus: Comparing Stories

Discover

Skill Focus: When comparing two different stories, concentrate on analyzing the similarities and differences in the plot events and story arc (exposition, rising action, climax, falling action, and resolution). Examine how the main characters are alike or different in terms of their goals, the challenges they face, and the personal journeys they undergo.

Reread the excerpt from *The Travels of Ibn Battuta*. Then read the following text from *The Arabian Nights: Tales from a Thousand and One Nights*, which is a collection of stories from the Middle East and India that dates back to the 8th or 9th century. The adventures of Aladdin, Ali Baba, and Sinbad the Sailor are set within the frame story of King Shahryar and Scheherazade. Betrayed by his unfaithful wife (whom he executes), Shahryar vows to take out his revenge by marrying a new wife each night and killing her in the morning. When the king marries Scheherazade, she devises a plan to save herself: she tells the king a story but ends it with a cliffhanger, promising to finish it the following night. King Shahryar, intrigued by her story, allows her to live another day. This goes on for 1,001 nights until the king has fallen deeply in love with Scheherazade. This excerpt is just one of Scheherazade's many tales.

As you read, mark any similarities between the story told by Ibn Battuta and this tale with a plus sign (+). Mark any differences with a minus sign (–).

excerpt

The Arabian Nights: Tales from a Thousand and One Nights

“The Ruined Man Who Became Rich Again Through a Dream”

Translated by Sir Richard Burton

- 1 There lived once in Baghdad a wealthy man and made of
money, who lost all his substance and became so destitute that
he could earn his living only by hard labor. One night he lay
down to sleep dejected and heavyhearted, and saw in a dream
5 a speaker who said to him, “Verily thy fortune is in Cairo.
Go thither and seek it.” So he set out for Cairo, but when he
arrived there, evening overtook him and he lay down to sleep
in a mosque. Presently, by decree of Allah Almighty a band

Notes:

of bandits entered the mosque and made their way thence
10 into an adjoining house, but the owners, being aroused by
the noise of the thieves, awoke and cried out. Whereupon the
Chief of Police came to their aid with his officers.

The robbers made off, but the **Wali**⁸ entered the mosque,
and finding the man from Baghdad asleep there, laid hold of
15 him and beat him with palm rods so **grievous** a beating that
he was well-nigh dead. Then they cast him into jail, where
he abode three days, after which the Chief of Police sent for
him and asked him, "Whence art thou?" and he answered,
"From Baghdad." Quoth the Wali, "And what brought thee to
20 Cairo?" and quoth the Baghdadi, "I saw in a dream One who
said to me, 'Thy fortune is in Cairo. Go thither to it.' But when
I came to Cairo the fortune which he promised me proved to
be the palm rods thou so generously gavest to me."

The Wali laughed till he showed his wisdom teeth and
25 said, "O man of little wit, thrice have I seen in a dream
one who said to me: 'There is in Baghdad a house in such
a district and of such a fashion and its courtyard is laid out
gardenwise, at the lower end whereof is a jetting fountain
and under the same a great sum of money lieth buried. Go
30 thither and take it.' Yet I went not, but thou, of the briefness
of thy wit, hast journeyed from place to place on the faith of
a dream, which was but an idle **galimatias**⁹ of sleep."

Then he gave him money, saying, "Help thee back herewith
to thine own country," and he took the money and set out upon
30 his homeward march. Now the house the Wali had described
was the man's own house in Baghdad, so the **wayfarer** returned

8 **Wali**: a magistrate or governor

9 **galimatias**: meaningless talk, nonsense, gibberish

Notes:

thither and, digging underneath the fountain in his garden,
discovered a great treasure. And thus Allah gave him abundant
fortune, and a marvelous coincidence occurred.



Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

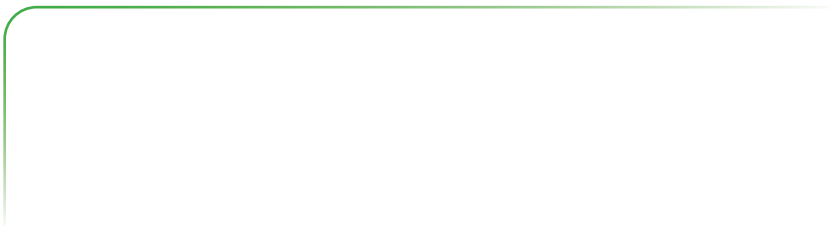
1. Is there a “marvelous coincidence” in Ibn Battuta’s narrative? If so, what is it?



2. What is the role of violence in both stories? Is it necessary? If so, why?



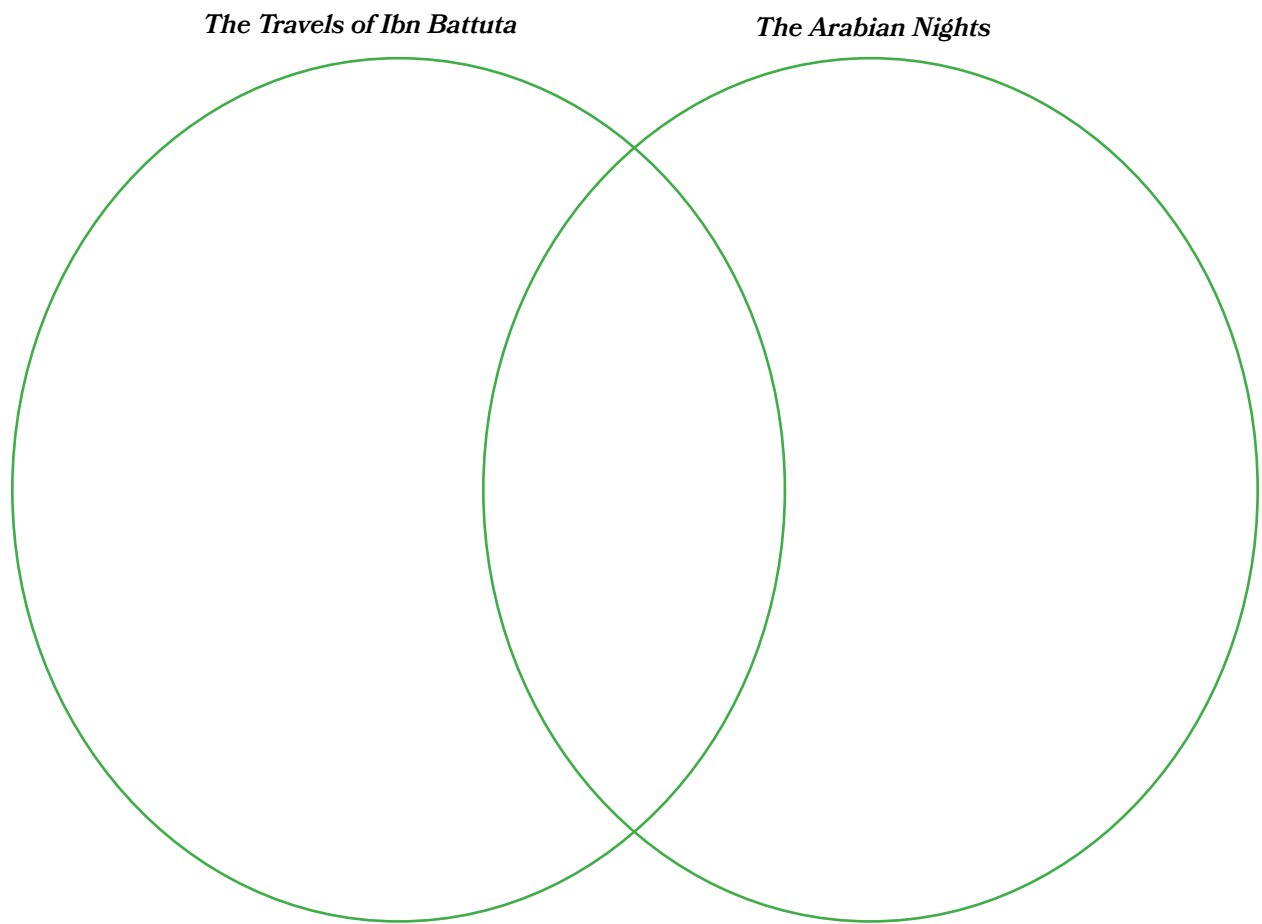
3. What role do the two dreams play in the story of “The Ruined Man”?



Demonstrate

Storytelling is very important within Arabic culture. Before the invention of the printing press and the availability of books, families and clans kept their history alive by telling stories. These tales were handed down from generation to generation as a way to preserve important events and record the faithfulness of their deities. In this way, stories also served to pass on religious and moral beliefs to future generations. Telling tales of adventure was also a form of entertainment; good storytellers could gather a large crowd. Using dramatic gestures, character voices, and audience participation, early storytellers could keep a crowd enthralled for hours. Using stories and songs to preserve history and cultural heritage is known as *oral tradition*.

What similarities and differences do you see between the story of Khasib in *Travels of Ibn Battuta* and the story of the man from Baghdad in *The Arabian Nights*? Consider similarities in the plots, characters, and themes of the story. Fill in the following chart with specific similarities and differences.



Exit Ticket

1 Based on your work in the graphic organizer, write a paragraph that describes similarities of the two texts. Refer to specific lines from the texts to support your ideas.

2 In groups of three or four, discuss the ways in which Khasib and the man from Baghdad's experiences are similar and different. Refer to your answers from the graphic organizer during your discussion. Collaborate to write a short summary of the similarities and differences between the texts.

Use these guidelines to guide your discussion and summary.

- Choose roles for each member, including leader, recorder, and timekeeper/gatekeeper, who makes sure everyone participates in the discussion.
- Before you begin your discussion, set ground rules to decide how you build consensus and ultimately make decisions.
- Listen actively to others' ideas and respond by building on their ideas.
- Stay on task by contributing relevant information and avoiding getting off-topic.
- Reflect on and adjust your response when other group members offer valid evidence.

When you are finished, evaluate how well your group collaborated to reach your goal. What did you do well? What needed improvement?

Review

In this chapter, you practiced analyzing characters, identifying theme, and comparing stories. Here are some examples of how questions on these skills might appear on standardized tests.

1. **Part A:** In *The Travels of Ibn Battuta*, the poet is brought before the Calif because

- A. he has been seen talking with Khasib.
- B. he wants to recite a poem he has written.
- C. he wants the Calif to forgive Khasib.
- D. he is suspected of having stolen a jewel.

Part B: Which excerpt from the passage provides the best support for the answer to the previous question?

- A. *When he had got to the end of the poem Khasib said, open this seam.*
- B. *. . . he then went to the street of the jewellers, and offered it for sale.*
- C. *He was told that such a stone could belong to none but the Calif.*
- D. *The Calif was then sorry for what he had done to Khasib . . .*

Explanation

- In the narrative, Khasib steals the jewel before he is blinded and banished. He gives the jewel to the poet, who then tries to sell it, but the jeweler is suspicious and has him arrested. The correct answer to Part A is choice D.
- While several of the excerpts in Part B relate to answer choices in Part A, only choice C gets to the correct situation. The jeweler could not believe that such a valuable stone could belong to anyone but the Calif—and certainly not to a poet.

2. Read this excerpt from *The Travels of Ibn Battuta*. Then answer the questions that follow.

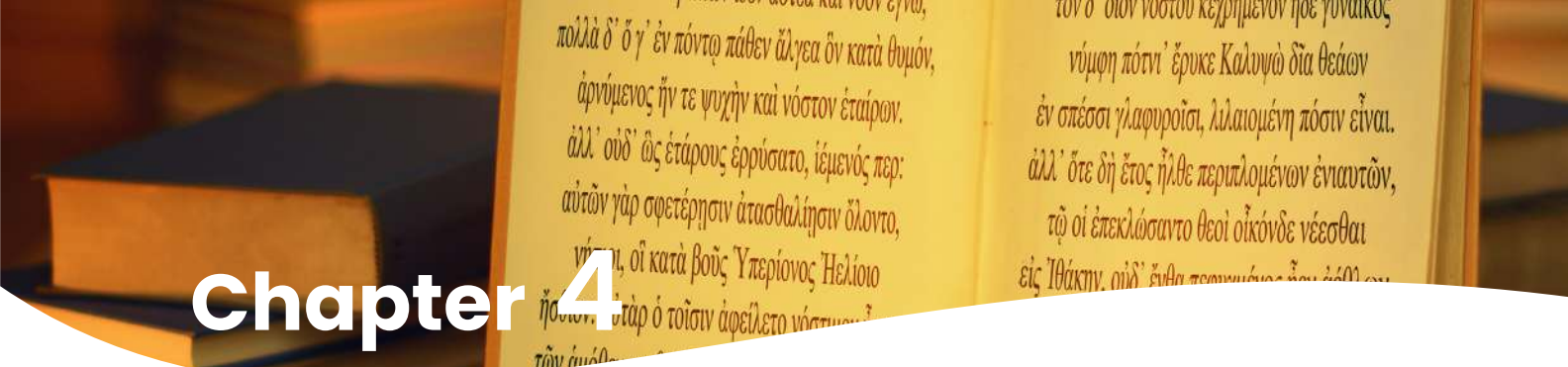
It is said, that one of the Califs of the house of Abbas was displeased with the people of Egypt, and took it into his head to place over them one of the meanest of his slaves, by way of punishment, and that he might afford an example to others.

Part A: Based on this passage, the reader can infer that the Calif is

- A. fair.
- B. humble.
- C. cruel.
- D. fickle.

Part B: Which lines from the passage best support the answer to Part A?

- A. *After a time this man presented himself to the Calif, who interrogated him as to his absence.*
 - B. *This enraged the Calif so that he ordered the eyes of Khasib to be put out, that he should be expelled from Egypt*
 - C. *When he came, the Calif gave him some splendid presents, and ordered that he should have whatever he might wish.*
 - D. *When I left him, I made no effort to follow his advice*
3. Both stories in this chapter
- A. featured wise and honorable leaders who guided the main characters.
 - B. emphasized the importance of being honest.
 - C. had main characters who suffered unfair reversals in their fortunes.
 - D. ended unhappily for the main character.
4. Which of the following lines from “The Ruined Man Who Became Rich Again Through a Dream” best supports the idea that stories are told to pass down a culture’s religious beliefs? Choose all that apply.
- A. *One night he lay down to sleep dejected and heavyhearted, and saw in a dream a speaker who said to him*
 - B. *Presently, by decree of Allah Almighty a band of bandits entered the mosque and made their way thence into an adjoining house,*
 - C. *evening overtook him and he lay down to sleep in a mosque.*
 - D. *But when I came to Cairo the fortune which he promised me proved to be the palm rods thou so generously gavest to me.*
 - E. *Yet I went not, but thou, of the briefness of thy wit, hast journeyed from place to place on the faith of a dream, which was but an idle galimatias of sleep.*
 - F. *Now the house the Wali had described was the man’s own house in Baghhdad, so the wayfarer returned thither and, digging underneath the fountain in his garden, discovered a great treasure.*
 - G. *And thus Allah gave him abundant fortune, and a marvelous coincidence occurred.*



Chapter 4

Analyzing Dramatic Irony

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- analyze interactions between characters and events.
- analyze the use of dramatic irony to build tension.
- analyze how a modern work transforms a scene from the *Odyssey*.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **character:** a person, animal, or figure represented in a literary work.
- **dramatic irony:** a situation in a drama in which the audience is more aware of the situation than the characters.
- **satire:** a literary work that exposes human weaknesses and ridicules or scorns them, usually by using humor.
- **tone:** a writer's attitude toward his writing or subject matter.

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. The show *Saturday Night Live* uses _____ to make fun of politicians, movie stars, and elements of modern society.
2. In *Romeo and Juliet*, the audience knows that Juliet is not truly dead, but Romeo is unaware of this _____ and tragically takes his own life.
3. The letter's formal _____ suggested that the bill required immediate attention.
4. My favorite _____ in the novel reminds me of my best friend and how much fun we always have together.

Preview Concepts

Why do you think many popular movies, books, and TV shows have followed the story of someone trying to get home? What is it in that situation that people find so compelling?

Think about a book you read or a movie or TV show you saw recently that was about someone trying to return home. It doesn't have to be a person! It can be an animal, an alien, or a robot. What made that story worth reading or watching? Write a response below.

Share your answers with a partner. In the space below, summarize the conclusions from your discussion.

Read for Understanding

The following excerpt is from the epic poem *The Odyssey* by Homer. *The Odyssey* (675–725 B.C.E.) has long been considered one of the great works of world literature. It tells the story of Greek hero Odysseus as he journeys home from the Trojan War. In this excerpt, Odysseus has finally returned to his home in Ithaca after years of difficult travel, only to discover that everyone thinks he is dead. His household is overrun by would-be suitors of his faithful wife, Penelope. These suitors stay in Odysseus's house, eating his food and picking fights with each other. Instead of announcing his return, Odysseus disguises himself as a beggar so he can investigate the situation. Only his son Telémakhos and the swineherd Eumaios know that Odysseus has returned.

As you read, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

The Odyssey (Book XVII)

by Homer

Translated by Robert Fitzgerald

1 So it looked as though Odysseus
had had his taste of what these men were like
and could return scot free to his own doorway—
but halting now before Antínoös

5 he made a little speech to him. Said he:
"Give a mite, friend. I would not say, myself,
you are the worst man of the young Akhaians.
The noblest, rather; kingly, by your look;
therefore you'll give more bread than others do.

10 Let me speak well of you as I pass on
over the boundless earth!

I, too, you know,

had fortune once, lived well, stood well with men,
and gave alms, often, to poor wanderers

Notes:

15 like this one that you see—aye, to all sorts,
no matter in what dire want. I owned
servants—many, god knows—and all the rest
that goes with being prosperous, as they say.
But Zeus the son of Kronos brought me down.

20 No telling
why he would have it, but he made me go
to Egypt with a company of rovers—
a long sail to the south—for my undoing.
Up the broad Nile and in to the river bank

25 I brought my dipping squadron. There, indeed,
I told the men to stand guard at the ships;
I sent patrols out—out to rising ground;
but reckless greed carried my crews away
to plunder the Egyptian farms; they bore off

30 wives and children, killed what men they found.
The news ran on the wind to the city, a night cry,
and sunrise brought both infantry and horsemen,
filling the river plain with dazzle of bronze;
then Zeus lord of lightning

35 threw my men into a blind panic; no one dared
stand against that host closing around us.
Their scything weapons left our dead in piles,
but some they took alive, into forced labor,
myself among them. And they gave me, then,

40 to one Dmêtôr, a traveller, son of Iasos,
who ruled at Kypros.
He conveyed me there.
From that place, working northward, miserably—”

Notes:

But here Antínoös broke in, shouting:

45 "God!

What evil wind blew in this pest?

Get over,

stand in the passage! Nudge my table, will you?

Egyptian whips are sweet

50 to what you'll come to here, you nosing rat,

making your pitch to everyone!

These men have bread to throw away on you

because it is not theirs. Who cares? Who spares

another's food, when he has more than plenty?"

55 With **guile** Odysseus drew away, then said:

"A pity that you have more looks than heart.

You'd grudge a pinch of salt from your own larder

to your own handy man. You sit here, fat

on others' meat, and cannot bring yourself

60 to rummage out a crust of bread for me!"

Then anger made Antínoös' heart beat hard,

and, **glowering** under his brows, he answered:

"Now!

You think you'll shuffle off and get away

65 after that impudence? Oh, no you don't!"

The stool he let fly hit the man's right shoulder

on the packed muscle under the shoulder blade—

like solid rock, for all the effect one saw.

Odysseus only shook his head, containing

Notes:

Notes:

70 thoughts of bloody work, as he walked on,
then sat, and dropped his loaded bag again
upon the door sill. Facing the whole crowd
he said, and eyed them all:

“One word only,

75 my lords, and suitors of the famous queen.
One thing I have to say.
There is no pain, no burden for the heart
when blows come to a man, and he defending
his own cattle—his own cows and lambs.

80 Here it was otherwise. Antínoös
hit me for being driven on by hunger—
how many bitter seas men cross for hunger!
If beggars interest the gods, if there are Furies
pent in the dark to avenge a poor man’s wrong, then may

85 Antínoös meet his death before his wedding day!”

Then said Eupéithês’ son, Antínoös:

“Enough.

Eat and be quiet where you are, or shamle elsewhere,
unless you want these lads to stop your mouth

90 pulling you by the heels, or hands and feet,
over the whole floor, till your back is peeled!”
But now the rest were mortified, and someone
spoke from the crowd of young bucks to rebuke him:

“A poor show, that—hitting this famished tramp—

95 bad business, if he happened to be a god.
You know they go in foreign **guise**, the gods do,
looking like strangers, turning up

in towns and settlements to keep an eye
on manners, good or bad."

100 But at this notion

Antínoös only shrugged.

Telémakhos,

after the blow his father bore, sat still
without a tear, though his heart felt the blow.

105 Slowly he shook his head from side to side,
containing murderous thoughts.

Penélopê

on the higher level of her room had heard
the blow, and knew who gave it. Now she murmured:

110 "Would god you could be hit yourself, Antínoös—
hit by Apollo's bowshot!"

And Eur'ynomê

her housekeeper, put in:

"He and no other?

115 If all we pray for came to pass, not one
would live till dawn!"

Her gentle mistress said:

"Oh, **Nan**¹, they are a bad lot; they intend
ruin for all of us; but Antínoös

120 appears a blacker-hearted hound than any.
Here is a poor man come, a wanderer,
driven by want to beg his bread, and everyone
in hall gave bits, to cram his bag—only
Antínoös threw a stool, and banged his shoulder!"

Notes:

1 **Nan:** Affectionate diminutive for an old woman.

125 So she described it, sitting in her chamber
among her maids—while her true lord was eating.
Then she called in the forester and said:

“Go to that man on my behalf, Eumaios,
and send him here, so I can greet and question him.
130 Abroad in the great world, he may have heard
rumors about Odysseus—may have known him!”

Then you replied—O swineherd!

“Ah, my queen,
if these Akhaian sprigs would hush their babble
135 the man could tell you tales to charm your heart.
Three days and nights I kept him in my hut;
he came straight off a ship, you know, to me.
There was no end to what he made me hear
of his hard roving; and I listened, eyes
140 upon him, as a man drinks in a tale
a minstrel sings—a minstrel taught by heaven
to touch the hearts of men. At such a song
the listener becomes **rapt** and still. Just so
I found myself enchanted by this man.
145 He claims an old tie with Odysseus, too—
in his home country, the Minoan land
of Krete. From Krete he came, a rolling stone
washed by the gales of life this way and that
to our own beach.

150 If he can be believed
he has news of Odysseus near at hand
alive, in the rich country of Thesprotia,
bringing a mass of treasure home.”

Notes:

First Focus: Analyzing Interactions Between Characters and Events

Discover

Skill Focus: An effective way to analyze a character is to pay close attention to their interactions with other characters. Consider how characters communicate, influence each other's actions and emotions, and even change one another through their interactions. Also observe how characters respond to the events in the story. Their reactions to problems and conflicts can reveal insights into their personalities and motivations and hint at possible changes they will undergo.

Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and draw a box around the tagline that introduces each character to signal each new speaker. In the Notes column, paraphrase what the speaker says. Also write questions you have about the passage in the Notes column.

Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. How would you characterize Antínoös based on the details in this excerpt? Give reasons for your answer.

2. What role does the swineherd play beginning in line 133?

3. How does Penelope feel about Antínoös?

Demonstrate

Odysseus has spent ten years trying to get from Troy back to his home in Ithaca—a journey that should have taken a few weeks! After years of fighting mythological monsters and dealing with revengeful gods, Odysseus is finally home. But wily Odysseus does not simply walk into his house. Instead, he disguises himself as a beggar to investigate the current state of affairs at home. He wants to see if his beloved wife, Penelope, is still the loving woman he left behind.

In the analysis of characters, Odysseus is the archetype of a hero. An *archetype* is a character, situation, or theme that occurs repeatedly in literature. An archetype is a universal symbol that is easily recognized by readers.

By analyzing how Odysseus interacts with his family, his enemies, and his kingdom upon his return, you can gain a deeper understanding of Homer’s exploration of human endurance, the complexities of heroism, and the importance of justice in restoring social order. The homecoming serves as a powerful conclusion that ties together the epic’s poem’s major themes of adventure, cunning, and moral responsibility.

Fill in the following chart to help you analyze the events in the excerpt. The major events in this excerpt are provided in the first column. Include a short quotation from the text explaining the event. An example is provided for you.

Event	Quotation from Text
1 Odysseus flatters Antínoös as he begs for some bread.	<i>"Give a mite, friend. I would not say, myself, you are the worst man of the young Akhaians. The noblest, rather; kingly, by your look; therefore you'll give more bread than others do."</i>

Event	Quotation from Text
2 Antínoös not only refuses; he insults Odysseus.	
3 Odysseus insults Antínoös, and Antínoös throws a chair at Odysseus.	
4 Odysseus curses Antínoös.	

continued on next page

Event	Quotation from Text
5 Penelope hears of the blow and asks Eumaios to send the beggar to her in case he has heard news about Odysseus.	
6 Eumaios says that the beggar stayed in his hut and has a connection to Odysseus.	

Exit Ticket

Share your answers to the chart above with a partner. Discuss any differences in your answers. If you disagree, provide relevant text evidence to support your claims. Then discuss the following questions:

- What other archetypes are found in this scene? Consider characters and situations.
- What other texts in different cultural and historical settings have similar characters, situations, and themes?
- Why do authors use archetypes?

In your discussion, use the term *archetype* correctly.

Second Focus: Analyzing Dramatic Irony

Discover

Skill Focus: One of the elements that makes this excerpt from *The Odyssey* so interesting is the use of dramatic irony. *Dramatic irony* is a literary device in which the reader and some of the characters have knowledge that the rest of the characters don't have.

This excerpt is just one scene from Odysseus's entire story. Odysseus is finally home, but his struggles are not over. This scene contributes to the success of the entire plot.

As you read the passage again, consider how the tension in the scene builds due to Odysseus's disguise. Place a star by lines that have a special meaning because the person who is speaking doesn't have the knowledge that the reader has.

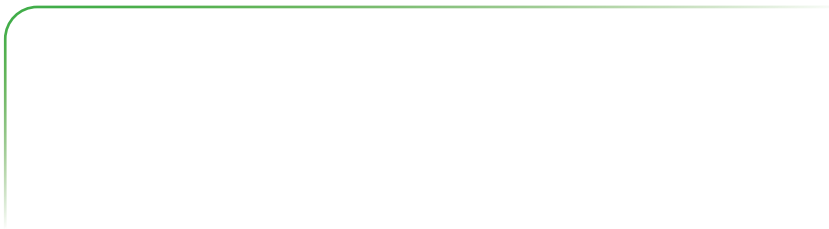
Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

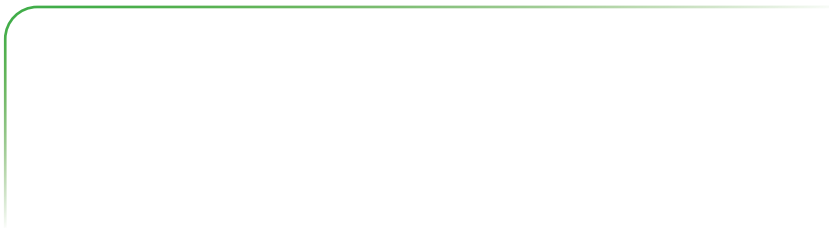
1. Why is it ironic that Antínoös accuses the beggar of impudence in line 65?



2. What makes Odysseus's curse in lines 84–85 especially ironic?



3. Are the housekeeper's words in lines 114–116 an example of dramatic irony? Why or why not?



Demonstrate

Dramatic irony is often used in plays and movies. A classic example occurs in *Romeo and Juliet* when Romeo, believing Juliet is dead, goes to her tomb and commits suicide. The audience knows that Juliet is actually in a deep sleep and has plans to run away with Romeo. As the audience watches Romeo pine for his lost Juliet, emotions are intensified by the knowledge that we have and that Romeo doesn't.

Analyze the dramatic irony in the excerpt by filling in the following chart. Some examples are provided for you. Fill in your own examples in the final rows.

Example from the Text	What is the character(s) saying?	Why is this an example of dramatic irony?
Give a mite, friend. I would not say, myself, you are the worst man of the young Akhaians. The noblest, rather; kingly, by your look; therefore you'll give more bread than others do . . . (lines 6–9)	Odysseus is asking a stranger to give him food. He flatters him, pretending to be a humble beggar.	We know that Odysseus is begging for his own bread and flattering a man who is trying to marry his own wife.
A poor show, that—hitting this famished tramp— bad business, if he happened to be a god. You know they go in foreign guise, the gods do, looking like strangers, turning up in towns and settlements to keep an eye on manners, good or bad. (lines 94–99)	The crowd warns Antínoös that the gods often appear as strangers to check on humans.	

Example from the Text	What is the character(s) saying?	Why is this an example of dramatic irony?

continued on next page

Example from the Text	What is the character(s) saying?	Why is this an example of dramatic irony?

Exit Ticket

Write a paragraph explaining the irony of the situation as Odysseus returns home from his travels. Explain specific lines of text that are ironic. Analyze how the dramatic irony adds tension and suspense to the scene. Finally, analyze how the scene contributes to the success of the plot as a whole, or the entire story of Odysseus's struggle to arrive home.

Discover

Skill Focus: When contemporary authors retell classic tales, they often put their own creative spin on the narrative by altering major plot points, introducing new characters, or shifting the setting to a different time and place. These updates can also change the tone, perhaps adding more humor, darker themes, or modern sensibilities that give a fresh perspective to the original story.

Read the excerpt from *The Odyssey* again. As you read, underline phrases that identify the unique time, place, and culture in which the action is set.

Then, watch the homecoming scene from the film *O Brother, Where Art Thou?* by Ethan and Joel Coen. Loosely based on *The Odyssey*, the movie follows the adventures of Ulysses Everett McGill and his cohorts Delmar and Pete in 1937 rural Mississippi. The trio escapes from a state penitentiary chain gang and attempts to reach McGill's home in Ithaca, Mississippi, to recover buried loot from a bank heist and to stop his wife Penny from remarrying. Along the way, they are waylaid by a series of strange characters—including beautiful women singing as they wash clothes in the river (Sirens!), a one-eyed Bible salesman, and a bank robber named George “Baby Face” Nelson. In the scene you will be viewing, McGill arrives in his hometown and finds his daughters singing at a campaign rally for a local politician.

As you watch, think about how the authors approach the story of a long-lost husband and father finally arriving home. What is the emotional tone? Use this viewers' guide to help you evaluate the scene.

Film Analysis Worksheet of *O Brother, Where Art Thou?* by Ethan and Joel Coen

Before Viewing:

Making Connections: Have you seen movies written or directed by the Coen brothers? What do you expect the movie to be like based upon what you know about the directors, the title, the actors, etc.?

continued on next page

Film Analysis Worksheet of *O Brother, Where Art Thou?* by Ethan and Joel Coen

During Viewing:

Cinematography: How does the film use color or light/dark to suggest tone and mood in the scene? Are there any striking uses of perspective (seeing through a character's eyes, camera angle, etc.)? How does this relate to the meaning of the scene?

Sound/Soundtrack: Is sound or silence used to enhance the film? (i.e. create drama, heighten tension, disorient the viewer, aid characterization, emphasize setting, etc.)

Characterization: How are the characters developed? What is their purpose in the scene? What do they do/ wear/say, etc., that establishes this purpose?

Setting: What is the setting? How do the location, setting, costumes, etc., establish the setting and tone?

Film Analysis Worksheet of *O Brother, Where Art Thou?* by Ethan and Joel Coen

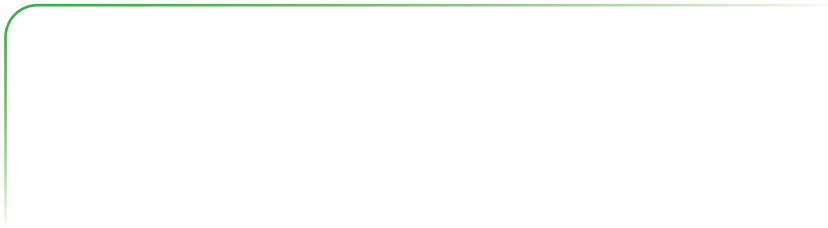
After Viewing:

Overall impressions: What did you like and dislike about the scene? What emotions did you experience? What other books and movies did the scene remind you of?

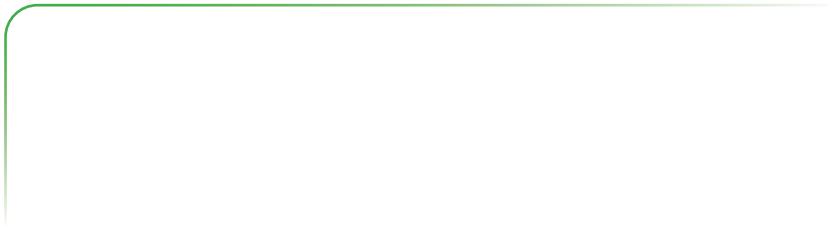
Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

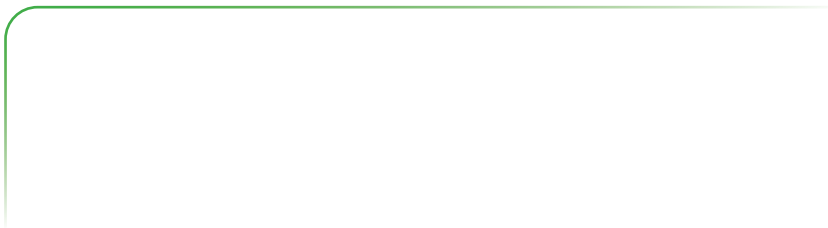
1. How are Odysseus and Everett alike? How are they different?



2. How are Penelope and Penny alike?



3. Why do the writers choose to have Everett use formal-sounding language such as *paterfamilias* and *succubus*?



Demonstrate

Many modern writers are inspired by classic works of literature. They may take a fairy tale, a myth, or a Shakespearean play and transform it into an entirely new work. Unexpected changes in the events, characters, or tone cause the audience—who are usually very familiar with the original work—to look at the story with fresh eyes as new complexities are added and previously unknown motivations are revealed. Sometimes the writer pokes fun at the original work by writing satire, a form of writing that uses humor to expose the weaknesses of the original work.

Often a writer transforms the original work by changing the tone. The tone of a literary work is the author’s attitude toward the subject matter, the characters, the settings, the plot—in short, the work itself. Tone can encompass a variety of emotions and attitudes, from darkly serious to lightly humorous, from optimistic to pessimistic, or from compassionate to dismissive.

Use the following organizer to compare the homecoming scenes from *The Odyssey* and *O Brother, Where Art Thou?* Include examples to support your conclusions about the two works.

	<i>The Odyssey</i>	<i>O Brother, Where Art Thou?</i>
Setting/ situation		
Main characters		

	<i>The Odyssey</i>	<i>O Brother, Where Art Thou?</i>
Events (Reception to the "Hero's" Return)		
Use of Language		
Tone		

Exit Ticket

- 1 Discuss with three or four classmates how the Coen brothers' approach to *The Odyssey* compares with Homer's approach in the original. Refer to your answers from the graphic organizer during your discussion.
- 2 Write a paragraph analyzing how the Coen brothers' homecoming scene transforms the original from *The Odyssey*. Refer to specific quotations from the excerpts to support your conclusions. Evaluate the effectiveness of the scene from *O Brother, Where Art Thou*

Review

In this chapter, you practiced using evidence from a reading passage to explore how interactions between characters build dramatic tension, and you identified examples of dramatic irony. The following questions are examples of how these skills may be tested on standardized tests.

1. **Part A:** Which best describes how the forester Eumaios feels about Odysseus disguised as the beggar?

- A. He mostly feels sorry for the man.
- B. He likes and greatly admires the man.
- C. He wishes the man would move on.
- D. He suspects the man is a god in disguise.

Part B: What evidence from the text best supports the answer to the previous question? Choose all that apply.

- A. *Three days and nights I kept him in my hut*
- B. *There was no end to what he made me hear*
- C. *I found myself enchanted by this man.*
- D. *He claims an old tie with Odysseus, too*

2. In the excerpt from *The Odyssey*, dramatic irony is created because the reader knows that

- A. Antínoös is hanging around Penelope's house because he wants to marry her.
- B. the beggar is really Odysseus in disguise.
- C. Penelope has been faithful to Odysseus.
- D. Antínoös is rude and arrogant.

3. **Part A:** Which of the following best describes the tone of *O Brother, Where Art Thou?*

- A. suspenseful
- B. humorous
- C. dramatic
- D. melancholic

Part B: Which of the following support your answer to Part A? Choose all that apply.

- A. It is set in 1937 Mississippi during the Depression.
- B. McGill has a daughter Penny never told him about.
- C. McGill's daughters are happy to see him.
- D. Penelope has told McGill's daughters that he was hit by a train.
- E. Waldrip defends Penny by hitting McGill in the nose.

Many tests will also contain questions over meanings of words in context. Answer the following questions.

4. Read this excerpt from *The Odyssey*.

Then anger made Antínoös' heart beat hard,
and, glowering under his brows, he answered:

"Now!|

You think you'll shuffle off and get away
after that impudence? Oh, no you don't!"

Part A: Which of the following is closest to the meaning of *impudence* as it is used in the passage?

- A. disrespect
- B. courage
- C. anger
- D. importance

Part B: Which of the following lines spoken by Odysseus provide the best evidence for the answer to Part A?

- A. *I, too, you know, had fortune once, lived well, stood well with men*
- B. *From that place, working northward, miserably—*
- C. *You sit here, fat on others' meat, and cannot bring yourself to rummage out a crust of bread for me!*
- D. *There is no pain, no burden for the heart when blows come to a man*



Chapter 5

Summarizing and Synthesizing Story Elements

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- summarize central ideas and events.
- analyze the relationship between cultural setting and story events.
- analyze how word choice communicates the author's perspective.
- analyze how an author draws on and transforms source material.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **connotation:** implied meaning of a word; emotional tone of a word
- **culture:** the beliefs, customs, arts, etc., of a particular society, group, place, or time.
- **character:** a person, animal, or figure represented in a literary work.
- **diction:** author's choice of words to create the tone and mood of a text
- **setting:** the time and place in which a narrative text occurs.
- **source material:** an original or previously written text on which another text is based.
- **structure:** how a text is organized, which usually involves a logical strategy.
- **summarize:** to explain the main points of a text.

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. After listening for more than two hours, it was impossible to _____ the candidate's speech.
2. The word *home* has a warm and comforting _____, often evoking feelings of safety, family, and belonging.
3. The problem and solution _____ of the research made the article much easier to understand.
4. Government documents use more formal _____ than is used in everyday conversation.

5. In the eerie _____ of the abandoned mansion, the howling wind and creaking floorboards heightened the suspense of the horror novel.
6. Many Asian _____ are influenced by the teachings of Buddha.
7. In the novel, the dynamic _____ undergoes significant personal growth and change throughout the story.
8. The _____ for James Joyce's famous novel *Ulysses* is *The Odyssey*.

Preview Concepts

How does the nature of a journey change when it's a race to the destination— when something valuable is at stake at the finish line? Does the destination become all that matters? Or does every aspect of the journey also become more important?

Have you ever seen the reality TV game show *The Amazing Race*? In the show, which began in 2001, teams compete with other teams in a race around the world. Contestants endure all kinds of travel hardships—including having to eat strange local foods along the way. If a million dollars were the prize, could you do it? Could you overcome your fears of the unknown and tackle any obstacle along the way?

Share your answers with a partner. In the space below, summarize the conclusions from your discussion.

Read for Understanding

The following excerpt is from one of the most famous travel novels of all time. It tells the story of Phileas Fogg, a nineteenth-century Englishman who accepts a bet that he can travel around the globe in 80 days. In this excerpt, Fogg and his servant Passepartout find themselves stuck in the countryside in India, a culture quite foreign to him in many ways, including its means of travel.

As you read, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

Around the World in Eighty Days

by Jules Verne

Chapter XI

IN WHICH PHILEAS FOGG SECURES A CURIOUS
MEANS OF CONVEYANCE AT A FABULOUS PRICE

1 The train stopped at eight o'clock in the midst of a glade
some fifteen miles beyond Rothal, where there were several
bungalows and workmen's cabins. The conductor, passing
along the carriages, shouted, "Passengers will get out here!"

5 Phileas Fogg looked at Sir Francis Cromarty for an
explanation, but the general could not tell what meant a halt
in the midst of this forest of dates and acacias.

Passepartout, not less surprised, rushed out and speedily
returned, crying: "Monsieur, no more railway!"

10 "What do you mean?" asked Sir Francis.

"I mean to say that the train isn't going on."

The general at once stepped out, while Phileas Fogg calmly
followed him, and they proceeded together to the conductor.

"Where are we?" asked Sir Francis.

15 "At the hamlet of Kholby."

"Do we stop here?"

"Certainly. The railway isn't finished."

Notes:

"What! Not finished?"

"No. There's still a matter of fifty miles to be laid from
20 here to Allahabad, where the line begins again."

"But the papers announced the opening of the railway
throughout."

"What would you have, Officer? The papers were mistaken."

"Yet you sell tickets from Bombay to Calcutta," retorted Sir
25 Francis, who was growing warm.

"No doubt," replied the conductor, "but the passengers
know that they must provide means of transportation for
themselves from Kholby to Allahabad."

Sir Francis was furious. Passepartout would willingly have
30 knocked the conductor down and did not dare to look at his
master.

"Sir Francis," said Mr. Fogg quietly, "we will, if you please,
look about for some means of conveyance to Allahabad."

"Mr. Fogg, this is a delay greatly to your disadvantage."

35 "No, Sir Francis; it was foreseen."

"What! You knew that the way—"

"Not at all, but I knew that some obstacle or other would
sooner or later arise on my route. Nothing, therefore, is lost.
I have two days, which I have already gained, to sacrifice. A
40 steamer leaves Calcutta for Hong Kong at noon on the 25th.
This is the 22nd, and we shall reach Calcutta in time."

There was nothing to say to so confident a response.

It was but too true that the railway came to a termination
at this point. The papers were like some watches, which have
45 a way of getting too fast, and had been premature in their
announcement of the completion of the line. The greater
part of the travellers were aware of this interruption, and

Notes:

leaving the train, they began to engage such vehicles as the village could provide: four-wheeled palkigharis, waggons
50 drawn by **zebus**¹, carriages that looked like **perambulating** pagodas, **palanquins**², ponies, and what not.

Mr. Fogg and Sir Francis Cromarty, after searching the village from end to end, came back without having found anything.

55 "I shall go afoot," said Phileas Fogg.

Passepartout, who had now rejoined his master, made a wry grimace as he thought of his magnificent but too frail Indian shoes. Happily he too had been looking about him, and after a moment's hesitation, said, "Monsieur, I think I
60 have found a means of conveyance."

"What?"

"An elephant! An elephant that belongs to an Indian who lives but a hundred steps from here."

"Let's go and see the elephant," replied Mr. Fogg.

65 They soon reached a small hut, near which, enclosed within some high palings, was the animal in question. An Indian came out of the hut and, at their request, conducted them within the enclosure. The elephant, which its owner had reared not for a beast of burden but for warlike purposes,
70 was half domesticated. The Indian had begun already, by often irritating him and feeding him every three months on sugar and butter, to impart to him a ferocity not in his nature, this method being often employed by those who train the Indian elephants for battle. Happily, however, for Mr. Fogg,
75 the animal's instruction in this direction had not gone far, and

1 **zebus**: very large domesticated oxen with a humped back

2 **palanquins**: enclosed seats, usually for one, carried on poles by men

Notes:

the elephant still preserved his natural gentleness. Kiouni—
this was the name of the beast—could doubtless travel
rapidly for a long time, and in default of any other means of
conveyance, Mr. Fogg resolved to hire him. But elephants are
80 far from cheap in India, where they are becoming scarce: the males,
which alone are suitable for circus shows, are much
sought, especially as but few of them are domesticated. When
therefore Mr. Fogg proposed to the Indian to hire Kiouni,
he refused point-blank. Mr. Fogg persisted, offering the
85 excessive sum of ten pounds an hour for the loan of the beast
to Allahabad. Refused. Twenty pounds? Refused also. Forty
pounds? Still refused. Passepartout jumped at each advance,
but the Indian declined to be tempted. Yet the offer was an
alluring one, for supposing it took the elephant fifteen hours
90 to reach Allahabad, his owner would receive no less than six
hundred pounds sterling.

Phileas Fogg, without getting in the least flurried, then
proposed to purchase the animal outright and at first offered
a thousand pounds for him. The Indian, perhaps thinking he
95 was going to make a great bargain, still refused.

Sir Francis Cromarty took Mr. Fogg aside and begged
him to reflect before he went any further; to which that
gentleman replied that he was not in the habit of acting
rashly, that a bet of twenty thousand pounds was at stake,
that the elephant was absolutely necessary to him, and that
100 he would secure him if he had to pay twenty times his value.
Returning to the Indian, whose small, sharp eyes, glistening
with **avarice**, betrayed that with him it was only a question
of how great a price he could obtain. Mr. Fogg offered first
twelve hundred, then fifteen hundred, eighteen hundred,

Notes:

105 two thousand pounds. Passepartout, usually so **rubicund**, was fairly white with suspense.

At two thousand pounds the Indian yielded.

"What a price, good heavens!" cried Passepartout, "for an elephant."

110 It only remained now to find a guide, which was comparatively easy. A young Parsee with an intelligent face offered his services, which Mr. Fogg accepted, promising so generous a reward as to materially stimulate his zeal. The elephant was led out and equipped. The Parsee, who was an
115 accomplished elephant driver, covered his back with a sort of saddle-cloth and attached to each of his flanks some curiously uncomfortable **howdahs**³. Phileas Fogg paid the Indian with some banknotes, which he extracted from the famous carpet-bag, a proceeding that seemed to deprive poor Passepartout
120 of his vitals. Then he offered to carry Sir Francis to Allahabad, which the brigadier gratefully accepted, as one traveller the more would not be likely to fatigue the gigantic beast. Provisions were purchased at Kholby, and while Sir Francis and Mr. Fogg took the howdahs on either side, Passepartout
125 got astride the saddle-cloth between them. The Parsee perched himself on the elephant's neck, and at nine o'clock they set out from the village, the animal marching off through the dense forest of palms by the shortest cut.

Notes:

3 **howdahs**: seats or platforms, often with a cover or canopy, attached to an elephant or camel

First Focus: Summarizing Text

Discover

Skill Focus: A summary is a restatement of the main points from a text. When summarizing an excerpt, capture the key ideas and important details in your own words without including minor examples or unnecessary descriptions.

Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and focus on the problem Fogg faces and his efforts to work out a solution. Underline where he is, where he wants to go, and how he will get there. Record any thoughts, comments, or questions you have in the Notes column.

Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. How is Passepartout the solution to Fogg's problem?

2. Why is Mr. Fogg so intent upon purchasing the elephant at any price?

3. What do you predict will happen in the narrative based on the detail in the last paragraph?

Demonstrate

Summarizing a text is a good exercise to make sure you comprehend the main ideas of a text. Remember that a summary includes only the most important ideas in the text. A good summary maintains the meaning and logical order of the text. One method of writing a summary is to use the six research questions to gather the important facts: *Who?* *What?* *Where?* *When?* *Why?* and *How?* Fill in the following chart with the answers to these questions. Provide evidence from the text to support your answers.

Who?
What?
Where?

continued on the next page

When?
Why?
How?

Focus on Experiencing World Cultures

One of the conflicts in this passage is caused by the fact that the characters are unfamiliar with the cultures of India. Culture includes the beliefs, customs, and way of life of a group of people. When travelers undertake to understand and participate in the culture of a country, we call this a “cultural experience.”

Culture affects a writer’s point of view and changes their opinion of events. For example, in the excerpt Fogg and the elephant’s owner spend much time haggling on a price for the elephant. This type of arguing over price is common in some cultures, but in other cultures the seller would consider it insulting for people to bargain about the cost of a good or service. In the space below, identify another example of Indian culture that is different from or similar to the culture in which you have grown up.

Exit Ticket

Write a short, one-paragraph summary of the scene based on your answers in the graphic organizer. Make sure your summary maintains the meaning and logical order of the story's events. Explain how culture impacted the events in the story.





Second Focus: Relating Structure to Story Elements

Discover

Skill Focus: Skilled authors write individual scenes by arranging a sequence of events, dialogue, and character actions that move the story forward while building suspense and increasing the readers' interest. The use of complications and cliffhangers increases the dramatic tension and leaves readers anxiously waiting to see how conflicts will be resolved.

Read the excerpt again. As you read and listen, focus on how the author structures the scene around a problem and its solution. Think about how both the problem and solution are related to the setting and how Phileas Fogg must adapt to a culture that is foreign to him.

Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What does Fogg mean in line 35 when he says that this problem was “foreseen”?

2. What exact moment or line do you consider the turning point of the plot?

3. How would the story be different if it had been told by Passepartout?

Demonstrate

When an author structures a scene, they must blend elements of setting, character, and plot to create and maintain dramatic tension. In the excerpt from *Around the World in Eighty Days*, the setting and culture of 19th-century India play a major part in both Fogg's problem and the solution he ultimately finds to his problem.

Also, the way complex characters interact helps move the story toward a solution. Notice that Passepartout is a foil to Phileas Fogg. A foil is a character that shows qualities in contrast to another character. The humble servant Passepartout provides a contrast to the overly confident Fogg. The interactions of these two characters create interest as they pursue a solution to the conflict.

Complete the chart to explore how the structure, setting, character, and conflict unite to create dramatic tension.

PROBLEM: Phileas Fogg must find a new "means of conveyance" to continue his travels and stay on schedule.	
What role does the historical and cultural setting play in the problem? Fogg is unaware that the railway system in India is not finished.	Evidence from text:

SOLUTION: Phileas Fogg buys an elephant and hires a guide to lead them to Calcutta.

What role does the historical and cultural setting play in the solution?

Evidence from text:

What role does characterization play in the solution?

Evidence from text:

Third Focus: Evaluating the Effects of Word Choice

Discover

Skill Focus: A writer's word choice, or diction, communicates the writer's opinions about their experiences. This is because words have connotations, or implied meanings. *Connotation* is the emotional component of word meanings. Two words may have similar denotations (dictionary meanings), but their connotation (implied meaning) may be different.

Reread the excerpt from *Around the World in Eighty Days*. Then read the following excerpt from the book *Around the World in 80 Days with Michael Palin*. The book is a companion volume to a popular British TV series of the same name. For the series, actor and comedian Palin was given the challenge of traveling Fogg's route around the world in eighty days or less—without traveling by airplane.

As you read each work, focus on the challenges involved in both the fictional and nonfiction narratives of traveling around the world by land and sea. Underline words that communicate Palin's perspective about his experiences in India. Pay special attention to words that describe his emotional experience of this new culture.

excerpt

Around the World in 80 Days with Michael Palin

by Michael Palin

Day 26

- 1 "It's out of the question for a sane man to spend his life
jumping from a steamer onto a train and from a train onto a
steamer, on the pretext of going round the world in 80 days!
No, all these antics will come to an end in Bombay, you can
5 be sure of that."

- I pondered on Passepartout's words as I lay in bed after
waking at dawn from a night during which my room had
very gently rocked from side to side. Passepartout's gloomy
prediction is nearer to my experience than his own. He and
10 Fogg arrived here in eighteen days, and left on a train across

Notes:

India within three and a half hours, during which time Fogg saw nothing of the city save for the inside of the station restaurant, where he was served with cat disguised as rabbit.

I'm eight days behind Fogg, and as yet I have no onward

15 passage from Madras to Singapore. The **dhow**¹ was a wonderful week out of life; now the realities must be faced and some clear thinking done. But somehow Bombay is not the best city, nor India the best sub-continent for clear thinking.

20 It's quiet now on the **quayside** below me, though I'm sure I heard marching bands and a confusion of drumbeats and explosions in the early hours. All I can see from my window are children and streetsellers around the Gate of India and pigeons wheeling and flapping about the **facade** of the

25 hotel. The fussy little balconies and turrets which project from every sea-view room are a pigeon's delight and, judging by the thick **encrustations** of bird lime, have been since the hotel was opened eighty years ago. Walk down to breakfast. The layout of rooms along open galleries leading off a

30 central staircase gives the impression of a **sumptuous** prison. There are huge arrangements of flowers about the place and I make the mistake of asking the lady who's setting them out if they're real.

"Of course they're real," she replies admonitorily, "this is

35 India, not Hong Kong."

I glean from her the reason for the unnatural quiet on the Apollo Bunder and the noises in the early hours which, like another traveller in the Indies, Waugh's Gilbert Pinfold, I'd begun to think were my imaginings. Today is

40 a festival day called Durga Puja, the climax of a ten-day

1 **dhow**: a sailing vessel

Notes:

celebration of the triumph of good over evil. There are at least seven different New Years in India, depending on when the harvest is brought in. **Effigies** up to 50 feet tall will be carried through the streets and destroyed
45 to commemorate the killing of the evil king Ravana of Sri Lanka by Lord Rama. The celebration of myth and the belief in the supernatural is an important part of Indian life, and on this festival day it is customary to bless whatever brings you your livelihood. . . .

50 The oldest surviving English building in Bombay is a more modest affair than the Victoria Terminal. It's a church with a simple perpendicular tower, completed in 1718 and full of sad memorials to those who, by and large, died young and far away from home. Of "cholera,
55 aged 32," of "wounds received at Lucknow, in the mutiny, aged 23." Now it is St. Thomas's Cathedral, the main Christian church of Bombay. I assume wrongly that it is frequented by the English community, but the priest in charge tells me that the congregation consists entirely of
60 native Christians and that Christianity, far from being a relic of the Raj, is the third most popular religion in India, after Hinduism and Islam.

The key to India's remarkable success as the world's largest democracy is, he says, tolerance. There are sixteen
65 different religions in India and all respect each other. There are, on one Indian banknote, fourteen different languages, all of which are protected.

On my way back to the hotel, I find the road blocked by chanting crowds who are milling around slow-moving
70 trucks carrying effigies of the goddess Kali and making

Notes:

a lot of noise; banging cymbals, dancing and singing.
They have crimson powder all over them and the Indian
photographer who is with me says that their wild stares
are probably the result of a certain amount of **ganja**².

75 "Join in!" he urges, and leaving me to be swept along
towards the Gate of India he rushes off to get some shots.
I don't know what's happening, except that I'm the only
white man there and I'm being carried along in the crush
toward the great arch and the sea. At about the spot
80 where I landed yesterday they begin to submerge their
goddesses, tossing in garlands, offerings in small clay pots
and, very often, themselves. Some of the more intense
disappear beneath the muddy waters for a minute or more,
to reappear jubilantly soaked. There is an edge of **hysteria**
85 which I'm glad to escape from unscathed.

Day 27

Extraordinary night of dreams. A series of benevolent
nightmares on the theme of travelling but never arriving.
Recurring images of friends and home veering wildly from
90 the modern (new information systems being installed at Swiss
Cottage underground) to a **Hardyesque**³ world of country pubs
and masques and morris dances. An Indian postal official dumps
his sports bag in my car, I try desperately to ring my wife and
tell her why I'm in Washington D.C. with George Harrison and
95 the next moment I'm driving a Mini over a ploughed field. The
reality is that I'm in India, which is more bizarre than any of my
dreams. I read in my *Times of India* at breakfast that fourteen
people were killed yesterday in a stampede at Jamshedpur
during the immersion of their goddess in the local river.

² **ganja**: marijuana, especially a potent variety used for smoking

³ **Hardyesque**: a reference to 19th century English writer Thomas Hardy

Notes:

100 Taxi to Victoria Terminal to collect my rail tickets for tomorrow. On the way we pass a shop called Dogy Items and another **mellifluously** named The Lovely Steel Centre. Traffic conditions in Bombay are anarchic. Pedestrians and cows have as much right to be in the road as cars and this makes
105 for a constant disorderly fight for space. My cab has a sticker on the dashboard which reads "Trust in God."

Notes:



During the Durga Puja festival, devotees take a statue of Durga to be immersed in the river.

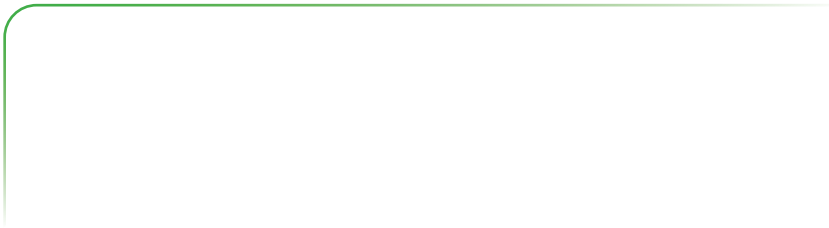
Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

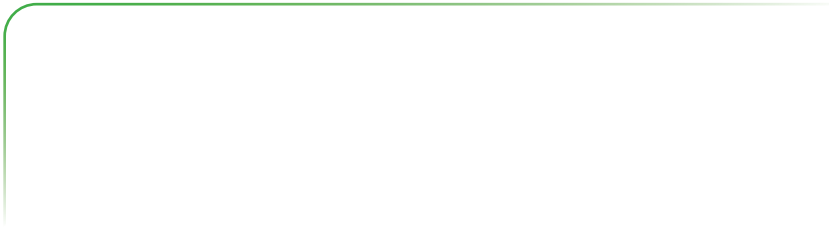
1. Can you find examples of imagery that appeal to each of the five senses in this passage?



2. Why do you think Palin endorses the priest's claim that the key to India's success is tolerance?



3. Why does Palin have nightmares about "travelling but never arriving"?



Demonstrate

The specific words an author selects when writing reveal a lot about the mood, imagery, and tone they are trying to create for the reader. By analyzing an author's precise diction, you can get a better sense of their writing style and the deeper meanings or perspectives they are conveying. As you know, the connotation of an author's words affects the message they are communicating to the reader.

Use the chart on the next page to help you identify words and phrases that imply Palin's perspective about his experiences. For each element in the first column, identify a detail from the text. Use a dictionary if needed to look up any unfamiliar words before filling in the third column.

Description of	Word or Phrase	Implied Meaning and Perspective
Hotel	<i>fussy little balconies and turrets</i> (line 25)	He thinks the architecture is overly detailed and unnecessary.
Religious diversity in India		
Celebration of Durga Puja		
His dreams		
Traffic		

Exit Ticket

- 1 With a partner, share your answers to the chart. Then discuss the question:
 - In general, what does the author's word choice imply about the author's thoughts about his experiences in India?
- 2 Write a paragraph in which you analyze Palin's thoughts about his time in Mumbai based on his word choice. Include specific references to words and phrases (and line numbers) from the chart above and what you learned during your discussion.

Focus on Drawing on Source Material

Michael Palin's book and TV series are directly inspired by the famous Jules Verne novel. Complete the following chart to explore ways in which Palin's real-life travels draw on details and elements of Phileas Fogg's fictional travels in the novel. For each element listed for the novel, find a detail or reference in the Palin text that either mentions details from the novel or parallels experiences of the original text.

Elements of Jules Verne's <i>Around the World in Eighty Days</i>	Details from Michael Palin's <i>Around the World in 80 Days</i>
Trying to keep to a time schedule	
Employing various means of travel	
Experiencing new cultures for the first time	

Exit Ticket

With a group of three or four, discuss the ways in which Palin's book is based on Verne's, and how it even makes direct references to it as a source. Refer to your answers from the graphic organizer to help you in your discussion.

Review

This chapter covered summarizing a text, understanding how structure supports the theme of a text, and analyzing how word choice reveals the author's perspective. The following questions model how you might be tested over these skills on standardized tests.

1. **Part A:** Why does Phileas Fogg agree to pay two thousand pounds for an elephant?

- A. He believes it is cheaper than renting the elephant.
- B. He learns it is a fair price for a trained elephant.
- C. He knows he can later sell it for as much or more.
- D. He figures it is worth it if it helps win his bet.

Part B: Which excerpt from the passage best supports the answer to Part A?

- A. *But elephants are far from cheap in India, where they are becoming scarce, the males, which alone are suitable for circus shows, are much sought*
 - B. *Phileas Fogg without getting in the least flurried then proposed to purchase the animal outright*
 - C. *to which that gentleman replied that he was not in the habit of acting rashly, that a bet of twenty thousand pounds was at stake*
 - D. *Phileas Fogg paid the Indian with some banknotes which he extracted from the famous carpet-bag*
2. Which of the following best summarizes the excerpt from *Around the World in Eighty Days* by Jules Verne?
- A. Fogg and an Indian get into a bidding war over the price of an elephant.
 - B. Fogg and Passepartout undertake a challenge to travel around the world in eighty days.
 - C. When Fogg's progress is prevented by an unfinished railroad, he buys an elephant to convey him across India.
 - D. In India, travelers use a variety of methods of travel, including wagons, carriages, and palanquins.

3. Read this sentence from the Palin excerpt.

I don't know what's happening, except that I'm the only white man there and I'm being carried along in the crush toward the great arch and the sea.

Part A: Which of the following is closest to the meaning of crush as used in the passage above?

- A. a pushing crowd
- B. a brief infatuation
- C. a strong embrace
- D. a forceful end

Part B: Which phrase from the excerpt supports the answer to Part A?

- A. *I don't know what's happening*
- B. *I'm the only white man there*
- C. *I'm being carried along*
- D. *toward the great arch and the sea*

4. Read the following excerpt from *Around the World in Eighty Days with Michael Palin*. Then answer the question that follows.

"It's out of the question for a sane man to spend his life jumping from a steamer onto a train and from a train onto a steamer, on the pretext of going round the world in 80 days! No, all these antics will come to an end in Bombay, you can be sure of that."

I pondered on Passepartout's words as I lay in bed after waking at dawn from a night during which my room had very gently rocked from side to side. Passepartout's gloomy prediction is nearer to my experience than his own. He and Fogg arrived here in eighteen days, and left on a train across India within three and a half hours, during which time Fogg saw nothing of the city save for the inside of the station restaurant, where he was served with cat disguised as rabbit.

Which of the following best explains the reason for Palin's references to Phileas Fogg and Passepartout?

- A. He wants to remind the reader that his book is a work of nonfiction.
- B. He imagines what it would have been like to travel with the two men.
- C. He has fallen behind in his efforts to keep pace with the fictional travelers.
- D. He believes Passepartout's comments offer some insight into India.



Chapter 6

Analyzing Perspectives in a Coming-of-Age Story

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- cite textual evidence when making inferences about texts.
- analyze how shifting points of view and tone impact the author's style.
- analyze plot elements of a coming-of-age story, including conflicting perspectives.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **characterization**: how an author develops an individual in a work of fiction.
- **coming-of-age story**: a story in which a young main character faces a struggle that causes him or her to mature or become an adult.
- **conflict**: the struggle or tension between opposing forces or elements within a story.
- **setting**: the time, place, and circumstances in which a story occurs or develops.
- **plot**: the plan or main story of a dramatic or literary work.
- **theme**: the underlying message or big idea of a talk, book, film, or other work.
- **tone**: the author or speaker's attitude toward a subject, evident through diction or the viewpoint of an author or speaker on a particular subject.

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. The _____ in some works of science fiction is the struggle between humans and technology.
2. Though the poem's _____ seemed lighthearted, I had a feeling it would take a more serious turn by the end.
3. The historical novel's _____ was Texas in 1856.
4. The author's _____ of the princess as an independent and intelligent woman was a welcome contrast to princesses in traditional fairy tales.

5. The _____ of the story involves a character who goes on a perilous journey to find her brother, who has been kidnapped.
6. A common _____ of popular movies is “Always be true to yourself.”
7. *To Kill a Mockingbird* is a _____ in which a young girl named Scout comes to understand the racism within her small town.

Preview Concepts

In this chapter, you will read about a young girl who loves to roam the natural world near her home. What are ways people can interact with the natural world? What experiences have you had with the natural world? Put a checkmark in the chart below to show ways that you and others you know have expressed or would like to express their love of nature. Add your own ideas to the blank rows in the chart.

	Walking or hiking in woods
	Visiting a beach
	Planting flowers or vegetables
	Camping in a state or national park
	Climbing a mountain
	Taking care of wildlife
	Volunteering or donating money to organizations that fund wildlife or environmental preservation
	Birdwatching

Share your answers with a partner. Discuss which things you've done or would like to do and give reasons why you feel those things are important. Summarize your conclusions from your discussion.

Read for Understanding

The following passage is from “A White Heron” by Sarah Orne Jewett. Note that this is an excerpt from the story. Summaries are provided to briefly explain what happens in the missing text. As you read, think about key ideas. What is this story mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out to you? Annotate the text and put Notes in the sidebar. Also, note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

Excerpt

A White Heron

by Sarah Orne Jewett

(Sylvia lives with her grandmother, Mrs. Tilley, in a small house in a rural area surrounded by woods.)

... Sylvia wondered what her grandmother would say because they [she and the cow] were so late. It was a great while since she had left home at half past five o'clock, but everybody knew the difficulty of making this errand a short one.

5 Mrs. Tilley had chased the horned torment too many summer evenings herself to blame anyone else for **lingering**, and was only thankful as she waited that she had Sylvia, nowadays, to give such valuable assistance. The good woman suspected that Sylvia **loitered** occasionally on her own account; there never
10 was such a child for straying about out-of-doors since the world was made! Everybody said that it was a good change for a little maid who had tried to grow for eight years in a crowded manufacturing town, but, as for Sylvia herself, it seemed as if she never had been alive at all before she came to live at the
15 farm. She thought often with wistful compassion of a wretched dry geranium that belonged to a town neighbor.

" 'Afraid of folks,' " old Mrs. Tilley said to herself, with a smile, after she had made the unlikely choice of Sylvia from her

Notes:

daughter's houseful of children, and was returning to the farm. "

20 'Afraid of folks,' they said! I guess she won't be troubled no great
with 'em up to the old place!" When they reached the door of
the lonely house and stopped to unlock it, and the cat came to
purr loudly, and rub against them, a deserted [cat], indeed, but
fat with young robins, Sylvia whispered that this was a beautiful
25 place to live in, and she never should wish to go home.

.....

*(Sylvia hears a whistle in the woods and meets a hunter
(sportsman). She is frightened of this stranger, but she agrees
to bring him to her grandmother's house. He explains that he is
hunting a white heron, and her grandmother allows him to stay
30 with them while he searches for the bird. Sylvia's grandmother
reveals that Sylvia knows the woods well, and animals seem
drawn to her. This interests the hunter, who says he will give ten
dollars to anyone who can lead him to the heron.)*

.....

The next day the young sportsman hovered about the
35 woods, and Sylvia kept him company, having lost her first fear of
the friendly lad, who proved to be most kind and **sympathetic**.
He told her many things about the birds and what they knew
and where they lived and what they did with themselves. And
he gave her a jack-knife, which she thought as great a treasure
40 as if she were a desert-islander. All day long he did not once
make her troubled or afraid except when he brought down some
unsuspecting singing creature from its bough. Sylvia would have
liked him vastly better without his gun; she could not understand
why he killed the very birds he seemed to like so much. But as
45 the day waned, Sylvia still watched the young man with loving
admiration. She had never seen anybody so charming and

Notes:

delightful; the woman's heart, asleep in the child, was vaguely thrilled by a dream of love. Some **premonition** of that great power stirred and swayed these young foresters who **traversed** the
50 solemn woodlands with soft-footed silent care. They stopped to listen to a bird's song; they pressed forward again eagerly, parting the branches—speaking to each other rarely and in whispers; the young man going first and Sylvia following, fascinated, a few steps behind, with her gray eyes dark with excitement.

55 She grieved because the longed-for white heron was **elusive**, but she did not lead the guest, she only followed, and there was no such thing as speaking first. The sound of her own unquestioned voice would have terrified her—it was hard enough to answer yes or no when there was need of that. At last evening
60 began to fall, and they drove the cow home together, and Sylvia smiled with pleasure when they came to the place where she heard the whistle and was afraid only the night before.

.....

(That night, Sylvia struggles to fall asleep. The next day, she climbs a tall pine tree in the woods to try to find the heron.)

.....

65 The birds sang louder and louder. At last the sun came up bewilderingly bright. Sylvia could see the white sails of ships out at sea, and the clouds that were purple and rose-colored and yellow at first began to fade away. Where was the white heron's nest in the sea of green branches, and was this wonderful sight
70 and pageant of the world the only reward for having climbed to such a giddy height? Now look down again, Sylvia, where the green marsh is set among the shining birches and dark hemlocks; there where you saw the white heron once you will see him again; look, look! a white spot of him like a single floating feather comes

Notes:

75 up from the dead hemlock and grows larger, and rises, and
comes close at last, and goes by the landmark pine with
steady sweep of wing and outstretched slender neck and
crested head. And wait! wait! do not move a foot or a finger,
little girl, do not send an arrow of light and consciousness
80 from your two eager eyes, for the heron has perched on a pine
bough not far beyond yours, and cries back to his mate on the
nest, and plumes his feathers for the new day!

The child gives a long sigh a minute later when a company
of shouting cat-birds comes also to the tree, and **vexed** by
85 their fluttering and lawlessness the **solemn** heron goes away.
She knows his secret now, the wild, light, slender bird that
floats and wavers, and goes back like an arrow presently to his
home in the green world beneath. Then Sylvia, well satisfied,
makes her perilous way down again, not daring to look far
90 below the branch she stands on, ready to cry sometimes
because her fingers ache and her lamed feet slip. Wondering
over and over again what the stranger would say to her, and
what he would think when she told him how to find his way
straight to the heron's nest.

95 "Sylvy, Sylvy!" called the busy old grandmother again and
again, but nobody answered, and the small husk bed was
empty, and Sylvia had disappeared.

The guest waked from a dream, and remembering his
day's pleasure hurried to dress himself that it might sooner
100 begin. He was sure from the way the shy little girl looked
once or twice yesterday that she had at least seen the white
heron, and now she must really be persuaded to tell. Here she
comes now, paler than ever, and her worn old frock is torn and
tattered, and smeared with pine pitch¹. The grandmother and

1 **pine pitch**: a sticky substance that a pine tree produces when a wound is formed

Notes:

105 the sportsman stand in the door together and question her, and
the splendid moment had come to speak of the dead hemlock-
tree by the green marsh.

But Sylvia does not speak after all, though the old
grandmother fretfully **rebukes** her, and the young man's kind
110 appealing eyes are looking straight in her own. He can make
them rich with money; he has promised it, and they are poor
now. He is so well worth making happy, and he waits to hear
the story she can tell.

No, she must keep silence! What is it that suddenly
115 forbids her and makes her dumb? Has she been nine years
growing, and now, when the great world for the first time puts
out a hand to her, must she thrust it aside for a bird's sake?
The murmur of the pine's green branches is in her ears, she
remembers how the white heron came flying through the
120 golden air and how they watched the sea and the morning
together, and Sylvia cannot speak; she cannot tell the heron's
secret and give its life away.

Dear loyalty, that suffered a sharp pang as the guest went
away disappointed later in the day, that could have served and
125 followed him and loved him as a dog loves! Many a night Sylvia
heard the echo of his whistle haunting the pasture path as she
came home with the loitering cow. She forgot even her sorrow
at the sharp report of his gun and the piteous sight of thrushes
and sparrows dropping silent to the ground, their songs hushed
130 and their pretty feathers stained and wet with blood. Were the
birds better friends than their hunter might have been, — who
can tell? Whatever treasures were lost to her, woodlands and
summertime, remember! Bring your gifts and graces and tell
your secrets to this lonely country child!

Notes:

First Focus: Making Inferences About Conflicting Perspectives

Discover

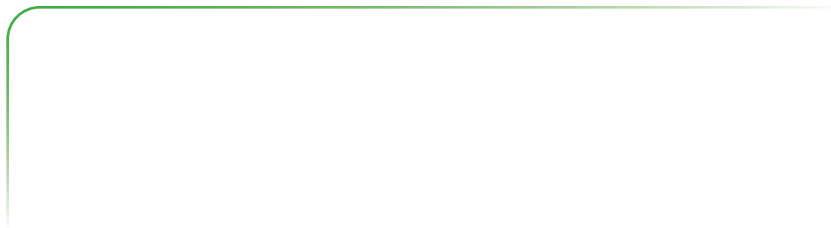
Skill Focus: Just as in real life, characters in literature don't always see eye to eye. Different people have different values; they want different things. These clashing perspectives, or ways of looking at life, cause conflict in a story. As a reader, you must make inferences about character perspectives and motivations that drive their actions based on what the characters do and say.

Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and underline words and phrases that help you make inferences about the setting (when and where the action is taking place), the conflict, and the relationships among the characters. Use the Notes column to record your inferences.

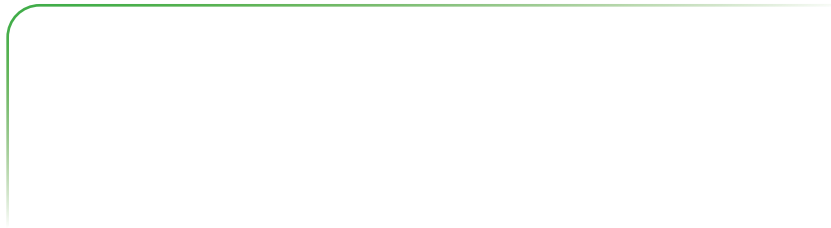
Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. How does Sylvia feel about her new home on a farm compared to her old home in a manufacturing town?



2. What evidence did you find in the text that supports your answer to question 1?



3. Why does the sportsman believe Sylvia will show him where the white heron's nest is? Support your answer with details from the text.

Demonstrate

As a reader of fiction, you often make inferences—educated guesses based on the text and your own knowledge and experience. Good readers are continually making inferences about the setting, the character's personality and motivations, and the themes of a text.

Read the following excerpt from the selection:

Here she comes now, paler than ever, and her worn old frock is torn and tattered, and smeared with pine pitch. The grandmother and the sportsman stand in the door together and question her, and the splendid moment had come to speak of the dead hemlock-tree by the green marsh.

What can be inferred about the characters' motivations based on this excerpt?

What the text says	What I know from my own experience	What I can infer about the sportsman's, grandmother's, and Sylvia's motivations
The text states explicitly that the grandmother, the sportsman, and Sylvia herself are all waiting for "the splendid moment" when Sylvia tells them where the white heron's nest is.	People have conflicting desires, and they like to get what they want.	▪ The hunter wants to know the location of the white heron's nest. ▪ Grandmother wants the ten-dollar reward. ▪ Sylvia wants to please the hunter and her grandmother, but she also wants to protect the white heron.

When speaking or writing, support your inferences with textual evidence either by quoting the text directly or by paraphrasing the information, as shown in the following examples.

- **Inference Supported by a Quote:** Sylvia loves being outdoors. Her grandmother observes, "there never was such a child for straying about out-of-doors since the world was made!"
- **Inference Supported by a Paraphrase:** Sylvia loves being outdoors. Her grandmother thinks that no other child in the world loves exploring nature as much as Sylvia does.

In “A White Heron,” the main characters have different perspectives about nature and the white heron. A character’s perspective is a particular attitude toward or way of regarding someone or something. These perspectives must be inferred from the details in the text.

Use the chart below to make inferences about the excerpt from “A White Heron” based on evidence you found in the text combined with your own experience and knowledge. Use the annotations you made during the first read to help you fill in the chart with information about Sylvia’s perspective and relationships. The first row has been completed for you. In subsequent rows, some of the cells have been filled in for you.

Sylvia’s Perspective/ Relationships	Text Evidence (Direct quotes from the passage)	My Own Knowledge	My Own Inference
Sylvia and the farm	<i>it seemed as if she never had been alive at all before she came to live at the farm</i> <i>Sylvia whispered that this was a beautiful place to live in, and she never should wish to go home.</i>	When people love a place, they want to spend time there. Country living usually means fewer people and more solitude, both things that a shy young girl might enjoy.	Sylvia loves the farm, the surrounding forest, and the natural world.
Sylvia and the town where she used to live		The manufacturing town was most likely noisy, dirty, and crowded, a place where natural things could not grow well.	Sylvia did not like living in the town.

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Sylvia's Perspective/ Relationships	Text Evidence (Direct quotes from the passage)	My Own Knowledge	My Own Inference
Grandmother's perspective about Sylvia coming to live with her		I know that older people can have less energy than kids, and a grandmother might need more help to take care of a farm.	
Sylvia's perspective toward the hunter			

Sylvia's Perspective/ Relationships	Text Evidence (Direct quotes from the passage)	My Own Knowledge	My Own Inference
Grandmother's perspective toward the sportsman/ hunter			
Sylvia's perspective toward the heron			

Exit Ticket

Read the following paragraph. Notice how Sylvia and the sportsman view each other.

But as the day waned, Sylvia still watched the young man with loving admiration. She had never seen anybody so charming and delightful; the woman's heart, asleep in the child, was vaguely thrilled by a dream of love. Some premonition of that great power stirred and swayed these young foresters who traversed the solemn woodlands with soft-footed silent care. They stopped to listen to a bird's song; they pressed forward again eagerly, parting the branches—speaking to each other rarely and in whispers; the young man going first and Sylvia following, fascinated, a few steps behind, with her gray eyes dark with excitement.

Write a four- or five-sentence paragraph that explains how Sylvia and the sportsman feel about each other. Support your inferences about their relationship with evidence from the passage. Use direct quotations and paraphrases as evidence.

Second Focus: Analyzing Author's Style

Discover

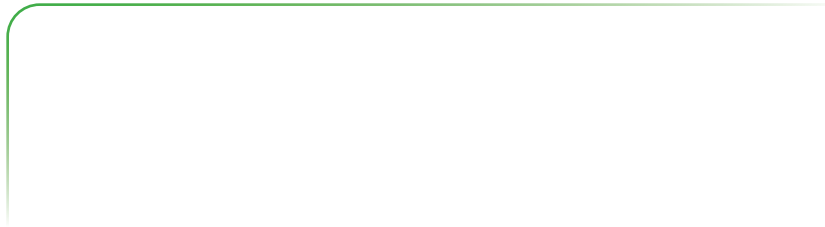
Skill Focus: An author's style refers to the distinct way they use language, structure, and writing techniques throughout their work. You can analyze an author's style by looking at their diction (word choice), syntax (arrangement of words), imagery, use of literary devices, and even formatting choices that make their voice recognizable. An author's style also includes specific word choices and descriptions that set a certain tone or mood.

Follow along as your teacher reads the excerpt aloud. Notice and underline sections where the narrator's point of view switches between different perspectives. In the Notes column, write words or phrases that help you understand the author's tone, or attitude toward the events in the story.

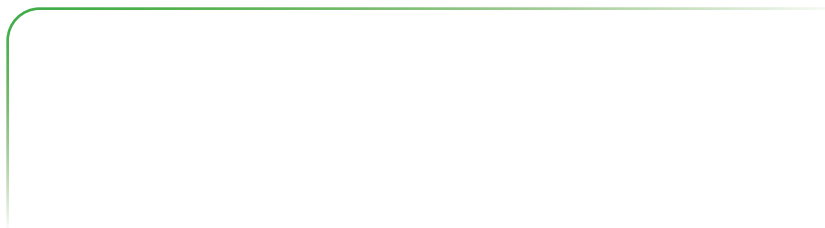
Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What details in the first two paragraphs help you visualize and understand the story's setting?



2. How do the setting and the characters create the central conflict for Sylvia?



3. What is the theme, or central message, of the story? In other words, what larger message do the setting, conflict, and characters communicate?

Demonstrate

In the past, you have studied key literary elements that readers encounter in a literary text, such as setting, plot, characterization, conflict, and theme. In addition, writers attempt to build multiple layers of meaning by going beyond the literal meaning of the words to set the tone, emphasize the mood, and give readers a sense of the purpose for which the text was written. Together, these elements make up the writer's style.

One unique element of Jewett's style is her use of shifting points of view in the narration.

Notice this example from the text.

... look, look! a white spot of him like a single floating feather comes up from the dead hemlock and grows larger, and rises, and comes close at last, and goes by the landmark pine with steady sweep of wing and outstretched slender neck and crested head. And wait! wait! do not move a foot or a finger, little girl, do not send an arrow of light and consciousness from your two eager eyes, for the heron has perched on a pine bough not far beyond yours, and cries back to his mate on the nest, and plumes his feathers for the new day!

Here, the narrator speaks directly to the main character, and the narrative switches from past to present tense. This has the effect of placing the reader alongside Sylvia up in the tall tree, watching the bird approach and land nearby. Jewett begins with "look, look!" which suggests excitement and wonder at what is about to happen. She describes the bird soaring through the air like a feather, coming closer and closer to the branch where the girl is sitting. Then, with "wait, wait!" the narrator warns the girl (and the reader) not to move so as not to scare the graceful wild bird away.

Jewett's shifting point of view contributes to the tone of the story. *Tone* is the author's attitude toward the story.

- Tone is revealed through the author's word choice and techniques.
- Words that describe tone include *serious*, *humorous*, *sarcastic*, *sentimental*, *sympathetic*, *urgent*, *passionate*, *hopeful*, or *instructive*.

Complete the last three columns of the following chart to analyze how the narrator's shifting points of view impact the tone of the writing. The first row has been completed for you.

Quote from Story	Explanation	Whose thoughts and feelings are being shared?	Tone/Narrator's attitude
Sylvia would have liked him vastly better without his gun; she could not understand why he killed the very birds he seemed to like so much. But as the day waned, Sylvia still watched the young man with loving admiration. She had never seen anybody so charming and delightful; the woman's heart, asleep in the child, was vaguely thrilled by a dream of love.	Sylvia doesn't like the fact that the sportsman killed harmless birds. Though she was a young girl, she was beginning to feel a kind of love for the sportsman.	Sylvia's	Tender and sympathetic toward the naïve girl's new feelings
Now look down again, Sylvia, where the green marsh is set among the shining birches and dark hemlocks; there where you saw the white heron once you will see him again; look, look! a white spot of him like a single floating feather . . . And wait! wait! do not move a foot or a finger, little girl, do not send an arrow of light and consciousness from your two eager eyes . . .			

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Quote from Story	Explanation	Whose thoughts and feelings are being shared?	Tone/Narrator's attitude
The guest waked from a dream, and remembering his day's pleasure hurried to dress himself that it might sooner begin. He was sure from the way the shy little girl looked once or twice yesterday that she had at least seen the white heron, and now she must really be persuaded to tell.			
Were the birds better friends than their hunter might have been, — who can tell? Whatever treasures were lost to her, woodlands and summertime, remember! Bring your gifts and graces and tell your secrets to this lonely country child!			

Exit Ticket

Read this brief excerpt from the passage and write a paragraph analyzing the narrator's point of view and tone.

She grieved because the longed-for white heron was elusive, but she did not lead the guest, she only followed, and there was no such thing as speaking first. The sound of her own unquestioned voice would have terrified her—it was hard enough to answer yes or no when there was need of that..

Third Focus: Analyzing a Coming-of-Age Story

Discover

Skill Focus: A coming-of-age story is a special type of book or movie. The story focuses on a young person who faces a conflict that leads to their maturity or entrance into adulthood.

At the beginning of the story, the main character is immature or naïve. As the story continues, this young person faces challenges and experiences events that are confusing or difficult. They might rebel against rules, deal with relationships and dating, figure out what kind of person they want to be, or struggle to find their purpose. Through all these experiences, they gain a better understanding of themselves and what's important in life. By the end of the story, the young, naïve protagonist has entered the world of adulthood.

Use active listening skills as you and your classmates take turns reading the excerpt aloud, one paragraph at a time. As you listen and read, pay close attention to the flow of Sylvia's changing thoughts and feelings. Use the Notes column to track your responses.

Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What does Sylvia want in this story?

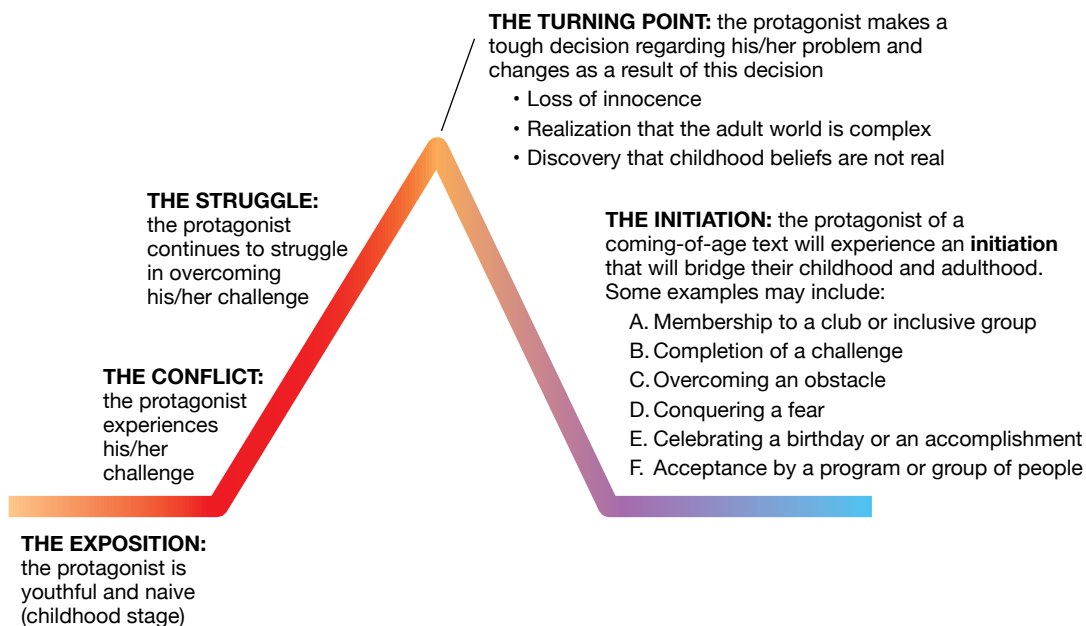
2. What stands in the way of her achieving what she wants?

3. How do you feel Sylvia might change because of her experiences in this story?

Demonstrate

The following diagram explains the progression of a coming-of-age story.

Plot Diagram of a Coming-of-Age Story



Consider the elements that make “A White Heron” a coming-of-age story. The main character is a young girl in a very tricky situation. Sylvia wants to win the affection of the sportsman, but she also wants to protect the rare white heron the sportsman has come looking to shoot. Sylvia is forced to choose between two opposing forces.

Fill in the chart to trace the plot of “The Heron.” For each of the plot elements recorded in the first column, provide a direct quotation from the story that provides evidence. Then in the final column, answer the question using your own words.

	Evidence from the Story	My Analysis
The Exposition: What is Sylvia like at the beginning of the story?		
The Struggle: What challenge or conflict does Sylvia face?		

	Evidence from the Story	My Analysis
The Turning Point: What decision does she make?		
The Initiation: What lesson about life does Sylvia learn?		

Exit Ticket

Evaluate “A White Heron” as a coming-of-age story. What elements are good examples of a typical coming-of-age story? What elements are not as typical? Use your answers to the table as you write a well-developed paragraph that makes a claim about whether the story is a good example of a coming-of-age story.

Review

Questions on reading tests will require you to make inferences about conflict, character motivation, and theme. Sometimes, these questions have a second part that asks you to provide textual evidence that supports your inference.

1. **Part A:** At the beginning of the passage, Sylvia feels _____

- A. happy with her life on the farm.
- B. unhappy because she lives so far from town.
- C. worried about her grandmother's poor health.
- D. fearful that hunters will come.

Part B: Choose the two details from the passage that best support the answer to Part A.

- A. *The good woman suspected that Sylvia loitered occasionally on her own account*
- B. *a jack-knife, which she thought as great a treasure as if she were a desert-islander*
- C. ***she never had been alive at all before she came to live at the farm***
- D. *Sylvia whispered that this was a beautiful place to live in*
- E. *She grieved because the longed-for white heron was elusive*

2. Which excerpt from the story reflects a shift in point of view as the narrator speaks directly to Sylvia?

- A. *Sylvia would have liked him vastly better without his gun*
- B. *where the green marsh is set among the shining birches and dark hemlocks; there where you saw the white heron once you will see him again . . .*
- C. *Mrs. Tilley had chased the horned torment too many summer evenings herself*
- D. *Sylvia cannot speak; she cannot tell the heron's secret and give its life away.*

3. The setting for most of this story is _____

- A. the seashore.
- B. a forest.
- C. a manufacturing town.
- D. an old woman's house.

4. Which part of the story reflects an aspect of the central conflict in the story?
- A. The grandmother is angry when Sylvia is late bringing the cow back.
 - B. Sylvia climbs a tree to look for the heron in the early morning light.
 - C. Sylvia longs to show the sportsman where the white heron's nest is, but she decides not to.
 - D. Sylvia is happy when the hunter leaves the farm so she can enjoy the solitude of nature.
5. **Part A:** In this coming-of-age story, what lesson about the world does Sylvia learn?
- A. Hunting and collecting rare birds is a good way to share these creatures with people in the city.
 - B. The difficulties of growing up poor and having to make hard choices between wants and desires.
 - C. That the natural world is precious and should be experienced directly rather than through the lens of others.
 - D. The importance of remaining true to one's values and protecting nature, even when offered financial rewards.

Part B: Choose one detail from the passage that best supports the answer to Part A.

- A. *Sylvia whispered that this was a beautiful place to live in, and she never should wish to go home.*
- B. *The child gives a long sigh a minute later when a company of shouting cat-birds comes also to the tree . . .*
- C. *The next day the young sportsman hovered about the woods, and Sylvia kept him company, having lost her first fear of the friendly lad . . .*
- D. *Wondering over and over again what the stranger would say to her, and what he would think when she told him how to find his way straight to the heron's nest.*
- E. *No, she must keep silence! What is it that suddenly forbids her and makes her dumb?*

Unit 2

Essential Question

What makes a great teacher?

Socrates. This superstar teacher of the ancient world was sentenced to death more than 2,400 years ago for “corrupting” the minds of the youth of Athens. However, his question-and-dialogue-based teaching style is still used in classrooms today. (You will participate in a Socratic seminar activity in this unit.)

Maria Montessori. One of the first female doctors in Italy, Montessori observed that young children often teach themselves by exploring their surroundings and drawing conclusions about their world. Today, many schools are dedicated to teaching students using the Montessori method, which uses the discovery method to tap into a child’s natural curiosity and motivation.

Booker T. Washington. His early attempts to get a formal education were thwarted by slavery and poverty, but Washington’s drive to learn could not be extinguished. He eventually earned his college degree, became a teacher, and founded Tuskegee Normal and Industrial Institute (now Tuskegee University) to provide educational opportunities for African Americans.

Anne Sullivan. When other teachers had given up on visually and hearing impaired Helen Keller, Sullivan endured. Visually impaired herself, Sullivan patiently looked beyond Keller’s behavior and understood her desire to understand the world. Both Sullivan and Keller became advocates for people with disabilities.

Jaime Escalante. An immigrant from Bolivia, Escalante came to the U.S. in 1963, taught himself English, and eventually became a math teacher. In the 1970s, he began teaching at Garfield High in inner-city Los Angeles. With the teaching style of a drill sergeant, Escalante taught advanced college-prep math classes, and his students excelled. His story is captured in the movie *Stand and Deliver*.

These are just a few examples of great teachers who encouraged, challenged, and inspired their students to reach their full potential—both academically and personally. In this unit you will read memoirs by great teachers. You will listen in on interactions between students and teachers and read advice to parents about how to teach their children. As you explore these texts, consider the question: What makes a great teacher?

GOALS

- To analyze how tone and point of view contribute to an author’s style
- To analyze purpose, main ideas, and key details of a passage
- To understand how authors use rhetorical appeals including ethos, pathos, and logos
- To identify the theme of a work
- To identify claims, reasons, evidence, and counterarguments in the structure of an argument
- To analyze the use of symbolism in an allegory
- To analyze the effectiveness of an argument by identifying fallacious reasoning



Chapter 7

Recognizing Author Voice

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- define and identify the tone of a passage.
- analyze how a writer changes point of view to enhance style.
- analyze elements of a writer's style.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **allusion**: a brief, indirect reference to a person, place, event, or literary work that the author assumes the reader will recognize.
- **epiphany**: a moment of sudden realization or insight.
- **figure of speech**: any expressive use of language, such as metaphor, simile, or personification, in which words are used in other than their literal sense; imagery.
- **hyperbole**: an exaggeration used for emphasis or effect.
- **idiom**: a commonly used expression that has a figurative meaning different from its literal meaning.
- **meiosis**: an understatement or downplaying of something for humorous effect
- **point of view**: the position of the narrator in relation to the story.
- **sentence structure**: the way words are arranged in sentences grammatically, including the placement of nouns and verbs.
- **tone**: the author's attitude toward his or her writing.

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. The _____ of the editorial was sarcastic but persuasive.
2. My first day as a teacher was a real _____ for me. I realized how difficult the job really is.
3. I like reading mystery novels in which the detective narrates the story in the first-person _____.

4. When I said, “I’m so hungry I could eat a horse,” I didn’t mean it literally—it was _____.
5. Books for beginning readers usually contain writing with simple _____.
6. An example of _____ is “The Great Wall of China? It’s just a long fence.”
7. The _____ “I’m pulling your leg” means that you are teasing and not being serious.
8. “You opened a real Pandora’s Box” is an example of a _____.
9. _____ include similes, metaphors, and other language that is not meant to be taken literally.

Preview Concepts

“Don’t use that tone with me!” If you’ve heard this phrase from a parent, you understand that *how* you say something can be as important as *what* you say. To illustrate this point, say “How are you?” in four different ways and have a classmate guess your tone (grumpy, excited, nervous, uninterested). How are you able to communicate different attitudes using the same three words? Write an explanation below.

When writing, *tone* refers to the author’s attitude toward the subject about which they are writing. In this chapter, you will learn the various elements that contribute to a writer’s voice; tone is merely one of them. The following are some examples of words used to describe author’s tone. (Don’t confuse tone with mood; mood is how the reader feels.)

amused	awestruck	sarcastic	serious
angry	humorous	judgmental	formal

With a partner, take turns defining the words above. Work together to add two more examples to the list.

Read for Understanding

The following excerpt is from *Teacher Man*, a memoir by Frank McCourt. As you read, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

Teacher Man

Chapter 6

by Frank McCourt

1 Mikey Dolan handed me a note from his mother explaining
his absence the day before:

Dear Mr. McCort, Mikey's grandmother who is my mother
eighty years of age fell down the stairs from too much coffee
5 and I kept Mikey at home to take care of her and his baby
sister so I could go to my job at the coffee shop in the ferry
terminal. Please excuse Mikey and he'll do his best in the
future as he likes your class. Sincerely yours, Imelda Dolan.
P.S. His grandmother is OK.

10 When Mikey handed me the note, so **blatantly** forged
under my nose, I said nothing. I had seen him writing it at
his desk with his left hand to disguise his own handwriting,
which, because of his years in Catholic primary schools, was
the best in the class. The nuns didn't care whether you went
15 to heaven or hell or married a Protestant as long as your
handwriting was clear and handsome and if you were weak
in that department they'd bend your thumbs back till you
screamed for mercy and promised a **calligraphy** that would
open the doors of heaven. . . .

20 An excuse note is just a part of school life. Everyone knows
they're fiction, so what's the big deal?

Notes:

Parents getting kids out of the house in the morning have little time for writing notes that they know will wind up in the school garbage anyway. They're so **harried** they'll say,

25 Oh, you need an excuse note for yesterday, honey? Write it yourself and I'll sign it. They sign it without even looking at it and the sad part is they don't know what they're missing. If they could read those notes they'd discover their kids are capable of the finest American prose: fluent, imaginative,

30 clear, dramatic, fantastic, focused, persuasive, useful.

I threw Mikey's note into a desk drawer along with dozens of others: notes written on every size and color of paper, scrawled, scratched, stained. While my classes took a test that day I began to read notes I had only glanced at before.

35 I made two piles, one for the genuine notes written by mothers, the other for forgeries. The second was the larger pile, with writing that ranged from imaginative to lunatic.

I was having an **epiphany**¹. I always wondered what an epiphany would be like and now I knew. I wondered also

40 why I'd never had this particular epiphany before.

Isn't it remarkable, I thought, how they resist any kind of writing assignment in class or at home. They whine and say they're busy and it's hard putting two hundred words together on any subject. But when they forge these excuse

45 notes they're brilliant . . .

The stove caught fire and the wallpaper went up and the fire department kept us out of the house all night.

The toilet was blocked and we had to go down the street to the Kilkenny Bar where my cousin works to use their toilet

50 but that was blocked too from the night before and you can imagine how hard it was for my Ronnie to get ready for

Notes:

¹ **epiphany**: a moment of sudden realization or insight

school. I hope you'll excuse him this one time and it won't happen again. The man at the Kilkenny Bar was very nice on account of how he knows your brother, Mr. McCord.

55 Arnold doesn't have his work today because he was getting off the train yesterday and the door closed on his school bag and the train took it away. He yelled to the conductor who said very vulgar things as the train drove away. Something should be done.

60 His sister's dog ate his homework and I hope it chokes him.
 Her baby brother peed on her story when she was in the bathroom this morning.

 A man died in the bathtub upstairs and it overflowed and messed up all Roberta's homework on the table.

65 Her big brother got mad at her and threw her essay out the window and it flew away all over Staten Island which is not a good thing because people will read it and get the wrong impression unless they read the ending which explains everything.

70 He had the composition you told him to write but he was going over it on the ferry and a big wind came and blowed it away.

 We were evicted from our apartment and the mean sheriff said if my son kept yelling for his notebook he'd have us all
75 arrested. . . .

 Toward the end of the term I typed a dozen excuse notes on a stencil and distributed them to my two senior classes. They read, silently and intently.

 Yo, Mr. McCourt, what's this?

80 Excuse notes.

 Whaddya mean, excuse notes? Who wrote them?

Notes:

You did, or some of you did. I omitted the names to protect the guilty. They're supposed to be written by parents, but you and I know the real authors. Yes, Mikey?

85 So, what are we supposed to do with these excuse notes?

We'll read them aloud. I want you to realize this is the first class in the world ever to study the art of the excuse note, the first class, ever, to practice writing them. You are so lucky to have a teacher like me who has taken your best
90 writing, the excuse note, and turned it into a subject worthy of study.

They're smiling. They know. We're in this together. Sinners.

Some of the notes on that sheet were written by people in this class. You know who you are. You used your
95 imagination and didn't settle for the old alarm-clock story. You'll be making excuses the rest of your life and you'll want them to be believable and original. You might even wind up writing excuses for your own children when they're late or absent or up to some devilment. Try it now. Imagine
100 you have a fifteen-year-old son or daughter who needs an excuse for falling behind in English. Let it rip.

They didn't look around. They didn't chew on their pens. They didn't dawdle. They were eager, desperate to make up excuses for their fifteen-year-old sons and daughters. It was
105 an act of loyalty and love and, you never know, some day they might need these notes. . . .

They said, More, more. Could we do more?

I was taken aback. How do I handle this enthusiasm?

Notes:

First Focus: Identifying Tone

Discover

Skill Focus: Authors use specific word choices and descriptions to create a tone. An author's tone refers to the attitude or emotion conveyed through their choice of words, phrasing, and style of expression. It could range from formal to casual, serious to humorous, objective to opinionated, and so on.

Now that you have a general understanding of *Teacher Man*, a memoir by Frank McCourt, who taught in New York City schools during the 1960s and 1970s, return to the excerpt and underline words that help you infer McCourt's tone.

Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. How does the author feel about the forged excuse notes he has received?

2. How do McCourt's students first react when he passes out the excuse notes?

3. What is the meaning of the phrase "let it rip" in line 101? How do these words affect the tone of the memoir? What does the expression suggest about McCourt as a teacher?

Demonstrate

Authors use specific word choices and descriptions to create tone.

Tone is the author's attitude toward the writing. For example, if an author uses informal, positive language, he creates an upbeat tone. If the author uses more formal words and academic language, he creates a more formal, academic tone. The author's tone reveals their purpose for writing.

An author's tone is developed through diction, or language used in descriptive details. Words have a dictionary definition, or a denotation. They also have connotation, or an emotional feeling connected with the word. Two words can have similar definitions but have very different implied meanings. For example, would you be offended if someone said you were thrifty? What if they said you were cheap? Connotation reveals the speaker's underlying tone and perspective.

Another element that reveals the author's tone is the use of figurative language, including the following:

- **hyperbole:** exaggeration used for emphasis or effect. Example: I've told you a million times to clean your room!
- **meiosis (understatement):** the opposite of hyperbole. It involves downplaying or minimizing something, often for ironic or humorous effect. Example: The Grand Canyon is just a little hole in the ground. No big deal.
- **allusion:** a brief, indirect reference to a person, place, event, or literary work that the author assumes the reader will recognize. Example: He's a real Romeo. I would be careful if he asked you out. (An allusion to Romeo's character from *Romeo and Juliet*)
- **idiom:** a commonly used expression that has a figurative meaning different from its literal meaning. Example: It's raining cats and dogs. (This means it's raining hard.)
- **personification:** literary device in which human characteristics, qualities, or behaviors are attributed to non-human entities, such as animals, objects, or abstract ideas. Example: In anger, the wind howled at the trees.

The use of hyperbole, meiosis, idiom, and personification often indicates the author is using a more informal tone. Hyperbole and meiosis can be used to create humor. Allusions can create a formal tone, if they refer to classic or academic works. However, allusions to popular culture can result in a modern, upbeat, or humorous tone. As a careful reader, it's up to you to decipher an author's tone by careful analysis of his or her language.

Read the details in the chart below and then comment on how the language used in the description reveals the writer's tone. For the cells that already have the effect filled in, find a detail for evidence. The first row has been completed for you.

Detail or Description	What effect does it have?
1. The nuns didn't care whether you went to heaven or hell or married a Protestant as long as your handwriting was clear and handsome and if you were weak in that department they'd bend your thumbs back till you screamed for mercy and promised a calligraphy that would open the doors of heaven. . . .	Adds humor. He uses exaggeration and sarcasm to mock the nuns' emphasis on handwriting and its overstated importance.
2. They're smiling. They know. We're in this together. Sinners.	
3. They didn't look around. They didn't chew on their pens. They didn't dawdle. They were eager. . . .	

Detail or Description	What effect does it have?
4.	Shows his respect for his students. Reveals that he believes in them and their abilities—an aspect of a great teacher.
5.	Proves he is honest and sincere. His willingness to learn alongside the students demonstrates an engaged and committed teacher.

Exit Ticket

1 Use your answers from the chart to draw a conclusion about the overall tone of the text. Write a paragraph that identifies McCourt's tone and supports your conclusion using examples of the tone from the text. Use at least one direct quotation.

2 In groups of three or four, conduct a peer review of your paragraph. Follow these steps:

Steps for Peer Review:

1. Select a timekeeper. Stick to the time. Each writer gets 5 minutes.
2. One person begins by reading aloud his or her paragraph while the others listen actively.
3. Pause. The same reader reads the paragraph aloud.
4. Group members listen and write comments or notes.
5. Writer asks: "What part was most clear to you?" Each member responds. Writer jots notes on draft.
6. Writer asks: "Was there any part that confused you?" Each member responds. Writer jots notes on draft.
7. Writer now can comment on any of the group members' responses.
8. Go to next writer in the group and repeat steps.

Second Focus: Analyzing Point of View

Discover

Skill Focus: Point of view refers to the perspective from which a story is told. The main points of view are as follows:

- First-person: the narrator is a character in the story and uses “I” to describe their own experiences and thoughts.
- Second-person: the narrator speaks directly to the reader and uses the pronoun “you.”
- Third-person: the narrator is outside the story, using “he,” “she,” and “they” to describe the characters’ experiences.

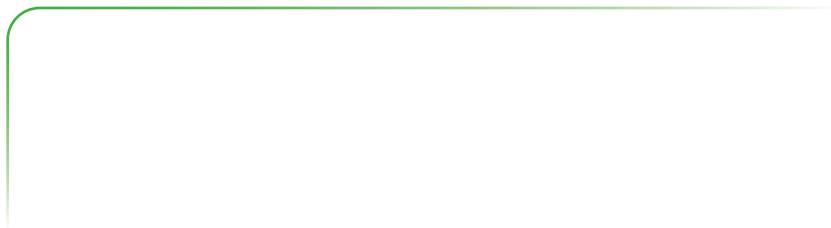
The point of view an author selects shapes how much the reader knows about the characters’ inner thoughts and motivations. It also affects the story’s level of subjectivity versus objectivity in the narration. For example, a story written from the first-person point of view provides the thoughts and opinions of a single character who may be biased or unreliable. Third-person point of view tends to be more neutral and objective since it relates the thoughts and actions of multiple characters.

As you listen to your teacher or a classmate read the excerpt aloud, identify how the point of view shifts from the author speaking to the reader to notes written by students and to the author speaking to his class. Trace how the writer changes point of view in the passage from writing from his own perspective to the perspective of parents or students. Label sections of the passage with *author*, *parent*, or *students*.

Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What point of view does the author use in paragraph 3? Explain your answer.



2. Compare and contrast the perspective used by the author in paragraphs 5 and 6. Give examples.

3. Why do you think McCourt includes the actual fake notes rather than a brief summary of their contents?

Demonstrate

In the chart below, give example sentences for each point of view.

Perspective	Example	Why does the author use this point of view?
Author speaks in first person		
Author speaks in third person (paragraphs 4–5)		

Perspective	Example	Why does the author use this point of view?
Students write as "parents"		
Author speaks in second person to class		

Exit Ticket

With a partner, review your answers to the chart, confirming that you understand McCourt's use of point of view. Then discuss the following question:

- Why does McCourt switch points of view throughout the passage?

Formulate a clear and concise answer. Then get together with another pair. Share your answers and then pick the stronger of the two (or combine them). Next, join another group of four and write the best possible sentence to answer the question. Have one student share this sentence with the class and compare it to the statements created by other groups. Then choose the sentence that you think best answers the question.

Third Focus: Analyzing Writing Style

Discover

Skill Focus: An author's style is reflected in their language, structure, and writing techniques throughout their work. You can analyze an author's style by looking at their diction, syntax, imagery, and use of literary devices that make their voice unique and recognizable.

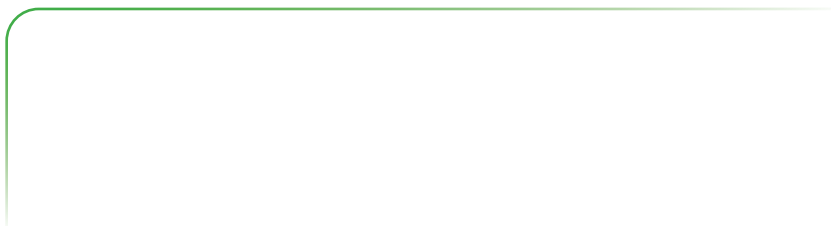
As you reread the text, imagine the scene in your mind. Can you visualize what the author sounds like as he tells the story? With a partner, read the passage aloud, alternating paragraphs. Try to read it with the attitude the author uses as he tells the story.

Underline words or phrases that stand out to you as good examples of the author's style.

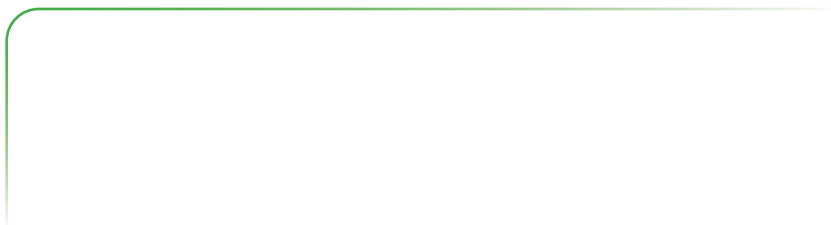
Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. Reread the third sentence in paragraph 3, which begins, "The nuns didn't care whether . . ." What style elements does McCourt use in this sentence to create humor?



2. Reread paragraphs 23–25. What style elements in this section make McCourt's writing lively and interesting?



Demonstrate

An author's style of writing is their own unique way of communicating. It encompasses specific elements of the writing, including word choice (also called *diction*), sentence structure (also known as *syntax*), and punctuation. You have read enough books to know that some writers use many adjectives and figures of speech. Others use mainly short, sparse sentences. The exercises you completed on McCourt's use of tone and point of view will help you analyze his overall style.

To help you analyze Frank McCourt's style, fill in the chart that follows.

Element of Style	Explanation	Describe McCourt's Style
Diction (Choice of Words)	Are the words fanciful, technical, casual, or flowery?	
Sentence Structure (Syntax)	Are the sentences long or short? Do they contain many clauses? Are there fragments? Are there mostly questions or statements or both?	

continued on next page

Element of Style	Explanation	Describe McCourt's Style
Punctuation	What types of punctuation does the author use (or not use)?	
Figures of Speech	Are there metaphors or similes, hyperboles (overstatement) or symbols?	

Element of Style	Explanation	Describe McCourt's Style
Tone	What is the author's attitude?	
Point of View	How does McCourt use point of view to communicate his main ideas?	

Exit Ticket

1 Write several paragraphs that discuss McCourt's writing style. Your goal is to synthesize the information gathered in the Third Focus chart. Your main idea sentence might begin in this way: Frank McCourt's style could be described as Support your main idea with examples of elements of style from the chart. Make sure you connect your supporting points logically, explaining how the elements contribute to McCourt's overall style. Use appropriate vocabulary in your response, including diction, syntax, and tone.

2 Read the students' excuses aloud. Try doing a popcorn reading (different students read aloud in no particular order). As you listen to your classmates deliver the excuses, think about the writers' voices. Which excuse is best? Be prepared to argue why it is the best and how it demonstrates, as McCourt says, "the finest American prose." Then, as a class, discuss how these students claim to dislike writing and yet demonstrate creativity and clarity when writing excuses.

Review

In this chapter, you looked at various literary elements that contribute to an author's style. When you take assessments, you will be tested over your ability to identify and analyze elements that contribute to the author's style including tone, point of view, and word choice. Answer the following questions to practice answering questions on these skills.

1. Read this sentence from Frank McCourt's *Teacher Man*.

I threw Mikey's note into a desk drawer along with dozens of others: notes written on every size and color of paper, scrawled, scratched, stained.

The sentence above is an example of

- A. a simile that compares excuse notes to a pile of trash.
 - B. hyperbole that emphasizes the variety of the notes.
 - C. an allusion that refers to an old manuscript kept hidden away.
 - D. symbolism that equates the notes with a child's schoolwork.
2. Read this sentence from Frank McCourt's *Teacher Man*.

I was having an epiphany. I always wondered what an epiphany would be like and now I knew. I wondered also why I'd never had this particular epiphany before.

Isn't it remarkable, I thought, how they resist any kind of writing assignment in class or at home. They whine and say they're busy and it's hard putting two hundred words together on any subject. But when they forge these excuse notes they're brilliant. . . .

In the excerpt above, the repetition of the word *epiphany* produces what effect?

- A. It emphasizes the speaker's fear and discomfort with his students.
- B. It communicates the speaker's appreciation for his students' epiphanies.
- C. It reveals the speaker's arrogance and his inability to learn.
- D. It dramatizes the excitement of the speaker's realization.

3. **Part A:** The overall tone of the excerpt could best be described as
- A. mocking.
 - B. angry.
 - C. melancholy.
 - D. humorous.

Part B: Which of the following is the best evidence for your answer to Part A?

- A. *When Mikey handed me the note, so blatantly forged under my nose, I said nothing.*
 - B. *The nuns didn't care whether you went to heaven or hell or married a Protestant as long as your handwriting was clear and handsome. . . .*
 - C. *Parents getting kids out of the house in the morning have little time for writing notes that they know will wind up in the school garbage anyway.*
 - D. *They whine and say they're busy and it's hard putting two hundred words together on any subject. But when they forge these excuse notes they're brilliant. . . .*
4. Read the following excerpt and answer the question that follows.

**They said, More, more. Could we do more?
I was taken aback. How do I handle this enthusiasm?**

Based upon this excerpt, the reader can infer that

- A. the students' excuses were examples of good writing.
- B. writing excuses is good practice for life after high school.
- C. students often ask for more writing assignments.
- D. McCourt wasn't used to students being excited about writing.

Chapter 8

Understanding Word Choice and Style

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- analyze purpose, main ideas, and key details of a passage.
- use context clues to determine word meanings.
- identify rhetorical strategies used to persuade.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

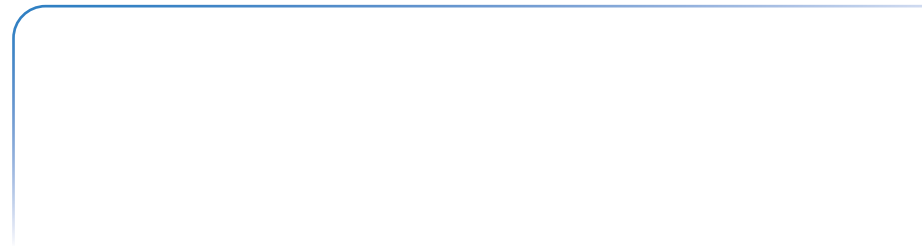
- **ethos**: an appeal to credibility, ethics, or moral principles
- **logos**: an appeal that relies on logic or reason.
- **pathos**: a persuasive appeal that evokes an audience's emotions.
- **purpose**: a writer's reason or goal for writing.
- **rhetoric**: 1. the ability to use language effectively; persuade.
2. language that is not honest, sincere, or meaningful.
- **tone**: the author's attitude toward his or her subject matter.

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. The author's careful selection of words and subtle use of imagery conveyed a serious and reflective _____ throughout the novel.
2. The author's _____ for writing the weather article was most likely to educate the reader. I think she met her goal because I learned a lot.
3. The writer grounded his speech in _____, giving sensible reasons for supporting his idea.
4. Both debaters in the competition used angry, over-the-top _____, which caused the judges to give them both low scores.
5. The speaker established their _____ by sharing personal anecdotes and demonstrating expertise on the subject, thereby gaining the trust and credibility of the audience.
6. The tragic tale of the protagonist's hardships caused profound _____, leaving readers emotional and empathetic.

Preview Concepts

What does the word *rhetoric* mean? Did you know the word has multiple meanings? Look up *rhetoric* in the dictionary and write two meanings of the word below.



Which meaning of the word has a positive connotation? Place a + by the definition above. Place a – next to the definition that has a negative connotation. The difficulty in understanding the meaning is that *rhetoric* can be used to describe a formal method of persuading people and can also be used to indicate language that is not honest. Study the examples below. Label each with a + or a – to indicate which meaning is used.

1. His study of rhetoric was clear in the way he presented a logical argument backed up with persuasive evidence.
2. The mayor's promises to clean up organized crime in the city turned out to be mere rhetoric to gain votes for his reelection.
3. "The media almost never discuss what the sweeping dismantling of public services inherent in the rhetoric of the antigovernment movement would mean in practice."
—E. J. Dionne Jr., *Commonweal*, 20 Nov. 2009

Read for Understanding

Read the following excerpt from *To Sir, with Love* by E. R. Braithwaite. Braithwaite was born in Guyana, South America. After joining the Royal Air Force as a pilot during World War II, he studied physics at the University of Cambridge. When he finished his doctorate, he was unable to find work, so he took a job as a teacher. *To Sir, with Love* is his memoir about teaching unmotivated 15-year-olds in the East End of London, a rough, working-class neighborhood in the 1950s.

As you read, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

To Sir, with Love

Chapter 9

by E. R. Braithwaite

1 Next morning I had an idea. It was nothing clear cut, merely speculative, but I considered it all the way to school. Then, after assembly, as soon as they were quiet I waded in. This might be a bit rough, I thought, but here goes.

5 "I am your teacher, and I think it right and proper that I should let you know something of my plans for this class." I tried to pitch my voice into its most informally pleasant **register**. "We're going to talk, you and I, but we'll be reasonable with each other. I would like you to listen to me without interrupting in any way, and when I'm through any one of you may say your piece without interruption from me." I was making it up as I went along and watching them; at the least sign that it wouldn't work I'd drop it, fast.

15 They were interested, in spite of themselves; even the husky blasé Denham was leaning forward on his desk watching me.

"My business here is to teach you, and I shall do my best to make my teaching as interesting as possible. If at any time I

Notes:

Notes:

say anything which you do not understand or with which you do not agree, I would be pleased if you would let me know.

20 Most of you will be leaving school within six months or so; that means that in a short while you will be embarked on the very adult business of earning a living. Bearing that in mind, I have decided that from now on you will be treated, not as children, but as young men and women, by me and by each
25 other. When we move out of the state of childhood certain higher standards of conduct are expected of us . . .”

At this moment the door was flung open and Pamela Dare rushed in, somewhat breathlessly, to take her seat. She was very late.

30 “For instance,” I continued, “there are really two ways in which a person may enter a room; one is in a controlled, dignified manner, the other is as if someone had just planted a heavy foot in your backside. Miss Dare has just shown us the second way; I’m quite sure she will now give us a
35 demonstration of the first.”

To this day I do not know what made me say it, but there it was. I was annoyed with the way in which she had just barged her way in, insolently carelessly late.

All eyes were on her as she had probably planned, but
40 instead of supporting her entrance they were watching her, waiting to see the result of my challenge. She blushed.

“Well, Miss Dare?”

Her eyes were black with anger and **humiliation**, but she stood up and walked out, closing the door quietly behind
45 her; then to my surprise, and I must confess, my relief, she opened it as quietly, and with a grace and dignity that would have befitted a queen, she walked to her seat.

Notes:

"Thank you. As from today there are certain courtesies which will be observed at all times in this classroom. Myself
50 you will address as 'Mr. Braithwaite' or 'Sir'—the choice is yours; the young ladies will be addressed as 'Miss' and the young men will be addressed by their surnames."

I hadn't planned any of this, but it was unfolding all by itself, and I hoped, fitting into place. There was a general
55 gasp at this, from boys and girls alike.

Potter was the first to protest.

"Why should we call 'em 'miss,' we know 'em."

"What is your name?"

"Potter."

60 "I beg your pardon?"

"Potter, Sir." The "Sir" was somewhat delayed.

"Thank you, Potter. Now is there any young lady present whom you consider unworthy of your courtesies?"

"Sir?"

65 "Is there any one of these young ladies, who you think does not deserve to be addressed as Miss?"

With one accord the girls turned to look at Potter, as if daring him; he **quailed** visibly before their converted eyes and said: "No, Sir."

70 "You should remember, Potter, that in a little while all of you may be expected to express these courtesies as part of your jobs; it would be helpful to you to become accustomed to giving and receiving them."

I walked around my desk and sat in my chair. For the
75 time being at least they were listening, really listening to me; maybe they would not understand every word, but they'd get the general import of my remarks.

Notes:

"The next point concerns the general **deportment** and conduct of the class. First, the young ladies. They must
80 understand that in the future they must show themselves both worthy and appreciative of the courtesies we men will show them. As Potter said, we know you. We shall want to feel proud to know you, and just how proud we shall feel will depend entirely on you. There are certain things which
85 need attention, and I have asked Mrs. Dale-Evans to discuss them with you in your Domestic Science period today." This last bit was right off the cuff; I'd have to see Grace about it during recess, but I felt sure she'd help.

"Now, the boys. I have seen **stevedores and**
90 **longshoremen**¹ who looked a lot cleaner and tidier. There is nothing weak and unmanly about clean hands and faces and shoes that are brushed. A man who is strong and tough never needs to show it in his dress or the way he cuts his hair. Toughness is a quality of the mind, like bravery or honesty
95 or ambition; it has nothing whatever to do with muscles. I suppose that in about a year or so some of you will be thinking of girlfriends; believe me, they will think you much more attractive with clean teeth, hands and faces than without."

100 I gave them a moment to digest that.

"You are the top class; the operative word is 'top.' That means you must set the standard in all things for the rest of the school for, whether you wish it or no, the younger ones will ape everything you do or say. They will try to walk like
105 you and use the words you use, and dress like you, and so, for as long as you're here, much of their conduct will be your responsibility. As the top class you must be top in cleanliness,

¹ **stevedores and longshoremen:** people employed at a dock to load and unload cargo from ships

department, courtesy and work. I shall help you in every way I can, both by example and encouragement. I believe that
110 you have it in you to be a fine class, the best this school has ever known, but I could be wrong; it all depends on you.
Now, any questions?"

A hand shot up.

"Yes, Miss Joseph?"

115 "What about Mr. Weston, he's never tidy, and his shoes are never clean, Sir."

Things were looking up already; the "Sir" came easily.

"Mr. Weston is a teacher, Miss Joseph, and we shall not discuss him."

120 There was a murmur of dissent at this.

"I am your teacher, and I'm the one you should criticize if I fail to maintain the standards I demand of you."

There was an absence of the silent hostility of yesterday. I felt that I had somehow won for myself a breathing space
125 at least. There were no further questions, so I told them they could spend the remaining minutes of that period considering and discussing the things I had said, providing they did so quietly. I sat back and observed them.

At recess I went to the staffroom and told Grace how I had
130 impulsively committed her to a talk with the girls; she was quite pleased about it and promised to "lay it on thick."

That day passed pleasantly enough. I felt more at ease with them and applied myself enthusiastically to each subject, blending informality with a correctness of expression
135 which I hoped would in turn help them to improve their own speech. I never spoke down to them; if they did not quite understand every word I used, the meaning was sufficiently

Notes:

clear in context, and I encouraged them to ask

for an explanation any time they felt unsure. Meanwhile

140 I was careful to discover the centers of leadership among them. Denham had quite a following among the boys; Potter, big and beefy, seemed to tag along with Denham through sheer laziness in asserting himself; Fernman and Seales were somewhat solitary characters, although they

145 worked extremely well in class and played as **boisterously** in the playground as anyone else. I had expected that Pamela Dare would be a leader among the girls, but this did not prove to be so; she had one or two familiars, but kept very much to herself with a certain sullenness which I found both

150 strange and intriguing. She was easily the brightest pupil, and her written work was neat and precise, in keeping with her personal appearance. Moira Joseph was the girl around whom the others circulated. She was tall, slim and vivacious, with a certain natural inclination to and aptitude for

155 innocent seductiveness; most of the boys were ready to eat out of her hand. If I could get these king-pins to cooperate the others would probably fall in line.

On my way home that evening I walked to the bus with Miss Blanchard, and told her about what I had done. She

160 was **dubious** about the wisdom of imposing unfamiliar social codes on the children, yet, as I had already committed myself, she hoped it would work. I was secretly pleased at the concern in her large eyes and felt more than ever determined to make a success of the class.

Notes:

First Focus: Identifying Key Elements

Discover

Skill Focus: By evaluating key elements of a text, you can better interpret a text's meaning, perspectives, and how effectively the message is communicated to the audience for the intended purpose and occasion. Key elements include

- Speaker: who is speaking or narrating the text
- Occasion: context or situation surrounding when and why the text was written
- Audience: who the intended audience is based on factors such as diction, references, and assumptions the speaker makes
- Purpose: to persuade, inform, entertain, or express emotion
- Subject: the main topic, idea, or issue that the text centers around and how comprehensively or objectively it is explored
- Tone: the author's attitude conveyed through diction, imagery, and details. The tone may be serious, humorous, sarcastic, objective, emotional, or something else.

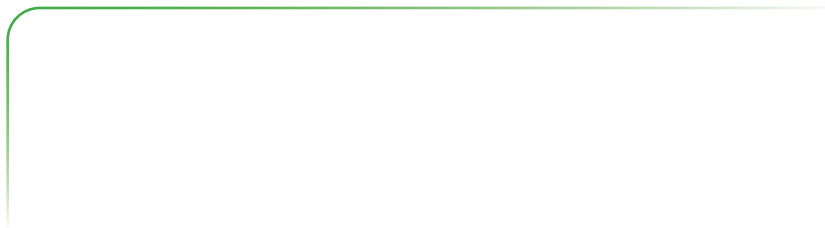
These literary elements provide insight into both the content and artfulness of the writing itself.

Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and underline sentences that exemplify Braithwaite's behavior as a teacher and the expectations he holds for his students. What point about teaching is he trying to make? In the Notes column, explain your feelings about the behavior that you have underlined.

Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What does Braithwaite do to begin the class? How would you characterize his approach?



2. How do Braithwaite's students react to his approach?

3. Reread the first sentence of paragraph 36. What do these words suggest about why Braithwaite has taken his current approach?

Demonstrate

To get an overall view of a text, identify the key elements that make up a piece of writing—**s**peaker, **o**ccasion, **a**udience, **p**urpose, **s**ubject, and **t**one. These elements are represented by the acronym SOAPSTone. Understanding these elements will deepen your understanding of the text as a whole. With a partner, fill in the chart below.

<i>To Sir, with Love</i>		
Speaker	Who is speaking or telling the story?	
Occasion	What is the setting? Where and when is the action taking place; what is the context that prompted the writing?	

<i>To Sir, with Love</i>		
Audience	To whom is the writer writing?	
Purpose	Why is the writer writing? (to inform, entertain, or persuade) What does the author want you to think or feel after reading the text?	
Subject	What is the main idea?	
Tone	What is the writer's/speaker's attitude toward the events or subject?	



Exit Ticket

Share your answers to the SOAPSTone chart with another pair of students. Are your answers similar? If not, discuss your thoughts until you can agree upon the best answer for each box.

Second Focus: Analyzing Author's Word Choice

Discover

Skill Focus: An author's voice is their distinctive personality that shines through in their writing, much like how you can recognize your friends by their unique way of speaking and the words they choose. Similarly, you can identify an author's individual style and character by paying attention to the language they employ in their work.

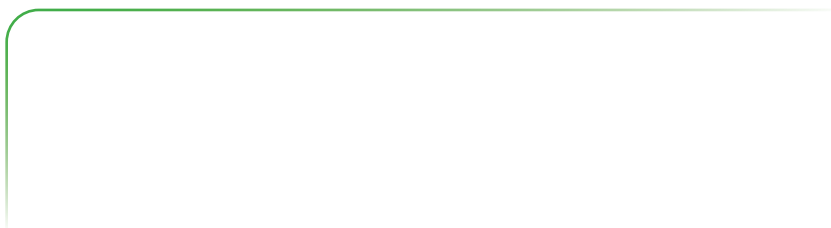
Read the passage again. This time pay attention to the words Braithwaite uses to describe his experiences with the students in his class. Which words are unfamiliar to you?

Underline words and phrases that you are unfamiliar with. Try to infer their meaning from the context.

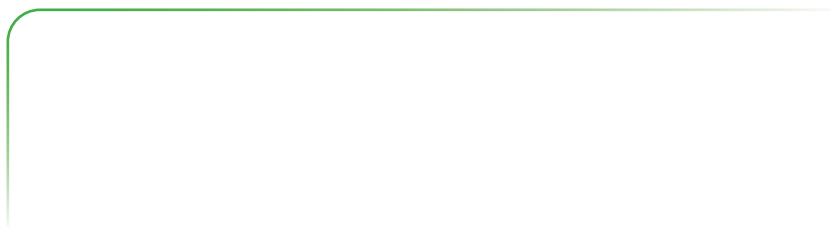
Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. How does Braithwaite react to Pamela Dare's entrance in lines 27 and following? Which words and phrases contribute most to his approach?



2. Compare and contrast the language Braithwaite uses when speaking to the class with the language he uses to address the reader. Give examples.



Demonstrate

By reading closely and analyzing the words that authors select, you can hear the unique voice and personality behind the writing. It's almost like getting to know their personality through their words. The right word choices make an author's distinctive voice leap off the page.

In a memoir, the author's voice and personality are conveyed by his or her choice of words. Some of Braithwaite's words indicate that he is a very educated man. Use the context to infer the meaning of the following underlined words from the passage. Circle any context clues that help you determine the meaning. Then confirm your inferences with a dictionary. For numbers 4 and 5, choose two more words that are unfamiliar to you.

1. *It was nothing clear cut, merely speculative, but I considered it all the way to school.* (lines 1–2)

Meaning based on context:

Dictionary definition:

2. *They were interested, in spite of themselves; even the husky blasé Denham was leaning forward on his desk watching me.* (lines 14–15)

Meaning based on context:

Dictionary definition:

3. *She was tall, slim and vivacious, with a certain natural inclination to and aptitude for innocent seductiveness; most of the boys were ready to eat out of her hand.* (lines 153–156)

Meaning based on context:

Dictionary definition:

4. Word in context: “You are the top class; the operative word is ‘top.’ That means you must set the standard in all things for the rest of the school for, whether you wish it or no, the younger ones will ape everything you do or say.”

Meaning based on context:

Dictionary definition:

5. Word in context: “As the top class you must be top in cleanliness, deportment, courtesy and work.”

Meaning based on context:

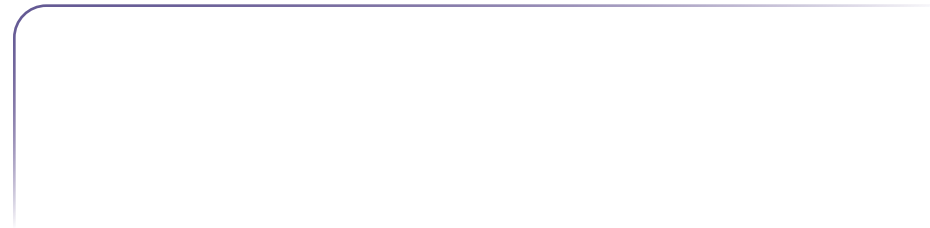
Dictionary definition:

6. Does Braithwaite use slang or informal language in his writing? Write any examples below.

7. What conclusions can you draw about the author based on his word choice? How does his word choice impact his tone? How does it influence how you as the reader view him?

Exit Ticket

1 Write a few paragraphs analyzing the impact of Braithwaite's words on the meaning and tone of his writing. Include specific examples from the passage to support your conclusions.



2 Read your paragraphs to a partner. Then listen carefully as your partner reads his or her paragraphs to you. Offer specific suggestions to improve the main idea or supporting reasons and examples in the paragraphs.

Third Focus: Understanding Rhetoric

Discover

Skill Focus: Rhetoric refers to the strategies and techniques that writers or speakers use to engage and persuade their audience. It's all about how to effectively convey ideas and argue a point.

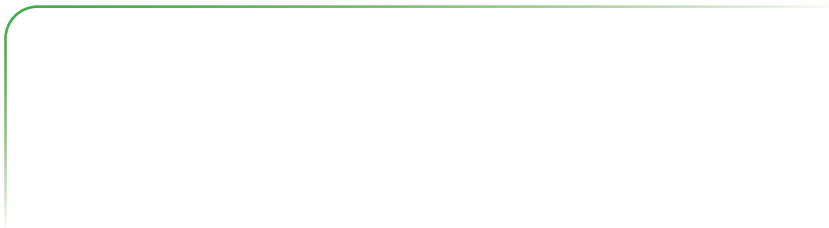
This time, listen as your teacher reads the passage aloud. Think about how Braithwaite speaks to the students in a way that communicates what he wants them to do and also to persuade them to agree to his plan.

Annotate the text with hand-drawn emoticons that track the students' responses to Mr. Braithwaite's speech.

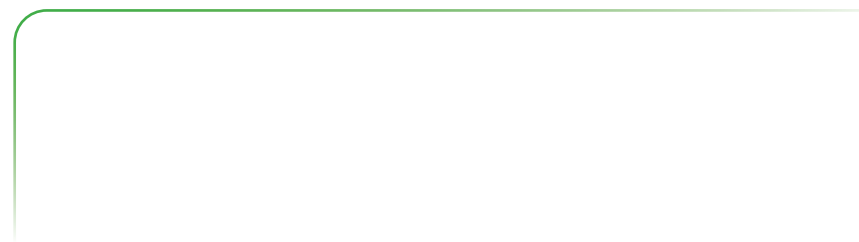
Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. Which type of appeal does Braithwaite make to his students in paragraph 2, and how effective is he? Give examples.



2. Compare the appeal Braithwaite uses in lines 48–52 and 65–69 with the appeal he uses in lines 70–73.



Demonstrate

To understand how Braithwaite persuades his students to adhere to certain social codes, look at his use of rhetoric. There are three major forms of rhetoric that can be used to make an argument—ethos, pathos, and logos. The best arguments will typically use all three forms of appeal.

Read the Rhetorical Appeals chart on the next page to understand each type of appeal. In the third column, add a direct quotation from the passage that illustrates Braithwaite's use of a particular appeal. Then briefly explain how the evidence you chose supports this type of appeal.

Rhetorical Appeals		
Type of Appeal	Explanation	Direct Quotation/Explanation
Ethos	Ethos, the ethical appeal, is based on the credibility of the writer. An author uses specific language to establish his or her reliability. The ethical appeal can be established by demonstrating respect for the audience or for opposing opinions, by showing genuine interest in and knowledge about a subject, or by including sources used for any research.	
Pathos	Pathos, or the emotional appeal, calls upon an audience's emotions and values in order to persuade. The emotional appeal can be established by evoking the audience's sensibilities such that the issue becomes more personal or relatable.	
Logos	Logos, or the logical appeal, relies on logic or reasoning. An author provides reasons and evidence to prove his or her point. An appeal to logic can be established by using specific facts to draw a general conclusion (inductive reasoning) or by beginning with a general rule and then supporting with specifics (deductive reasoning).	

Exit Ticket

Choose one of the forms of appeal from the chart on the previous page and write several paragraphs that explain how the author uses that appeal to earn his students' attention and respect. Be sure to do the following:

- Introduce your main idea in the first sentence.
- Support your main idea with evidence from the text.
- Use transitions and precise language.
- Maintain an objective tone as you write.
- Provide a concluding statement that comments on the effect of Braithwaite's rhetoric.

Review

When you take assessments, you will be tested over your ability to read an excerpt then discern the speaker's tone and define words from context. The following questions will give you practice answering assessment questions on these skills.

1. Read the sentence from *To Sir, with Love* and then answer the question that follows.

I was secretly pleased at the concern in her large eyes and felt more than ever determined to make a success of the class.

The speaker's tone can best be described as

- A. hopeful and haughty.
 - B. reproachful and frustrated.
 - C. gratified and resolute.
 - D. delighted and nervous.
2. Read the sentence from *To Sir, with Love* and then answer the question that follows.

"Most of you will be leaving school within six months or so; that means that in a short while you will be embarked on the very adult business of earning a living."

In this context, the phrase *embarked on* most likely means

- A. trained in.
 - B. entered into.
 - C. relieved of.
 - D. forbidden from.
3. Read the sentence from *To Sir, with Love* and then answer the question that follows.

"I am your teacher, and I'm the one you should criticize if I fail to maintain the standards I demand of you."

Based on the sentence above, Mr. Braithwaite's character can best be described as

- A. condescending and insolent.
- B. indignant and self-righteous.
- C. forgiving and affectionate.
- D. accountable and trustworthy.

4. Read the following excerpt from *To Sir, with Love* and then answer the questions that follow.

"You are the top class; the operative word is 'top.' That means you must set the standard in all things for the rest of the school for, whether you wish it or no, the younger ones will ape everything you do or say. They will try to walk like you and use the words you use, and dress like you, and so, for as long as you're here, much of their conduct will be your responsibility. As the top class you must be top in cleanliness, deportment, courtesy and work. I shall help you in every way I can, both by example and encouragement."

Part A: The word *ape* most nearly means

- A. mimic.
- B. make fun of.
- C. follow.
- D. watch.

Part B: Which of the following is the best evidence to support your answer to Part A?

- A. "*You are the top class; the operative word is 'top.'*"
- B. "*That means you must set the standard in all things for the rest of the school . . .*"
- C. "*They will try to walk like you and use the words you use, and dress like you . . .*"
- D. "*As the top class you must be top in cleanliness, deportment, courtesy and work.*"



Chapter 9

Synthesizing Details from Multiple Texts

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- analyze how details contribute to the theme of a work.
- identify the theme of a work.
- analyze use of figurative language to enhance a theme.
- analyze the use of aphorisms.
- synthesize details from multiple sources.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **aphorism:** a statement of truth or wisdom expressed in a concise and witty manner.
- **figurative language:** language expressing one thing in terms normally denoting another; ideas are expressed in a non-literal or imaginative way.
- **synthesize:** to gather information from various sources and combine them to form a cohesive argument or understanding of a topic.
- **theme:** a main idea or an underlying message of a literary work that may be stated directly or indirectly.

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. The story's _____—that everyone embodies elements of good and evil—was hardly original.
2. The writer showed his inexperience by using tired, old _____, such as this simile: “It felt light as a feather.”
3. An _____ may appear in a fable, such as this adage: slow and steady wins the race.
4. Our assignment was to read multiple texts and then _____ the information in a report.

Preview Concepts

Artistic unity is the condition of a successful literary work whereby all its elements work together for the achievement of its central purpose. Story elements, such as setting, figurative language, and characterization, must all contribute to the meaning. This means every detail and every word should be relevant and intentional.

Look around your classroom right now. Jot down notes on the following details about the room.

Amount of light or windows:

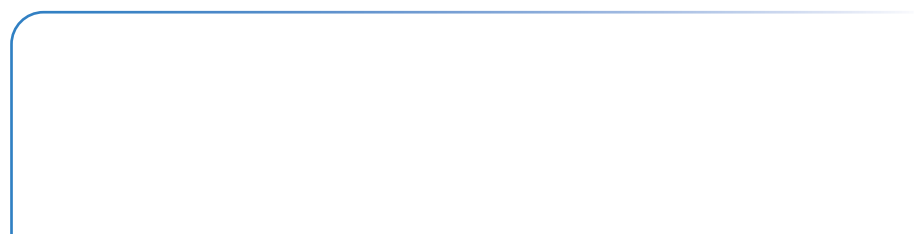
Sounds:

Decorations on the walls:

People in the room:

Time of day:

Based upon the details you recorded above, finish this sentence: **The classroom**



With a partner, share the details you jotted down and also your one-sentence description. Did your sentence description of the room fit with the details you recorded? Did your explanation effectively communicate the experience of being in the room?

Read for Understanding

The following excerpt is from *Tuesdays with Morrie*, a memoir written by Mitch Albom. Albom is a newspaper sports columnist who reports on his weekly visits with his old sociology professor, Morrie Schwartz, who is 78 years old and dying. Though the two men haven't seen each other in 16 years, they have a special bond. As an elder with years of wisdom and insight, Morrie inspires Albom, and Albom provides company for Morrie.

As you read, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

Tuesdays with Morrie

by Mitch Albom

The Classroom

1 The sun beamed in through the dining room window,
lighting up the hardwood floor. We had been talking there
for nearly two hours. The phone rang yet again and Morrie
asked his helper, Connie, to get it. She had been jotting the
5 callers' names in Morrie's small black appointment book.
Friends. Meditation teachers. A discussion group. Someone
who wanted to photograph him for a magazine. It was clear I
was not the only one interested in visiting my old professor—
the "**Nightline**" appearance had made him something of
10 a celebrity—but I was impressed with, perhaps even a bit
envious of, all the friends that Morrie seemed to have.
I thought about the "buddies" that circled my orbit back in
college. Where had they gone?

 "You know, Mitch, now that I'm dying, I've become much
15 more interesting to people."

 You were always interesting.

 "Ho." Morrie smiled. "You're kind."

 No, I'm not, I thought.

Notes:

"Here's the thing," he said. "People see me as a bridge. I'm
20 not as alive as I used to be, but I'm not yet dead. I'm
sort of . . . in-between."

He coughed, then regained his smile. "I'm on the last great
journey here—and people want me to tell them what to pack."

The phone rang again.

25 "Morrie, can you talk?" Connie asked.

"I'm visiting with my old pal now," he announced. "Let
them call back."

I cannot tell you why he received me so warmly. I was hardly
the promising student who had left him sixteen years earlier.

30 Had it not been for "**Nightline**", Morrie might have died
without ever seeing me again. I had no good excuse for this,
except the one that everyone these days seems to have. I had
become too wrapped up in the siren song of my own life. I
was busy.

35 *What happened to me?* I asked myself. Morrie's high,
smoky voice took me back to my university years, when I
thought rich people were evil, a shirt and tie were prison
clothes, and life without freedom to get up and go—
motorcycle beneath you, breeze in your face, down the
40 streets of Paris, into the mountains of Tibet—was not a good
life at all. *What happened to me?*

The eighties happened. The nineties happened. Death
and sickness and getting fat and going bald happened. I
traded lots of dreams for a bigger paycheck, and I never even
45 realized I was doing it.

Yet here was Morrie talking with the wonder of our
college years, as if I'd simply been on a long vacation.

"Have you found someone to share your heart with?"
he asked.

Notes:

50 "Are you giving to your community?

"Are you at peace with yourself?

"Are you trying to be as human as you can be?"

I squirmed, wanting to show I had been **grappling** deeply with such questions. *What happened to me?* I once promised
55 myself I would never work for money, that I would join the Peace Corps, that I would live in beautiful, inspirational places.

Instead, I had been in Detroit for ten years now, at the same workplace, using the same bank, visiting the same barber. I was thirty-seven, more efficient than in college, tied
60 to computers and modems and cell phones. I wrote articles about rich athletes who, for the most part, could not care less about people like me. I was no longer young for my peer group, nor did I walk around in gray sweatshirts with unlit cigarettes in my mouth. I did not have long discussions over
65 egg salad sandwiches about the meaning of life.

My days were full, yet I remained, much of the time, unsatisfied.

What happened to me?

"Coach," I said suddenly, remembering the nickname.

70 Morrie beamed. "That's me. I'm still your coach."

He laughed and resumed his eating, a meal he had started forty minutes earlier. I watched him now, his hands working **gingerly**, as if he were learning to use them for the very first time. He could not press down hard with a knife. His fingers
75 shook. Each bite was a struggle; he chewed the food finely before swallowing, and sometimes it slid out the sides of his lips, so that he had to put down what he was holding to dab his face with a napkin. The skin from his wrist to his knuckles was dotted with age spots, and it was loose, like

Notes:

80 skin hanging from a chicken soup bone.

For a while, we just ate like that, a sick old man, a healthy, younger man, both absorbing the quiet of the room. I would say it was an embarrassed silence, but I seemed to be the only one embarrassed.

85 "Dying," Morrie suddenly said, "is only one thing to be sad over, Mitch. Living unhappily is something else. So many of the people who come to visit me are unhappy."

Why?

"Well, for one thing, the culture we have does not make
90 people feel good about themselves. We're teaching the wrong things. And you have to be strong enough to say if the culture doesn't work, don't buy it. Create your own. Most people can't do it. They're more unhappy than me—even in my current condition.

95 "I may be dying, but I am surrounded by loving, caring souls. How many people can say that?"

I was astonished by his complete lack of self-pity. Morrie, who could no longer dance, swim, bathe, or walk; Morrie, who could no longer answer his own door, dry himself
100 after a shower, or even roll over in bed. How could he be so accepting? I watched him struggle with his fork, picking at a piece of tomato, missing it the first two times—a **pathetic** scene, and yet I could not deny that sitting in his presence was almost magically **serene**, the same calm breeze that
105 soothed me back in college.

I shot a glance at my watch—force of habit—it was getting late, and I thought about changing my plane reservation home. Then Morrie did something that haunts me to this day.

"You know how I'm going to die?" he said.

Notes:

110 I raised my eyebrows.

"I'm going to suffocate. Yes. My lungs, because of my asthma, can't handle the disease. It's moving up my body, this **ALS**¹. It's already got my legs. Pretty soon it'll get my arms and hands. And when it hits my lungs . . ."

115 He shrugged his shoulders.

". . . I'm sunk."

I had no idea what to say, so I said, "Well, you know, I mean . . . you never know."

Morrie closed his eyes. "I know, Mitch. You mustn't be
120 afraid of my dying. I've had a good life, and we all know it's going to happen. I maybe have four or five months."

Come on, I said nervously. Nobody can say—

"I can," he said softly. "There's even a little test. A doctor showed me."

A test?

125 "Inhale a few times."

I did as he said.

"Now, once more, but this time, when you exhale, count as many numbers as you can before you take another breath."

I quickly exhaled the numbers. "One-two-three-four-five-
130 six-seven-eight . . ." I reached seventy before my breath was gone.

"Good," Morrie said. "You have healthy lungs. Now. Watch what I do."

He inhaled, then began his number count in a soft, wobbly
135 voice. "One-two-three-four-five-six-seven-eight-nine-ten-eleven-twelve-thirteen-fourteen-fifteen-sixteen-seventeen-eighteen—"

1 **ALS:** amyotrophic lateral sclerosis (also called Lou Gehrig's disease); a disease that attacks the nerve cells, causing the muscles to weaken and ultimately lose function

Notes:

Notes:

He stopped, gasping for air.

“When the doctor first asked me to do this, I could reach
140 twenty-three. Now it’s eighteen.”

He closed his eyes, shook his head. “My tank is almost empty.”

I tapped my thighs nervously. That was enough for one afternoon.

145 “Come back and see your old professor,” Morrie said when I hugged him good-bye.

I promised I would, and I tried not to think about the last time I promised this.



First Focus: Understanding the Impact of Details

Discover

Skill Focus: Details are like windows into a text's meaning. They give readers a deeper look at aspects of character and theme. Authors use specific details to reveal insights into characters' personalities, backgrounds, and inner thoughts that go beyond surface-level descriptions. By carefully analyzing descriptive details, readers can uncover symbolic meanings and recognize broader themes reflected in the narrative.

Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and notice how the two main characters are described. Use one color to underline details that describe Morrie in and different color to underline details that describe Mitch. Then, in the Notes column, write a word that describes the general feeling of the underlined detail: positive or negative.

Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. How does the phone ringing in the first paragraph impact the story?

2. When the phone rings a second time, Morrie doesn't take the call, saying, "I'm visiting with my old pal now." How does Mitch react to this event?

3. What do the details in lines 36 and following reveal about Mitch?
Give examples.

Demonstrate

Copy the descriptive details you highlighted in the passage into the chart below. In the second column, indicate if the detail is positive or negative. Finally, in the third column explain why you labeled this detail as positive or negative. The first row has been completed for you.

Description of Morrie (Words and Actions)	Positive or Negative	Explanation
<i>"People see me as a bridge. I'm not as alive as I used to be, but I'm not yet dead. I'm sort of . . . in-between."</i>	Positive and Negative	This seems negative at first because he is dying, but Morrie implies that this is a good thing—a way to help people understand the transition from life to death.

Description of Mitch (Words and Actions)	Positive or Negative	Explanation

Exit Ticket

With a partner discuss the details you recorded on the charts and how you labeled them. If you disagree with a positive or negative label or an explanation, listen carefully to your partner's explanation before giving justifications for your own answer.

Then discuss the following questions:

- Were most of the details about Morrie positive or negative?
- Were most of the details about Mitch positive or negative?

Second Focus: Determining the Theme

Discover

Skill Focus: A memoir is a true story written by the person who lived through the events being described. The theme is the main idea, message or life lesson that the author wants to convey through the stories and reflections shared in their memoir.

To determine the theme of a memoir:

- Identify the central topics, issues and experiences the author writes about most. What are the key events and challenges? How does the author change or grow over time?
- Look for repeated ideas, images or phrases. Does the author emphasize certain concepts over and over? These can provide clues to the main themes.
- Consider what the author has learned from their experiences. Most memoirs involve the author arriving at new understandings or life lessons. The central insights or realizations point to the key themes.
- Themes are usually universal concepts that many people can relate to, even if the specific experiences are unique to the author. Some common memoir themes include identity, family, overcoming obstacles, forgiveness, love, loss, coming of age, etc. See if the main ideas line up with any broad themes.

The theme is rarely stated directly. You have to infer it by analyzing the important elements and ideas and how they tie together to convey a deeper meaning. The theme is the author's central point, the "so what?" that they want readers to understand through reading about their life experiences.

Read through the excerpt from *Tuesdays with Morrie* again with a partner. One person should take the part of Morrie and the other the part of Mitch.

What is the theme of the passage? To help you determine the theme, underline one or two sentences that capture the main idea of the passage.

Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. How does Morrie explain his popularity in lines 14 and following? What do you think of his reasoning?

2. How does Mitch describe what it feels like to sit with Morrie? Give examples.

Demonstrate

Authors carefully include descriptive details to develop the theme of a text. In the First Focus, you looked at the descriptive details about the two main characters. How do these details support the theme the author is communicating?

Read the dialogue below and then answer the questions on the next page.

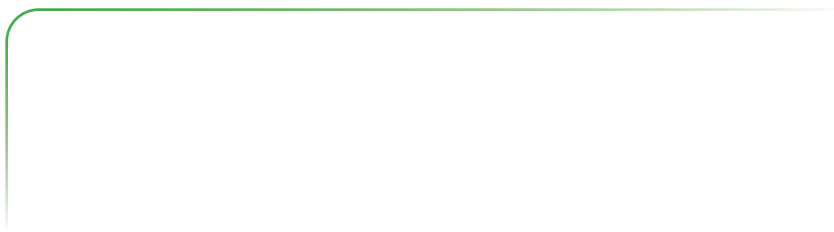
"Dying," Morrie suddenly said, "is only one thing to be sad over, Mitch. Living unhappily is something else. So many of the people who come to visit me are unhappy."

Why?

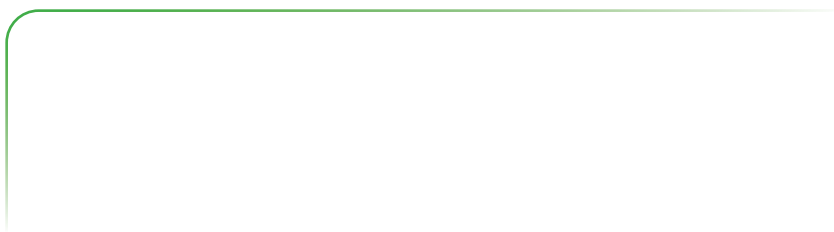
"Well, for one thing, the culture we have does not make people feel good about themselves. We're teaching the wrong things. And you have to be strong enough to say if the culture doesn't work, don't buy it. Create your own. Most people can't do it. They're more unhappy than me—even in my current condition.

"I may be dying, but I am surrounded by loving, caring souls. How many people can say that?"

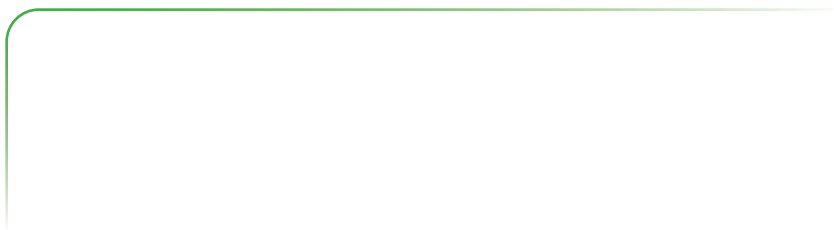
1. What theme or themes does the discussion between Mitch and Morrie introduce?



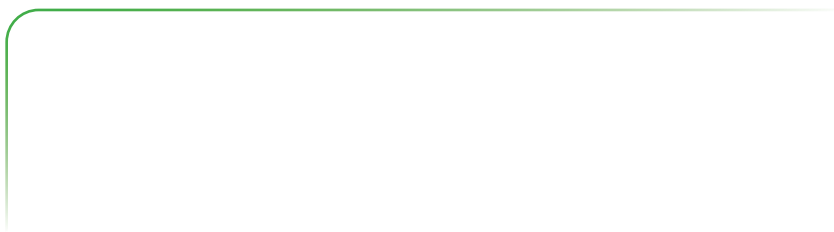
2. Based on his words and actions, how would you describe Morrie's character?



3. Based on his thoughts and actions, how would you describe Mitch's character?



4. How do the details about Mitch and Morrie support the theme of the passage?





Exit Ticket

Write several paragraphs in which you explain how descriptive details about Mitch and Morrie develop the theme of the text. Use examples of what the characters say, do, and think to support your analysis.

Third Focus: Synthesizing Details from Multiple Sources

Discover

Skill Focus: Synthesizing details means making connections between the sources and integrating different pieces of information. To synthesize effectively, you need to closely read each source, identify important details and examples, and consider the relationship between those details. The details may complement or contradict each other. The goal is not to treat the sources in isolation but to synthesize the details so that you gain a more complete understanding of the topic or events.

Read the excerpt from *Tuesdays with Morrie* one more time. Then read the following excerpt from a book by Morrie Schwartz himself.

Preview the text by looking at the structure and reading the headers and quotations under them. Think about how these features help the writer accomplish his purpose and message. As you read, underline important lessons about life and death.

excerpt

Morrie: In His Own Words

by Morrie Schwartz

Relating to Others

Keep your heart open for as long as you can, as wide as you can, for others and especially for yourself. Be generous, decent, and welcoming.

- 1 During the course of this illness I've made a half a dozen
or more new friends, people I had not met before. I've also
reestablished ties with people I had been out of touch with
for years, including former students who contacted me after
5 hearing that I was ill.

- If you are lonely, it's not too late to develop new
friendships or reconnect with people you've known. Even if
you have not been a friendly or approachable person in the
past, there is still time enough for you to change. But you're
10 not going to become a more benevolent person just by the
fact that you are dying; if you were a curmudgeon before,

Notes:

you'll still be one unless you make the effort to change.

Wanting to be different is just the beginning. There's no single way to go about changing the way you relate to others, but here are some suggestions. Identify what behavior you'd like to change; try to be specific. For example, if you don't want to be a curmudgeon any longer, you might set as your goal to be more cheerful or more outgoing. Then you need to identify things you can do toward accomplishing your goal. Your first step may be as simple as saying "Good morning," "please," and "thank you" more often. If your goal is to have people talk to you more often, work on being an attentive and concerned listener. If you want people to visit you more often, work on making their visits more pleasant for them.

You may feel a little uncomfortable for a while, especially if you worry that you are merely going through the motions or pretending to be what you are not. Look at it this way: What made you a curmudgeon, or whatever, was the fact that you acted like one. When you act like a kind and generous person, you eventually become one. However, don't push yourself too hard or try to change too quickly; otherwise you may become discouraged and give up. Also, don't expect others to notice or accept your changes immediately. Some people may never respond to you as you would like; others may take a while to warm up and want to associate with you.

No matter how others respond to the changes you make or how successful you are in your attempts to change, you will be a better person for having tried.

Notes:

Considering Death

*Learn how to live, and you'll know how to die;
learn how to die, and you'll know how to live.*

Notes:

The best preparation for living fully and well is to be
45 prepared to die at any time, because impending death
inspires a clarity of purpose, a homing in on what really
matters to you. When you feel that the end is near, you are
more likely to pay close attention to whatever you treasure, especially
relationships with loved ones.

50 The goals I have set for myself to help me stay composed during this
illness are not unlike those most of us have
aspired to since childhood: to behave with courage, dignity, generosity,
humor, love, openheartedness, patience, and
self-respect. When you are close to death, it is not easier to
55 achieve these goals than at other stages of your life, just
more urgent that you try. And the more committed you are to
living an ethical life, the less you have to fear having your life
come to an end.

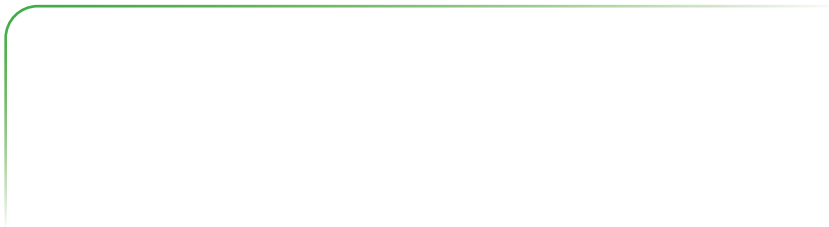
Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What does Morrie say about expecting others to respond to a change in behavior—and why? Give examples.



2. Morrie writes in “Considering Death”: “. . . impending death inspires a clarity of purpose, a homing in on what really matters to you.” How does this statement apply to Mitch’s reaction to Morrie in *Tuesdays with Morrie*?



Demonstrate

Morrie’s book of wisdom is organized by aphorisms. Using this organizational design allows him to teach important life lessons. An *aphorism* is a pithy observation that contains a general truth. Many teachers throughout history used aphorisms or proverbs to capture important ideas in a few careful words. Proverbs can be found in the Bible, Shakespeare’s plays, the writings of Ben Franklin, and the speeches of Dr. Martin Luther King Jr.

Return to the passage from *Tuesdays with Morrie* and identify where Morrie can be seen practicing the wisdom he shares in his own book. Fill in the table that appears on the next page.

Aphorism from <i>Morrie: In His Own Words</i>	Application in <i>Tuesdays with Morrie</i>
1.	
2.	
3.	
4.	



Exit Ticket

Choose one aphorism from *Morrie: In His Own Words* and explain how Morrie demonstrated this idea in *Tuesdays with Morrie*. Write two or more paragraphs using evidence from both texts. End your response with a reflection of the lesson you learned from what you read in this chapter.

Review

In this chapter, you learned to identify a work's theme, to analyze how details contributed to the theme of a work, and to synthesize information from multiple texts. This section will give you practice answering standardized test questions on the skills covered in this chapter.

1. Read the passage below from *Tuesdays with Morrie*. Then answer the question that follows.

I was astonished by his complete lack of self-pity. Morrie, who could no longer dance, swim, bathe, or walk; Morrie, who could no longer answer his own door, dry himself after a shower, or even roll over in bed. How could he be so accepting? I watched him struggle with his fork, picking at a piece of tomato, missing it the first two times—a pathetic scene, and yet I could not deny that sitting in his presence was almost magically serene, the same calm breeze that soothed me back in college.

Part A: Morrie's character can best be described as

- A. weary and ill-tempered.
- B. aging and sullen.
- C. positive but dramatic.
- D. suffering but tranquil.

Part B: Underline two sentences from the excerpt that support your answer to Part A.

2. Read the passage below from *Tuesdays with Morrie*. Then answer the questions that follow.

I squirmed, wanting to show I had been grappling deeply with such questions. *What happened to me?* I once promised myself I would never work for money, that I would join the Peace Corps, that I would live in beautiful, inspirational places. Instead, I had been in Detroit for ten years now, at the same workplace, using the same bank, visiting the same barber. I was thirty-seven, more efficient than in college, tied to computers and modems and cell phones. I wrote articles about rich athletes who, for the most part, could not care less about people like me. I was no longer young for my peer group, nor did I walk around in gray sweatshirts with unlit cigarettes in my mouth. I did not have long discussions over egg salad sandwiches about the meaning of life.

Part A: Mitch's character can best be described as

- A. adventurous and wealthy.
- B. reflective and contemplative.
- C. depressed and resentful.
- D. interested and grateful.

Part B: Underline two sentences from the excerpt that support your answer to Part A.

3. The contrasting descriptions of Morrie and Mitch best emphasize the truth of which of the following aphorisms?
- A. There's no single way to go about changing the way you relate to others.
 - B. Be generous, decent, and welcoming.
 - C. Keep your heart open for as long as you can, as wide as you can, for others and especially for yourself.
 - D. Learn how to live, and you'll know how to die; learn how to die, and you'll know how to live.



Chapter 10

Analyzing an Argument

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- learn strategies to help you read and comprehend difficult texts.
- identify a central claim in an argumentative text.
- identify and analyze reasons and evidence in an argument.
- understand the role of assumptions (warrants) in an argument.
- synthesize information from a graph into a written argument.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **argument:** a speech or essay that presents a claim and supports it with reasons and evidence.
- **claim:** the main statement of a written work that usually appears as an introduction or a point on which the author will develop the work in order to convince readers.
- **evidence:** facts, examples, or quotations presented in a written work in support of an argument or claim.
- **treatise:** a written work dealing formally and systematically with a subject.
- **warrant:** an explanation of why or how data supports a claim; the underlying assumption that connects data to a claim.

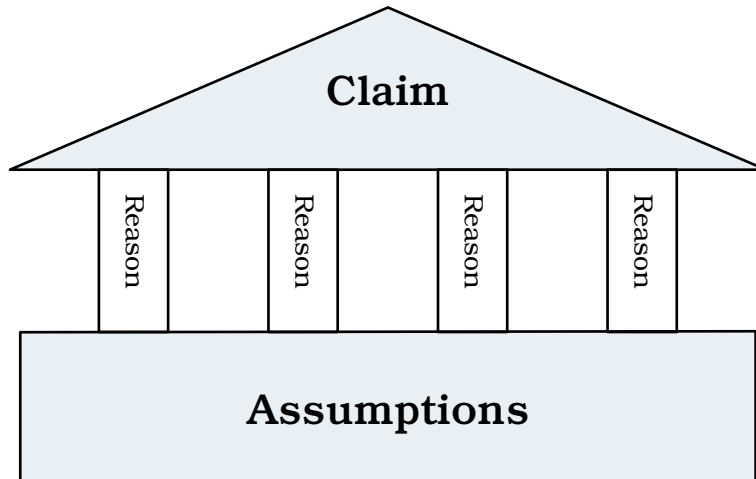
Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. The professor was famous for his _____ on teenagers' sleep patterns.
2. Anantha wrote a(n) _____ to persuade others to adopt her opinion about having a later start time for school.
3. The _____ in Anantha's essay stated that students, parents, and teachers would all benefit if school started 30 minutes later.
4. To support her argument about starting school later, Anantha gave strong _____, including research data and quotes from education experts and physicians.
5. The _____ for Anantha's argument was built upon a foundation of research, compelling evidence, and logical reasoning, providing a solid framework for the her claims.

Preview Concepts

An argumentative essay contains an opinion—a central claim—which the essay as a whole develops. The writer supports their claim with reasons. The reasons are generally developed in a paragraph with evidence. An entire argument is based upon assumptions that are the foundation of the argument. An assumption is an underlying premise on which the entire argument is based.

Here is a visual representation of the structure of an argument.



1. Where does evidence fit into the diagram? Add it to the diagram.
2. Read the following sentences. Identify which contains information that is a central claim, a reason, an assumption, and evidence.
 - “Intelligence” is the ability to think critically and solve problems effectively. _____
 - Technology is making us dumb. _____
 - The Internet—as the central medium by which we read, write, and learn—has fundamentally changed the wiring of our brains, diminishing our ability to think deeply and critically. _____
 - Studies have shown that reading uninterrupted text results in faster completion and better understanding, recall, and learning than reading text filled with hyperlinks and ads. _____

3. In an argument, writers often address a counterclaim, or an opposing viewpoint, so that they can explain why it is incorrect or unworkable. What is a counterclaim to the claim in question 2?



Read for Understanding

John Locke (1632–1704) was an English philosopher and physician whose writings led to the Enlightenment, an intellectual movement that emphasized reasoning and scientific thinking. He is known for his theories on the mind and the self, which greatly influenced the philosophers Voltaire and Rousseau, as well as many American founding fathers, including Thomas Jefferson. His work, *Some Thoughts Concerning Education*, was published in 1693 and became the leading philosophical work on education in England.

In this excerpt, Locke writes to parents about giving children too many rules. You will probably find this text challenging. Here are a few hints for reading difficult passages:

- Monitor your comprehension. When it breaks down, try rereading the last few sentences or paragraphs.
- Adjust your pace to the purpose of reading. Easier texts can be skimmed for main ideas. Difficult texts that require you to analyze details must be read more slowly.
- If you don't understand an idea, draw a question mark in the margin and keep reading. When you come to an idea that you do understand, use it to unlock the meaning of the unclear text you read previously. Write questions you have in the margins.
- Connect new ideas with what you already know. Finish the sentence, "This reminds me of . . ."
- To help you understand the main ideas and supporting points, look for transitional words and phrases and underline them.

Watch for words that indicate supporting points: *one thing, first, second, last*. If you see these words in a text, look back to find the idea the details are supporting.

Words that indicate relationships between ideas include *because, for, thus, but, on the other hand, or, since, and however*. When you see these words, try to figure out the relationship between the ideas.

As you read the following excerpt, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

Some Thoughts Concerning Education

by John Locke

Notes:

1 **64. Rules** And here give me leave to take notice of one thing
I think a fault in the ordinary method of education; and that
is, the **charging** of children's memories, upon all occasions,
with rules and **precepts**, which they often do not understand,
5 and constantly as soon forget as given. It be some action you
would have done, or done otherwise, whenever they forget,
or do it awkwardly, make them do it over and over again, 'till
they are perfect, whereby you will get these two advantages.
First, to see whether it be an action they can do, or is fit to
10 be expected of them: for sometimes children are bid to do
things which upon trial they are found not able to do, and
had need be taught and exercis'd in before they are requir'd
to do them. But it is much easier for a tutor to command than
to teach. Secondly, another thing got by it will be this, that by
15 repeating the same action 'till it be grown habitual in them,
the performance will not depend on memory or reflection, the
concomitant¹ of **prudence**² and age, and not of childhood, but
will be natural in them. Thus bowing to a gentleman, when he
salutes him, and looking in his face, when he speaks to him, is
20 by constant use as natural to a well-bred man, as breathing; it
requires no thought, no reflection. Having this way cured in
your child any fault, it is cured for ever: and thus one by one
you may weed them out all, and plant what habits you please.

I have seen parents so heap rules on their children, that it
25 was impossible for the poor little ones to remember a tenth
part of them, much less to observe them. However, they were
either by words or blows corrected for the **breach**³ of those

1 **concomitant**: happening at the same time

2 **prudence**: the quality of being wise or cautious

3 **breach**: an act of breaking or failing to observe a law, agreement, or code of conduct.

multiply'd and often very **impertinent**⁴ precepts. Whence
it naturally follow'd that the children minded not what was
30 said to them, when it was evident to them that no attention
they were capable of was sufficient to preserve them from
transgression⁵, and the **rebukes**⁶ which follow'd it.

Let therefore your rules to your son be as few as possible,
and rather fewer than more than seem absolutely necessary.
35 For if you burden him with many rules, one of these two
things must necessarily follow; that either he must be very
often punish'd, which will be of ill consequence, by making
punishment too frequent and familiar; or else you must
let the transgressions of some of your rules go unpunish'd,
40 whereby they will of course grow contemptible, and your
authority become cheap to him. Make but few laws, but see
they be well observ'd when once made. Few years require
but few laws, and as his age increases, when one rule is by
practice well establish'd, you may add another.

45 But pray remember, children are not to be taught by rules
which will be always slipping out of their memories. What you
think necessary for them to do, settle in them by an
indispensable practice, as often as the occasion returns; and if
it be possible, make occasions. This will beget habits in them
50 which being once establish'd, operate of themselves easily
and naturally, without the assistance of the memory. But here
let me give two cautions. 1. The one is, that you keep them to the
practice of what you would have grow into a habit
in them, by kind words, and gentle **admonitions**, rather as
55 minding them of what they forget, than by harsh rebukes and
chiding, as if they were wilfully guilty. 2. Another thing
you are to take care of, is, not to endeavour to settle too

4 **impertinent**: not relevant to a particular matter

5 **transgression**: the act of breaking a law, rule, or code of conduct

6 **rebukes**: expressions of sharp disapproval or criticism

Notes:

many habits at once, lest by variety you confound them, and so perfect none. When constant custom has made any one thing easy and natural to 'em, and they practise it without reflection, you may then go on to another.

This method of teaching children by a repeated practice, and the same action done over and over again, under the eye and direction of the tutor, 'till they have got the habit of doing it well, and not by relying on rules trusted to their memories, has so many advantages, which way soever we consider it, that I cannot but wonder (if ill customs could be wondered at in any thing) how it could possibly be so much neglected. I shall name one more that comes now in my way. By this method we shall see whether what is requir'd of him be adapted to his capacity, and any way suited to the child's natural genius and constitution; for that too much be consider'd in a right education. We must not hope wholly to change their original tempers, nor make the **gay**⁷ **pensive**⁸ and grave, nor the melancholy **sportive**⁹, without spoiling them. God has stamp'd certain characters upon men's minds, which like their shapes, may perhaps be a little mended, but can hardly be totally alter'd and transform'd into the contrary.

Notes:

7 **gay**: cheerful and lively personality
8 **pensive**: engaged in deep or serious thought
9 **sportive**: playful and active

First Focus: Identifying Central Ideas

Discover

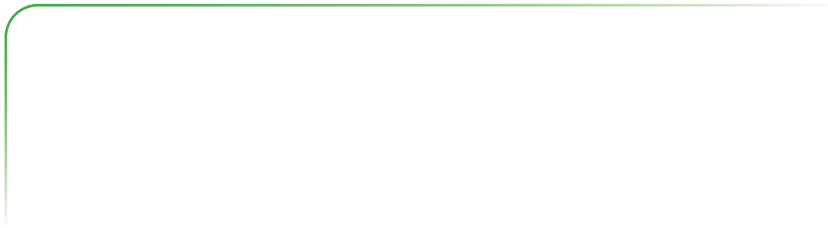
Skill Focus: Understanding the central ideas acts like a guide to recognizing the central claim at the heart of any persuasive argument. Authors use the main points to build up to and support their primary claim or viewpoint. Once you've determined the main ideas being emphasized, you can connect those to find the author's central claim.

Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and notice that Locke is talking about two different ways of teaching children—using rules and using repeated practice. Write rules next to each section that talks about rules. Write practice next to each section that discusses repeated practice.

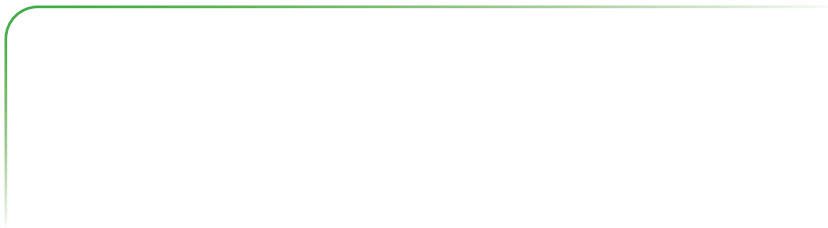
Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What does Locke advise about the role of repetition? Give examples.



2. What does Locke think results from forcing children to memorize rules? Give examples.



Demonstrate

Fill in the chart to help you organize the key ideas of the passage. Paraphrase or directly quote sentences that give details about the following central ideas.

Teaching by Giving Rules	Teaching by Repeated Practice/Modeling

Exit Ticket

With a partner, compare your answers in the chart. Then return to the text and underline the sentence that best captures the central claim of the text. Together, write a paraphrase of Locke's central claim. Write your sentence below.

Share your sentence with the class. Work together to write the best sentence that expresses the central claim most clearly.

Second Focus: Identifying Supporting Details

Discover

Skill Focus: In an argument, supporting details are the reasons, facts, examples, quotes, or other evidence an author provides to help prove their claim is valid and worth believing. All of these supporting details work together to bolster and justify the main claim being made. They answer the question “Why should I believe this claim is true?”

Reread the text. This time focus on how Locke supports his central claim. As you read, write a “what it says” statement and a “what it does” statement for each paragraph in the Notes column. The “what it says” statement summarizes the paragraph; the “what it does” statement explains the purpose of the paragraph. In other words, this exercise will help you determine how each paragraph supports the central claim of the text.

For example, next to the first paragraph of the excerpt, you might write: *What it says is that children should not be taught by giving them many rules to follow but by repetition of the behavior you want them to learn. What it does is explain the advantages (reasons) why repetition is better than rules.*

Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. How does Locke support the idea that giving children too many rules is counterproductive?

2. In the last half of paragraph 5, what other benefit does Locke argue will result from applying his method? Give examples.

Demonstrate

Locke develops his argument logically. Use textual clues to help you identify Locke's reasons that support his central claim.

1. Fill in the central claim in row 1 of the chart.
2. Add four reasons in support of the claim in row 2.
3. In an argument, good writers anticipate counterclaims to their claim and offer proof why their ideas are better than opposing ones. Identify where Locke anticipates opposition from people who say that children must be taught with many rules. Then fill in row 3 of the chart.
4. In an argument, writers often clarify their claim by defining terms and qualifying their ideas. Where does Locke offer some cautions about his claim and explain more in depth what he means by teaching with repetition and practice? Paraphrase these cautions in row 4 of the chart.

1. Central Claim:

2. Three reasons that support the central claim:

3. Reasons why using rules to teach children doesn't work (addressing a counterclaim):

4. Further explanation/qualifications of Locke's claim:

All arguments are based upon assumptions, or ideas that all people hold to be true. These are sometimes called *warrants*. Assumptions are usually beliefs about what is valuable and important or what people and the world are like. Assumptions connect reasons to the claim. The following graphic organizer breaks down the argument in the last paragraph by claim and reason. Return to the passage to identify the assumption Locke makes about education and human nature. Then fill in the final box below.

Analysis of Final Paragraph
Claim: This method of teaching children by a repeated practice, and the same action done over and over again, under the eye and direction of the tutor, 'till they have got the habit of doing it well, and not by relying on rules trusted to their memories, has so many advantages. . . .
Reason: By this method we shall see whether what is requir'd of him be adapted to his capacity, and any way suited to the child's natural genius and constitution
Assumption about education and human nature:

Third Focus: Evaluating an Argument

Discover

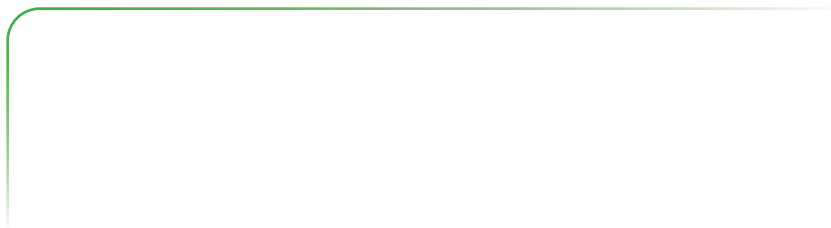
Skill Focus: When you evaluate a written argument, you're analyzing how convincing and well-supported the author's claims, reasons, and evidence are. It's like being a judge weighing the evidence. Identify the central claim, which is the main opinion, idea, or point the author wants you to agree with. Then look at all the supporting evidence and reasons the author provides to back up that claim. Your job is to closely examine all components of the argument and sources of evidence. Decide if you find the claim and reasons convincing and well-substantiated, or if there are too many gaps, flaws, or poor evidence that undermine the position.

Follow along as your teacher reads the text aloud. Imagine you are having a conversation with the author. As you listen to the arguments presented, question the writer in your mind. Think about responding with "Yes, but . . ." What reasons seem agreeable to you? What objections come to mind? Write down your objections and questions in the margin of the text.

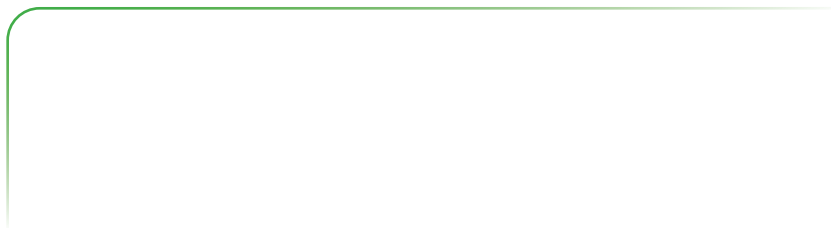
Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. In paragraph 1, Locke supports his claim about using practice, rather than rules, to teach children with an example of a desired behavior: "bowing to a gentleman, when he salutes him, and looking in his face, when he speaks to him." Upon what assumption is this example based?



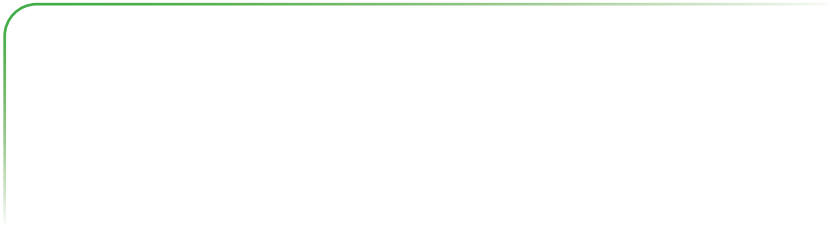
2. In lines 67–69, Locke states that his method of education makes so much sense that "I cannot but wonder (if ill customs could be wondered at in any thing) how it could possibly be so much neglected." Which sentence in the passage suggests one reason why parents and teachers often resort to imposing lots of rules?



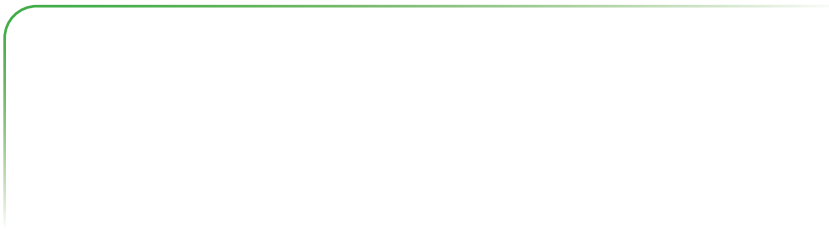
Demonstrate

Review the chart that you used to outline the writer's argument. Use the questions below to evaluate Locke's argument.

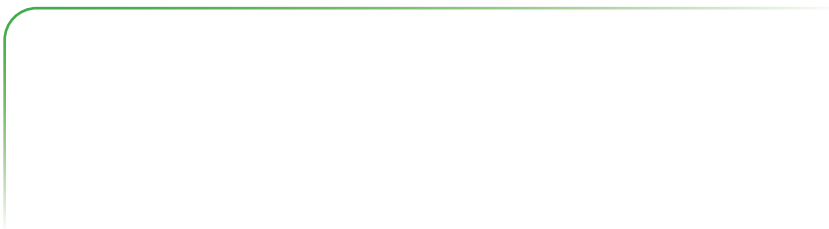
1. Do the reasons logically support the claim? Which reason is the strongest? Which is the weakest?



2. Does the writer attempt to address objections to his claim? Is this section effective? Does it strengthen or weaken his argument?



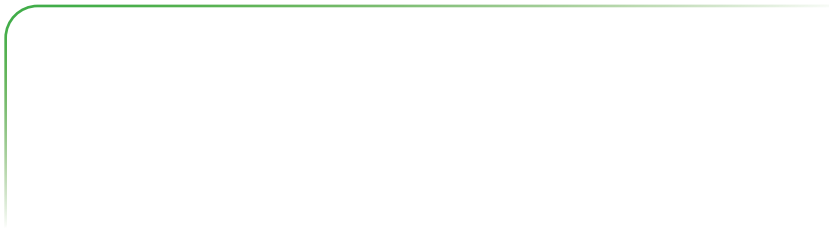
3. Does the writer offer evidence to support his reasons? Explain.



4. Does the writer show bias or use emotion to manipulate the audience?
Provide examples to support your conclusion.



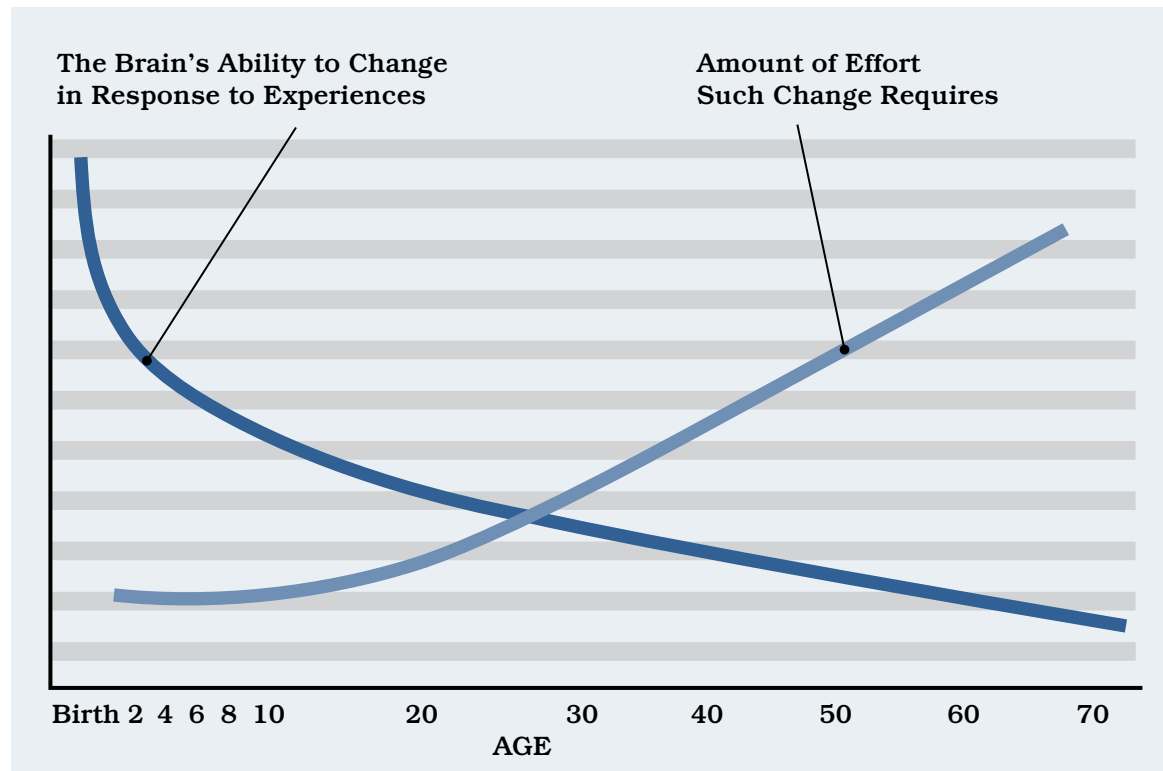
5. Is the tone appropriate? Support your answer with evidence.



Focus on Integrating Information into an Argument:

Locke wrote his thesis on education in 1693. He supported his arguments with conclusions based upon observations of how children learn. Today, writers use scientific data as evidence to support reasons. Study the graph below.

Critical Periods of Brain Development



Source: <http://developingchild.harvard.edu/science/key-concepts/brain-architecture/>

It is easier and less costly to form strong brain circuits during the early years than it is to intervene or “fix” them later.

1. What data about the brain's ability to change does the graph communicate? At what ages is it easiest for the brain to change?

2. Does this graph support Locke's thesis that children should be able to learn new behaviors based on repeated practice? Why or why not?

3. Which of Locke's reasons does the graph above best support?



Exit Ticket

- 1 Share your answers to questions 1–3 with a partner. Discuss any differences between your answers.
- 2 Find another piece of evidence that supports or refutes Locke's arguments about the best methods for teaching children. Explain in a few sentences how modern science supports and/or refutes Locke's argument.

Review

On reading assessments, you may be asked to analyze an argument and identify claims, reasons, and evidence. Some questions may ask you about relationships among ideas in a text.

Read the following and then answer the questions that follow.

I have seen parents so heap rules on their children, that it was impossible for the poor little ones to remember a tenth part of them, much less to observe them. However, they were either by words or blows corrected for the breach of those multiply'd and often very impertinent precepts. Whence it naturally follow'd that the children minded not what was said to them, when it was evident to them that no attention they were capable of was sufficient to preserve them from transgression, and the rebukes which follow'd it.

Let therefore your rules to your son be as few as possible, and rather fewer than more than seem absolutely necessary. For if you burden him with many rules, one of these two things must necessarily follow; that either he must be very often punish'd, which will be of ill consequence, by making punishment too frequent and familiar; or else you must let the transgressions of some of your rules go unpunish'd, whereby they will of course grow contemptible, and your authority become cheap to him. Make but few laws, but see they be well observ'd when once made. Few years require but few laws, and as his age increases, when one rule is by practice well establish'd, you may add another.

1. How does the first paragraph fit into the author's argument?
 - A. It provides an example to support a reason.
 - B. It provides background for the argument.
 - C. It attacks and refutes the opposing side to the argument.
 - D. It explains an assumption on which the argument is based.
2. The main purpose of the first paragraph is to explain _____.
 - A. the number of rules children should be given.
 - B. why parents who give their children many rules should be punished.
 - C. why giving children many rules is not effective.
 - D. the best way to punish a child for breaking rules.

3. **Part A:** In the second paragraph Locke attacks the viewpoint of parents who believe in giving their children many rules by _____
- A. giving an example of how too many rules damaged a child's emotional life.
 - B. explaining the impossibility of consistently disciplining a child when too many rules are imposed.
 - C. contrasting the ease of teaching a child by memorization as opposed to giving them rules to follow.
 - D. assuring parents that children can learn as many rules as their age.

Part B: Which of the following excerpts from the passage best supports your answer to Part A?

- A. *that it was impossible for the poor little ones to remember a tenth part of them, much less to observe them.*
- B. *However, they were either by words or blows corrected for the breach of those multiply'd and often very impertinent precepts.*
- C. *or else you must let the transgressions of some of your rules go unpunish'd, whereby they will of course grow contemptible, and your authority become cheap to him.*
- D. *Few years require but few laws, and as his age increases, when one rule is by practice well establish'd, you may add another.*

Read the paragraph and then answer the questions that follow.

This method of teaching children by a repeated practice, and the same action done over and over again, under the eye and direction of the tutor, 'till they have got the habit of doing it well, and not by relying on rules trusted to their memories, has so many advantages, which way soever we consider it, that I cannot but wonder (if ill customs could be wondered at in any thing) how it could possibly be so much neglected. I shall name one more that comes now in my way. By this method we shall see whether what is requir'd of him be adapted to his capacity, and any way suited to the child's natural genius and constitution; for that too much be consider'd in a right education. We must not hope wholly to change their original tempers, nor make the gay pensive and grave, nor the melancholy sportive, without spoiling them. God has stamp'd certain characters upon men's minds, which like their shapes, may perhaps be a little mended, but can hardly be totally alter'd and transform'd into the contrary.

4. Which of the following explains a specific reason for the author's claim?
 - A. *This method of teaching children by a repeated practice, and the same action done over and over again, under the eye and direction of the tutor, 'till they have got the habit of doing it well . . . has so many advantages. . . .*
 - B. *I cannot but wonder (if ill customs could be wondered at in any thing) how it could possibly be so much neglected.*
 - C. *By this method we shall see whether what is requir'd of him be adapted to his capacity, and any way suited to the child's natural genius and constitution; for that too much be consider'd in a right education.*
 - D. *God has stamp'd certain characters upon men's minds, which like their shapes, may perhaps be a little mended, but can hardly be totally alter'd and transform'd into the contrary.*
5. Which of the following best explains the assumption Locke makes to connect the reason to the claim?
 - A. Children have personalities which can't be completely changed.
 - B. Children can more easily change their behavior than adults.
 - C. Children learn better from each other than from adults.
 - D. Children have unique learning styles as established by their genes.



Chapter 11

Using Literal and Figurative Language to Persuade

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- analyze the use of symbolism in an allegory.
- identify the meaning of an allegory.
- understand what makes an argument valid and reasoning logical.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **allegory:** a story, poem, or picture that can be interpreted to reveal a hidden meaning, usually moral or political.
- **analogy:** a comparison of two things, typically on the basis of their structure and for the purpose of explanation or clarification.
- **fallacious reasoning:** the use of invalid or otherwise faulty logic in the construction of an argument.
- **metonymy:** a word, name, or expression used as a substitute for something else with which it is closely associated.
- **satire:** the use of humor, irony, exaggeration, or ridicule to expose and criticize people's stupidity or vices, particularly in the context of politics and other topical issues.
- **symbolism:** a type of figurative language in which an object, person, or event in a literary text represents something else.

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. By using the Statue of Liberty to stand for freedom in his novel, the author incorporated _____ into his writing.
2. The novel *The Lord of the Flies* is often interpreted as an _____, with the island representing society and the boys' descent into savagery symbolizing the darker aspects of human nature.
3. In the sentence, "The White House issued a statement," the term "White House" is a _____ used to refer to the United States government as a whole.

4. Political cartoons often feature _____ that ridicules state and national government officials.
5. Superstition is a form of _____ because we know that people don't suffer bad luck just because they walk under a ladder or see a black cat.
6. When I told Dad I wanted to apply to Harvard, he remarked that I was "swinging for the fences," making a(n) _____ between life and baseball.

Preview Concepts

Symbolism is a type of figurative language in which an object, person, or event in a literary text stands for something else. Often, symbols are physical objects that represent abstract qualities. For example, a heart is often used as a symbol for love or a dove is used to represent peace. In literature, symbols are often more complicated. For example, a ghost that appears to a main character may represent past guilt or failures that continue to haunt the character in the present day. In fables and fairy tales, animals represent character qualities, such as the owl, which often symbolizes the quality of wisdom. Identify what the following might symbolize.

eagle

fox

pig

mirror

the color white

clock

What other examples of symbolism can you think of? Write them below.

Read for Understanding

Read the following excerpt from a letter written by Benjamin Franklin. As a teenager, Benjamin Franklin tried and failed to publish his work in his older brother's newspaper, *The New-England Courant*. Franklin then took the pen name Mrs. Silence Dogood and secretly left letters under his brother's door. As a result of the name change, he successfully published 14 letters (called epistles) in the *Courant*, the first of which was published in 1722. Franklin's letters were both entertaining and instructive. They mocked elements of American society, such as women's petticoats and public education.

In the following letter, Franklin (writing as Dogood) questions a reverend about whether her son should go to college.

As you read, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

Silence Dogood Letter #4

by Benjamin Franklin

May 14, 1722

1 Sir,

Discoursing the other Day at Dinner with my Reverend
Boarder, formerly mention'd, (whom for Distinction sake we
will call by the Name of Clericus,) concerning the Education
5 of Children, I ask'd his Advice about my young Son William,
whether or no I had best bestow upon him Academical
Learning, or (as our Phrase is) *bring him up at our College*¹:
He persuaded me to do it by all Means, using many weighty
Arguments with me, and answering all the Objections that
10 I could form against it; telling me withal, that he did not
doubt but that the Lad would take his Learning very well,
and not idle away his Time as too many there now-a-days do.
These Words of Clericus gave me a Curiosity to inquire a little more
15 strictly into the present Circumstances of that famous Seminary of
Learning; but the Information which he gave

1 **our College:** Harvard College

Notes:

me, was neither pleasant, nor such as I expected.

As soon as Dinner was over, I took a solitary Walk into my Orchard, still **ruminating** on Clericus's Discourse with much Consideration, until I came to my usual Place of Retirement
20 under the *Great Apple-Tree*; where having seated my self, and carelessly laid my Head on a **verdant**² Bank, I fell by Degrees into a soft and undisturbed Slumber. My waking Thoughts remained with me in my Sleep, and before I awak'd again, I dreamt the following Dream.

25 I fancy'd I was travelling over pleasant and delightful Fields and Meadows, and thro' many small Country Towns and Villages; and as I pass'd along, all Places resounded with the Fame of the Temple of Learning: Every Peasant, who had wherewithal, was preparing to send one of his
30 Children at least to this famous Place; and in this Case most of them consulted their own Purses instead of their Children's Capacities: So that I observed, a great many, yea, the most part of those who were travelling thither, were little better than Dunces and Blockheads. Alas! alas!

35 At length I entred upon a spacious Plain, in the Midst of which was erected a large and stately **Edifice**: It was to this that a great Company of Youths from all Parts of the Country were going; so stepping in among the Crowd, I passed on with them, and presently arrived at the Gate.

40 The Passage was kept by two sturdy Porters named *Riches* and *Poverty*, and the latter obstinately refused to give Entrance to any who had not first gain'd the Favour of the former; so that I observed, many who came even to the very Gate, were obliged to travel back again as ignorant as they
45 came, for want of this necessary Qualification. However, as

Notes:

2 **verdant**: a bright green color

a Spectator I gain'd Admittance, and with the rest entred directly into the Temple.

In the Middle of the great Hall stood a stately and magnificent Throne, which was ascended to by two high and
50 difficult Steps. On the Top of it sat Learning in awful State; she was apparelled wholly in Black, and surrounded almost on every Side with innumerable Volumes in all Languages. She seem'd very busily employ'd in writing something on half a Sheet of Paper, and upon Enquiry, I understood she was
55 preparing a Paper, call'd, *The New-England Courant*. On her Right Hand sat English, with a pleasant smiling Countenance, and handsomely attir'd; and on her left were seated several *Antique Figures* with their Faces **vail'd**³. I was considerably puzzl'd to guess who they were, until one informed me,
60 (who stood beside me,) that those Figures on her left Hand were *Latin, Greek, Hebrew, &c.* and that they were very much reserv'd, and seldom or never unvail'd their Faces here, and then to few or none, tho' most of those who have in this Place acquir'd so much Learning as to distinguish them from
65 *English*, pretended to an intimate Acquaintance with them. I then enquir'd of him, what could be the Reason why they continued vail'd, in this Place especially: He pointed to the Foot of the Throne, where I saw *Idleness*, attended with *Ignorance*, and these (he informed me) were they, who first
70 vail'd them, and still kept them so.

Now I observed, that the whole Tribe who entred into the Temple with me, began to climb the Throne; but the Work proving troublesome and difficult to most of them, they withdrew their Hands from the Plow, and contented
75 themselves to sit at the Foot, with Madam *Idleness* and her

Notes:

3 **vail'd**: veiled, wearing veils

Maid *Ignorance*, until those who were assisted by Diligence and a **docile** Temper, had well nigh got up the first Step:

But the Time drawing nigh in which they could no way avoid ascending, they were **fain** to crave the Assistance of those

80 who had got up before them, and who, for the Reward perhaps of a *Pint of Milk*, or a *Piece of Plumb-Cake*, lent the Lubbers a helping Hand, and sat them in the Eye of the World, upon a Level with themselves.

The other Step being in the same Manner ascended, and

85 the usual Ceremonies at an End, every Beetle-Scull seem'd well satisfy'd with his own Portion of Learning, tho' perhaps he was *e'en just* as ignorant as ever. And now the Time of their Departure being come, they march'd out of Doors to make Room for another Company, who waited for Entrance:

90 And I, having seen all that was to be seen, quitted the Hall likewise, and went to make my Observations on those who were just gone out before me. . . .

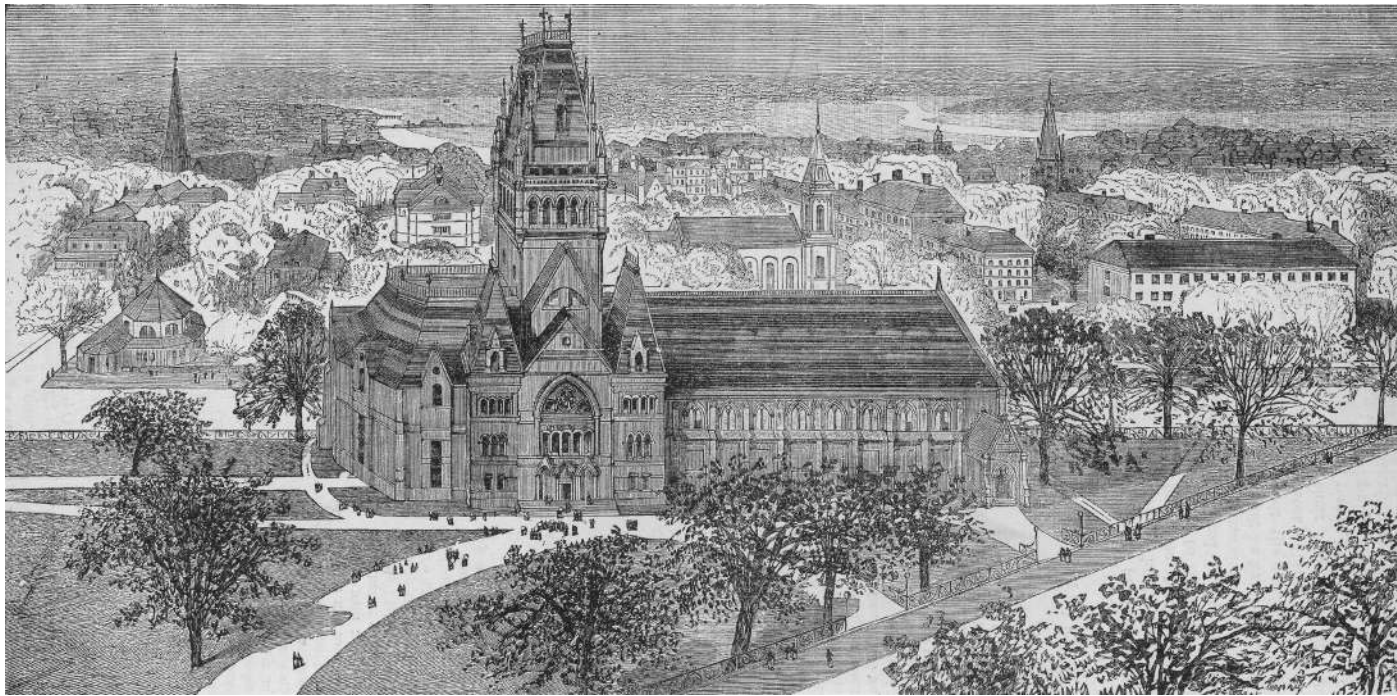
Now I bethought my self in my Sleep, that it was Time to be at Home, and as I fancy'd I was travelling back thither, I

95 reflected in my Mind on the extream Folly of those Parents, who, blind to their Childrens Dulness, and insensible of the Solidity of their Skulls, because they think their Purses can afford it, will needs send them to the Temple of Learning, where, for want of a suitable Genius, they learn little more
100 than how to carry themselves handsomely, and enter a Room genteely, (which might as well be acquir'd at a Dancing-School,) and from whence they return, after Abundance of Trouble and Charge, as great Blockheads as ever, only more proud and self-conceited.

Notes:

105 While I was in the midst of these unpleasant Reflections,
Clericus (who with a Book in his Hand was walking under
the Trees) accidentally awak'd me; to him I related my
Dream with all its Particulars, and he, without much Study,
presently interpreted it, assuring me, *That it was a lively*
110 *Representation of Harvard College, Etcetera.* I remain, Sir,
Your Humble Servant,
SILENCE DOGOOD.

Notes:



Engraving of Harvard Yard at Harvard University, Cambridge, Massachusetts, circa 1780

First Focus: Understanding Allegory

Discover

Skill Focus: An allegory is a story or narrative that has two layers of meaning—a literal level and a deeper, symbolic level. On the surface, an allegory tells a straightforward story about characters and events. But allegories also function as an extended metaphor, where the characters, plot, and details represent abstract ideas, historical events, or moral and political concepts. Essentially, allegories use fictional stories as symbolic representations to convey a moral, lesson, or deeper message about real-world situations, human nature, political systems, or historic events.

A simple example of allegory is “The Tortoise and the Hare.” The Hare represents people who are overconfident and lazy. The Tortoise represents people who work hard and are persistent. The race represents life. The outcome of the story communicates the theme that, ultimately, perseverance and dedication pay off.

When reading an allegory, you have to interpret it on two levels—understanding both the surface story being told, as well as decoding the richer symbolic meaning.

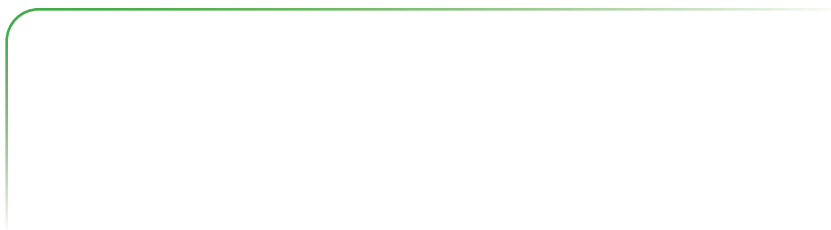
Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and visualize what is being described in the dream; draw pictures of what is happening. Draw a line where the introduction ends and the dream begins and a line where the dream ends and the conclusion starts. Write questions you have about the text in the Notes column.

Overall, is the opinion of higher education good or bad?

Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What does the author mean by this sentence from paragraph 5: “The Passage was kept by two sturdy Porters named *Riches* and *Poverty*, and the latter obstinately refused to give Entrance to any who had not first gain’d the Favour of the former; . . . many who came even to the very Gate, were obliged to travel back again as ignorant as they came, for want of this necessary Qualification”?



2. What is happening in paragraph 6, and why does the author include it? Give examples.

Demonstrate

An allegory is a story, poem, or picture in which characters represent abstract ideas and qualities. The characters act like symbols that have meaning in and of themselves but also stand for something else. An allegory is often used to teach a moral lesson.

Some symbols from Franklin’s letter are listed in the first column below. In the second column, describe the object or character literally. In the third column, explain the symbolic meaning within the context of the letter. This is the symbol’s figurative meaning.

Symbols in Silence Dogood’s Letter		
Symbol	Description in the Allegory	Figurative Meaning
Temple of Learning		

continued on next page

Symbols in Silence Dogood's Letter		
Symbol	Description in the Allegory	Figurative Meaning
Porters: Riches and Poverty		
Learning		
Idleness & Ignorance		

Symbols in Silence Dogood's Letter		
Symbol	Description in the Allegory	Figurative Meaning
Antique Figures with their Faces vail'd		
The Reward		

Exit Ticket

Share your answers to the chart with a partner. If you disagree about what the symbols mean, discuss your differences in opinion, using evidence from the text to support your point of view. Then join with another pair and share your answers.

Understanding Metonymy

Metonymy is a figure of speech in which a word stands for something else with which it is closely associated. Here are some examples.

- The White House made the decision. (*The White House* stands for the president and his office.)
- Hollywood produced powerful films this year. (*Hollywood* stands for the U.S. film industry.)
- The pen is mightier than the sword. (*Pen* stands for written words and *sword* refers to military force.)

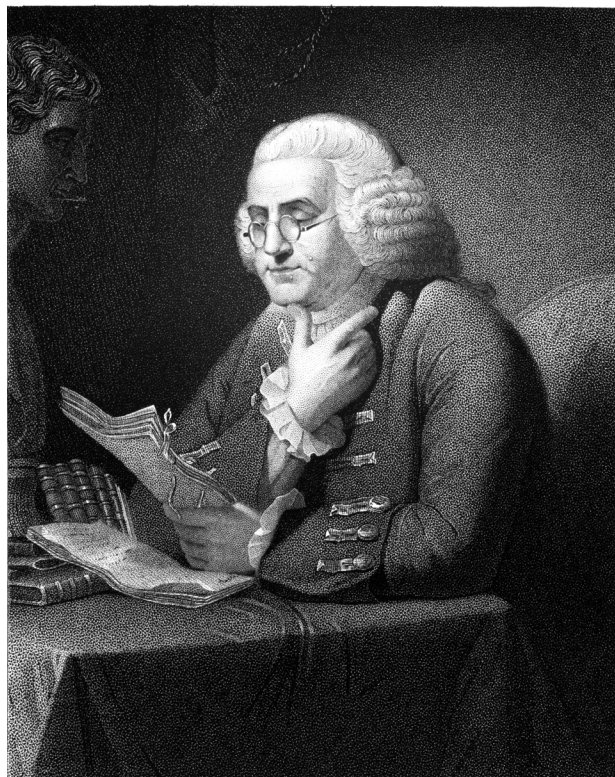
Notice the following examples of metonymy in Benjamin Franklin's letter. Find each word in the text and note the context. Then, next to each word below, write the idea that is being represented by the object.

1. purse

2. skulls

3. a helping hand

4. gate



Second Focus: Determining Theme

Discover

Skill Focus: To find the theme or deeper meaning of an allegory, you have to look beyond the literal story being told. Since allegories use characters, situations, and details to symbolize abstract ideas, determining the theme lies in uncovering what those symbols represent. What universal concept does the entire narrative symbolize? Is it revealing truths about freedom, justice, morality, or human strengths and flaws? By interpreting how the fictional allegory symbolically depicts something true about the real world, you can determine the key theme the author is conveying with their extended metaphor story.

Reread the text with a partner. Take turns reading a paragraph and then summarizing the content. Follow these steps:

Partner 1: Read a paragraph.

Partner 2: Summarize what you heard.

Both: Write a one-sentence summary of the paragraph in the Notes column.

Continue with Partner 2 reading and Partner 1 summarizing. Alternate roles until the entire passage has been read and each paragraph summarized. When you are finished reading, write questions you have about the meaning of the text.

Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What does the author believe results from sending unsuitable students to college? Give examples.

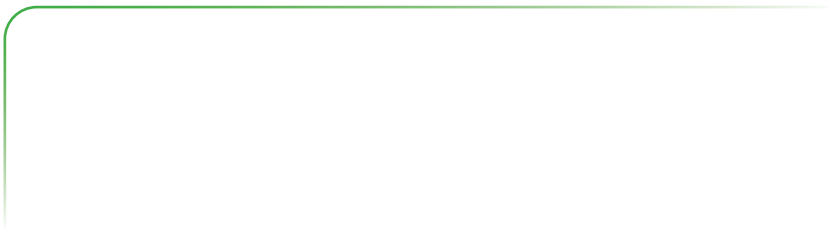
2. What do you think motivated Franklin to write this letter? Upon which text details do you base your opinion?

Demonstrate

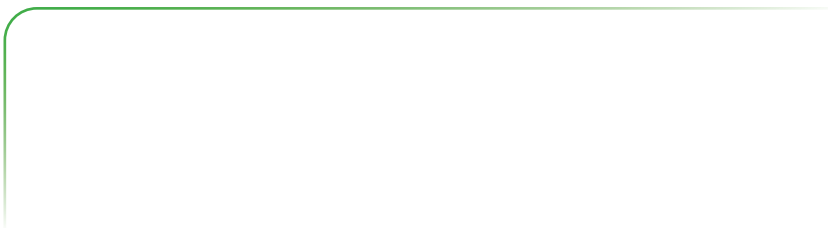
An allegory is a story that has a hidden meaning, which is usually related to morality or politics. During the 15th and 16th centuries, morality plays were a popular form of entertainment. In these plays, the main character, Everyman, represented all of humanity. Everyman often encountered characters named Greed or Lust, who tempted him to do evil and eventually led to his downfall. Clearly, these plays were meant to teach audiences to avoid temptation and pursue the path of good.

Franklin's allegory is a bit more sophisticated. He is not merely trying to warn students and their parents, but he is also satirizing higher education and specifically Harvard College. *Satire* is writing that points out society's flaws through the use of humor, exaggeration, or ridicule. Answer the following questions to help you determine the theme of the passage.

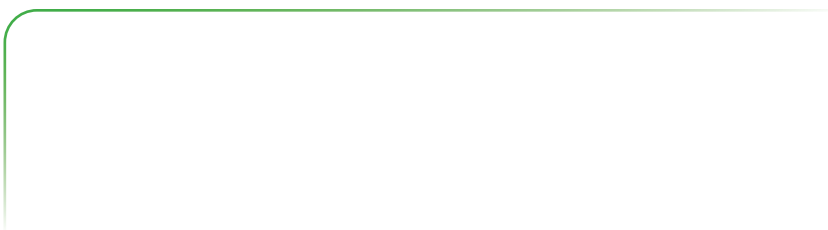
1. What do the two Porters satirize?



2. What do Learning and the Antique Figures satirize?



3. What does the description of the Tribe climbing the Throne and the use of Rewards satirize?



4. What is the theme of the work?

Exit Ticket

With a group of four or five students, conduct a Socratic seminar on the following question.

- Does Franklin's allegory more effectively accomplish his purpose than if he had written his thoughts directly and literally? Why or why not?

Come to the seminar with an entry ticket—your answers to the questions written down along with evidence from the text. Also, prepare one question (not one that can be answered with a simple **yes or no**) and write it at the bottom of your notes. In order to have a successful seminar, be ready to ask questions and delve deeper into the passages. Before you participate, study the following code of conduct.

Socratic Seminar

Code of Conduct

- ☐ Bring your student book, notes, pencil, and entry ticket.
- ☐ Speak one at a time, without interrupting each other.
- ☐ Speak without raising hands.
- ☐ Adjust your words and tone to a formal discussion with your classmates.
- ☐ Use eye contact and names when addressing others.
- ☐ Listen to whoever is speaking and take notes.
- ☐ Cite line or paragraph numbers from the text when speaking.
- ☐ Connect your ideas with someone else's.
- ☐ Agreeably disagree with the idea—not the person.
- ☐ Ask people to rephrase if you don't understand; ask for examples.
- ☐ Be open to other opinions—don't assume your idea is the only "right" one.
- ☐ Challenge yourself, others, and the text.

continued on the next page

Before the seminar, study the rubric below so you understand the expectations for the activity. Use it to keep track of your participation during the seminar. Afterward, use it to rate yourself.

	Description	Rating (5-meets qualifications to 1-does not meet qualifications)
Questioning	▪ Has prepared several high level questions based upon the text(s) ▪ Asks pertinent questions in a positive manner	
Speaking	▪ Comments move the conversation forward ▪ Refers to the text while offering insightful contributions ▪ Builds upon the ideas of others	
Listening	▪ Actively listens and takes notes ▪ Addresses other students' ideas and builds on them ▪ Asks for clarification as needed	
Reading	▪ Uses evidence from the text that demonstrates a thorough understanding of the main themes and ideas ▪ Offers personal commentary and inferences about ideas in the texts	

Comments:

Third Focus: Recognizing Valid Reasoning and Relevant Evidence

Discover

Skill Focus: When reading argumentative essays, try to envision you are having a debate with the author. Do not passively accept what they write. Question whether the main ideas are valid and supported with logical evidence.

This following is an excerpt from a commentary about getting college education. In her classic essay from 1975, “Where College Fails Us,” author Caroline Bird argues that college isn’t right for everyone.

Read Bird’s essay with the viewpoint of a skeptic. Interact with the text by asking questions: *Is this true? Is this convincing? What about . . . ?* Write these and other questions in the Notes column next to the text.

excerpt

Where College Fails Us

by Caroline Bird

- 1 The case for college has been accepted without question for more than a generation. All high school graduates ought to go, says Conventional Wisdom and statistical evidence, because college will help them earn more money, become
- 5 “better” people, and learn to be more responsible citizens than those who don’t go.

- But college has never been able to work its magic for everyone. And now that close to half our high school graduates are attending,¹ those who don’t fit the pattern
- 10 are becoming more numerous, and more obvious. College graduates are selling shoes and driving taxis; college students sabotage each other’s experiments and forge letters of recommendation in the intense competition for admission to graduate school. Others find no stimulation in

¹ Ms. Bird’s article appeared in 1975. In 2015, 69.2 percent of high school graduates went on to enroll in college or university.

Notes:

15 their studies, and drop out—often encouraged by college administrators.

Some observers say the fault is with the young people themselves—they are spoiled, stoned, overindulged, and expecting too much. But that's mass character assassination, and doesn't explain all campus unhappiness. Others blame the state of the world, and they are partly right. We've been told that young people have to go to college because our economy can't absorb an army of untrained eighteen-year-olds. But disillusioned graduates are learning that it can no longer absorb an army of trained twenty-two-year-olds, either.²

Some adventuresome educators and campus watchers have openly begun to suggest that college may not be the best, the proper, the only place for every young person after the completion of high school. We may have been looking at all those surveys and statistics upside down, it seems, and through the rosy glow of our own remembered college experiences. Perhaps college doesn't make people intelligent, ambitious, happy, liberal, or quick to learn new things—maybe it's just the other way around, and intelligent, ambitious, happy, liberal, and quick-learning people are merely the ones who have been attracted to college in the first place. And perhaps all those successful college graduates would have been successful whether they had gone to college or not. This is heresy to those of us who have been brought up to believe that if a little schooling is good, more has to be much better. But contrary evidence is beginning to mount up.

Notes:

² The National Center for Education Statistics (NCES) states 1,920,718 students at the bachelor's degree level graduated as the Class of 2016. In 2015 there were approximately 5.5 million job openings.

The unhappiness and discontent of young people is
45 nothing new, and problems of adolescence are always
painfully intense. But while traveling around the country,
speaking at colleges, and interviewing students at all kinds
of schools—large and small, public and private—I was
overwhelmed by the prevailing sadness. It was as visible on
50 campuses in California as in Nebraska and Massachusetts.
Too many young people are in college reluctantly, because
everyone told them they ought to go, and there didn't seem
to be anything better to do. Their elders sell them college
because it's good for them. Some never learn to like it, and
55 talk about their time in school as if it were a sentence to be
served.

Students tell us the same thing college counselors tell us—
they go because of pressure from parents and teachers, and
stay because it seems to be an alternative to a far worse fate.
60 It's "better" than the Army or a dead-end job, and it has to
be pretty bad before it's any worse than staying at home.

College graduates say that they don't want to work "just"
for the money: They want work that matters. They want to
help people and save the world. But the numbers are stacked
65 against them. Not only are there not enough jobs in world-
saving fields, but in the current slowdown it has become
evident that there never were, and probably never will be,
enough jobs requiring higher education to go around. . . .

A diploma saves the employer the cost of screening
70 candidates and gives him a predictable product: He can
assume that those who have survived the four-year ordeal
have learned how to manage themselves. They have learned
how to budget their time, meet deadlines, set priorities, cope

Notes:

with impersonal authority, follow instructions, and stick with

75 a task that may be tiresome without direct supervision.

The employer is also betting that it will be cheaper and easier to train the college graduate because he has demonstrated his ability to learn. But if the diploma serves only to identify those who are talented in the art

80 of schoolwork, it becomes, in the words of Harvard's Christopher Jencks, "a hell of an expensive aptitude test." It is unfair to the candidates because they themselves must bear the cost of the screening—the cost of college.

Candidates without the funds, the academic temperament, 85 or the patience for the four-year obstacle race are ruled out, no matter how well they may perform on the job. But if "everyone" has a diploma, employers will have to find another way to choose employees, and it will become an empty credential. . . .

Taxpayers now provide more than half of the astronomical 90 sums that are spent on higher education. But less than half of today's high school graduates go on, raising a new question of equity: Is it fair to make all the taxpayers pay for the minority who actually go to college? We decided long ago that it is fair for childless adults to pay school taxes because 95 everyone, parents and nonparents alike, profits by a literate population. Does the same reasoning hold true for state-supported higher education? There is no conclusive evidence on either side.³

Young people cannot be expected to go to college for the 100 general good of mankind. They may be more altruistic than their elders, but no great numbers are going to spend four years at hard intellectual labor, let alone tens of thousands

Notes:

³ Beginning in 2014, students at four-year colleges and universities now pay half or more on average of the full institutional cost to provide their education.

of family dollars, for “the advancement of human capability in society at large,” one of the many purposes invoked by
105 the Carnegie Commission report. Nor do any considerable number of them want to go to college to beat the Russians to Jupiter, improve the national defense, increase the Gross National Product, lower the crime rate, improve automobile safety, or create a market for the arts—all of which have
110 been suggested at one time or other as benefits taxpayers get for supporting higher education.

One sociologist said that you don’t have to have a reason for going to college because it’s an institution. His definition of an institution is something everyone subscribes to without
115 question. The burden of proof is not on why you should go to college, but why anyone thinks there might be a reason for not going. The implication—and some educators express it quite frankly—is that an eighteen-year-old high school graduate is still too young and confused to know what he
120 wants to do, let alone what is good for him.

Mother knows best, in other words.

It had always been comfortable for students to believe that authorities, like Mother, or outside specialists, like educators, could determine what was best for them.
125 However, specialists and authorities no longer enjoy the credibility former generations accorded them. Patients talk back to doctors and are not struck suddenly dead. Clients question the lawyer’s bills and sometimes get them reduced. It is no longer self-evident that all adolescents must study
130 a fixed curriculum that was constructed at a time when all educated men could agree on precisely what it was that made them educated.

Notes:

The same with college. If high school graduates don't want to continue their education, or don't want to continue it
135 right away, they may perceive more clearly than their elders that college is not for them.

College is an ideal place for those young adults who love learning for its own sake, who would rather read than eat, and who like nothing better than writing research papers.
140 But they are a minority, even at the prestigious colleges, which recruit and attract the intellectually oriented.

The rest of our high school graduates need to look at college more closely and critically, to examine it as a consumer product, and decide if the cost in dollars, in time,
145 in continued dependency, and in future returns, is worth the very large investment each student—and his family—must make.

Notes:



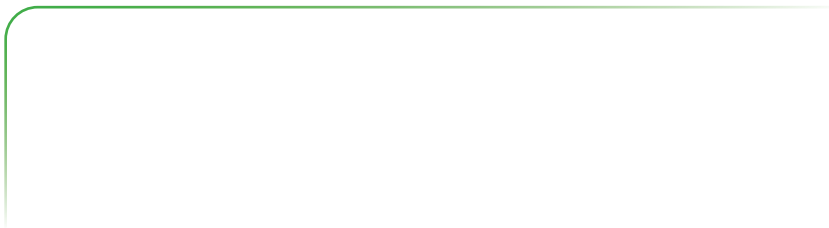
Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

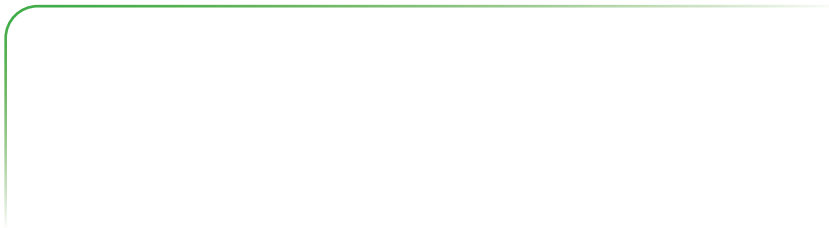
1. In paragraph 3, what does Bird mean by “the state of the world,” and how does it relate to “campus unhappiness”?



2. Reread lines 38–44. What is Bird’s point here, and how does she support it?



3. How relevant to today are Bird’s ideas about the importance of a college degree?



Demonstrate

In her essay “Where College Fails Us,” Bird claims that college is not a good option for some students. Unlike Franklin, who writes a creative satire of Harvard College, Bird develops an extended argument. When reading argumentative essays, try to imagine you are having a debate with the author. Do not passively accept what he or she writes. Question whether the main ideas are valid and supported with logical evidence. Here are some questions that will help you evaluate an argumentative essay—including Bird’s.

- Are any statements false? Watch for superlatives such as *all*, *never*, or *always*. Statements that include these words can be difficult to prove beyond the shadow of a doubt.
- Are reasons supported with evidence such as expert opinion or scientific data?
- Are emotional appeals used appropriately? Emotional appeals can be used to inspire a person to action, but they should not be the sole support for an argument. Be wary of writing that plays to your emotions to an inappropriate degree. Examples include an argument that focuses mainly on the fear of crime or the fear of global warming without backing up claims with data.
- Is the reasoning logical? Fallacious reasoning is giving false or inaccurate reasons to support a claim. The chart below explains some common fallacies.

Common Fallacies	
False cause	This fallacy mistakes correlation or association for causation by assuming that because one thing follows another, it was caused by the other. Example: After the legislature passed tax increases for those earning more than \$500,000 a year, the economy tanked. The tax increases caused the Recession.
False analogy	Many arguments rely on an analogy between two or more objects, ideas, or situations. If the two things that are being compared aren’t really alike in the relevant respects, the analogy is a weak one, and the argument that relies on it commits the fallacy of false analogy. Example: Both guns and knives can be used to kill people. And yet we don’t have the same restrictions on the purchase of knives as we do for guns. Thus restrictions on purchasing guns are equally ridiculous.
Hasty generalization	This fallacy applies a specific rule to a general situation (without proper evidence). It is incorrectly assuming what is true in some instances is true of the whole group. Stereotypes about people are a common example of the principle underlying hasty generalization. Example: Based upon a survey of people in our neighborhood, Americans don’t mind paying more taxes.

Common Fallacies	
Sweeping generalization	This fallacy applies a general rule to a specific situation. It incorrectly assumes that what is generally true is true in one specific instance. Example: All movie stars are rude. I saw Matt Damon in an airport and asked for his autograph and he told me he was too busy.
Red herring	This fallacy diverts the attention from the point being argued by bringing up a side issue instead of attacking the issue itself. Example: If we loosen up on mandatory life sentences, fewer people will go to jail and many correctional officers will lose their jobs.

A good argument

1. includes a clear claim based on correct assumptions.
2. doesn't make a claim that is so strong or sweeping that it can't be supported.
3. is based on logical, relevant reasons and accurate evidence (facts, data, expert opinions).
4. addresses the most important or relevant aspects of the issue (that is, your claim and reasons that focus on what is really important to the issue).
5. avoids faulty and illogical reasoning.

Let's break down Bird's argument point by point. Answer the questions under Evaluation.

Excerpt from Argument	Evaluation
1. All high school graduates ought to go, says Conventional Wisdom and statistical evidence, because college will help them earn more money, become "better" people, and learn to be more responsible citizens than those who don't go.	Is the claim based upon correct assumptions? Does it accurately represent the opposing viewpoint?

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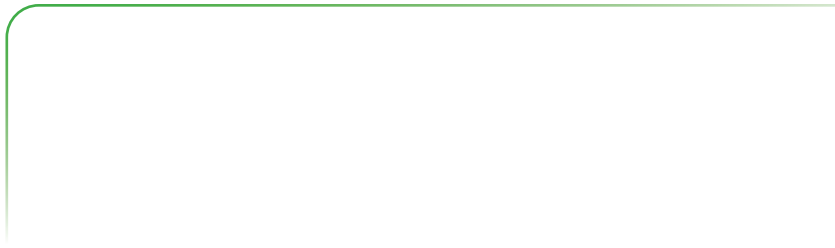
Excerpt from Argument	Evaluation
2. But college has never been able to work its magic for everyone. And now that close to half our high school graduates are attending, those who don't fit the pattern are becoming more numerous, and more obvious. College graduates are selling shoes and driving taxis; college students sabotage each other's experiments and forge letters of recommendation in the intense competition for admission to graduate school.	Does the evidence support the reason? Explain.
3. Perhaps college doesn't make people intelligent, ambitious, happy, liberal, or quick to learn new things—maybe it's just the other way around, and intelligent, ambitious, happy, liberal, and quick-learning people are merely the ones who have been attracted to college in the first place. And perhaps all those successful college graduates would have been successful whether they had gone to college or not. This is heresy to those of us who have been brought up to believe that if a little schooling is good, more has to be much better. But contrary evidence is beginning to mount up.	Is accurate evidence provided? Explain.

Excerpt from Argument	Evaluation
4. The unhappiness and discontent of young people is nothing new, and problems of adolescence are always painfully intense. But while traveling around the country, speaking at colleges, and interviewing students at all kinds of schools—large and small, public and private—I was overwhelmed by the prevailing sadness. It was as visible on campuses in California as in Nebraska and Massachusetts. Too many young people are in college reluctantly, because everyone told them they ought to go, and there didn't seem to be anything better to do.	Is this logical or fallacious reasoning? Explain your answer.
5. It had always been comfortable for students to believe that authorities, like Mother, or outside specialists, like educators, could determine what was best for them. However, specialists and authorities no longer enjoy the credibility former generations accorded them. Patients talk back to doctors and are not struck suddenly dead. Clients question the lawyer's bills and sometimes get them reduced. It is no longer self-evident that all adolescents must study a fixed curriculum that was constructed at a time when all educated men could agree on precisely what it was that made them educated.	Is this logical or fallacious reasoning? Explain your answer.

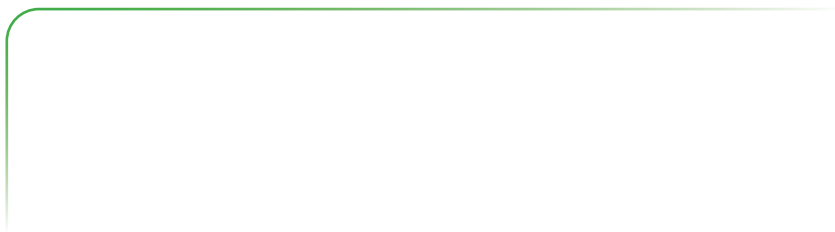
Excerpt from Argument	Evaluation
6.	Is this logical or fallacious reasoning? Explain your answer.
7.	Is this logical or fallacious reasoning? Explain your answer.

8. Which of Bird's reasons for why all students shouldn't go to college are the weakest? Why? Provide evidence from the passage to support your conclusions.

9. Which of her reasons are the strongest? Why? Provide evidence from the passage to support your conclusions.



10. Overall, do you think Bird's argument is convincing or not? Why? Provide evidence from the passage to support your conclusions.



Exit Ticket

With a partner, review your answers for the chart and questions 8 to 10. Do you agree in your evaluation of Bird's argument? If not, respectfully explain your position. Examine your own motives. Do you have any bias about the idea of attending or not attending college that might prevent you from looking at the issue objectively?

Review

Some test questions may ask you to analyze the use of figures of speech and how an argument is developed or structured. The following questions will give you practice in these skills.

1. Read the following passage. Then answer the questions that follow.

Now I observed, that the whole Tribe who entred into the Temple with me, began to climb the Throne; but the Work proving troublesome and difficult to most of them, they withdrew their Hands from the Plow, and contented themselves to sit at the Foot, with Madam *Idleness* and her Maid *Ignorance*, until those who were assisted by Diligence and a docible Temper, had well nigh got up the first Step: But the Time drawing nigh in which they could no way avoid ascending, they were fain to crave the Assistance of those who had got up before them, and who, for the Reward perhaps of a *Pint of Milk*, or a *Piece of Plumb-Cake*, lent the Lubbers a helping Hand, and sat them in the Eye of the World, upon a Level with themselves.

Part A: Based upon the context, the phrase *they withdrew their Hands from the Plow* is

- A. a symbol that represents studying the field of agriculture.
- B. metonymy in which “plow” represents work and “hands” are people.
- C. allegory for leaving Harvard College.
- D. a metaphor for flunking out of college.

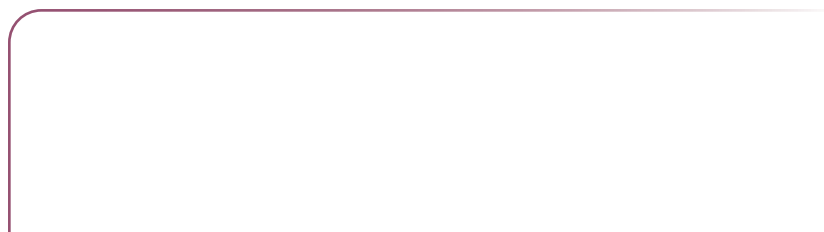
Part B: Which words or phrases from the text best help the reader understand the meaning of the phrase *they withdrew their Hands from the Plow*? Choose **two** answers.

- A. *Now I observed, that the whole Tribe who entered into the Temple with me, began to climb the Throne*
- B. *but the Work proving troublesome and difficult to most of them*
- C. *and contented themselves to sit at the Foot, with Madam Idleness and her Maid Ignorance*
- D. *But the Time drawing nigh in which they could no way avoid ascending, they were fain to crave the Assistance of those who had got up before them*
- E. *lent the Lubbers a helping Hand, and sat them in the Eye of the World, upon a Level with themselves*

Read the following passage from “Where College Fails Us” by Caroline Bird. Then answer the questions that follow.

[1] It had always been comfortable for students to believe that authorities, like Mother, or outside specialists, like educators, could determine what was best for them. [2] Patients talk back to doctors and are not struck suddenly dead. [3] Clients question the lawyer’s bills and sometimes get them reduced. [4] It is no longer self-evident that all adolescents must study a fixed curriculum that was constructed at a time when all educated men could agree on precisely what it was that made them educated.

2. In sentences 2 and 3, the writer supports her argument by
 - A. drawing an analogy about questioning different authorities.
 - B. providing data about authority figures.
 - C. making a generalization about students and authority.
 - D. providing a case study about a person who questioned authority.
3. Do sentences 2 and 3 effectively support the main idea of the paragraph? Why or why not? Write your answer below.



Read the following paragraph from Caroline Bird's essay and answer the question that follows.

The employer is also betting that it will be cheaper and easier to train the college graduate because he has demonstrated his ability to learn. But if the diploma serves only to identify those who are talented in the art of schoolwork, it becomes, in the words of Harvard's Christopher Jencks, "a hell of an expensive aptitude test." It is unfair to the candidates because they themselves must bear the cost of the screening—the cost of college. Candidates without the funds, the academic temperament, or the patience for the four-year obstacle race are ruled out, no matter how well they may perform on the job. But if "everyone" has a diploma, employers will have to find another way to choose employees, and it will become an empty credential. . . .

4. In this paragraph, the author argues that
- A. employers should require aptitude tests for all potential employees.
 - B. many jobs can be done by employees without a college education.
 - C. employers should not make a college degree required for all jobs.
 - D. someday everyone will have a college degree and hiring will be based on standards other than education.

Carefully read the following. Then answer the question that follows.

More than half of employers who raised education standards [for potential employees] say they have seen higher quality work as a result, while 43 percent reported improved productivity and 38 percent reported better communication.

—*Chicago Tribune*, March 19, 2016

5. Which of the following best describes the relationship between the paragraph by Bird and the information from the *Chicago Tribune*?
- A. It supports the author's argument that a college degree only serves "to identify those who are talented in the art of schoolwork."
 - B. It contradicts the author's argument that a college degree only serves "to identify those who are talented in the art of schoolwork."
 - C. It contradicts the idea that candidates without a college degree will be less likely to be considered for jobs.
 - D. It supports the idea that a college diploma will "become an empty credential."

Unit 3

Essential Question

What are the costs of scientific innovation?

The history of human existence is, in large part, the history of scientific innovation—the changes wrought by new discoveries and new machines. Simple devices such as the wheel and more sophisticated developments like farming have revolutionized the way people live and work.

But progress is not simply a straight line from a dark, primitive past to a bright, utopian future. Innovations have costs and lead to unexpected consequences. Consider the famous story of Marie Curie, who discovered the elements polonium and radium and became the first woman to win the Nobel Prize. Yet her exposure to radioactivity (a term she coined) led to her death.

In the last century, the pace of scientific advancement has quickened, and the world has grown increasingly interconnected by ever-faster transportation and digital telecommunication. People have traveled in space, cured diseases, and unlocked many of nature's secrets. But at the same time, human civilization has polluted the skies and the oceans and created technologically advanced weapons capable of immense destruction.

In this unit, you will explore the costs and benefits of some significant scientific innovations. You will read about the experiences of those who survived the world's first nuclear attack. You will learn about the systems that provide the world's food and electricity needs. You will also see American presidents argue over the proper use of human biological material in medical research. As you delve into these and other topics, you will consider how authors treat sometimes controversial subject matter to inform, to make technical ideas accessible and engaging, and to promote their points of view.

GOALS

- To examine storytelling and stylistic devices in nonfiction
- To recognize rhetorical and organizational techniques
- To analyze the author's craft and compare primary American historical documents
- To determine the purpose and meaning of figurative language and other word choices
- To observe the relationship between ideas as authors develop complex texts



Chapter 12

Analyzing Storytelling Techniques in Nonfiction Texts

Chapter Goals

In this chapter, you will:

- analyze how imagery is used to communicate the main idea of a narrative.
- analyze the styles of texts on similar topics.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **anecdote**: a short account of an event or incident that is told in an interesting or amusing way.
- **diction**: an author's choice of words that contribute to the style, mood, and tone of the writing.
- **mood**: overall emotional atmosphere or feeling that a literary work conveys to the reader.
- **sentence fragment**: an incomplete sentence that lacks a subject, a predicate (verb) or both; it does not express a complete thought.
- **sensory imagery**: vivid, descriptive language that helps a reader picture sensory details in a literary work. Imagery includes language that appeals to various senses and experiences, including: auditory (hearing), gustatory (taste), kinesthetic (movement), olfactory (smell), organic (emotions), tactile (touch), and visual (sight).
- **style**: the way in which the author uses word choice, sentence structure, figurative language, and the arrangement of sentences and ideas to create their own unique way of writing.
- **syntax**: the way a writer arranges words, phrases, and clauses to form sentences.

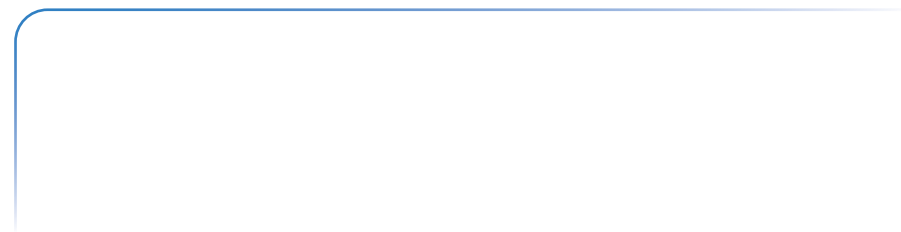
Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. The author was famous for his use of _____, which made his writing style, and especially his dialogue, realistic.
2. The _____ of the horror movie was enhanced by the suspenseful music.
3. I could almost feel the strong winds of the hurricane while reading the novel because of the author's vivid _____.
4. During dinner, Jamal's dad was infamous for sharing humorous _____ about his day.

5. Our writing teacher asked us to choose a book we enjoy, study the author's _____, and be prepared to discuss the word choice and sentence structure.
6. Charles Dickens, the author of *A Christmas Carol*, is known for his complex _____ and long, wordy sentences.
7. When speaking informally with friends, your _____ may include slang that would not be appropriate for a school assignment.

Preview Concepts

Think of a time when you were nervous or afraid that something bad was about to happen. How did you act? How did you interact with others? Was the outcome different than you had anticipated? Explain. Share your answers with a partner.



Read for Understanding

The following excerpt is from Chapter 1 of *Hiroshima* by John Hersey. On August 6, 1945, an American B-29 bomber dropped a nuclear bomb on Japan that killed at least 80,000 people and devastated the city of Hiroshima. Sickness, injury, and radiation continued to kill people after the explosion. Following the attack, the United States Army concealed the extent of the destruction from the Japanese public.

Almost a year after the bombing, a journalist named John Hersey visited Japan in order to interview survivors. His account focused on six survivors and first appeared in the August 31, 1946, issue of *The New Yorker*. It was then published as a book and later won the Pulitzer Prize. The book, however, was prohibited in Japan.

As you read, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

Hiroshima

Chapter 1: A Noiseless Flash

by John Hersey

1 At exactly fifteen minutes past eight in the morning, on
August 6, 1945, Japanese time, at the moment when the
atomic bomb flashed above Hiroshima, . . . the Reverend
Mr. Kiyoshi Tanimoto, pastor of the Hiroshima Methodist
5 Church, paused at the door of a rich man's house in Koi, the
city's western suburb, and prepared to unload a handcart full
of things he had evacuated from town in fear of the massive
B-29 raid which everyone expected Hiroshima to suffer. . . .

 The Reverend Mr. Tanimoto got up at five o'clock that
10 morning. He was alone in the **parsonage**¹, because for some
time his wife had been commuting with their year-old baby
to spend nights with a friend in Ushida, a suburb to the
north. Of all the important cities of Japan, only two, Kyoto
and Hiroshima, had not been visited in strength by *B-san*,

Notes:

¹ **parsonage:** a house provided to clergy by the church

Notes:

15 or Mr. B, as the Japanese, with a mixture of respect and
unhappy familiarity, called the B-29; and Mr. Tanimoto, like
all his neighbors and friends, was almost sick with anxiety.
He had heard uncomfortably detailed accounts of mass raids
on Kure, Iwakuni, Tokuyama, and other nearby towns; he
20 was sure Hiroshima's turn would come soon. He had slept
badly the night before, because there had been several air-
raid warnings. Hiroshima had been getting such warnings
almost every night for weeks, for at that time the B-29s were
using Lake Biwa, northeast of Hiroshima, as a **rendezvous**²
25 point, and no matter what city the Americans planned to
hit, the Superfortresses streamed in over the coast near
Hiroshima. The frequency of the warnings and the continued
abstinence³ of Mr. B with respect to Hiroshima had made its
citizens **jittery**; a rumor was going around that the Americans
30 were saving something special for the city.

Mr. Tanimoto was a small man, quick to talk, laugh, and
cry. He wore his black hair parted in the middle and rather
long; the prominence of the frontal bones just above his
eyebrows and the smallness of his mustache, mouth, and
35 chin gave him a strange, old-young look, boyish and yet
wise, weak and yet fiery. He moved nervously and fast, but
with a restraint which suggested that he was a cautious,
thoughtful man. He showed, indeed, just those qualities in
the uneasy days before the bomb fell. Besides having his wife
40 spend the nights in Ushida, Mr. Tanimoto had been carrying
all the portable things from his church, in the close-packed
residential district called Nagaragawa, to a house that
belonged to a rayon manufacturer in Koi, two miles from the

2 **rendezvous**: meeting

3 **abstinence**: refusal to act

center of town. The rayon man, a Mr. Matsui, had opened
45 his then unoccupied estate to a large number of his friends
and acquaintances, so that they might evacuate whatever
they wished to a safe distance from the probable target area.
Mr. Tanimoto had had no difficulty in moving chairs, hymnals,
Bibles, altar gear, and church records by pushcart himself, but
50 the organ console and an upright piano required some aid.
A friend of his named Matsuo had, the day before, helped
him get the piano out to Koi; in return, he had promised
this day to assist Mr. Matsuo in hauling out a daughter's
belongings. That is why he had risen so early. . . .

55 Before six o'clock that morning, Mr. Tanimoto started
for Mr. Matsuo's house. There he found that their burden
was to be a *tansu*, a large Japanese cabinet, full of clothing
and household goods. The two men set out. The morning
was perfectly clear and so warm that the day promised to
60 be uncomfortable. A few minutes after they started, the
air-raid siren went off—a minute-long blast that warned
of approaching planes but indicated to the people of
Hiroshima only a slight degree of danger, since it sounded
every morning at this time, when an American weather
65 plane came over. The two men pulled and pushed the
handcart through the city streets. Hiroshima was a fan-
shaped city, lying mostly on the six islands formed by the
seven **estuarial** rivers that branch out from the Ota River;
its main commercial and residential districts, covering about
70 four square miles in the center of the city, contained three-
quarters of its population, which had been reduced by
several evacuation programs from a wartime peak of 380,000
to about 245,000. Factories and other residential districts, or

Notes:

suburbs, lay compactly around the edges of the city. To the
75 south were the docks, an airport, and the island-studded
Inland Sea. A rim of mountains runs around the other three
sides of the delta. Mr. Tanimoto and Mr. Matsuo took their
way through the shopping center, already full of people, and
across two of the rivers to the sloping streets of Koi, and up
80 them to the outskirts and foothills. As they started up a valley
away from the tight-ranked houses, the all-clear sounded.
(The Japanese radar operators, detecting only three planes,
supposed that they **comprised a reconnaissance**⁴.) Pushing
the handcart up to the rayon man's house was tiring, and the
85 men, after they had maneuvered their load into the driveway
and to the front steps, paused to rest awhile. They stood with
a wing of the house between them and the city. Like most
homes in this part of Japan, the house consisted of a wooden
frame and wooden walls supporting a heavy tile roof. Its
90 front hall, packed with rolls of bedding and clothing, looked
like a cool cave full of fat cushions. Opposite the house, to
the right of the front door, there was a large, **finicky** rock
garden. There was no sound of planes. The morning was still;
the place was cool and pleasant.

95 Then a tremendous flash of light cut across the sky. Mr.
Tanimoto has a distinct recollection that it travelled from
east to west, from the city toward the hills. It seemed a sheet
of sun. Both he and Mr. Matsuo reacted in terror—and both
had time to react (for they were 3,500 yards, or two miles,
100 from the center of the explosion). Mr. Matsuo dashed up the
front steps into the house and dived among the bedrolls and
buried himself there. Mr. Tanimoto took four or five steps

Notes:

4 **comprised a reconnaissance:** made up an observation mission

and threw himself between two big rocks in the garden. He bellied up very hard against one of them. As his face was
105 against the stone, he did not see what happened. He felt a sudden pressure, and then splinters and pieces of board and fragments of tile fell on him. He heard no roar. (Almost no one in Hiroshima recalls hearing any noise of the bomb. But a fisherman in his **sampan**⁵ on the Inland Sea near Tsuzu, the
110 man with whom Mr. Tanimoto's mother-in-law and sister-in-law were living, saw the flash and heard a tremendous explosion; he was nearly twenty miles from Hiroshima, but the thunder was greater than when the B-29s hit Iwakuni, only five miles away.)

115 When he dared, Mr. Tanimoto raised his head and saw that the rayon man's house had collapsed. He thought a bomb had fallen directly on it. Such clouds of dust had risen that there was a sort of twilight around. In panic, not thinking for the moment of Mr. Matsuo under the ruins, he dashed
120 out into the street. He noticed as he ran that the concrete wall of the estate had fallen over—toward the house rather than away from it. In the street, the first thing he saw was a squad of soldiers who had been burrowing into the hillside opposite, making one of the thousands of dugouts in which
125 the Japanese apparently intended to resist invasion, hill by hill, life for life; the soldiers were coming out of the hole, where they should have been safe, and blood was running from their heads, chests, and backs. They were silent and dazed. Under what seemed to be a local dust cloud, the day
130 grew darker and darker.

Notes:

5 **sampan**: a small boat

First Focus: Understanding Key Images and Descriptions

Discover

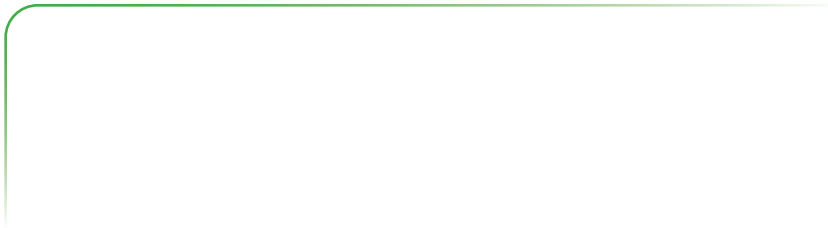
Skill Focus: When authors use vivid descriptions and imagery in their writing, it allows you as the reader to create clearer, more realistic mental pictures in your mind. Detailed descriptions of characters, settings, objects, and events paint a vibrant image that makes the story world feel alive and jump off the page. Good writers also use imagery that engages all five senses. Powerful descriptions and sensory imagery allow you to escape into the book's reality. You connect more emotionally and feel transported into the author's imaginative world through their carefully painted words and images. It makes for a much more absorbing, unforgettable reading adventure.

Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and note the author's use of sensory words to dramatize historical events. As you read the excerpt from *Hiroshima*, visualize the images described and the story they tell. Underline sensory images and label them: *see*, *hear*, *feel*, *taste*, or *smell*.

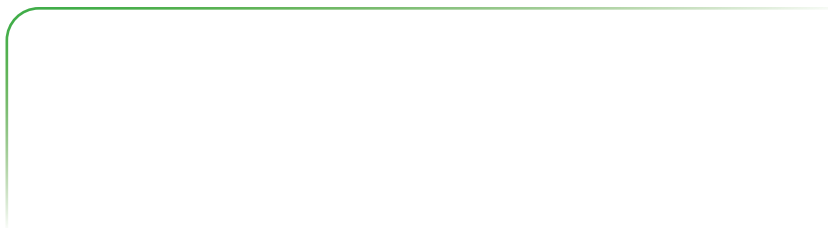
Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. How does the author create suspense in the narrative? Point to words and phrases that indicate the mood of Hiroshima and foreshadow the bombing. Does this add to the interest of the text? Why or why not?



2. Reread the last paragraph of the excerpt. What images does the author use to describe the aftermath of the bombing? Summarize the images into a statement of fact that does not use sensory language.



Demonstrate

The subject of this text is the atomic bomb blast in Hiroshima. Notice that the author uses description and anecdotes (brief accounts of real, specific incidents) to communicate what the event was like for those present.

Imagery is the use of vivid descriptive language to help readers fully picture the ideas of a literary work. Several types of imagery appeal not only to our senses of sight and sound, but also to smell, taste, and other faculties. The writer utilizes sensory words in order to create images in the reader's mind.

Below is a brief description of each type of imagery.

Visual	Visual imagery appeals to the sense of sight, describing size, shape, color, and light.
Auditory	Auditory imagery appeals to the sense of hearing, including onomatopoeia (words that sound like sounds, such as <i>bang</i>) or the absence of sound to suggest quiet.
Olfactory	Olfactory imagery appeals to the sense of smell; words such as <i>musty</i> , <i>smoky</i> , or <i>floral</i> evoke this sense.
Gustatory	Gustatory imagery appeals to the sense of taste; it uses words like <i>sweet</i> , <i>bitter</i> , and <i>tangy</i> .
Tactile	Tactile imagery appeals to the sense of touch, including descriptions of weight, temperature, and texture.
Organic	Organic imagery appeals to the emotions, describing feelings such as sadness, fear, joy, or nostalgia.
Kinesthetic	Kinesthetic imagery appeals to the sense of bodily movement; examples include sensations of falling, balance, or performing an action.

This excerpt from *Hiroshima* is packed with imagery of many kinds. Use the sections you underlined and the chart below to help you classify each kind of imagery. Write examples of imagery from the text in the chart.

Imagery	Examples from the Text
Visual	1. "... the day grew darker and darker." 2.
Tactile	1. "The morning was still; the place was cool and pleasant." 2.

Imagery	Examples from the Text
Auditory	1. "There was no sound of planes." 2.
Kinesthetic	1. "He moved nervously and fast, but with a restraint which suggested that he was a cautious, thoughtful man." 2.
Organic	1. "In panic, not thinking for the moment of Mr. Matsuo under the ruins . . ." 2.

Exit Ticket

Look over the sensory images you underlined in the text. Then sketch the scene as described in the text, including Mr. Matsui's estate at the time of the bombing, on a blank sheet of paper. Your sketch does not need to be artistic or appear professional, but it does need to represent the details in the text. Share your sketch with a classmate. Notice which images each of you chose to include. Why did Hersey include these details? What do the images alone tell you about that day in 1945?

Second Focus: Understanding Storytelling Through Imagery

Discover

Skill Focus: Authors often use vivid, descriptive imagery as a tool to reinforce a deeper message or meaning beyond just setting a scene. Their carefully chosen words and details can paint pictures in readers' minds that drive home an important point or concept. Through multi-sensory imagery and descriptions, authors can convey complex themes and facilitate real understanding in a reader's imagination. More than just decorative language, imagery illuminates truth. The right words can create mental images that reveal abstract notions such as injustice, loss, hope, inner turmoil, and more. Used purposefully, imagery causes realizations, shapes perspectives, and leaves readers fundamentally "seeing" the author's intended vision.

As you read the excerpt again, consider the effect of the images you noted during the First Focus. In the Notes column, list details that help you understand the mood of the city of Hiroshima. Think about these questions:

- What is the story that Hersey was trying to tell?
- How do the details impact your understanding of world war and nuclear weapons?

Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

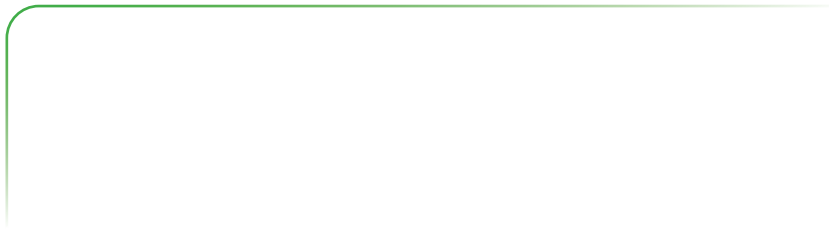
1. Reread lines 95–114 (paragraph 5). Look at the information in parentheses. How is this information different from that in the rest of the paragraph? Does this information change the nature of what is being told? Why or why not?

2. Reread lines 115–130 (paragraph 6). Tell the same story in facts rather than imagery.

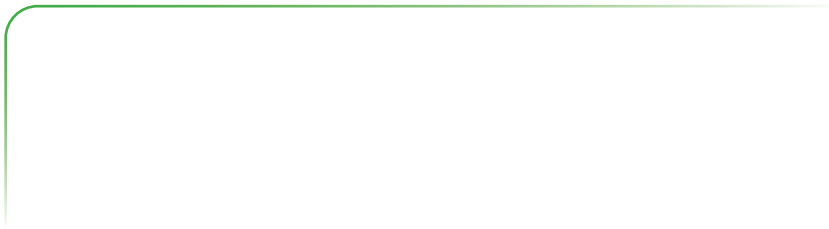
Demonstrate

Imagery can serve several purposes. It can add to the mood or emotion of a piece. It can reinforce or extend meaning, and it can also reveal new meaning. In this excerpt, the imagery is a key tool in imparting the writer's assessment of the atomic bomb. Hersey's account immediately brought a different perspective to people's understanding of Hiroshima as well as world wars and nuclear weapons in general. Let's look at how.

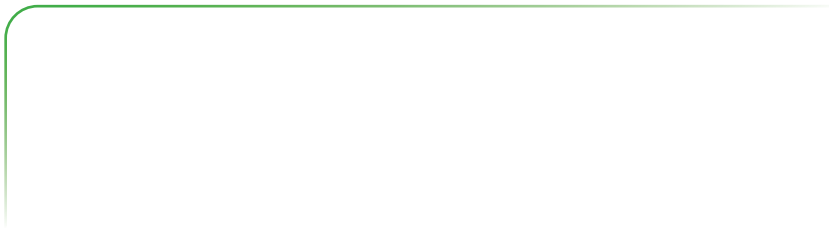
1. Based on the description in lines 1–8 (paragraph 1), explain the kinesthetic imagery of this scene. How does it foreshadow the impending explosion?



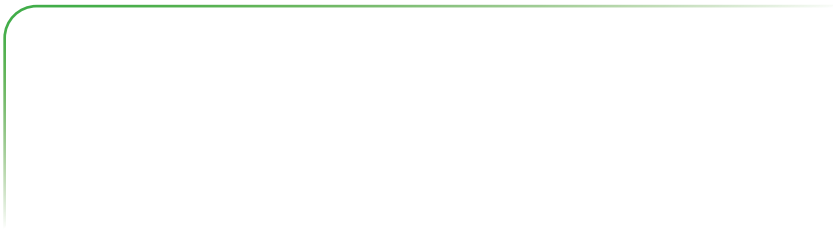
2. Based on the imagery in those lines, identify the emotion the people in the text are feeling. How does the emotion allow the reader to understand what it's like to be part of a community living under the threat of war?



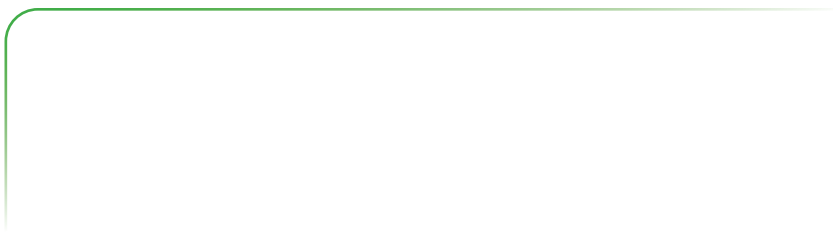
3. How does the visual and kinesthetic imagery in lines 100–120 contribute to the mood of the scene?



4. How do the images affect your understanding of those who survived and those who didn't?



5. How do the visual and auditory images in lines 105–130 contribute to the mood of the scene?



6. How does the mood add to your understanding of war and nuclear weapons?



Exit Ticket

1 Choose one image (or group of images) from the excerpt that you did not write about in the previous exercise. Then, in a well-written paragraph, explain the importance of that image (or group of images) to the meaning of the story as a whole. Use the following questions to help you.

- What does the image add to Hersey's account of the events?
- How does it affect your understanding of Tanimoto's experience?
- How does it affect your understanding of Hiroshima or war in general?

2 In groups of three or four, conduct a peer review of your paragraph.

Steps for a Peer Review

1. Select a timekeeper. Stick to the time. Each writer gets 5 minutes.
2. One person begins by reading aloud his or her paragraph while other members listen.
3. Pause. The same reader reads the paragraph aloud a second time. (Don't skip this step.)
4. Group members listen and write comments or notes.
5. Writer asks, "What part was unclear?" Each member responds. Writer jots notes on draft.
6. Go to the next writer in the group and repeat the steps.

Third Focus: Analyzing Style in Nonfiction Narrative

Discover

Skill Focus: John Hersey was a journalist. He could have chosen to write an article about Hiroshima that was packed with facts about the number of people who died and the amount of property destroyed. Instead, he chose to write about the lives of six people, including Mr. Tanimoto from the excerpt, who experienced the devastation first-hand. The survivors' stories are interspersed with statistics about the magnitude of the destruction, but the core of the work is a narrative—a story of average people's lives before and after the bombing. Hersey was one of the pioneers of this style of journalism, which is commonly used by nonfiction writers today. This style, coined the New Journalism, incorporated the storytelling techniques of fiction into nonfiction reporting.

Read *Hiroshima* again, noting where Hersey moves away from the story of Mr. Tanimoto to offer facts about the war, the city, and the bomb.

Then read the following selection from *Hiroshima in the Morning* by Rahna Reiko Rizzuto. In this selection, the author describes her aunt's experience of working in Hiroshima after the war as she also relates her own story. Note sections that describe Molly's experiences and the author's response by labeling them *Molly* and *Rizzuto* in the text. Consider how the writer's sentence structure (*syntax*) and word choice (*diction*) impact the style and how the style communicates the main ideas.

excerpt

Hiroshima in the Morning

Aunt Molly's Vision

by Rahna Reiko Rizzuto

Rahna Reiko Rizzuto, an award-winning Japanese-American author, traveled to Hiroshima in 2001 in order to interview survivors of the bombing. Rizzuto turned her research into a memoir in which she explores the traumatic experiences of the survivors while also examining her own life and the role that memory plays in understanding ourselves.

- 1 Aunt Molly saw the city when it was not. She told me about it the first time we met, but I wasn't listening. And my deafness then—almost eight years ago now—is the reason I've come to Japan.

Notes:

Notes:

5 Molly arrived in Hiroshima in 1946. Too late to see the lily
of the valley lamps that hung in telescoping arches over the
Hondori shopping arcade, or the men in creased black suits
and bowler hats, or the ladies they escorted. Ladies who
trailed hems of flowers around their **covert** ankles, who were
10 replaced by workers scurrying in **monpe pants**⁶; men who
were never replaced but simply disappeared. Too late for the
bomb, for the sea of fire, the endless bed of concrete stones.
My great-aunt was one of the few Americans who ever saw
the burned-out city, but by the time she got to Hiroshima,
15 people were already building shelters on the small plots of
the wasteland where their homes had stood. Where their
brothers and sisters had been **incinerated**. Where they'd
returned to gather their mothers' gleaming bones.

In those days, if you hiked even a short distance up the
20 mountains that ring the Ota River delta, you could still get a
clear view through the ghost of what once was Hiroshima,
miles away to the shore of the Inland Sea. But there was
already a black market where people sold what they had, and
bought what they could, and ate dog meat without caring
25 what it was. There were soldiers (albeit Australian and English
because the Americans were being housed in radiation-free
zones) giving chocolate to begging orphans with the stock
benevolence⁷ we have all come to recognize from the movies.
Hiroshima was manageable by then—if not a city, then still a
30 place. If not alive, then at least no longer dying. . . .

When I first went to California to interview my mother's
aunt, more than fifty years after the bombing, Molly was
full of Hiroshima, haunted and desperate to get it out. She

6 **monpe pants**: a Japanese garment with loose, baggy legs that are tied at the calf

7 **benevolence**: kindness

wanted to break the silence.

35 But I didn't want to hear.

This is what haunts me now: How could I have come into adulthood in America without knowing about the atomic bombings? Once I was faced with a family member who'd actually been there, how could I have chosen to ignore?

40 Perhaps I was afraid of the tremble that came into Molly's voice when she talked about it, or of exposing my own ignorance. I found it much easier to stick to the topic I'd

come to discuss: the **internment camps**⁸, where Molly and the rest of my mother's family had been banished during

45 World War II. That was a wartime embarrassment I was familiar with—the makeshift barracks in the desert where the US put its own ethnically Japanese citizens—an episode I had control over by having already spent a year exploring its limits and parameters. My first novel was inspired by my

50 mother's discovery that she herself had been interned as a child, and my fantasies about what secrets and safeties such a silence might contain. Aunt Molly may, at that point, have been one of the few people still alive who had lived the unique Japanese American **trptych**⁹ of the **internment**¹⁰,

55 the American occupation of Japan and the atomic bomb aftermath, but I didn't know that. The interview with her was one of the last I was doing to wrap up a book that had already taken shape. That was the truth: I had come with one topic, and couldn't allow my aunt to stray too far from it. The
60 bomb was too risky to conceive of. It was too big a world.

But then, when so much time had passed that I could

8 **internment camps**: concentration camps where Japanese-Americans were kept during the war

9 **trptych**: a three-part work of art

10 **internment**: the act of forcing people to stay within a place or prison

Notes:

no longer vouch for a single detail of my meeting with Aunt Molly, I started having nightmares of my own. I was walking through an atomic wasteland. Fires

65 burning, buildings at my feet. I had lost something; I was searching—I was walking on ashes through a place where I'd lived, that should have been familiar, but which would never again hold the things I loved, or even resemble the world I once knew.

70 I didn't know what I was looking for in my nightmares, only that I never found it. I woke with a fist in my chest, and an awareness that, of course this had something to do with Hiroshima, but also with my mother. I was embarrassed at knowing nothing, at ignoring my mother's

75 recollections of a time when she herself had been in Aunt Molly's living room avoiding the "crazy peace people" with her cousins, so this was my mother's history too, however glancing, that I had lost.

A memory, then, from that interview: my great-aunt,

80 single girl in her twenties, in a shiny black car with the doctors. They are going house to house; they are visiting the mothers of stillborn babies. Molly is a file clerk for the Americans, or a **statistician**, but she can also be an interpreter. She can ask the grieving mothers for the details—

85 where were you when the bomb dropped?

She can ask for the body of the dead baby.

I remember her every word, "I thought we were helping."

When she found out—and how did that happen?—that she was the enemy, that the US government was classifying

90 all that information so no one could fully understand what

Notes:

the bomb did, that they were offering no help and no medical care—and here begins the outrage—that’s when she became a peace **activist**.

95 I’m almost sure that’s what Molly told me. I had no other source of information, so it had to come from her.

But when I returned—just over a year ago, surrounded by silence, suffocating—to really listen to her story . . .

Molly had finally forgotten.

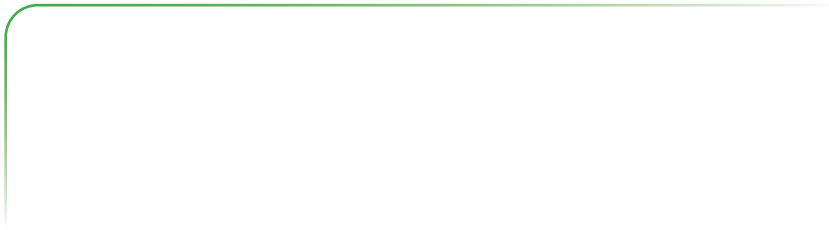
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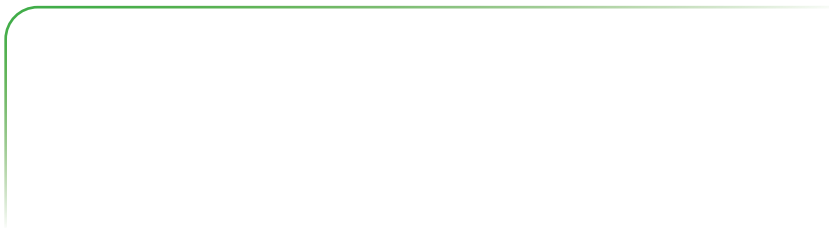
Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

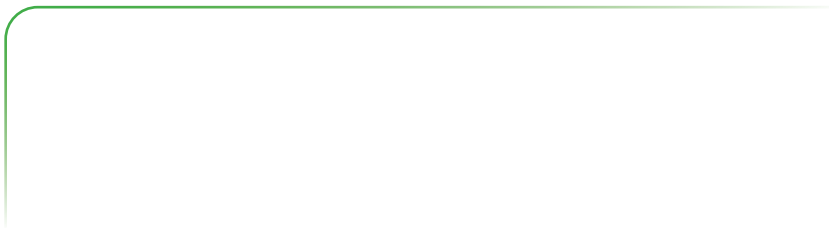
1. What examples of sensory imagery does the author use?



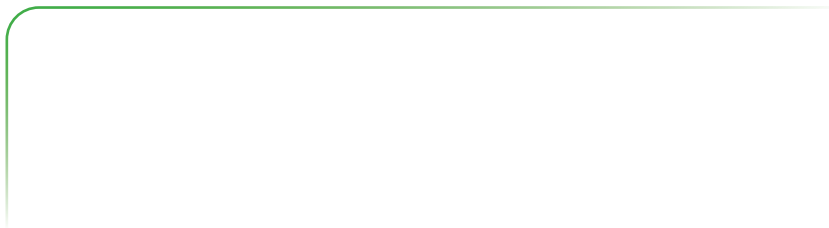
2. Why does the author originally visit her aunt? What does she want to discuss with her?



3. What is meant by lines 53–55: “one of the few people still alive who had lived the unique Japanese American triptych of the internment, the American occupation of Japan and the atomic bomb aftermath”?



4. What is the implied meaning of the author’s nightmare in lines 63–78?



5. How did the government use Molly's skills and knowledge of Japanese to their advantage? What effect did this have on Molly?

6. What is the meaning of the final line of the story? Support your inferences with evidence from the text.

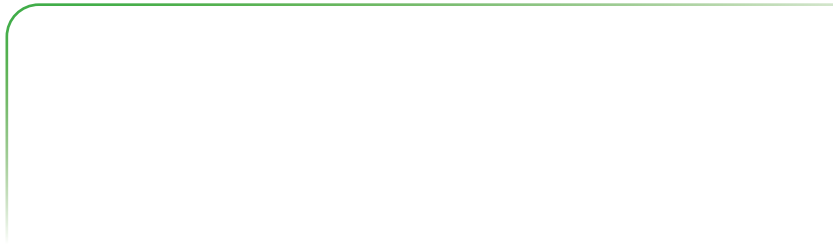
Demonstrate

The term *writing style* refers to the manner in which an author conveys ideas, including their word choice, sentence structure (or *syntax*), and use of imagery. An author's style influences the meaning of the story itself. For example, notice how Rizzuto tells only part of an anecdote or shows only half of an image. The broken sentences, or sentence fragments, reinforce the idea of fractured lives and memories. Thus, her style helps her create meaning as she reveals bits and pieces of the lives of her Aunt Molly, her mother, the people of Hiroshima, and even herself.

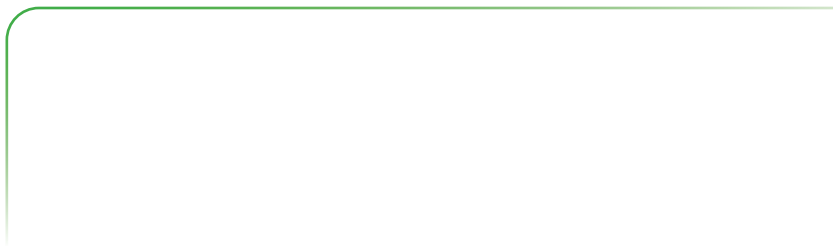
To help you analyze elements of Rizzuto's writing that make up her style, answer the following questions.

1. Why does the author use fragments in lines 16–18: *Where their brothers and sisters had been incinerated. Where they'd returned to gather their mothers' gleaming bones?* What effect does this have?

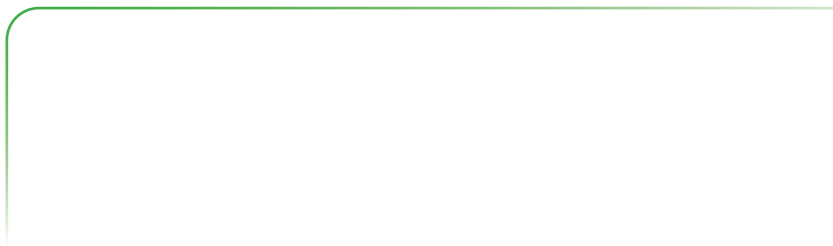
2. What effect does the description of life in Hiroshima before and after the bombing in lines 5–18 have?



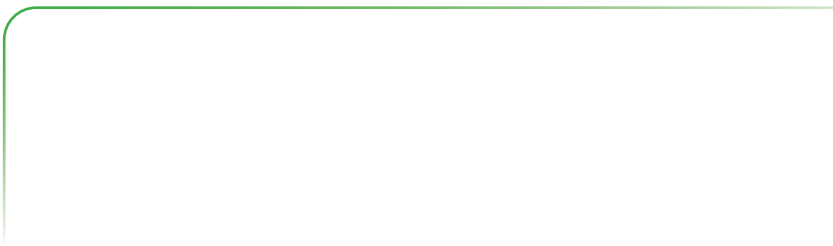
3. Why does the author use short sentences as entire paragraphs?
(Lines 35, 86, 98)



4. Rhetorical questions are questions that aren't meant to be answered.
What is the point of the rhetorical questions in lines 36–39?



5. What is the effect of the author intertwining her own story of writing about Japanese internment camps with her aunt's story of working for the government in Hiroshima?



6. With a partner, write a description of Rizzuto's writing style. Provide evidence to support your conclusions. Base your description on your answers to questions 1–5.

Exit Ticket

Write a comparative analysis of the styles of the two texts you read in this chapter. Use the following chart to help you gather and organize your ideas.

Style Choices	<i>Hiroshima</i> by John Hersey	<i>Hiroshima in the Morning</i> by Rahna Reiko Rizzuto
Use of storytelling elements		
Sensory imagery		
Sentence structure/ fragments		
Point of view (first person, third person)		

Style Choices	<i>Hiroshima</i> by John Hersey	<i>Hiroshima in the Morning</i> by Rahna Reiko Rizzuto
Mood created through language		

Write your comparative analysis below. Use evidence from the texts to support your conclusions about writing style.

Review

A test may ask you to analyze how a writer uses techniques to advance his or her meaning. Answer the following questions.

Read the following sentences from the text. Then answer the question that follows.

Molly arrived in Hiroshima in 1946. Too late to see the lily of the valley lamps that hung in telescoping arches over the Hondori shopping arcade, or the men in creased black suits and bowler hats, or the ladies they escorted. Ladies who trailed hems of flowers around their covert ankles, who were replaced by workers scurrying in *monpe* pants; men who were never replaced but simply disappeared. Too late for the bomb, for the sea of fire, the endless bed of concrete stones.

1. **Part A:** The tone of this passage could best be described as_____

- A. upbeat and hopeful.
- B. suspenseful.
- C. horrified by violence.
- D. longing for what was lost.

Part B: Explain how the mood of the passage shifts from the beginning to the end of the paragraph. Cite words and phrases that support your insights.

2. Read the following sentence and answer the question below.

A memory, then, from that interview: my great-aunt, single girl in her twenties, in a shiny black car with the doctors.

Part A: Describe the style of this sentence.

Part B: What idea does the style help emphasize?

3. Which of the following sentences from *Hiroshima* contains the best example of tactile imagery?
- A. . . . Mr. Tanimoto, like all his neighbors and friends, was almost sick with anxiety.
 - B. The morning was perfectly clear and so warm that the day promised to be uncomfortable.
 - C. The Reverend Mr. Tanimoto . . . was alone in the parsonage, because for some time his wife had been commuting with their year-old baby . . .
 - D. Such clouds of dust had risen that there was a sort of twilight around.
4. Read this excerpt from *Hiroshima*. Then answer the question that follows.

Like most homes in this part of Japan, the house consisted of a wooden frame and wooden walls supporting a heavy tile roof. Its front hall, packed with rolls of bedding and clothing, looked like a cool cave full of fat cushions. Opposite the house, to the right of the front door, there was a large, finicky rock garden. There was no sound of planes. The morning was still; the place was cool and pleasant.

Which of the following best describes the effect created by the imagery in this excerpt?

- A. It evokes a feeling of peace so readers will not find the bombing upsetting.
- B. It enables readers to imagine themselves living in Japan during wartime.
- C. It creates a sense of foreboding by hinting at what is about to happen.
- D. It helps to dramatize how shocking the moment of the bombing was.



Chapter 13

Analyzing the Structure of an Argument

Chapter Goals

In this chapter, you will:

- identify main ideas within a text.
- determine an author's purpose for sections of a text.
- identify the central claim of an argument and evaluate the effectiveness of the supporting reasons.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **author's purpose:** reason for writing or speaking.
- **claim:** in an argument, the position or idea for which the person is arguing.
- **reasons:** logical justifications that support a claim
- **evidence:** source-based information including facts, figures, and details used to support the writer or speaker's reasons and claims

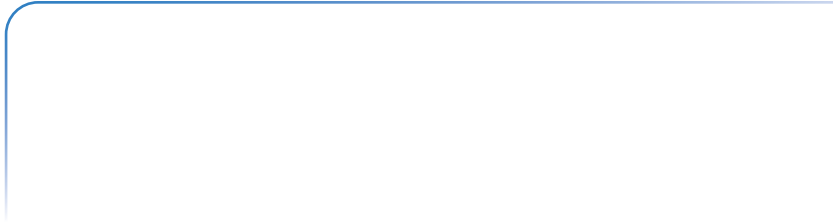
Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. The Declaration of Independence made a _____ that the colonists had a right to be free from Great Britain.
2. The _____ for writing the article was to convince people to immediately stop using pesticides that kill bees.
3. The scientific study on the declining number of bees was strong _____ for her argument.
4. Although Sally argued against the pipeline, she failed to provide any logical _____ that supported her environmental claims.

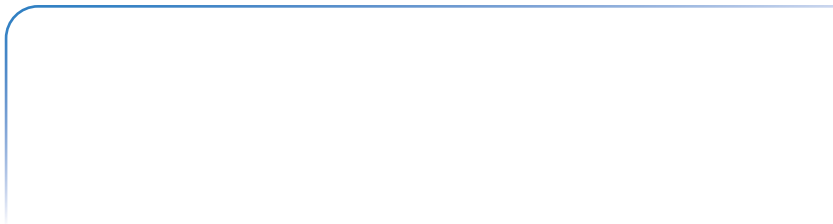
Preview Concepts

The excerpt in this chapter presents an argument about America's eating habits. Answer the questions on your own and then discuss them with a partner.

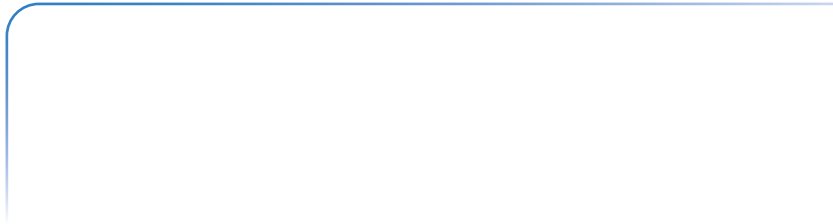
1. How many days a week does your family eat dinner at home and what kind of food do you eat?



2. If you eat out, what type of place do you usually go?



3. Would you describe your eating habits as “healthy”? If yes, what evidence could you offer to support your claim?



The choices people make about food are personal, but they are influenced by everything from biology to industry. Think about how your family balances the need to eat healthy foods with the desire to taste favorites that aren't so healthy. As you read the chapter selection, connect your own experiences with the author's claims.

Read for Understanding

The Omnivore's Dilemma by Michael Pollan explores how technology and modern food processing have changed our eating habits. (An *omnivore* is a creature that eats both meat and plants.) Pollan describes the three food chains that feed us: industrialized food, organic food, and hunter-gatherer type food. For each, he traces the food's origin to its place on the table.

In this excerpt, Pollan discusses the increasing percentage of people who are overweight around the world. As you read, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

The Omnivore's Dilemma

The Consumer: A Republic of Fat

by Michael Pollan

1 According to the surgeon general, obesity today is officially
an epidemic; it is arguably the most pressing public health
problem we face, costing the health care system an estimated
\$90 billion a year. Three of every five Americans are
5 overweight; one of every five is **obese**¹. . . . A recent study in
the *Journal of the American Medical Association* predicts that
a child born in 2000 has a one in three chance of developing
diabetes. . . . Because of diabetes and all the other health
problems that accompany obesity, today's children may
10 turn out to be the first generation of Americans whose life
expectancy will actually be shorter than that of their parents.
The problem is not limited to America: The United Nations
reported that in 2000 the number of people suffering from
overnutrition—a billion—had officially surpassed the number
15 suffering from **malnutrition**—800 million.

You hear plenty of explanations for humanity's expanding
waistline, all of them plausible. Changes in lifestyle (we're

Notes:

¹ **obese:** overweight to a degree that may have negative health effects

more **sedentary**; we eat out more). **Affluence** (more people can afford a high-fat Western diet). Poverty (healthier whole
20 food costs more). Technology (fewer of us use our bodies in our work; at home, the remote control keeps us pinned to the couch). Clever marketing (supersized portions; advertising to children). Changes in diet (more fats; more carbohydrates; more processed foods).

25 All these explanations are true, as far as they go. But it pays to go a little further, to search for the cause behind the causes. Which, very simply, is this: When food is abundant and cheap, people will eat more of it and get fat. Since 1977 an American's average daily intake of calories has jumped
30 by more than 10 percent. . . . But the important question is, Where, exactly, did all those extra calories come from in the first place? And the answer to that question takes us back to the source of almost all calories: the farm.

Most researchers trace America's rising obesity rates
35 to the 1970s. This was, of course, the same decade that America embraced a cheap-food farm policy and began dismantling forty years of programs designed to prevent overproduction. [One Secretary of Agriculture] sought to drive up agricultural yields in order to drive down the price
40 of the industrial food chain's raw materials, particularly corn and soybeans. It worked: the price of food is no longer a political issue. Since the Nixon administration, farmers in the United States have managed to produce 500 additional calories per person every day . . . ; each of us is, heroically,
45 managing to put away 200 of those surplus calories at the end of their trip up the food chain. . . .

One might think that people would stop eating and

Notes:

drinking these **gargantuan** portions as soon as they felt full, but it turns out hunger doesn't work that way. . . . Human appetite, it turns out, is surprisingly elastic, which makes excellent evolutionary sense; it **behooved** our hunter-gatherer ancestors to feast whenever the opportunity to feast presented itself, allowing them to build up reserves of fat against future famine. Obesity researchers call this trait the "thrifty gene." And while the gene represents a useful **adaptation** in an environment of food scarcity and unpredictability, it's a disaster in an environment of food abundance, when the opportunity to feast presents itself 24/7. Our bodies are storing reserves of fat against a famine that never comes. . . .

Natural selection **predisposed** us to the taste of sugar and fat (its texture as well as taste) because sugars and fats offer the most energy (which is what a calorie is) per bite. Yet in nature—in whole foods—we seldom encounter these nutrients in the **concentrations** we now find them in processed foods: You won't find a fruit with anywhere near the amount of **fructose**² in a soda, or a piece of animal flesh with quite as much fat as a chicken nugget.

You begin to see why processing foods is such a good strategy for getting people to eat more of them. The power of food science lies in its ability to break foods down into their **nutrient** parts and then reassemble them in specific ways that, in effect, push our **evolutionary** buttons, fooling the omnivore's inherited food selection system. Add fat or sugar to anything and it's going to taste better on the tongue of an animal that natural selection has wired to seek

Notes:

2 **fructose:** a form of sugar

out energy-dense foods. . . .

This begs the question of why the problem has gotten so much worse in recent years. It turns out the price of a calorie
80 of sugar or fat has **plummeted** since the 1970s. One reason that obesity and diabetes become more **prevalent** the further down the **socioeconomic** scale you look is that the industrial food chain has made energy-dense foods the cheapest foods in the market,
85 when measured in terms of cost per calorie. A recent study in the *American Journal of Clinical Nutrition* compared the “energy cost” of different foods in the supermarket. The researchers found that a dollar could buy 1,200 calories of potato chips and cookies; spent on a whole food like carrots, the same dollar buys only
90 250 calories. On the beverage aisle, you can buy 875 calories of soda for a dollar, or 170 calories of fruit juice from concentrate. It makes good economic sense that people with limited money to spend on food would spend it on the cheapest calories they can find, especially when the cheapest calories—fats and sugars—are
95 precisely the ones offering the biggest **neurobiological**³ rewards.
. . .

Very simply, we **subsidize**⁴ high-fructose corn syrup in this country, but not carrots. While the surgeon general is raising alarms over the epidemic of obesity, the president is signing farm bills designed to keep the river of cheap corn flowing,
100 guaranteeing that the cheapest calories in the supermarket will continue to be the unhealthiest.

Notes:

3 **neurobiological**: affecting the nervous system

4 **subsidize**: the government pays part of the cost of producing

First Focus: Understanding Main Ideas

Discover

Skill Focus: When you're reading an argumentative piece, identifying the main, or central, ideas is crucial for fully understanding the writer's opinion and evaluating whether the argument is convincing. The central ideas are the central claims that the writer makes to create their overall argument. After you've identified the main ideas, you can move on to analyze the effectiveness of the supporting reasons and evidence.

Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and place a star by the reason he cites as "the cause behind the causes." Then in the Notes column, write a short summary of each paragraph.

Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What facts does the author give about obesity in the United States?

2. What is the difference between the "causes" of obesity and the "cause behind the causes"?

3. What does the author imply about the government's role in causing the obesity epidemic?

Demonstrate

In the first paragraph, Pollan identifies what he believes is the main effect of obesity—the attendant rise in diabetes and other related illnesses. What does he explain next? How does this introduction fit into the main idea of the entire excerpt?

Use your thoughts from the Notes column to identify the main idea of each paragraph. Fill in the chart below. Put the author's ideas into your own words.

Paragraph 1	Obesity has become a costly health problem in America and around the world.
Paragraph 2	Several explanations have been proposed, including changes in lifestyle, economic status, and diet.
Paragraph 3	
Paragraph 4	
Paragraph 5	
Paragraph 6	
Paragraph 7	

continued on next page

Paragraph 8	
Paragraph 9	

 Exit Ticket

Share your answers to the graphic organizer with a partner. Then formulate a main idea statement for the entire excerpt. Make sure it is clear and specific.



Second Focus: Analyzing the Structure of an Argument

Discover

Skill Focus: When writers construct an argument, each paragraph plays an important role in building up support for the central claim. The beginning of an argument usually introduces the author's central claim. The rest of the argument focuses on providing valid reasons and convincing evidence that back up the central claim. So from the introduction to the conclusion, each paragraph in an argument works together to accomplish the author's purpose of convincing the reader to agree with the author's claim.

As you read the text a second time, think about how the ideas and structure of each paragraph work together to communicate Pollan's main idea. In the Notes column, answer the question: How does this paragraph contribute to Pollan's main idea?

Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. In lines 16–24, Pollan lists common explanations for the obesity crisis. Then, in line 25, he states, “these explanations are true as far as they go . . .” Do you agree that the explanations are true? Do you agree that “it pays to go a little further” as Pollan does in his “cause behind the causes”? Why or why not?

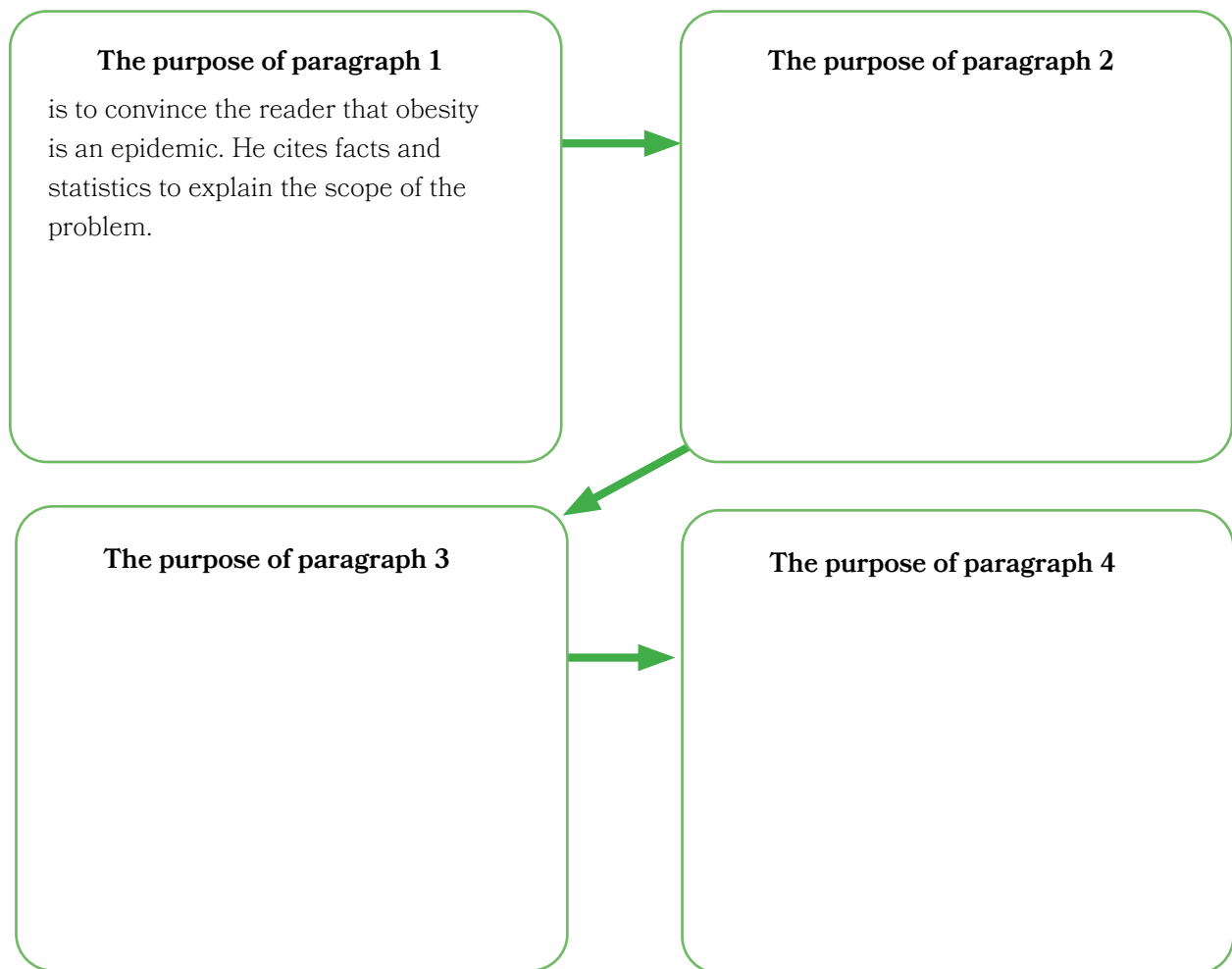
2. Pollan discusses a “cheap-farm food” program as a negative development that has led to widespread obesity. Can you think of possible benefits from this program? What facts would you research to support your answer?

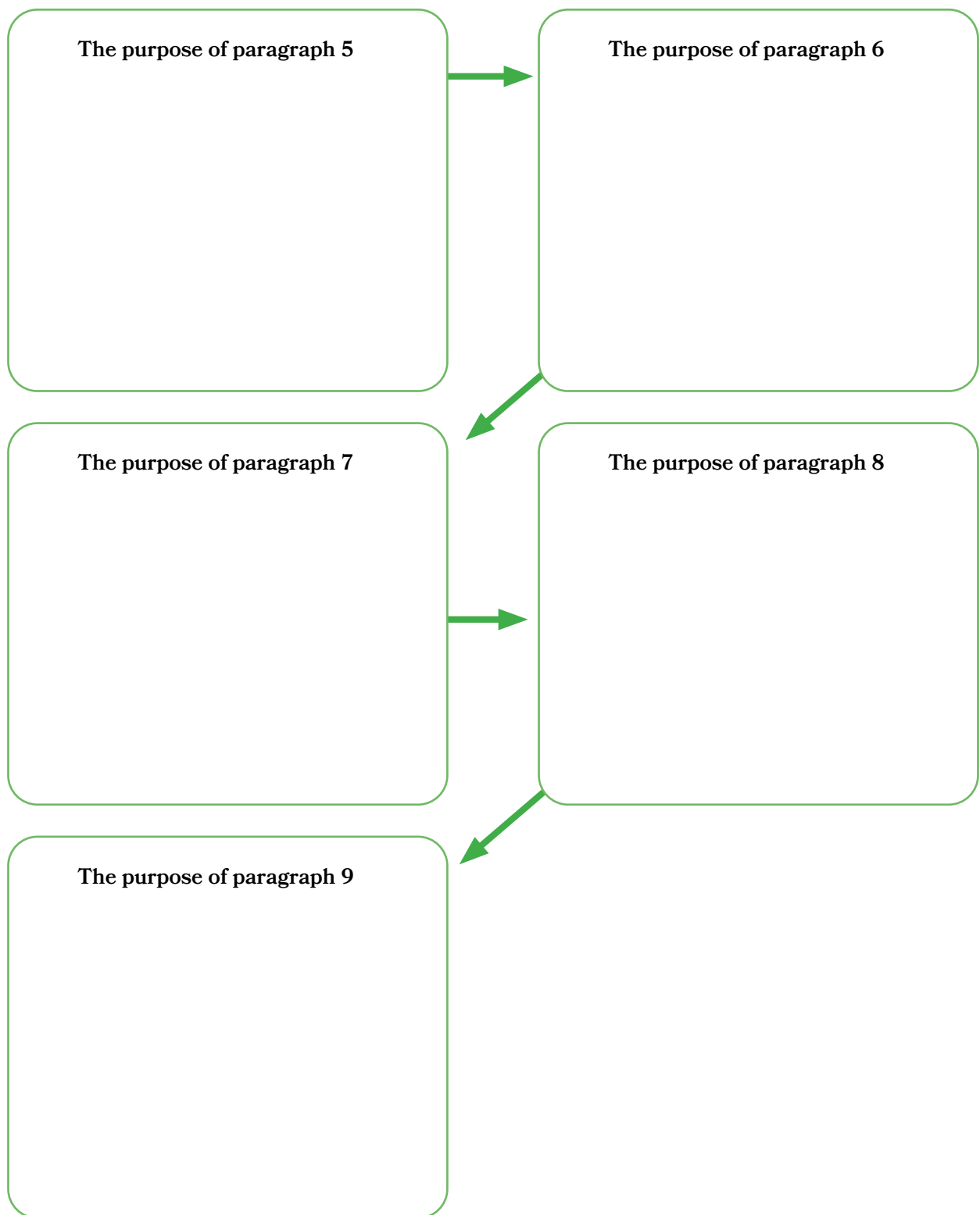
Demonstrate

Writers build arguments with intention, much like architects design buildings. They have a main idea to communicate to readers, and each paragraph must move the reader closer to seeing that main idea and being convinced that the author's opinion is correct and valid. Writers may give background, explain details, provide examples, or tell a story in pursuit of communicating their main idea.

Consider the opening paragraph of the excerpt. Michael Pollan claims that obesity is an epidemic. Then he cites the surgeon general and a medical journal. He provides facts to support his claim. He also provides details that explain the scope of the problem, such as “Three of every five Americans are overweight; one of every five is obese.” If readers aren't convinced that obesity is a problem, the rest of the excerpt is irrelevant.

Use the following chart to analyze the purpose of each paragraph as it relates to the overall main idea. Try using the following verbs to communicate purpose: *convince*, *persuade*, *introduce*, *explain*, *connect*, and *demonstrate*. The first one has been completed for you.





Exit Ticket

Share your answers to the graphic organizer with a partner.

Third Focus: Evaluating an Argument

Discover

Skill Focus: Evaluating a written argument involves analyzing how convincing and well-supported the author's position and claims are. You'll want to ask yourself questions such as the following.

- Are the supporting details relevant, accurate, and sufficient to prove the claim?
- Are there lapses in reasoning, faulty logic, or weak evidence?
- Does the author consider counterarguments or other perspectives?
- Is the argument objective and free of bias, emotional language, or invalid assumptions?

Your job is to closely examine all components of the argument and sources of evidence. Decide if you find the claim and reasons convincing and well-substantiated or if there are too many gaps, flaws, or poor evidence that undermine the position. Evaluating means being a critical reader—analyzing the quality of reasoning, looking at multiple viewpoints, weighing credibility, and determining if the argument properly proves its case.

As you read the excerpt again, read critically, noting which paragraphs contain sufficient and valid evidence and which ones seem lacking in support. Write any questions you have in the Notes column.

Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

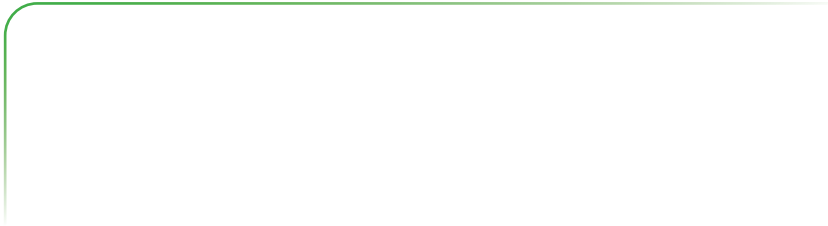
1. After reading this text, what new thoughts do you have about your own eating habits? Refer to details that most struck you.

2. What other books, articles, or movies does *The Omnivore's Dilemma* remind you of?

Demonstrate

Pollan clearly makes an argument for the “causes behind the causes” of the obesity epidemic. Let’s evaluate Pollan’s argument.

1. Write Pollan’s central claim below.



What reasons does Pollan give to support his central claim? Identify the following reasons for each detail of Pollan’s claim. Then describe the evidence he uses to support his reasons.

2. Reason food is abundant:

Evidence:

3. Reason food is cheap:

Evidence:

4. Reason people eat too much:

Evidence:

5. Reason people eat too much processed food:

Evidence:

6. What implied claim does Pollan make in the final paragraph?

7. Next to your answers to questions 1–6, identify which reasons and evidence are the best developed and which reasons and evidence are underdeveloped.

8. Conduct research to find evidence that confirms or disputes one of the reasons or evidence from Pollan's argument. Summarize your findings below and include source information.

Exit Ticket

With a partner, discuss your evaluation of Pollan's argument. Do you find it convincing? Why or why not? Support your opinion with evidence. If you disagree, explain your point of view respectfully by responding with appropriate words and tone of voice. Use the academic vocabulary from this chapter: *claims*, *reasons*, and *evidence*.

Review

In this chapter, you practiced summarizing a text, identifying author's purpose, and analyzing an argument. Answer the questions below in order to demonstrate your command of these skills and to understand how these skills might be tested on standardized assessments.

1. Which of the following sentences explains a specific cause of obesity?
 - A. *Most researchers trace America's rising obesity rates to the 1970s.*
 - B. *On the beverage aisle, you can buy 875 calories of soda for a dollar, or 170 calories of fruit juice from concentrate.*
 - C. *When food is abundant and cheap, people will eat more of it and get fat.*
 - D. *You begin to see why processing foods is such a good strategy for getting people to eat more of them.*

EXPLANATION

- Carefully read the question so that you understand what is required. The key word in the question is *cause*. Circle important words in the test question to help you stay focused and clear.
- Choice A is not a cause. It explains the problem.
- Choice B is not a cause. It is a detail that supports the cause.
- Choice C is a cause and also is the author's main claim. This is the correct answer.
- Choice D is not a cause. It is a sentence that connects the food industry to human behavior. It is part of the supporting evidence for the cause.

2. **Part A:** Read the sentence below and then choose the answer that is the most accurate inference.

While the surgeon general is raising alarms over the epidemic of obesity, the president is signing farm bills designed to keep the river of cheap corn flowing, guaranteeing that the cheapest calories in the supermarket will continue to be the unhealthiest.

- A. The president and the surgeon general are signing bills that will help decrease cheap food and therefore obesity rates, as well.
- B. The president is ignoring the surgeon general's health warning because cheap food helps big business and the American economy.
- C. Neither the surgeon general nor the president understands the seriousness of obesity.
- D. The president is making new laws to support small farms and make cheap food less accessible.

Part B: Which statement from the text best supports your answer to Part A?

- A. *According to the surgeon general, obesity today is officially an epidemic; it is arguably the most pressing public health problem we face . . .*
- B. *[One Secretary of Agriculture] sought to drive up agricultural yields in order to drive down the price of the industrial food chain's raw materials . . .*
- C. *You won't find a fruit with anywhere near the amount of fructose in a soda, or a piece of animal flesh with quite as much fat as a chicken nugget.*
- D. *The researchers found that a dollar could buy 1,200 calories of potato chips and cookies; spent on a whole food like carrots, the same dollar buys only 250 calories.*



3. Read this paragraph from the selection and answer the questions that follow.

Most researchers trace America's rising obesity rates to the 1970s. This was, of course, the same decade that America embraced a cheap-food farm policy and began dismantling forty years of programs designed to prevent overproduction. [One Secretary of Agriculture] sought to drive up agricultural yields in order to drive down the price of the industrial food chain's raw materials, particularly corn and soybeans. It worked: the price of food is no longer a political issue. Since the Nixon administration, farmers in the United States have managed to produce 500 additional calories per person every day . . . ; each of us is, heroically, managing to put away 200 of those surplus calories at the end of their trip up the food chain. . .

The purpose of this paragraph is to

- A. explain the technological advances that cause farmers to be able to produce more food.
 - B. provide background on how government policies are related to overproduction of food.
 - C. convince farmers to stop overproducing food.
 - D. describe why farmers produce corn and soybeans more than any other crops.
4. Which of the lines from the paragraph above best support the idea that if more food is available, people will eat more food?
- A. *Most researchers trace America's rising obesity rates to the 1970s.*
 - B. *This was, of course, the same decade that America embraced a cheap-food farm policy and began dismantling forty years of programs designed to prevent overproduction.*
 - C. *[One Secretary of Agriculture] sought to drive up agricultural yields in order to drive down the price of the industrial food chain's raw materials, particularly corn and soybeans.*
 - D. *farmers in the United States have managed to produce 500 additional calories per person every day . . . ; each of us is, heroically, managing to put away 200 of those surplus calories*

Read this paragraph from the selection and answer the questions that follow.

One might think that people would stop eating and drinking these gargantuan portions as soon as they felt full, but it turns out hunger doesn't work that way. . . Human appetite, it turns out, is surprisingly elastic, which makes excellent evolutionary sense; it behooved our hunter-gatherer ancestors to feast whenever the opportunity to feast presented itself, allowing them to build up reserves of fat against future famine. Obesity researchers call this trait the "thrifty gene." And while the gene represents a useful adaptation in an environment of food scarcity and unpredictability, it's a disaster in an environment of food abundance, when the opportunity to feast presents itself 24/7. Our bodies are storing reserves of fat against a famine that never comes.

5. Which sentence in this paragraph best states its main idea?
- A. *One might think that people would stop eating and drinking these gargantuan portions as soon as they felt full, but it turns out hunger doesn't work that way. . . .*
 - B. *Human appetite, it turns out, is surprisingly elastic, which makes excellent evolutionary sense; it behooved our hunter-gatherer ancestors to feast whenever the opportunity to feast presented itself, allowing them to build up reserves of fat against future famine.*
 - C. *And while the gene represents a useful adaptation in an environment of food scarcity and unpredictability, it's a disaster in an environment of food abundance, when the opportunity to feast presents itself 24/7.*
 - D. *Our bodies are storing reserves of fat against a famine that never comes.*
6. If the author wanted to add evidence to better support the main idea of the paragraph, which of the following would be most effective?
- A. a story about an overweight child who developed diabetes
 - B. advice from a nutritionist on eating healthy foods
 - C. research on how geneticists identified the "thrifty gene" in one ethnic group
 - D. a quote from a scientist about how our brains are programed to enjoy sugary food

Chapter 14

Understanding Narrative Nonfiction and American Documents

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- learn how nonfiction authors use the techniques of narrative writing.
- analyze how an author uses a variety of writing types to create a unified theme within a narrative.
- compare American historical documents' approach to common ideas.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **characterization**: development of a character in writing by directly describing a character or alternatively by revealing the character's words, thoughts, actions, and/or effect on others.
- **description**: words that provide a mental image for the reader of a person, place, thing, emotion, or situation.
- **dialogue**: a conversation that occurs between characters in a written work.
- **juxtaposition**: placing two things together or side by side for comparison and contrast.
- **narrative nonfiction**: nonfiction writing that uses storytelling devices like dialogue, pacing, description, reflection, and multiple plot lines to get readers emotionally invested in the text.
- **pace**: the speed at which a story is told and information is revealed.
- **reflection**: thoughts or opinions that are provided in a writing.
- **theme**: the underlying message of a text.

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. A _____ book often reads like a novel even though it is nonfiction.
2. The book's _____ is that secrets can't stay hidden but will always come out in the end.
3. The picture of an innocent child in the midst of a dangerous and deadly war zone is an example of _____.

4. The _____ of the events in the book was fast enough to keep the readers interested.
5. The author's skillful _____ of the main character reveals her inner conflict through her thoughts and internal monologues.
6. Her _____, "the clear, blue water sparkled in the sunshine," captured the appeal of the painting.
7. The lack of _____ between the two classmates revealed that they had little in common.
8. The author shared how writing the book had changed him in his _____ on authoring the events in the story.

Preview Concepts

You've probably had to write a personal narrative as a school assignment. What techniques did you use to make your story interesting? What are some elements most people expect to find in a narrative? List them below.

What if the story you were telling were true, but most of the events happened before you were born? Could you still use the same techniques you used when writing about events you personally experienced? Return to the list you created above and identify which techniques you could use and which ones would be more challenging.

Read the following quotation.

But to reconstruct stories and scenes, nonfiction writers must conduct vigorous and responsible research. In fact, narrative requires more research than traditional reportage, for writers cannot simply tell what they learn and know; rather, they must show it. When I talk with my students, I introduce a process of work I call the three R's: First comes research, then real world exploration and finally and perhaps most important, a fact-checking review of all that has been written.

—"The Three R's of Narrative Nonfiction" by Lee Gutkind

Explain how this relates to the problems with writing narrative nonfiction you described above.

Read for Understanding

The following excerpt is from *The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks* by Rebecca Skloot. Skloot, a science writer, spent ten years researching and writing a book that examines the story behind a widely used set of human cells grown in culture—in other words, outside of a person's body. Skloot explores the origin of the cells, what became of the donor and her family, and how those stories affected her own life.

As you read, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks

Prologue: The Woman in the Photograph

by Rebecca Skloot



- 1 There's a photo on my wall of a woman I've never
met, its left corner torn and patched together with tape.
She looks straight into the camera and smiles, hands on hips,
dress suit neatly pressed, lips painted deep red. It's the late
5 1940s, and she hasn't yet reached the age of thirty. Her light
brown skin is smooth, her eyes still young and playful, **oblivious**
to the tumor growing inside her—a tumor that would leave her
five children motherless and change the future of medicine.
Beneath the photo, a caption says her name is "Henrietta
10 Lacks, Helen Lane or Helen Larson."

- No one knows who took that picture, but it's appeared
hundreds of times in magazines and science textbooks, on
blogs and laboratory walls. She's usually identified as Helen
Lane, but often she has no name at all. She's simply called
15 HeLa, the code name given to the world's first immortal
human cells—*her* cells, cut from her cervix just months before
she died.

Her real name is Henrietta Lacks.

Notes:

I've spent years staring at that photo, wondering what
20 kind of life she led, what happened to her children, and what
she'd think about cells from her cervix living on forever—
bought, sold, packaged, and shipped by the trillions to
laboratories around the world. I've tried to imagine how
she'd feel knowing that her cells went up in the first space
25 missions to see what would happen to human cells in zero
gravity, or that they helped with some of the most important
advances in medicine: the polio vaccine, chemotherapy,
cloning, gene mapping, **in vitro fertilization**¹. I'm pretty
sure that she—like most of us—would be shocked to
30 hear that there are trillions more of her cells growing in
laboratories now than there ever were in her body.

There's no way of knowing exactly how many of
Henrietta's cells are alive today. One scientist estimates that
if you could pile all HeLa cells ever grown onto a scale, they'd
35 weigh more than 50 million metric tons—an inconceivable
number, given that an individual cell weighs almost nothing.
Another scientist calculated that if you could lay all HeLa
cells ever grown end-to-end, they'd wrap around the Earth at
least three times, spanning more than 350 million feet. In her
40 prime, Henrietta herself stood only a bit over five feet tall.

I first learned about HeLa cells and the woman behind
them in 1988, thirty-seven years after her death, when I was
sixteen and sitting in a community college biology class. My
instructor, Donald Defler, a gnomish balding man, paced
45 at the front of the lecture hall and flipped on an overhead
projector. He pointed to two diagrams that appeared on
the wall behind him. They were **schematics** of the cell

Notes:

¹ **in vitro fertilization**: a medical procedure in which a sperm and egg are combined in a test tube rather than in a human body; also called IVF

reproduction cycle, but to me they just looked like a neon-colored mess of arrows, squares, and circles with words I
50 didn't understand, like "MPF Triggering a Chain Reaction of Protein Activations."

I was a kid who'd failed freshman year at the regular public high school because she never showed up. I'd transferred to an alternative school that offered dream
55 studies instead of biology, so I was taking Defler's class for high-school credit, which meant that I was sitting in a college lecture hall at sixteen with words like *mitosis* and *kinase inhibitors* flying around. I was completely lost.

"Do we have to memorize everything on those diagrams?"
60 one student yelled.

Yes, Defler said, we had to memorize the diagrams, and yes, they'd be on the test, but that didn't matter right then. What he wanted us to understand was that cells are amazing things: There are about one hundred trillion of them in our bodies,
65 each so small that several thousand could fit on the period at the end of this sentence. They make up all our tissues—muscle, bone, blood—which in turn make up our organs.

Under the microscope, a cell looks a lot like a fried egg: It has a white (the **cytoplasm**²) that's full of water
70 and proteins to keep it fed, and a yolk (the *nucleus*) that holds all the **genetic** information that makes you *you*. The cytoplasm buzzes like a New York City street. It's crammed full of molecules and vessels endlessly shuttling enzymes and sugars from one part of the cell to another, pumping
75 water, nutrients, and oxygen in and out of the cell. All the while, little cytoplasmic factories work 24/7, cranking out

Notes:

2 **cytoplasm:** the material within a living cell, excluding the nucleus

Notes:

sugars, fats, proteins, and energy to keep the whole thing running and feed the nucleus. The nucleus is the brains of the operation; inside every nucleus within each cell in your
80 body, there's an identical copy of your entire **genome**³. That genome tells cells when to grow and divide and makes sure they do their jobs, whether that's controlling your heartbeat or helping your brain understand the words on this page.

Defler paced the front of the classroom telling us how
85 mitosis—the process of cell division—makes it possible for embryos to grow into babies, and for our bodies to create new cells for healing wounds or **replenishing** blood we've lost. It was beautiful, he said, like a perfectly **choreographed**⁴ dance.

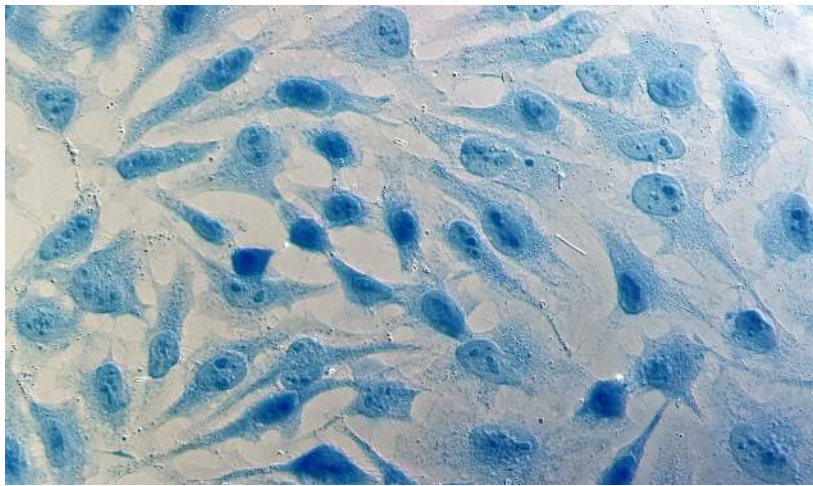
90 All it takes is one small mistake anywhere in the division process for cells to start growing out of control, he told us. Just one enzyme misfiring, just one wrong protein activation, and you could have cancer. Mitosis goes **haywire**, which is how it spreads.

95 "We learned that by studying cancer cells in **culture**," Defler said. He grinned and spun to face the board, where he wrote two words in enormous print: HENRIETTA LACKS.

Henrietta died in 1951 from a vicious case of cervical cancer, he told us. But before she died, a surgeon took
100 samples of her tumor and put them in a petri dish. Scientists had been trying to keep human cells alive in culture for decades, but they all eventually died. Henrietta's were different: they reproduced an entire generation every twenty-four hours, and they never stopped. They became
105 the first immortal human cells ever grown in a laboratory.

³ **genome**: the complete set of genes in a cell or organism

⁴ **choreographed**: planned; arranged like the steps in a dance



HeLa cervical cancer cells under the microscope

Notes:

"Henrietta's cells have now been living outside her body far longer than they ever lived inside it," Defler said. If we went to almost any cell culture lab in the world and opened its freezers, he told us, we'd probably find millions—if not
110 billions—of Henrietta's cells in small vials on ice.

Her cells were part of research into the genes that cause cancer and those that suppress it; they helped develop drugs for treating herpes, leukemia, influenza, hemophilia, and Parkinson's disease; and they've been used
115 to study lactose digestion, sexually transmitted diseases, appendicitis, human **longevity**, mosquito mating, and the negative **cellular** effects of working in sewers. Their chromosomes and proteins have been studied with such detail and precision that scientists know their every **quirk**.
120 Like guinea pigs and mice, Henrietta's cells have become the standard laboratory workhorse.

"HeLa cells were one of the most important things that happened to medicine in the last hundred years," Defler said.

Then, matter-of-factly, almost as an **afterthought**, he said,

Notes:

125 "She was a black woman." He erased her name in one fast swipe and blew the chalk from his hands. Class was over.

As the other students filed out of the room, I sat thinking, *That's it? That's all we get? There has to be more to the story.*

130 I followed Defler to his office.

"Where was she from?" I asked. "Did she know how important her cells were? Did she have any children?"

"I wish I could tell you," he said, "but no one knows anything about her."

135 After class, I ran home and threw myself onto my bed with my biology textbook. I looked up "cell culture" in the index, and there she was, a small parenthetical:

In culture, cancer cells can go on dividing indefinitely, if they have a continual supply of nutrients, and thus are

140 said to be "immortal." A striking example is a cell line that has been reproducing in culture since 1951. (Cells of this line are called HeLa cells because their original source was a tumor removed from a woman named Henrietta Lacks.)

That was it. I looked up HeLa in my parents' encyclopedia,
145 then my dictionary: No Henrietta.

As I graduated from high school and worked my way through college toward a biology degree, HeLa cells were **omnipresent**⁵. I heard about them in histology, neurology, pathology; I used them in experiments on how neighboring
150 cells communicate. But after Mr. Defler, no one mentioned Henrietta.

When I got my first computer in the mid-nineties and

5 **omnipresent**: everywhere

started using the Internet, I searched for information about her, but found only confused **snippets**: most sites said her
155 name was Helen Lane; some said she died in the thirties; others said the forties, fifties, or even sixties. Some said ovarian cancer killed her, others said breast or cervical cancer.

Eventually I tracked down a few magazine articles about her from the seventies. *Ebony* quoted Henrietta's husband
160 saying, "All I remember is that she had this disease, and right after she died they called me in the office wanting to get my permission to take a sample of some kind. I decided not to let them." Jet said the family was angry—angry that Henrietta's cells were being sold for twenty-five dollars a vial, and angry
165 that articles had been published about the cells without their knowledge. It said, "Pounding in the back of their heads was a gnawing feeling that science and the press had taken advantage of them."

The articles all ran photos of Henrietta's family: her oldest
170 son sitting at his dining room table in Baltimore, looking at a genetics textbook. Her middle son in military uniform, smiling and holding a baby. But one picture stood out more than any other: in it, Henrietta's daughter, Deborah Lacks, is surrounded by family, everyone smiling, arms around each other, eyes bright
175 and excited. Except Deborah. She stands in the **foreground** looking alone, almost as if someone pasted her into the photo after the fact. She's twenty-six years old and beautiful, with short brown hair and catlike eyes. But those eyes glare at the camera, hard and serious. The caption said the family had found
180 out just a few months earlier that Henrietta's cells were still alive, yet at that point she'd been dead for twenty-five years.

All of the stories mentioned that scientists had begun

Notes:

doing research on Henrietta's children, but the Lackses didn't seem to know what that research was for. They said they
185 were being tested to see if they had the cancer that killed Henrietta, but according to the reporters, scientists were studying the Lacks family to learn more about Henrietta's cells. The stories quoted her son Lawrence, who wanted to know if the immortality of his mother's cells meant that
190 he might live forever too. But one member of the family remained voiceless: Henrietta's daughter, Deborah.

As I worked my way through graduate school studying writing, I became **fixated**⁶ on the idea of someday telling Henrietta's story. At one point I even called directory
195 assistance in Baltimore looking for Henrietta's husband, David Lacks, but he wasn't listed. I had the idea that I'd write a book that was a biography of both the cells and the woman they came from—someone's daughter, wife, and mother.

I couldn't have imagined it then, but that phone call would
200 mark the beginning of a decade-long adventure through scientific laboratories, hospitals, and mental institutions, with a cast of characters that would include Nobel **laureates**, grocery store clerks, convicted felons, and a professional con artist. While trying to make sense of the history of cell culture
205 and the complicated **ethical** debate surrounding the use of human tissues in research, I'd be accused of conspiracy and slammed into a wall both physically and metaphorically, and I'd eventually find myself on the receiving end of something that looked a lot like an **exorcism**⁷. I did eventually meet
210 Deborah, who would turn out to be one of the strongest and most **resilient** women I'd ever known. We'd form a deep

Notes:

6 **fixated**: preoccupied

7 **exorcism**: a ritual meant to expel evil spirits

personal bond, and slowly, without realizing it, I'd become a character in her story, and she in mine.

Deborah and I came from very different cultures: I grew up
215 white and **agnostic**⁸ in the Pacific Northwest, my roots half
New York Jew and half Midwestern Protestant; Deborah was
a deeply religious black Christian from the South. I tended
to leave the room when religion came up in conversation
because it made me uncomfortable; Deborah's family tended
220 toward preaching, faith healings, and sometimes voodoo.
She grew up in a black neighborhood that was one of the
poorest and most dangerous in the country; I grew up in a
safe, quiet middle-class neighborhood in a **predominantly**
white city and went to high school with a total of two
225 black students. I was a science journalist who referred to all
things supernatural as "woo-woo stuff"; Deborah believed
Henrietta's spirit lived on in her cells, controlling the life of
anyone who crossed its paths. Including me.

"How else do you explain why your science teacher knew
230 her real name when everyone else called her Helen Lane?"
Deborah would say. "She was trying to get your attention."
This thinking would apply to everything in my life: when I
married while writing this book, it was because Henrietta
wanted someone to take care of me while I worked. When
235 I divorced, it was because she'd decided he was getting in
the way of the book. When an editor who insisted I take
the Lacks family out of the book was injured in a mysterious
accident, Deborah said that's what happens when you piss
Henrietta off.
240 The Lackses challenged everything I thought I knew about

Notes:

8 **agnostic**: nonreligious; claiming neither faith nor disbelief

faith, science, journalism, and race. Ultimately, this book is the result. It's not only the story of HeLa cells and Henrietta Lacks, but of Henrietta's family—particularly Deborah—and their lifelong struggle to make peace with the existence of
245 those cells, and the science that made them possible.



First Focus: Identifying Theme

Discover

Skill Focus: Narrative nonfiction recounts true events and experiences. To determine the theme of narrative nonfiction, consider the central characters and the important conflicts they must overcome. Sometimes the writer emerges as a character in the narrative, sharing what they have learned from researching and writing about the events. The author's personal reflections may also point to the theme of the work.

As you reread the excerpt, pay attention to how the four stories overlap to tell one bigger story. In the Notes column, write *HL* next to paragraphs about Lacks, *RS* for paragraphs about the author's life, *DL* for Lacks' daughter, and *CL* for the HeLa cell line. Consider how the pictures help you make predictions and understand the main ideas of the text.

Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. In what way were Henrietta Lacks' cells unique?

2. How have Henrietta Lacks' cells contributed to the advancement of our understanding of the science of cells and of diseases?

3. Which character did you relate to or understand the best: the author (Rebecca Skloot), the main character (Henrietta Lacks), or Henrietta's daughter (Deborah)? Support your response with details from the text.

4. Based on the characters' emotions and reactions, what is a possible theme of this piece? That is to say, what message about human experience is the author trying to convey?

Demonstrate

The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks is the true story of a deceased woman’s living cells. Rebecca Skloot uses a technique similar to fiction writing called *narrative nonfiction*. Narrative nonfiction writing uses familiar storytelling devices such as dialogue, pacing, description, reflection, and multiple plot lines to make true events more interesting and engaging for the reader. As you read the excerpt, you are drawn into the intersecting stories of multiple characters.

For each subject listed below, write a brief summary of their story as conveyed in this excerpt. Use the details you highlighted in the text to fill in each row. Don’t write a theme statement now; you will have a chance to discuss the theme in a small group.

Subject	Summary
Henrietta Lacks	
HeLa cells	

Subject	Summary
Deborah Lacks	
Rebecca Skloot	
Themes (in complete sentence form)	

Exit Ticket

In a group of four, discuss each subject listed in the chart. Use these steps:

1. Assign one subject to each group member. Present information about your subject clearly, concisely, and logically so listeners can follow your thinking.
2. Discuss this question: What is the main idea of the entire excerpt? Your answer should encompass the broader idea of all four story lines in the chart. Also consider your answer to the First Response question related to author's purpose.
3. Discuss why each story matters in order to uncover the theme(s). Add your group's answer to the chart above. Be prepared to share your theme statements with the whole class.

Second Focus: Analyzing Author's Craft

Discover

Skill Focus: When writers incorporate different types of writing in their narrative nonfiction, they're like master chefs, carefully blending expository, narrative, and descriptive elements to create a story that's informative, engaging, and captivating. Just like a perfectly baked cake, the right balance of these ingredients makes for a delightful reading experience!

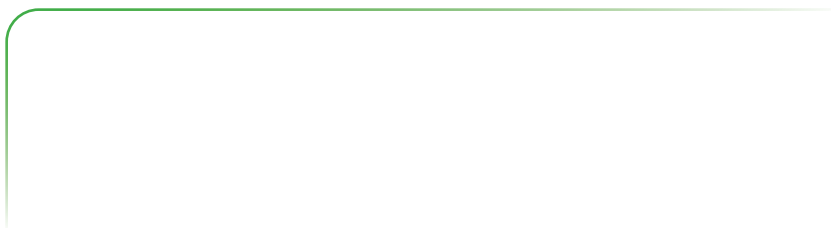
- **Expository writing** provides structure and holds everything together. In narrative nonfiction, expository writing is used to explain, inform, or describe a concept or idea.
- **Narrative writing** adds richness and depth to the story. Narrative writing brings the story to life by telling a sequence of events or sharing personal experiences.
- **Descriptive writing** adds flavor with vivid language to create sensory experiences for the reader. Descriptive writing is similar to painting a picture with words, allowing readers to see, hear, smell, taste, and feel what's happening in the story. In narrative nonfiction, descriptive writing helps readers visualize scenes, understand characters, and immerse themselves in the setting.

As you read the excerpt a second time, notice how Skloot uses different types of writing to accomplish her overall purpose. As you read, identify the type of writing used in sections, for example: narrative, expository (giving information), or descriptive. Consider how each of these types of writing makes the entire excerpt engaging for the reader.

Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. Reread the conversation between Skloot and DeFler when she follows DeFler to his office. Why does the author include each of these particular lines of dialogue verbatim rather than paraphrasing what was said?



2. What time period is covered in this selection? How does the author order the selection to cover the time period?

Demonstrate

Sophisticated writers are able to incorporate different types of writing to support complex story lines. Skloot doesn't just tell Henrietta's story; she also explains complex information about cells in a way that is understandable for the average reader. The reader appreciates the information because it helps them understand the impact of Henrietta's cells on research.

Fill in the chart on the next page to help you analyze major sections of the excerpt and how they contribute to the overall themes.

Section	Type of Writing	How does this section contribute to the overall theme(s)?	Evidence from the Text (Quotations)
Lines 1–19	Description of what Henrietta looks like	This section introduces Henrietta as a living person and gives a name to the “first immortal human cells” known as HeLa. Our first understanding is of the woman and not just her cells.	“her eyes still young and playful, oblivious to the tumor growing inside her” “She’s simply called HeLa” “Her real name is Henrietta Lacks.”
Lines 19–40			

continued on next page

Section	Type of Writing	How does this section contribute to the overall theme(s)?	Evidence from the Text (Quotations)
Lines 41–67			
Lines 68–94			
Lines 95–145			

Section	Type of Writing	How does this section contribute to the overall theme(s)?	Evidence from the Text (Quotations)
Lines 146–213			
Lines 214–245			

Exit Ticket

1 Review the chart with a partner. Discuss any differences in your analyses.

Discuss the following questions:

1. Is Skloot's inclusion of herself as a character within the narrative effective? Why or why not?
2. Where does Skloot use juxtaposition (two things being placed side by side for the purpose of comparison) in the story? Why do you think she uses this literary device? What does it add to the story?
3. Do you find Skloot's writing style effective for the subject matter? Why or why not?

2 Based upon the work you did during the First and Second Focus of the passage, write a multi-paragraph analysis of the excerpt from *The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks*. Explain how Skloot effectively weaves together several subjects using different types of writings. Use direct quotations to support your conclusions about the text.

Third Focus: Comparing Arguments in American Documents

Discover

Skill Focus: In this Focus you'll be looking at two different texts that argue opposite sides of the same topic. Your job is to compare how each author builds his argument and to think critically about how well he supports his claims.

- First, you'll need to identify the main arguments each author is making. Then, look at the information they use to back up their claims. Do they use facts, statistics, examples, or expert opinions? How does each author interpret and present this information to support his side of the argument?
- Next, evaluate how effective and valid each argument is. Validity means checking if the arguments are sound and logical. Do the authors' claims make sense based on the evidence they provide? Are there any gaps in their reasoning or information that seems misleading?
- Finally, analyze how the authors might use the same piece of information in different ways to achieve their goals. For example, two authors might cite the same statistic, but one uses it to argue in favor of a position while the other uses it to argue against it.

Throughout American history, political and social leaders have produced documents that declare principles, argue policy, and record the tenor of the times. Such documents include speeches, letters, and laws.

Recent history has included ethical struggles over the proper role of the government in funding scientific research. In particular, presidents of successive administrations have disagreed about whether to fund embryonic stem cell research.

Like the HeLa cell line, stem cells are studied in efforts to find new treatments for diseases. But embryonic stem cells are taken from embryos, fertilized egg cells that could grow into human children. Some embryos are created in a laboratory—a process called in vitro fertilization—in order to help people conceive a child. Often, more embryos are created than the parents will use, and unused embryos may be donated for scientific research.

Read the following two selections. The first is an excerpt from President George W. Bush's memoir. The second is from a speech President Barack Obama delivered in 2009. As you read them, note how each president addresses related concepts. Underline key words or phrases in Obama's speech that reflect on ideas discussed in Bush's memoir. Write questions you have about embryonic stem cell research in the Notes column.

excerpt

Decision Points

Chapter 4: Stem Cells

by George W. Bush

In 2001, President Bush banned government funding for research on stem cells obtained from human embryos. He believed the research was destroying human lives. In July 2006, Congress passed the Stem Cell Research Enhancement Act, a bill that would restore funding to this type of research. Bush was faced with a choice: to reverse his earlier position and sign the bill into law, or to maintain his opposition and reject the bill. In the following excerpt, Bush explains his decision.

1 Five and a half years into the presidency, I had yet to veto a piece of legislation. I had worked closely with our congressional majorities to pass bills I could accept. But as the stem cell bill was working its way through Congress, I had
5 made it clear I would veto it. When it reached my desk, I did.

I was hit with all sorts of labels, “stubborn” being one of the most polite. But I would not change my position. If I abandoned my principles on an issue like stem cell research, how could I maintain my **credibility** on anything else?

10 I thought a lot about how to send the right signal about the veto. I wanted a vivid way to show that my position was grounded in my reverence for life, not any **aversion** to science. When Karl Zinsmeister, my domestic policy adviser, suggested inviting a group of snowflake babies to the White
15 House, I thought the idea was perfect. Each had come from a frozen embryo that, rather than being destroyed for research, was implanted in an adoptive mother.

I gave my veto speech in the East Room with twenty-four excited children and their parents onstage. One of the little

Notes:

20 wigglers was fourteen-month-old Trey Jones. He started life as
an embryo fertilized by Dave and Heather Wright of Macomb,
Michigan. The couple had undergone IVF treatment, which
helped them bring three beautiful children into the world.
They gave permission for their remaining frozen embryos to
25 be adopted, instead of being destroyed for research.

In Cypress, Texas, J. J. and Tracy Jones were praying for
a child. Through Nightlight Christian Adoptions, they were
paired with the Wright family embryos. The result was the
smiling, blond-haired boy named Trey whom I held in my
30 arms at the White House. Thanks to the miracle of science
and the compassion of two families, Trey had a loving home
and a hopeful life ahead of him.

A few weeks after the event, I received a touching letter from
J. J. Jones. He described the "pain of infertility" and how blessed
35 he and Tracy felt to have their "precious Trey who some describe
as a leftover destined to be either destroyed or used for research."
He also informed me that Trey would soon have a sibling, the
product of another frozen embryo he and Tracy had adopted.

Congress's response to my veto was not so warm. The
40 Democratic sponsor of the bill erupted with a statement
claiming that my veto was based on "**cynical** political gain."
It was hard to see how, since most polls showed my stem
cell **stance** was not popular. As punishment for my veto,
Democrats refused to pass legislation supporting research
45 into alternative sources of stem cells. The message was that if
they couldn't fund stem cell research that destroyed embryos,
they would prefer to fund none at all. So much for their
passionate desire to see new cures.

Notes:

When Democrats won control of the House and Senate,
50 they decided to make another run at overturning my policy.
Speaker Nancy Pelosi announced that it was one of her top
priorities. They sent me another bill in June 2007; I sent it
back again with my veto. Thanks to the courage of many
Republicans on Capitol Hill, the veto held.

55 Five months later, Americans awoke to an unexpected
headline on the front page of the *New York Times*: “Scientists
Bypass Need for Embryo to Get Stem Cells.” The article
described how two teams of researchers, one in Wisconsin
and one in Japan, had reprogrammed an adult skin cell to
60 behave like an embryonic stem cell. By adding just four genes
to the adult cell, scientists were able to **replicate** the medical
promise of embryonic stem cells without moral controversy.

The discovery **reverberated** throughout the scientific
community. Fervent advocates of embryonic stem cell
65 research hailed the breakthrough as “a spectacular advance”
and “ethically uncomplicated.” Ian Wilmut, the Scottish
scientist who cloned Dolly the sheep, announced that he
would no longer pursue the cloning of human embryos, but
would instead use this new technique.

70 I was thrilled by the news. This was the scientific
breakthrough that I had hoped for when I made my
announcement in 2001. Charles Krauthammer, one of the
most insightful columnists in America and a respectful critic
of my stem cell decision in 2001, wrote, “The verdict is clear:
75 Rarely has a president—so **vilified** for a moral stance—been
so thoroughly **vindicated**.”

In the years to come, our nation will face more **dilemmas**

Notes:

about bioethics, from cloning to genetic engineering.

History will judge the character of our country in large part

80 by the way we answer these challenges to human dignity.

I have faith, as I did when I announced my stem cell decision in 2001, that science and ethics can coexist. With thoughtful policy, we can usher in the new cures that Nancy Reagan hoped for, without moving toward the world foreseen by

85 **Aldous Huxley**⁹.

9 **Aldous Huxley**: author of *Brave New World*, a science fiction novel about a future society in which artificial human cloning is widespread and natural reproduction is forbidden

Notes:



excerpt

Signing of Stem Cell Executive Order and Scientific Integrity Presidential Memorandum

by President Barack Obama, March 9, 2009

Less than two years after Bush's 2007 veto, President Obama issued an executive order—an instruction to agencies or officials that report to the executive branch of the government—reversing the government's position on embryonic stem cell research. Obama made this speech explaining his decision.

- 1 Today, with the Executive Order I am about to sign, we will
bring the change that so many scientists and researchers; doctors
and innovators; patients and loved ones have hoped
for, and fought for, these past eight years: we will lift the
5 ban on federal funding for promising embryonic stem cell
research. We will vigorously support scientists who pursue
this research. And we will aim for America to lead the world
in the discoveries it one day may yield.

- At this moment, the full promise of stem cell research
10 remains unknown, and it should not be overstated. But
scientists believe these tiny cells may have the potential to
help us understand, and possibly cure, some of our most
devastating diseases and conditions. To **regenerate** a severed
spinal cord and lift someone from a wheelchair. To spur insulin
15 production and spare a child from a lifetime of needles. To
treat Parkinson's, cancer, heart disease and others that affect
millions of Americans and the people who love them. . . .

- But in recent years, when it comes to stem cell research,
rather than furthering discovery, our government has forced
20 what I believe is a false choice between sound science
and moral values. In this case, I believe the two are not
inconsistent. As a person of faith, I believe we are called

Notes:

to care for each other and work to ease human suffering. I believe we have been given the capacity and will to pursue
25 this research—and the humanity and conscience to do so responsibly.

It is a difficult and delicate balance. Many thoughtful and decent people are conflicted about, or strongly oppose, this research. I understand their concerns, and we must respect
30 their point of view.

But after much discussion, debate and reflection, the proper course has become clear. The majority of Americans—from across the political spectrum, and of all backgrounds and beliefs—have come to a **consensus** that we should
35 pursue this research. That the potential it offers is great, and with proper guidelines and strict oversight, the perils can be avoided. . . .

Ultimately, I cannot guarantee that we will find the treatments and cures we seek. No President can promise
40 that. But I can promise that we will seek them—actively, responsibly, and with the urgency required to make up for lost ground. Not just by opening up this new frontier of research today, but by supporting promising research of all kinds, including groundbreaking work to convert ordinary
45 human cells into ones that resemble embryonic stem cells.

I can also promise that we will never undertake this research lightly. We will support it only when it is both scientifically worthy and responsibly conducted. We will develop strict guidelines, which we will rigorously enforce,
50 because we cannot ever tolerate misuse or abuse. And we will ensure that our government never opens the door to the use of cloning for human reproduction. It is dangerous,

Notes:

profoundly wrong, and has no place in our society, or any society. . . .

55 There is no finish line in the work of science. The race is always with us—the urgent work of giving substance to hope and answering those many bedside prayers, of seeking a day when words like “terminal” and “incurable” are finally retired from our vocabulary.

60 Today, using every resource at our disposal, with renewed determination to lead the world in the discoveries of this new century, we rededicate ourselves to this work.

Thank you, God bless you, and may God bless America.

Notes:



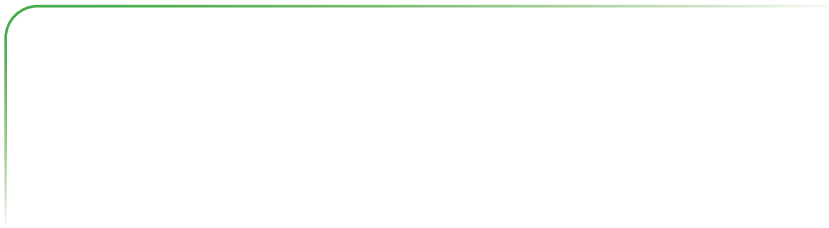
Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

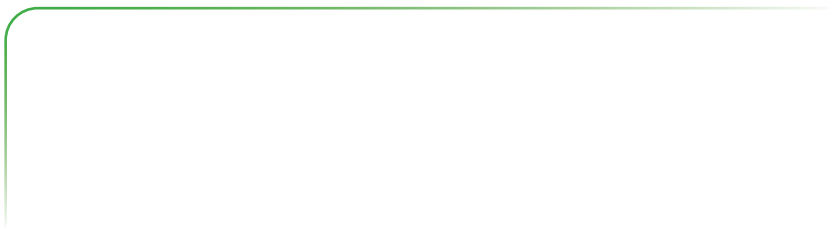
1. What is the main reason President Bush gives for his opposition to stem cell research?



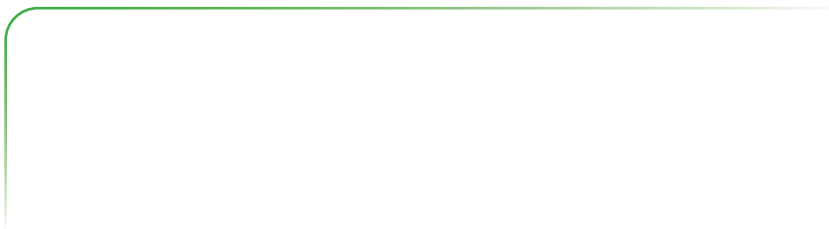
2. What rhetorical technique (*ethos*, *pathos*, or *logos*) does Bush use to drive his point home?



3. What is the main reason President Obama is in favor of stem cell research?



4. What rhetorical technique (*ethos*, *pathos*, or *logos*) does Obama use to support his point?



5. What is one point made in Obama's speech that Bush would agree with?

Demonstrate

President Bush and President Obama present different arguments about the ethics of funding embryonic stem cell research. Here are the general elements found in an argument.

Claim: The idea for which the author is arguing

Reasons: Explanation of why the claim should be accepted as true

Evidence: Data, personal anecdotes, expert opinions that support the claim

Counterclaim: A claim that disagrees with the writer's/speaker's claim

Rebuttal: Evidence that negates or disagrees with the counterclaim

Concession: Acknowledgment of a point made by the opposition

Use the chart below to analyze the argument of each president. Consider how their purpose and audience affects their message.

	President Bush	President Obama
Who is the audience?		
Why is he writing/ speaking?		

	President Bush	President Obama
Claim(s)		
Evidence		

continued on next page

	President Bush	President Obama
Counterclaims		
Rebuttal or Concessions		
Other rhetorical appeals (emotional appeals, shifts, parallelism, antithesis)		

Exit Ticket

1 Write a few paragraphs analyzing President Bush's argument and then do the same for President Obama's.

2 With a small group of classmates, read all your paragraphs analyzing President Bush's argument. Discuss any differences among your answers and come to a consensus on the elements of his argument, even if you disagree with Bush's position. Repeat this process with your paragraphs about President Obama's argument.

Review

On assessments you may be asked to identify the themes, purposes, and techniques of narrative nonfiction. Answer the questions below in order to demonstrate your knowledge of narrative writing.

1. *The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks* features parallel stories of Henrietta Lacks, her family, and the author herself. Which of the following themes do these stories share?
 - A. Strangers' lives may be connected in unexpected ways.
 - B. The pursuit of knowledge can change a person's life.
 - C. Policies of racial segregation have had lingering effects.
 - D. One person's misfortune may be another person's gain.

2. Read these paragraphs from *Decision Points* and answer the question that follows.

... One of the little wigglers was fourteen-month-old Trey Jones. He started life as an embryo fertilized by Dave and Heather Wright of Macomb, Michigan. The couple had undergone IVF treatment, which helped them bring three beautiful children into the world. They gave permission for their remaining frozen embryos to be adopted, instead of being destroyed for research.

In Cypress, Texas, J. J. and Tracy Jones were praying for a child. Through Nightlight Christian Adoptions, they were paired with the Wright family embryos. The result was the smiling, blond-haired boy named Trey whom I held in my arms at the White House. Thanks to the miracle of science and the compassion of two families, Trey had a loving home and a hopeful life ahead of him.

What is most likely the intended effect of including the story of the Jones family?

- A. It demonstrates the author's commitment to the principle of preserving life.
 - B. It dramatizes the reasoning that led Bush to ban funding for embryonic stem cell research.
 - C. It offers an example of the medical advancements that stem cell research has produced.
 - D. It proves the author's claim that he does not oppose science in general.
3. Read the paragraph on the next page from *The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks* and answer the question that follows.

There's a photo on my wall of a woman I've never met, its left corner torn and patched together with tape. She looks straight into the camera and smiles, hands on hips, dress suit neatly pressed, lips painted deep red. It's the late 1940s and she hasn't yet reached the age of thirty. Her light brown skin is smooth, her eyes still young and playful, oblivious to the tumor growing inside her—a tumor that would leave her five children motherless and change the future of medicine. Beneath the photo, a caption says her name is "Henrietta Lacks, Helen Lane or Helen Larson."

Why does the author begin the prologue with this description of a photograph? Choose all that apply.

- A. She wants readers to understand that Henrietta Lacks was a real person.
 - B. She hopes to stir readers' interest before introducing a technical topic.
 - C. She reveals that this story is as much about herself as about Henrietta Lacks.
 - D. She wants readers to first become aware of Henrietta Lacks the same way she did.
4. **Part A:** Despite their opposite conclusions, what idea appears in both *Decision Points* and President Obama's speech?
- A. It is important to respect the views of those who disagree about stem cell research.
 - B. Embryos that are not used for research could be allowed to develop into children and adopted.
 - C. Government officials have a responsibility to carry out what the majority of citizens want.
 - D. The use of cloning for human reproduction is morally unacceptable.

Part B: Explain your answer to Part A. Include evidence from *Decision Points* and President Obama's speech to support your response.



Chapter 15

Analyzing Structure and Tone

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- recognize the complex relationship between cause and effect in a text.
- identify how authors' use of figurative language can advance their purpose.
- analyze the way authors' word choices create an effective tone.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **analogy**: a comparison of two things based on their being alike in some way.
- **antithesis**: the rhetorical contrast of ideas by means of parallel arrangements of words, clauses, or sentences
- **asyndeton**: figure of speech in which conjunctions are intentionally omitted between words, phrases, or clauses, often to create a more emphatic or rhythmic effect.
- **cause and effect**: the relationship between two or more events when one event can be traced as the reason that a subsequent event or several subsequent events occurred.
- **dysphemism**: the use of a negative or unpleasant term to express a pleasant or neutral idea.
- **hyperbole**: exaggerated statements or claims not meant to be taken literally.
- **rhetorical question**: asked to make a point or create a dramatic effect, rather than to elicit an answer
- **synecdoche**: a part is used to represent a whole or a whole represents a part
- **tone**: a writer's attitude toward the subject or audience, conveyed through word choice, sentence structure, point of view, details.

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. A fierce wind was the _____, and damage to our roof when the large tree in our front yard fell was the _____.
2. When you call your psychologist a "shrink," you are using a(n) _____.
3. Ms. May's use of _____ on the first day of school backfired when her students started a petition to protest her exaggerated promise of "a hundred pages of homework per night."

4. “She ran through the forest, leaped over the creek, scrambled up the hill, never stopping to catch her breath” is an example of _____
5. The author’s harsh _____ appropriately expresses her anger toward the development of more condos in her already crowded neighborhood.
6. In her explanation, she used a(n) _____ comparing the human brain to a computer processor, illustrating complex functions in a relatable manner.
7. “They offer stagnation, while we offer progress; they embrace fear, while we embrace hope.” is an example of _____
8. “All hands on deck” is an example of _____.
9. The speaker ended with the _____: “If we don’t do something, then who will?”

Preview Concepts

How can you determine cause and effect in a text?

Sometimes the relationship is subtle, and sometimes many causes combine to create multiple effects. In more complex texts, authors show a series of causes and effects rather than just one of each. The simple cause/effect model of *ice + heat = water* must be replaced with a more sophisticated understanding.

Cause and effect is one organizational pattern that is often used in textbooks for history and science. Being able to recognize causes and effects will help you comprehend your reading assignments. What are some key words that indicate causes and effects? Write them below.

Words that indicate causes:

Words that indicate effects:

Another technique for understanding causes and effects is to draw arrows from the cause(s) to the effect(s) within the text as you read. If you can’t write in your book, use arrows between ideas in your notes.

In this chapter, you will read about the development of America’s energy system and its effects on the environment. In the space below, freewrite about what you know about the topics of electricity production and climate change.

Read for Understanding

The following excerpt is from *Hot, Flat, and Crowded* by Thomas L. Friedman. In his award-winning book, foreign affairs columnist Friedman connects the environment, the economy, and politics to argue that a green revolution is necessary in order to build a more sustainable future. The title refers to three challenges: global warming (hot), globalization (flat), and population growth (crowded). In this excerpt, Friedman explains why utilities are cheap and abundant and also why they are harmful and inefficient.

As you read, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

Hot, Flat, and Crowded

by Thomas L. Friedman

- 1 Before we lift the curtain on this magic show, I first need to do something really mundane. I need to explain how our current electricity system in America, primarily based on a network of **publicly regulated** utilities, actually works.
- 5 Probably the last time you stopped and thought about utilities was when you landed on one in Monopoly and had to decide whether to shell out \$150 to buy the Electric Company. That was certainly the case for me before I started researching this book. I knew how my car worked and
- 10 where the closest gasoline station was. I knew where my local water tower and pumping stations were. But I knew absolutely nothing about this thing called an electric **utility**, which provided the electrons that powered my life every day. I knew we got an electric bill once a month and paid it, but
- 15 that's about it. Well, our power utilities are more interesting than you think—and they are also more critical to getting the **Code Green revolution**¹ right than people realize. . . .

Today there are almost 3,200 electric utility companies

¹ **Code Green revolution:** what Friedman calls the move toward clean energy production

Notes:

in America, some of which have service territories spanning
20 huge swaths of multiple states, while others serve just a
single township or part of a county. Eventually these electric
companies and their power lines coalesced into three
regional grids in America: the Eastern Interconnection, which
includes the eastern U.S. seaboard, the Plains states, and the
25 eastern Canadian provinces; the Western Interconnection,
which continues all the way to the Pacific, except in Texas,
which has its own grid—ERCOT, the Electric Reliability Council
of Texas. That's it. That's our electricity system. . . .

In many ways, your local utility was “like a big all-you-can-
30 eat-for-five-dollars energy buffet,” explained Peter Corsell,
the CEO of GridPoint, which makes an apparatus that can
manage all the power systems in your home. . . . The utilities
“were paid by the **regulators** to provide us reliable, cheap,
all-you-can-eat power.” And we came to that all-you-can-eat
35 buffet every day, and we ate whatever we wanted. And it
was always open. And it was always cheap. Life was good.

One reason it was cheap, though, was that the public
and the regulators never asked the utilities to serve two
additional things at this energy buffet. We didn't ask that the
40 power they generated be free of CO2 **emissions**. (We asked
that traditional pollutants, particularly mercury, nitrogen
oxides, and sulfur oxides emitted during the coal combustion
process, be removed, which the utilities did very well, but
not carbon dioxide.) And we didn't encourage them to
45 offer energy efficiency programs. We didn't encourage our
utilities to reward consumers for saving energy or to enable
consumers to respond to changes in supply or prices, so they
could buy more electricity when it was cheaper to generate

Notes:

and use less when it was more expensive to generate.

50 This emphasis on cheap trumped efficiency and global warming considerations. It made sure that utilities relied as much as possible on coal plants. And for many years, if utilities could deliver electricity at a nickel a kilowatt-hour, few people cared if those coal plants spewed out
55 millions of tons of CO₂, and few people cared if you used those kilowatt-hours very inefficiently or in wasteful applications. In fairness, the regulators pressured the utilities to keep prices down and focus where possible on cheap sources like coal.

60 The mandates for “ubiquitous” and “reliable” also worked against efficiency. Why? Because they required utilities to overbuild their supply capacity so they always had an adequate “reserve margin”—at great cost, which was passed on to you—so they could always meet peak load demand on
65 the very hottest days, which might occur only once or twice a summer. Adding supply was always the answer to every problem, never trying to manage demand.

But then one day a funny thing happened on the way to the all-you-could-eat electron buffet. A few people—like **Al**
70 **Gore**²—started to wander around out back into the kitchen, and what they saw there was not pretty. And then they came back to the front of the buffet line and told the rest of us: “Do you know what is going on out back? Do you know why this all-you-can-eat electron buffet costs only \$5? It’s because there
75 are all sorts of costs being **incurred** that are not being passed on to us customers. They are being paid by someone else.”

These costs were being paid by society at large or charged

Notes:

2 **Al Gore:** former vice president and environmental activist

to our children's credit cards. In particular, the coal, natural gas, and oil that were generating all those cheap electrons
80 for our all-you-can-eat buffets were causing global warming, childhood asthma, acid rain, deforestation, **biodiversity**³ loss, and **petrodictatorship**⁴—and no one was factoring these costs into the price per kilowatt-hour you were paying. And since when something is free, or practically free, people
85 usually demand more of it, more cheap electrons were demanded, and more destruction was occurring out back.

The people running these buffets are your neighbors and mine. They're not out to harm society. They're part of it. But the Dirty Fuels System was set up to reliably deliver
90 all-you-can-eat electrons at the cheapest price to every customer who wanted them (and low-cost gasoline to every driver who wanted it) even if that meant **devastating** our ecosystems and climate as side effects. We just didn't make all the connections until recently—and many people
95 still haven't.

Now the public consensus is shifting. Now we are beginning to understand that we need a new system—a Clean Energy System. We still want our electricity and fuels to be cheap, reliable, and ubiquitous, but now we also want them to
100 come as much as possible from non-CO₂-emitting sources and via a system that promotes energy efficiency and conservation, not just consumption and pollution. To be more specific, roughly 40 percent of America's total CO₂ emissions come from the production of electricity used in homes, offices,
105 and factories. Another 30 percent of American emissions come from the transportation sector—primarily cars, trucks,

3 **biodiversity**: the variety of forms of plant and animal life

4 **petrodictatorship**: rule by those who control petroleum production

Notes:

boats, trains, and airplanes. So if we could **electrify** all of our transportation fleet, save for airplanes, and make all of them, and our buildings too, vastly more energy efficient at the same
110 time—and then supply this whole 70 percent, buildings and transportation, with clean, abundant, cheap, reliable electrons through a smarter grid—that would be a revolution. It would be a giant step toward reducing America’s consumption of fossil fuels and our carbon footprint.

Notes:





First Focus: Understanding Cause and Effect

Discover

Skill Focus: When you're reading longer or more complicated texts, it's important to look for different causes that lead to certain effects happening. The story may not have just one single cause and one effect. Usually multiple causes product an effect. And then that effect may go on to cause other new effects to happen as a result. It creates a chain reaction of causes and multiple effects.

As you're reading, you have to analyze and map out these intricate cause-and-effect relationships. Look for clue words such as *because*, *since*, *due to*, *as a result*, *consequently*, *therefore*, and *this led to*. These will signal when causes and effects are being linked together. The more complex the subject, the more likely an overlapping chain of multiple causes will lead to multiple interrelated effects. Identifying and disentangling these intricate connections is key to fully comprehending how events, ideas, or situations unfold and progress in complicated texts.

Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and underline the causes of our nation's dependence on a coal-based energy system in one color and the effects in another color.

Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. According to the article, what enabled utility companies to offer inexpensive service?

2. What was the effect of the country's expectations for "ubiquitous and reliable efficiency?" What might have been a better approach?

3. What reasons does Thomas Friedman cite for American's dependence on coal power?

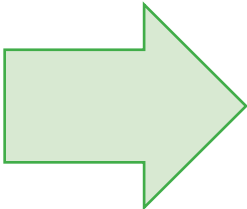
Demonstrate

In more complex texts, authors show a series of causes and effects rather than just one of each. In this excerpt, Friedman points out several causes for America's dependence on coal as well as several effects. Use the graphic organizer on the next page to summarize the relationship between coal-powered utilities and the environment and human health.



Cause and Effect Organizer

Causes	Effects



Exit Ticket

With a partner, take turns summarizing the causes and effects you noted in the organizer. Use your notes to clearly explain the issue of coal consumption so that your listener can follow the argument. When you are finished, ask your partner to assess your verbal summary for clarity, organization, and conciseness using the guidelines below. Write Yes or No in the left-hand column.

Use the following guidelines for your summary.	
Name of person filling out evaluation:	
	Clearly explains the causes and effects of coal consumption.
	Organizes points in a logical fashion.
	Explanation is concise and to the point without fillers. (um, ah)

Second Focus: Using Rhetorical Devices to Advance Purpose

Discover

Skill Focus: When authors write, they often employ specific language techniques called *rhetorical devices*. These are tools writers use to more effectively communicate their message and achieve their intended purpose. Examples of rhetorical devices include figures of speech, irony, and rhetorical questions. These devices allow writers to creatively reinforce the message and intent behind their work in an impactful, thought-provoking way for readers. The rhetorical devices act as powerful vehicles to convey purpose. By analyzing the rhetorical strategies an author employs, you as the reader, can better comprehend their deeper purpose beyond just the literal words on the page.

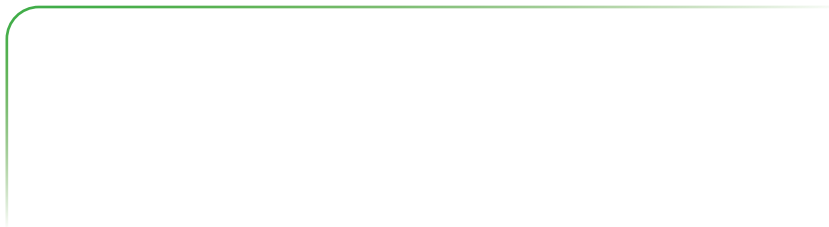
Thomas Friedman makes use of several types of rhetorical devices to simplify a complex issue and make his argument understandable for the average person.

As you read the excerpt a second time, underline phrases that develop the analogy Friedman uses throughout the text.

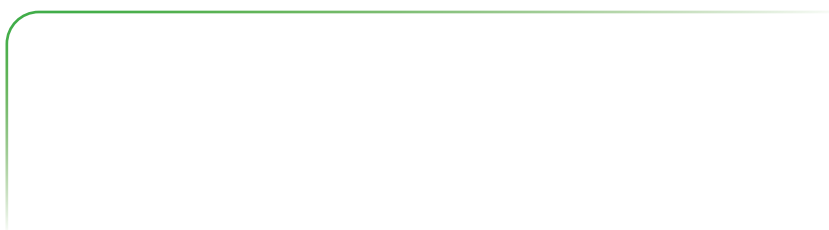
Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. In your opinion, which rhetorical device was the most powerful or effective in Friedman's argument? Cite the text and explain your choice.



2. What problems in the United States remind you of Friedman's piece? What causes and effects can you find related to these problems?



Demonstrate

Rhetoric is the act of writing or speaking effectively—often to persuade and convince an audience. Analyzing how authors use rhetorical devices can help you better understand an author's purpose.

In the chart that follows, fill in the second column with a definition of the term and the third column with an example of figurative language from the text. The first row has been completed for you.

Rhetorical Devices	Definition of Term	Example from Text (or another source)
Dysphemism	the use of negative expressions instead of positive or neutral ones (the opposite of euphemism)	Dirty Fuels System
Figures of Speech— Simile, Metaphor		
Analogy		
Hyperbole		

Rhetorical Devices	Definition of Term	Example from Text (or another source)
Parallelism or anaphora		
Rhetorical question		
Antithesis		
Zeugma		There are no examples in the selection. Example: "He lost his keys and his temper."

continued on next page

Rhetorical Devices	Definition of Term	Example from Text (or another source)
Synecdoche		General example: "She's got a new set of wheels." (Wheels refers to a car.)
Asyndeton		General example: "I came, I saw, I conquered." -Julias Caesar

Exit Ticket

Write a paragraph that identifies and explains the purpose of the analogy Friedman uses to explain America's relationship with electricity. Include an evaluation of the effectiveness of the analogy. Use direct quotations from the text to support your conclusions.

Third Focus: Analyzing Author's Tone

Discover

Skill Focus: An author's tone refers to the attitude or feeling they convey toward the topic through their word choices and writing style. Analyzing the tone is important because it provides clues about the author's perspective and purpose. For example, if the language includes negative words such as *terrible* or *corrupt*, the tone likely conveys disapproval or criticism. Informal contractions such as *can't* suggest a more conversational, casual tone.

Some common tones to identify include:

- Humorous, mocking, sarcastic
- Formal, pragmatic, scholarly
- Optimistic, hopeful, encouraging
- Pessimistic, cynical, apprehensive
- Intimate, reflective, nostalgic

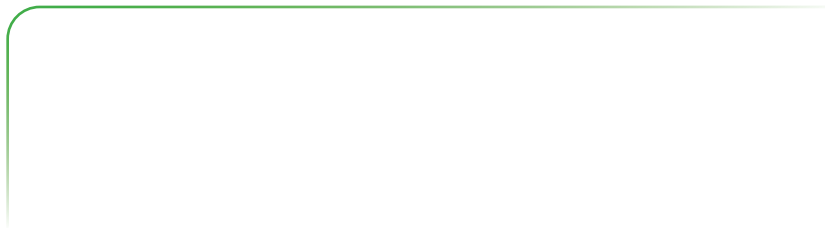
An author's tone shapes the overall perspective and dramatically impacts how readers interpret the work.

As you read the excerpt again, pay attention to Friedman's tone. How would you describe it? Take notes about the tone of the passage in the Notes column. Use words such as *conversational*, *informal*, *formal*, *accusatory*, *defensive*, or *passionate*. Circle words and phrases in the selection that are evidence of his tone.

Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. Overall, is Thomas Friedman's argument regarding the need to move to clean energy sources convincing to you? Why or why not?



2. Do you think Friedman is an optimist or a pessimist about America's energy future? Why do you think this?

Demonstrate

An author's attitude, or tone, connects directly to the intended audience. If an author were writing for a group of lawyers and judges, the tone would be more formal and academic than if the author were writing an opinion piece for a local newspaper.

Friedman's book *Hot, Flat, and Crowded* was written for a general audience of Americans, not scientists or lawyers or politicians in particular. In order to assess his tone, look mainly at the author's word choice, syntax (sentence structure), and sentence length. Are the words lofty and formal or casual and conversational? Are the sentences long and complex or short and concise? Here are some examples of tone:

- **hopeful:** optimistic, positive
- **apathetic:** indifferent due to lack of energy or concern
- **derisive:** critical, mocking
- **indignant:** marked by anger aroused by injustice
- **colloquial:** casual, informal, conversational
- **morose:** gloomy, sullen, surly, despondent
- **sarcastic:** caustic; often saying the opposite of what is really meant; ironic
- **matter-of-fact:** informational

Reread the following sentences from *Hot, Flat, and Crowded*. Then choose a word from the list above that best describes his tone and write it below each one.

1. Before we lift the curtain on this magic show, I first need to do something really mundane.

2. Probably the last time you stopped and thought about utilities was when you landed on one in Monopoly and had to decide whether to shell out \$150 to buy the Electric Company. That was certainly the case for me before I started researching this book.

3. And we didn't encourage them to offer energy efficiency programs. We didn't encourage our utilities to reward consumers for saving energy or to enable consumers to respond to changes in supply or prices.

4. The people running these buffets are your neighbors and mine. They're not out to harm society. They're part of it. But the Dirty Fuels System was set up to reliably deliver all-you-can-eat electrons at the cheapest price to every customer who wanted them.

5. . . . then supply this whole 70 percent, buildings and transportation, with clean, abundant, cheap, reliable electrons through a smarter grid—that would be a revolution. It would be a giant step toward reducing America's consumption of fossil fuels and our carbon footprint.

Exit Ticket

1 With a partner, discuss the following questions: How does Friedman's tone help his cause? Do you find Friedman's tone effective for his subject matter? Are you convinced by his rhetorical devices and tone?

2 If Friedman's sentence structure, word choice, and figurative language were different, would his tone change? How would that affect the purpose of his writing?

Choose a different tone that does *not* reflect Friedman's attitude. Rewrite a paragraph from the excerpt so it reflects the tone you chose. To do this, simply retain the meaning of each sentence but change the way you deliver the message. Read your new paragraph aloud and have your classmates or a partner guess what tone word you chose. For successful examples, discuss how the writers were able to change the tone without changing the meaning of the passage.

Review

In this chapter you learned about structure, rhetorical devices, and tone in nonfiction writing. On a test you may be asked to evaluate these techniques in a text. Answer the questions below in order to demonstrate your knowledge of these topics.

1. What does Friedman describe as the main cause of both inefficiency and carbon pollution?
 - A. the requirement of low energy prices
 - B. the demand for constant, limitless energy
 - C. the need for universal energy availability
 - D. the ignorance of energy consumers
2. Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow.

I knew where my local water tower and pumping stations were. But I knew absolutely nothing about this thing called an electric utility, which provided the electrons that powered my life every day.

Part A: Which of the following best describes the tone of the passage above?

- A. arrogant
- B. mocking
- C. reflective
- D. indifferent

Part B: Choose two phrases from the passage above that provide the best evidence for your answer to Part A. Write them below and explain why they support your answer to Part A.

3. **Part A:** Which of the following sentences from the selection contains an example of an analogy?
- A. *In fairness, the regulators pressured the utilities to keep prices down and focus where possible on cheap sources like coal.*
 - B. *Adding supply was always the answer to every problem, never trying to manage demand.*
 - C. *A few people—like Al Gore—started to wander around out back into the kitchen, and what they saw there was not pretty.*
 - D. *Now we are beginning to understand that we need a new system—a Clean Energy System.*

Part B: Explain the meaning of the analogy you selected in Part A.



4. Which sentence from the selection best represents Friedman's tone when discussing energy producers?
- A. *These costs were being paid by society at large or charged to our children's credit cards.*
 - B. *The people running these buffets are your neighbors and mine.*
 - C. *And for many years, if utilities could deliver electricity at a nickel a kilowatt-hour, few people cared if those coal plants spewed out millions of tons of CO₂ . . .*
 - D. *Because they required utilities to overbuild their supply capacity so they always had an adequate "reserve margin"—at great cost, which was passed on to you . . .*



Chapter 16

Assessing Balance in Informational Text

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- observe how minor ideas connect to a broader issue in an informational text.
- analyze the use of paragraphing, transitions, and topic sentences to link ideas.
- assess whether an author presents a balanced view of a controversial topic.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **balanced presentation:** giving evidence to support both sides of an issue in order to fairly present the issue.
- **bias:** cause to feel or show inclination or prejudice for or against someone or something
- **subtopic:** a specific aspect of a broader topic.
- **transition:** a word or phrase that connects one idea to the next.

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. The speaker promised a _____ of the issue; however, she only gave evidence in favor of the building of condominium units.
2. Ali's paper on the future of jellyfish included several _____ that detailed the various types of jellyfish found in the ocean.
3. Some common _____ to use in an essay include the following words: *however*, *therefore*, and *additionally*.
4. The opinion piece only presented one side of the issue; therefore, it contained _____.

Preview Concepts

What is the difference between a topic and a subtopic? Write your ideas in the space below.

Subtopics are more specific aspects of broader subjects. In a text, authors move from one subtopic to the next, linking them with topic sentences, transitional phrases, and verb phrases in order to connect to the main idea. A writer must use sentence placement and paragraphing to make the connection between ideas for the reader.

When authors discuss controversial topics, they may wish to convey information without taking sides. In such cases, authors attempt to balance the claims of those who support an idea and those who oppose it. Presenting facts and letting readers decide can be a difficult task—a balancing act, some might say.

Read for Understanding

The following excerpt is from *Frankenstein's Cat* by Emily Anthes. Anthes writes about the intersection between science and animal welfare. The title of her book plays on the story of Frankenstein's monster, who was assembled from parts of different human bodies.

As you read, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

Frankenstein's Cat

by Emily Anthes

1 Science has given us a whole new toolbox for tinkering
with life, and we have the power to modify animals in
profound new ways. We are editing their genetic codes,
rebuilding their broken bodies, and supplementing their
5 natural senses. Headlines frequently herald the birth of
strange new creatures: **Bionic** beetles! *Glowing cats!* *Spider*
goats! *Roborats!* The breakthroughs are simultaneously
astounding and puzzling. What *are* these creatures exactly?
What do they look like? Who's creating them, and why? And
10 are these animals really so novel?

Indeed, we have a long history of refashioning animal
bodies. Take the varied members of the species *Canis lupus*
familiaris—the modern dog—which are products of **millennia**
of life with humans and bear little resemblance to their
15 ancestors, gray wolves. Exactly how this dog **domestication**
began is a subject of intense debate. Some scientists suggest
that we deliberately set out to acquire **canine** companions,
adopting wild wolf pups. Others **hypothesize** that hungry
wolves, attracted to the bones, trash, and scraps produced
20 by early humans, approached our camps on their own terms,

Notes:

and that our tolerance of the least threatening **interlopers**¹ gave rise to future generations of human-friendly canines. Either way, as wolves became part of human society, moving from cold ground to warm hearth, they lost many of the traits they needed to survive in the wild. Their bodies and heads shrank, their faces and jaws grew more compact, and their teeth decreased in size.

As our relationship with canines developed, we began to breed them more carefully, molding dogs that excelled at specific tasks. We created the bulky, barrel-chested mastiff to guard our homes, and the dachshund, a wiggly salami of a dog, to shimmy into badger burrows. The **diversity** among modern dogs is so astounding that the thirty thousand dogs that strut their canine stuff at Crufts, the largest dog show in the world, don't even look like members of the same species. . . . Today, thanks to us, dogs are the most physically diverse species on Earth.

We've reshaped other species, too, turning **scrawny** chickens into plump broiler birds and bristly-haired wild sheep into producers of soft wool. The list goes on and on. We learned to breed animals that suited our every need, creating hunters, herders, guardians, food sources, and companions. Over the course of generations, the members of many species diverged from their wild ancestors and took their place in a human world.

But selective breeding was a blunt instrument, one that required us to transform animals using educated guesswork, breeding desirable hounds together, over and over again, until a puppy we liked squirmed into the world. It took

Notes:

¹ **interlopers:** outsiders

50 thousands of years to turn wolves into dogs. Now we can
create novel organisms in years, months, even days.

Today, the tools of molecular biology allow us to target
one specific gene, to instantly turn it on or off, to silence or
amplify its effects. . . .

55 Genetics isn't the only field providing us with the power
to reengineer other species. Advances in electronics and
computing make it possible to merge animal bodies with
machines, to use tiny electrodes to hijack a rat's brain and
guide the rodent, like a remote-controlled toy, through a
60 complicated obstacle course. Breakthroughs in materials
science and veterinary surgery are helping us build bionic
limbs for injured animals, and we can train monkeys to
control robotic arms with their thoughts. Today, our grandest
science fiction fantasies are becoming reality.

65 Some of us may find our growing control over living,
breathing beings to be unsettling. After all, **biotechnology**²
is the stuff of dystopian nightmares, and many an **apocalyptic**
scenario has been constructed around crazy **chimeras**³ or
world-conquering **cyborgs**⁴. Ethicists and activists worry
70 about whether we should be altering other species when we
can't possibly get their consent. Some say that manipulating
the planet's wild things—whether we're inserting genes or
electrodes—is profoundly unnatural, causes animal suffering,
and turns other life-forms into commodities. Critics worry
75 that our effort to remake the world's **fauna**⁵ is the worst
example of human **hubris**, the expression of an arrogant
desire to play God.

2 **biotechnology**: the manipulation of living organisms to change their characteristics

3 **chimeras**: creatures made up of parts from different animals

4 **cyborgs**: organisms whose bodies include robotic parts

5 **fauna**: animal life

Notes:

It's true that remaking other species according to our own wants and needs doesn't necessarily put animal welfare first. Selective breeding hasn't always turned out well for animals—we've saddled dog breeds with all sorts of hereditary diseases and created turkeys with such gigantic breasts that they can barely walk. And of course, biotechnology gives us new ways to do damage. . . .

85 If there is peril here, there is also great promise. Biotechnology could do more for animals than it's given credit for. Sure, we can make animals sick, but we can also choose to deploy our species-shaping powers to help other species survive and thrive, to create healthier, happier, fitter critters, and some scientists are doing just that. With the sophisticated techniques at our fingertips, we may even be able to undo some of the damage we've done to other species, alleviating genetic disorders in dogs, for instance, or bringing wild animal populations back from the brink of extinction. Some forward-thinking philosophers are dreaming of more extreme **interventions**, such as boosting the brainpower of apes, and using genetic modification and electronic **enhancement** to help animals transcend the limits of their own bodies.

100 Right now all the options are open. Though biotechnology's strange new creatures are being created in the world's labs, they don't tend to stay there very long, and there are already cutting-edge animals living in fields, homes, and nature reserves across America. . . .

105 Most of us care deeply about some form of animal life, whether it's the cat or dog curled up on the couch—60 percent of Americans share their homes with pets of one

Notes:

species or another—the chickens laying our eggs, or some exotic **predator** fighting to survive as its **habitat** disappears.

110 Now that we can sculpt life into an endless parade of forms, what we choose to create reveals what it is we want from other species—and what we want *for* them. But even if you feel no special affection for the creatures with whom we share this planet, our reinvention of animals matters for us, 115 too. It provides a peek into our own future, at the ways we may start to enhance and alter ourselves. Most of all, our grand experiments reveal how entangled the lives of human and nonhuman animals have become, how **intertwined** our fates are. Enterprising scientists, entrepreneurs, and 120 philosophers are dreaming up all sorts of projects that could alter the course of our collective future.

Notes:



First Focus: Identifying Key Ideas and Subtopics

Discover

Skill Focus: An informative or expository essay is written to teach the reader about a particular topic or subject. The writer has an overall central idea or claim they want to convey. To fully explain this central idea, the author presents supporting ideas throughout the essay. These may include descriptive details, reasons, facts, examples, or stories that all reinforce that core central idea. Each of these supporting ideas provides critical information and details that convince the reader that the central idea is true and valid.

Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and underline the main idea of the entire passage and write *main idea*. Then identify the subpoints or supporting ideas by underlining them and writing *subpoints* in the Notes column.

Discuss: Whole Group

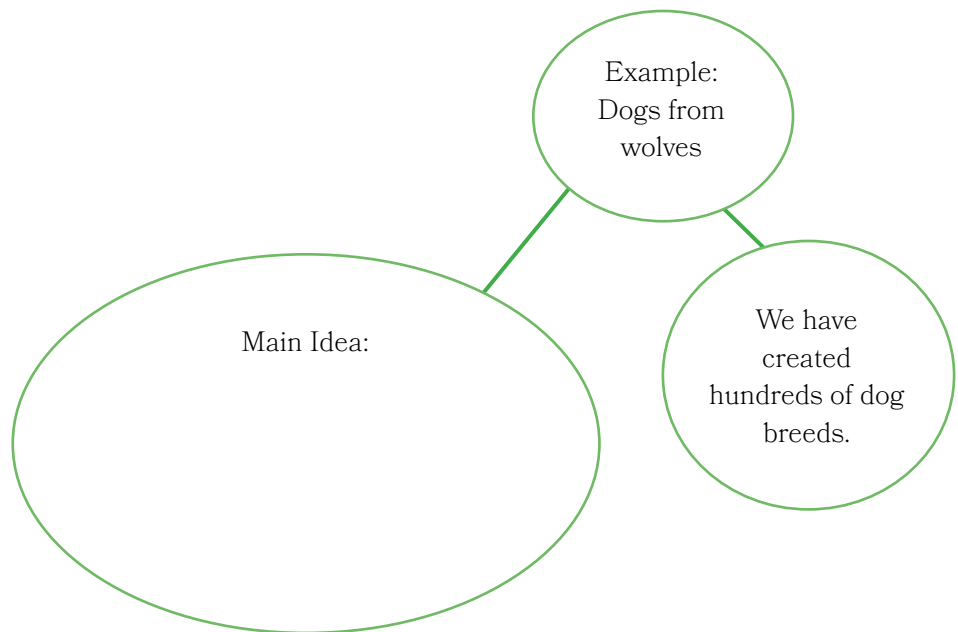
Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. According to the selection, what are some of the ways that humans have altered animals?

2. What concerns does Anthes raise in this selection?

Demonstrate

In the passage you just read, the author supports the central idea by developing subtopics. Understanding the relationship between the main idea and the supporting points is important to reading comprehension. Creating a visual of the ideas can be a helpful tool. The image below is a beginning of a concept web. Write the main idea of the excerpt in the center circle. Draw lines and circles radiating from the center circle and fill in the subtopics. If a paragraph develops a subtopic, connect that circle to the subtopic circle with a line.



Exit Ticket

Based on the web you created, prepare a brief speech (1 to 3 minutes) on the subtopic that interests you most. What intrigues you about this subject, and why is it important to you? What do you already know about this topic? What would you like to learn more about? Take a few minutes to plan your speech. Then, with a partner, take turns speaking and listening. Evaluate your partner on their explanation, reasoning, and speaking style.

Second Focus: Connecting Key Ideas

Discover

Skill Focus: When writers are explaining a concept or providing information on a topic, they organize their ideas into separate paragraphs or sections. A topic sentence states the main idea or focus of that particular paragraph. As a reader, identifying these topic sentences helps you follow how each paragraph supports and relates to the larger subject being comprehensively explained.

Authors use transitions to help bridge the gap and create a logical flow between supporting points in informational text. Transitions are words, phrases, or sentences that connect one idea to the next.

Some common transition words and phrases include:

- *First, second, third*
- *Additionally, furthermore, moreover*
- *In contrast, however, on the other hand*
- *For example, for instance, specifically*
- *As a result, consequently, therefore*
- *In conclusion, ultimately, in summary*

By using these transitional cues, authors move from one key idea to the next in an organized, coherent manner. As a reader, pay attention to transitional phrases. They will help you follow the progression of ideas and understand the relationships between the central ideas and supporting details.

As you read the excerpt a second time, underline the topic sentence of each paragraph and any transitional phrases that help you understand the relationship between ideas.

Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion question below.

1. Create an outline for the excerpt from *Frankenstein's Cat*. Notice how the author structures the piece and what techniques she uses. For instance, what is the purpose of the first several paragraphs? Where does Anthes change structure, and why?

Demonstrate

Look back at the topic sentences you underlined in the selection. Notice how Anthes transitions from one idea to the next while staying on topic. She uses repetition, transitions, and topic sentences to link one idea to the next.

In the chart that follows, note which two ideas the writer connects and which transitional word or phrase is used to link the ideas. You may need to reread portions of the text in order to fill in the second column. The first row has been completed for you.

Topic Sentence(s)	Two Connected Ideas	Transitional Word or Phrase
Indeed, we have a long history of refashioning animal bodies.	Breakthroughs in biotechnology are linked to the domestication of dogs.	Indeed
As our relationship with canines developed, we began to breed them more carefully, molding dogs that excelled at specific tasks.		

Topic Sentence(s)	Two Connected Ideas	Transitional Word or Phrase
Today, thanks to us, dogs are the most physically diverse species on Earth. We've reshaped other species, too, turning scrawny chickens into plump broiler birds and bristly-haired wild sheep into producers of soft wool.		
Genetics isn't the only field providing us with the power to reengineer other species. Advances in electronics and computing make it possible to merge animal bodies with machines, to use tiny electrodes to hijack a rat's brain and guide the rodent, like a remote-controlled toy, through a complicated obstacle course.		
Some of us may find our growing control over living, breathing beings to be unsettling. After all, biotechnology is the stuff of dystopian nightmares, and many an apocalyptic scenario has been constructed around crazy chimeras or world-conquering cyborgs.		
If there is peril here, there is also great promise.		

Exit Ticket

Write a short paragraph explaining how the author uses translational phrases to link ideas. Provide examples from your completed Topic Sentence chart.

Third Focus: Evaluating Balance

Discover

Skill Focus: A balanced essay is like a well-rounded meal. It gives fair consideration to different perspectives or sides of an argument. To check for balance, look for evidence and arguments presented from multiple viewpoints. Is the author giving equal attention to different sides of the issue?

Bias in an essay is similar to a buffet that only serves one type of food, for example, pizza. It's tasty, but it doesn't give you a complete picture of what's out there. To spot bias, look for signs that the author is favoring one viewpoint over others without considering opposing arguments. Are they ignoring evidence that doesn't support their position?

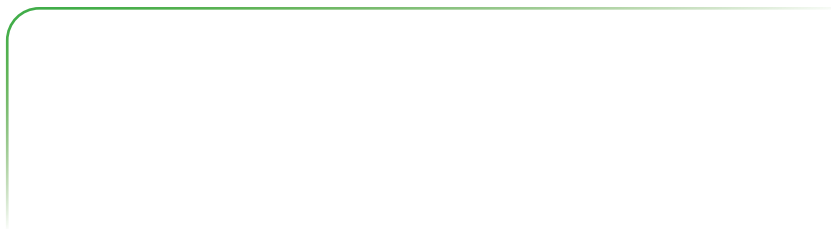
When evaluating an essay for balance versus bias, think about the presentation in terms of whether it's like a well-rounded meal that considers different viewpoints (balance) or if it's more like eating only one type of food without exploring other options (bias). By looking for a variety of evidence and considering different perspectives, you can determine whether the essay is fair and balanced or if it leans too heavily in one direction.

Both pros (favorable factors) and cons (unfavorable factors) are connected to advances in biotechnology. As you read the excerpt again, add a plus sign (+) next to the pros and a negative sign (-) next to the cons.

Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

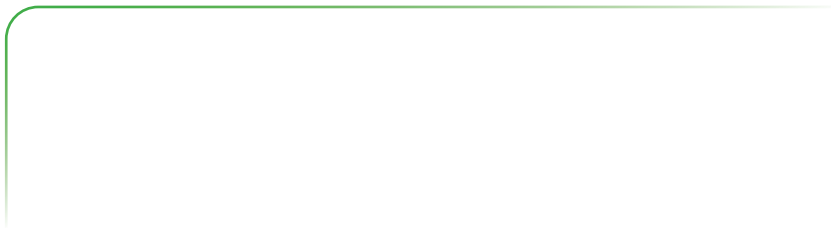
1. In your opinion, which of Anthes's examples of modifying a species to suit human needs is the most ethical? Which is the least ethical? Explain both of your answers.



2. Do you think that Anthes's tone is biased or unbiased? What word choices or examples make you think so?



3. Which position do you think the author would agree with more: using modern scientific processes to intervene in nature, or leaving nature largely alone?



Demonstrate

In order to provide a balanced presentation, an author must offer evidence supporting and criticizing an issue. Does Anthes make a balanced presentation in this excerpt? In the T-chart on the next page, list the details you found that make up both sides of the discussion.

Biotechnology Used for Manipulating the Genes of Animals	
Pros	Cons

Exit Ticket

1 Does the author provide sufficient reasoning for both sides? Which side does her overall presentation skew toward? Does she delineate the benefits of biotechnology as well as the risks inherent in inventing new species? Talk about the answers with a peer or with your class as a whole.

2 Choose to argue either the pros or cons of biotechnology. Then using the excerpt from *Frankenstein's Cat*, write a paragraph that supports or opposes the use of biotechnology to alter a species. Introduce the topic of biotechnology with a definition or brief explanation. Then develop your points by providing claims that are supported by examples, quotations, or facts.

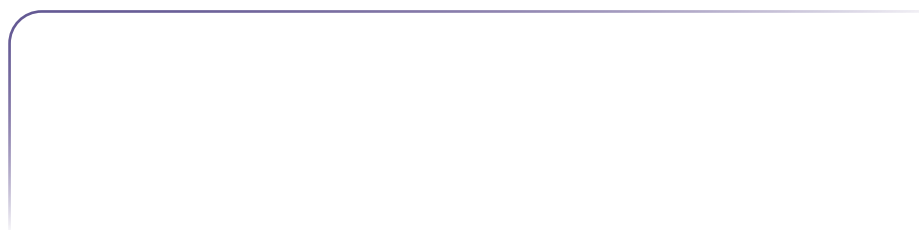
Review

In this chapter, you analyzed a passage for main ideas and subtopics, gaining an understanding of the relationship between ideas. The following questions illustrate how this skill may be tested on standardized assessments.

1. Read the passage below and then answer the questions that follow.

Some of us may find our growing control over living, breathing beings to be unsettling. After all, biotechnology is the stuff of dystopian nightmares, and many an apocalyptic scenario has been constructed around crazy chimeras or world-conquering cyborgs. Ethicists and activists worry about whether we should be altering other species when we can't possibly get their consent. Some say that manipulating the planet's wild things—whether we're inserting genes or electrodes—is profoundly unnatural, causes animal suffering, and turns other life-forms into commodities. Critics worry that our effort to remake the world's fauna is the worst example of human hubris, the expression of an arrogant desire to play God.

Part A: Identify two types of people who might be uncomfortable with advances in biotechnology.



Part B: Give three reasons from the passage that some people may criticize advances in biotechnology.



2. Which of the following subtopics does the author include as part of the larger topic of using biotechnology to reshape animal species?
- A. selective breeding
 - B. history of dog breeds
 - C. the popularity of pets
 - D. bionic limbs
3. Which statement from the selection best displays the balance between positions on biotechnology?
- A. *Today, our grandest science fiction fantasies are becoming reality.*
 - B. *Selective breeding hasn't always turned out well for animals—we've saddled dog breeds with all sorts of hereditary diseases . . .*
 - C. *If there is peril here, there is also great promise.*
 - D. *Enterprising scientists, entrepreneurs, and philosophers are dreaming up all sorts of projects that could alter the course of our collective future.*
4. Read this paragraph and answer the question that follows.

But selective breeding was a blunt instrument, one that required us to transform animals using educated guesswork, breeding desirable hounds together, over and over again, until a puppy we liked squirmed into the world. It took thousands of years to turn wolves into dogs. Now we can create novel organisms in years, months, even days.

What two topics does this paragraph connect in the excerpt from the chapter?

- A. the history of selective breeding and the development of modern biotechnology
- B. the uncertain process of selective breeding and the certainty of genetic modification
- C. the slow pace of selective breeding and the speed of molecular biology
- D. the success of selective breeding and the risks associated with editing genetic codes



Chapter 17

Comparing Arguments

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- analyze the impact of text structures and the use of features in a text.
- analyze an author's use of rhetoric in a text.
- compare and evaluate two opposing arguments.

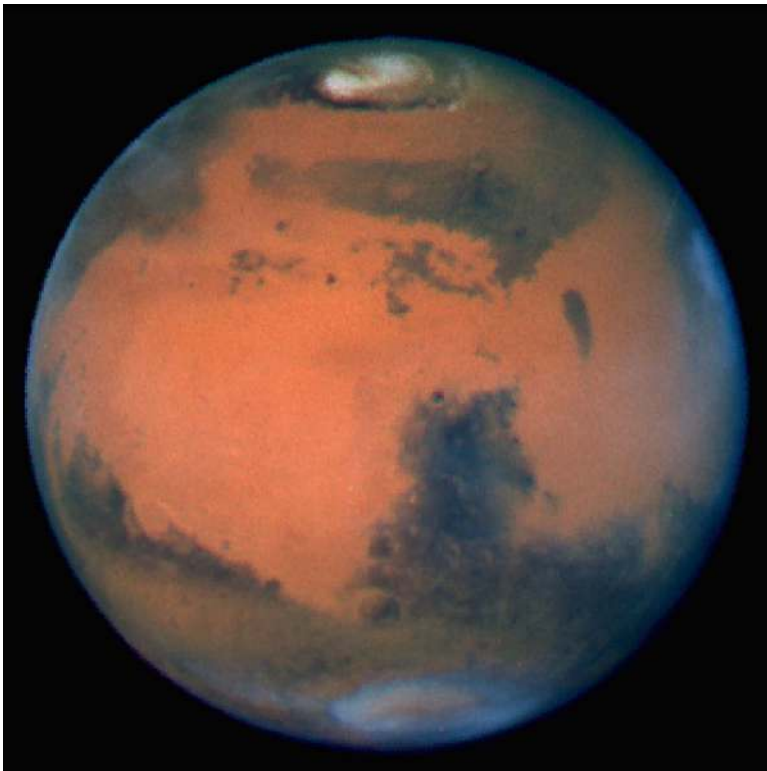
Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **argument:** a coherent series of reasons, statements, or facts intended to support or establish an opinion
- **author's perspective:** the author's attitude toward a topic or subject.
- **claim:** to say that something is true or is a fact.
- **evaluate:** to judge or calculate the quality, importance, amount, or value of something.
- **evidence:** source-based information including facts, figures, and details used to support the writer's central idea or claim.
- **opposing:** disagreeing or disapproving.
- **rhetoric:** the art or skill of speaking or writing formally and effectively, especially to persuade or influence people.
- **text features:** the components of a story or article that are not the main body of text, including the table of contents, glossary, pictures, and bold words.
- **text structures:** structures used to organize information in a text; examples include chronology, comparison, cause and effect.
- **tone:** the author's attitude toward a subject.
- **valid:** truthful with respect to the information presented.

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. When constructing an argumentative essay, it's essential to clearly state your _____ and provide evidence to persuade your audience.
2. He recognized the _____ points that both sides were making in the argument about road safety.
3. As you read, pay attention to the various _____, such as headings, captions, and diagrams, which can aid comprehension.
4. The speaker used no direct _____ to support his claim that dogs are the best animal for a family pet.
5. Recognizing different _____, such as chronological order or cause and effect, can help readers better understand the organization of a text.
6. The _____ of the author's article about the challenges of space travel is optimistic and forward-thinking.
7. The speaker's impassioned _____ soon had the crowd on its feet.
8. You need to carefully _____ your communications with others on social media to avoid misunderstandings.
9. To develop a well-rounded understanding of a topic, it is important to consider both supporting and _____ viewpoints.
10. In literary analysis, it's essential to provide textual evidence to support any _____ about a character's motivations or the author's thematic intentions.
11. In analyzing a persuasive essay, it's crucial to identify the _____ on the topic before evaluating the strength of their argument.



Preview Concepts

In this chapter you will explore the Essential Question: What are the costs of scientific innovation?

Take a moment to consider a future where humans have colonized Mars. Envision the challenges and opportunities such a feat would present, both for individuals and society as a whole. Record your ideas on the chart below.

Challenges	Opportunities

Would it be a good idea for humans to attempt to colonize Mars? In one paragraph, make a claim and support your argument with reasons from your chart.

Read for Understanding

The following passages present different ideas about colonizing the planet Mars. As you read, think about key ideas. What is this story mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out to you? Annotate the text and put Notes in the sidebar. Also, note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

Excerpt

from “To Save Earth, Go to Mars”

by Joe Mascaro

Al Gore often ends his presentations on climate change by showing a classic image of the Blue Marble – the full sunlit disk of the Earth, hanging vulnerably against the blackness of space – before adding some cautionary words: ‘Don’t let anyone tell
5 you we can escape to Mars; we couldn’t even evacuate New Orleans. The Earth is the only planet **habitable** for human beings. We’re going to have to make our stand right here.’

This is a rational view of the challenge. We have to deal with famine and disease. An estimated one billion people live
10 on less than \$1.90 per day. Climate change is threatening a tenuous global economy. Why would we invest resources on **habitable** another planet when we need them so urgently on Earth? . . .

But lately I’ve found myself wondering: what if our societal
15 view of problem-solving is flat-out wrong? More specifically, what if addressing a crisis directly is not always the most effective route to success, and investing resources toward a different, seemingly unrelated challenge could lead to faster, more effective breakthroughs?

20 It sounds like a wild claim, but this indirect approach, known as lateral innovation, is responsible for many of the

Notes:

Notes:

most remarkable innovations we encounter in our daily lives, generally with little awareness of where they came from. One of the most dramatic recent examples is the graphics processing unit (GPU)¹. Fast, powerful GPUs were originally developed to meet the demand for increasingly realistic video games, especially ultraviolent first-person shooters. But machine learning, computer vision and neural networks pose very similar computational challenges, and the technology quickly migrated over. Specialized GPUs are now used for diagnostic medicine, facial recognition, self-driving cars and market forecasting. Built on innovations developed for games such as Doom and Grand Theft Auto, machine learning is powering one of the fastest-growing sectors in the world economy. . . .

35 In short, Gore got it exactly wrong. To save the Earth, we have to go to Mars.

The challenges of surviving on Mars are extreme, but they are hardly alien. Among the most basic steps for **colonizing** Mars are growing food in a cold, arid environment and generating energy without **fossil fuels**. Today, international development organizations are experimenting with crops that achieve the same basic goal: to produce calories in inhospitable environments. Salt-tolerant potatoes in Pakistan. Drought-tolerant maize in East Africa. Nutrient-rich rice in India. 40 The difference is that the Martian problem requires much more extreme, innovative solutions. . . .

Finally, and perhaps most importantly, living on the Martian surface—and especially returning home from it—will require an ability to manipulate the Martian atmosphere. On Earth, 50 the primary gases in the air we breathe are nitrogen, oxygen,

¹ **Graphic Processing Unit (GPU):** a computer chip that renders graphics and images by performing rapid mathematical calculations; used for both professional and personal computing

and several trace gases including carbon dioxide. On Mars, the atmosphere is extremely thin, just a little over 1 percent of the density of Earth's. And although oxygen and nitrogen are essentially absent, carbon dioxide is hyper-abundant, constituting 95 percent of the Martian atmosphere.

The abundant CO₂ in the Martian atmosphere will be a crucial resource for a self-sustaining Mars colony. By extracting carbon molecules, we can react them with hydrogen to produce methane, a rocket fuel that will send our astronauts home. We can also pull oxygen out of the CO₂ to make water. The basic chemistry involved in these reactions has been known for centuries, but there's been little incentive to innovate the techniques used to manipulate them. Water and oxygen are so bountiful on Earth that we've never had much incentive to develop efficient ways of extracting them from carbon dioxide. But today it is becoming clear that processing CO₂ could be the key to reducing carbon emissions and creating useful materials such as plastics without fossil fuels.

The challenge of colonizing Mars shares remarkable DNA with the challenges we face here on Earth. Living on Mars will require mastery of recycling matter and water, producing food from barren and arid soil, generating carbon-free nuclear and solar energy, building advanced batteries and materials, and extracting and storing carbon from atmospheric carbon dioxide—and doing it all at once. The dreamers, thinkers and explorers who decide to go to Mars will, by necessity, fuel unprecedented lateral innovations.

Notes:

“The Impossible Dream of Terraforming Mars”

80 The idea of colonizing Mars has captured the imagination of scientists, entrepreneurs, and dreamers for decades. However, despite the enthusiasm and ambition surrounding this concept, the reality is that humans will likely never establish a permanent settlement on the Red Planet². The
85 challenges and obstacles that stand in the way of this goal are simply too numerous and complex to overcome. These obstacles include:

- making Mars habitable for humans and other life forms
- reducing the dangers posed by radiation exposure
- 90 ▪ addressing the limited availability of resources
- managing substantial costs

Hurdles to Terraforming Mars

One of the most significant hurdles to colonizing Mars is the process of **terraforming**. This hypothetical concept involves
95 geoengineering the planet to make it habitable for humans and other life forms. The process would require the introduction of oxygen and other gases into the Martian atmosphere to raise surface temperature and air pressure, among other interventions. While this may sound like a viable solution to the
100 problem of Mars' inhospitable environment, the reality is that terraforming is a process that would take thousands of years to complete, if it is even possible at all.

The logistics of terraforming Mars are also a major obstacle. In a 2018 paper published in *Nature*, researchers
105 Bruce Jakosky and Christopher Edwards from the University of Colorado, Boulder sought to determine the amount of carbon

² **Red Planet:** a name for Mars because iron minerals on Martian soil oxidize, causing the soil and atmosphere to look red

Notes:

Notes:

dioxide that would be needed to increase the air pressure on Mars to a level that would allow humans to work on the surface without the need for pressure suits. They also examined the
110 amount of CO₂ required to raise the temperature enough for liquid water to exist and persist on the surface without freezing or evaporating. Their conclusion was that there is simply not enough carbon dioxide on Mars—either in the atmosphere or in other sources—to achieve these goals. Although the current
115 Martian atmosphere itself consists mostly of carbon dioxide, it is far too thin and cold to support liquid water, an essential ingredient for life. Future geoengineers would need to find a way to import the necessary gases from elsewhere.

Barriers to Human Settlement

120 Even if the terraforming process were to be successful, there are still numerous other challenges that would need to be addressed before humans could live on Mars. For example,⁵the planet is bombarded with high levels of radiation due to its lack of a magnetic field and thin atmosphere. This radiation
125 exposure would be a significant health risk for any human settlers, and finding ways to mitigate this risk would be a major challenge.

Another issue is the lack of resources on Mars. While the planet may have some water ice and other essential elements,
130 the quantities are limited, and extracting them would be a difficult and energy-intensive process. Additionally, the soil on Mars is toxic due to the presence of perchlorates³, which would make growing food a challenge.

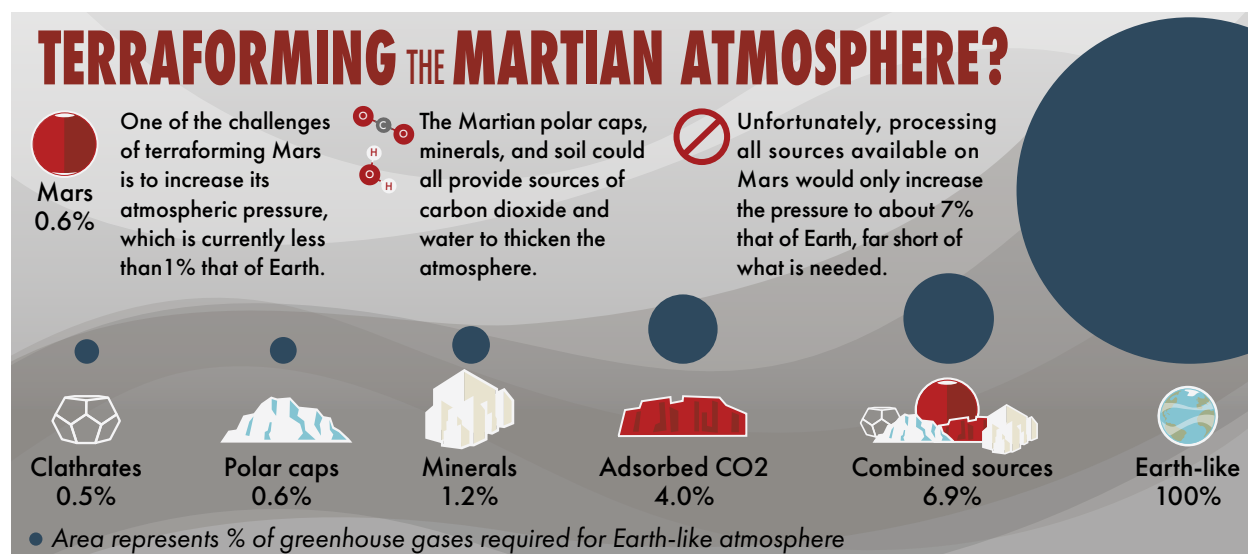
³ **perchlorates:** a group of chemical compounds containing the perchlorate ion commonly found in Martian soil that are harmful to human health

The Economic Realities of Mars Colonization

135 Finally, there is the issue of cost. Establishing a permanent
human presence on Mars would be an incredibly expensive
endeavor, requiring massive investments in technology,
infrastructure, and resources. Given the numerous other pressing
issues facing humanity, such as climate change, poverty, and
140 disease, it is difficult to justify spending such vast sums of money
on a project with such uncertain outcomes.

While the idea of colonizing Mars may be a fascinating and
inspiring one, the reality is that it is unlikely to ever come to fruition.
The challenges of terraforming, radiation exposure, resource
145 scarcity, and cost are simply too great to overcome. Instead of
focusing on this distant and uncertain goal, we should direct our
efforts toward solving the problems we face here on Earth and
finding ways to live sustainably on our own planet.

Notes:



This infographic shows the various sources of carbon dioxide on Mars and their estimated contribution to Martian atmospheric pressure.

Credits: NASA Goddard Space Flight Center

First Focus: Analyzing the Impact of Text Structures and Text Features

Discover

Skill Focus: Text structures and text features are tools that authors use to make writing more effective and engaging for readers.

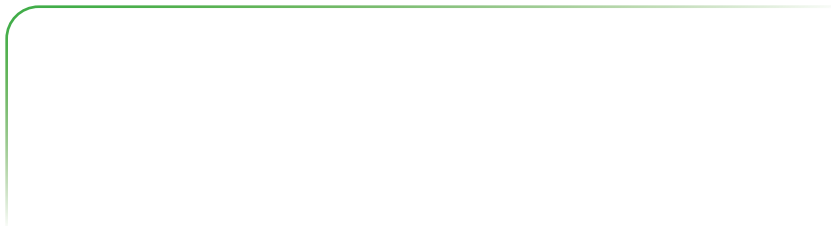
- **Text features:** components outside of the main text, such as headings, pictures and captions, and diagrams, that provide information or resources for the reader
- **Text structures:** ways of organizing information in a text, such as chronological, cause and effect, or problem/solution

Now that you have a general understanding of the selections, return to the passages and underline words and phrases that help you identify the text structures used in each article. Also note any text features that are present, such as bold or italicized words, footnotes, headings, charts, or diagrams.

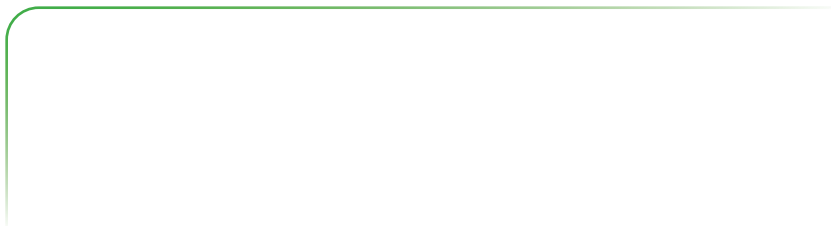
Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. How does the first passage challenge the conventional view of addressing global challenges solely on Earth? How does this alternative approach, termed “lateral innovation,” connect to the potential benefits of investing in Martian colonization?



2. In the context of the first passage, how does the exploration of Mars offer opportunities for addressing Earth’s challenges, such as climate change and resource scarcity?



3. The second passage outlines numerous challenges and obstacles to terraforming Mars and establishing a permanent human presence. What specific factors mentioned in the passage contribute to the argument that colonizing Mars is unlikely to be feasible?

Demonstrate

The following chart explains the differences between text structures and text features.

Term	Definition	Examples
Text Structures	The way authors organize information in a text	chronological, compare and contrast, problem and solution, description, cause and effect, sequence
Text Features	The components of a story or article that are not the main body of text.	Table of contents, headings, captions, photographs, charts, illustrations, glossary, footnotes, annotations, and appendix

Recognizing the underlying structure of a text can help readers focus on key concepts, anticipate what is to come next, and increase comprehension as they read. Text features, on the other hand, help readers locate important information in a text.

The charts below identify text structures and features and how they help the reader.

Text Structure	Helps the Reader . . .
Cause and Effect	Understand the relationship between events or actions and their consequences, providing insights into why things happen the way they do.
Chronological	Follow the progression of events in a clear and orderly manner.
Compare and Contrast	Discern similarities and differences between subjects or concepts.
Description	Visualize and immerse themselves in the subject being described.

continued on next page

Text Structure	Helps the Reader ...
Problem and Solution	Identify and comprehend complex issues or challenges, clarifying the nature of the problem at hand.
Sequence	Navigate procedural or instructional content in a logical manner, ensuring comprehension and successful execution of tasks.

Text Feature	Helps the Reader ...
Annotations	Comprehend the key ideas.
Appendix	Understand ideas in more depth.
Bold/Italic Print	Identify important words and information.
Bullets	Identify key ideas or details.
Captions	Understand illustrations or photographs.
Charts/Graphs/ Infographics	Visualize and understand data and information.
Footnotes	Understand specific words or phrases; verify the accuracy of the information by its source.
Glossary	Define words used in the text.
Headings/Subheadings	Identify topics and subtopics within the text.
Illustrations	Understand what something looks like.
Maps	Understand political, geographical, or historical features
Photographs	Understand exactly how something looks.
Table of Contents	Locate topics in the text.
Titles	Understand the topic of the text.

Ultimately, authors use text structures and features to enhance the readability, clarity, and impact of their writing, making it more enjoyable and informative for their audience.

Now it's your turn. Complete the chart below by identifying various text structures and features in both articles. Include at least one text structure and two text features from each article (some features will be present in both articles). Then explain the purpose of each feature. The first one has been completed for you.

Text Structure or Feature	Passage	Helps the Reader . . .
Problem and Solution Text Structure	"To Save Earth, go to Mars"	Understand the magnitude of global challenges and consider innovative approaches and solutions that may have far-reaching implications for the future of humanity on Earth and beyond.

continued on next page

Text Structure or Feature	Passage	Helps the Reader . . .



Exit Ticket

Reflect on what you've learned about text structures and features. Write down one text structure or feature you found particularly interesting or useful in understanding the two passages about colonizing Mars. Briefly explain how identifying this structure or feature helped you comprehend the text better.

Second Focus: Analyzing the Use of Rhetoric

Discover

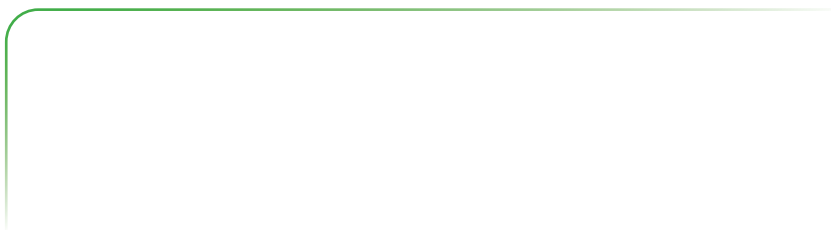
Skill Focus: *Rhetoric* is the art of effective communication, often used to persuade an audience. Authors employ various rhetorical strategies, such as appealing to emotions (pathos), using logic and reasoning (logos), or establishing credibility (ethos), to convince readers of their perspective or argument.

Follow along as your teacher reads the passages aloud. Notice and underline words and phrases that grab your attention and persuade you to believe each author's argument. In the Notes column, write a sentence that explains each author's perspective.

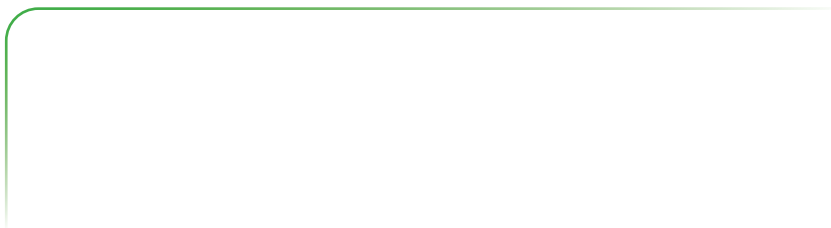
Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. These passages present contrasting perspectives on the potential benefits and challenges of colonizing Mars. How does each author use evidence and reasoning to support their claims?



2. Which author do you find more persuasive and why? Consider factors such as the clarity of their arguments, the credibility of their sources, and the emotional impact of their writing.



Demonstrate

Rhetoric is the set of tools that speakers and writers use to persuade or influence their audience. It's all about using words effectively to make people think or feel a certain way about something.

Rhetoric	the art or skill of speaking or writing formally and effectively, especially to persuade or influence people
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Authors use rhetoric to make their writing more powerful and convincing. Imagine you are trying to convince a friend to see a movie with you. You might use exciting words to describe the plot or talk about how much fun you'll have together. That's using rhetoric!

Authors do the same thing when they write essays, articles, and stories. They choose their words carefully to grab your attention, make you think, or even change your mind about something. So, whenever you read something, keep an eye out for how the author uses words to persuade you or make their point.

Review the chart below to understand the three types of rhetorical appeals.

Rhetorical Appeal	Explanation	Examples
Logos (Logic)	The use of logic, reasoning, and evidence to support an argument and persuade the audience.	▪ statistics ▪ scientific research ▪ cause and effect reasoning ▪ expert opinions ▪ logical explanations
Pathos (Emotion)	Appealing to the audience's emotions (empathy, compassion, anger, fear, etc.) to create an emotional connection and evoke a specific response or reaction.	▪ expressive descriptions ▪ vivid imagery ▪ personal stories ▪ emotion-laden vocabulary, ▪ making the audience feel empathy, disgust, fear, compassion
Ethos (Credibility)	Establishing the author's credibility, expertise, and trustworthiness by demonstrating their knowledge, experience, qualifications, and integrity.	▪ citing reputable sources ▪ referencing personal expertise or credentials ▪ acknowledging counterarguments ▪ maintaining a professional tone ▪ quoting experts ▪ providing references and citations

Use the chart below to analyze the rhetorical appeals of each argument. The first row has been done for you. Find at least one example of each type of rhetoric for each passage. Provide textual evidence and an explanation for each example.

"To Save Earth, Go to Mars"		
Appeal	Textual Evidence	Explanation
Ethos	"Al Gore often ends his presentations on climate change. . ."	The author appeals to the authority of Al Gore, a prominent figure in environmental activism, to establish credibility for the argument about the urgency of addressing global challenges like climate change.

"The Impossible Dream of Terraforming Mars"		
Appeal	Textual Evidence	Explanation

Exit Ticket

Choose one rhetorical appeal (ethos, logos, or pathos) used in one of the passages. In one paragraph, explain how the author uses this rhetorical device to persuade the reader of their viewpoint on colonizing Mars. Be sure to provide specific examples from the text to support your explanation.

Third Focus: Comparing and Evaluating Opposing Arguments

Discover

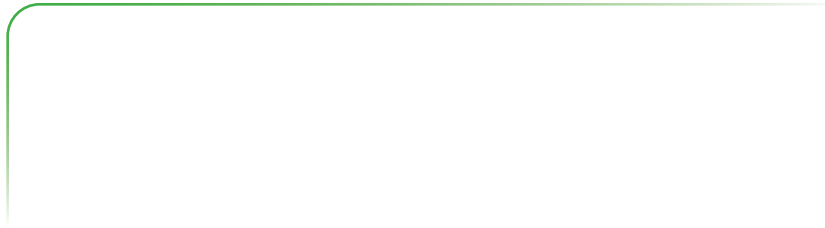
Skill Focus: The authors of the two passages that you have been studying have different perspectives on colonizing Mars. Each author has a distinct claim and has built their argument by providing supporting details. In fact, both authors use the same facts and information to support very different claims.

Find a partner. Listen as your partner reads, “To Save Earth, Go to Mars.” Then, your partner will listen as you read “The Impossible Dream of Terraforming.” As you listen and read, note the evidence provided to support each claim.

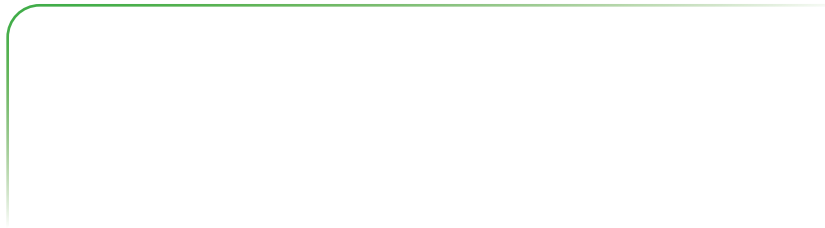
Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. Both passages discuss the challenges and potential benefits of colonizing Mars, but they arrive at different conclusions. What evidence do the authors provide to support their respective viewpoints?



2. In the first passage, the author argues for the potential benefits of Martian colonization, while passage two presents a more skeptical perspective. How do the authors use tone and language to convey their positions, and how does this impact the reader’s perception of the feasibility of colonizing Mars?



Demonstrate

Review the Academic Vocabulary below:

Term	Definition	Sentence
argument	A coherent series of reasons, statements or facts intended to support or establish a point of view	The author presented a compelling argument in favor of Martian colonization, citing the potential benefits for both Earth and future generations.
author's perspective	The author's attitude toward a topic or subject	It's important to consider the author's perspective when analyzing their argument, as it can reveal biases or motivations that may influence their viewpoint.
claim	To say that something is true or fact	The claim that Mars could serve as a viable solution to Earth's environmental challenges was supported by extensive scientific research and expert opinions.
evaluate	To judge or calculate the quality, importance, amount, or value of something	When evaluating the effectiveness of an argument, it's crucial to assess the quality of the evidence presented.
evidence	Source-based information including facts, figures, and details used to support the writer's central idea or claim	The author provided concrete evidence from various sources to bolster their argument for the feasibility of Martian colonization.
opposing	Disagreeing or disapproving	It's essential to consider opposing viewpoints when examining a contentious issue like Martian colonization, as it allows for a more comprehensive understanding of the topic.
valid	Truthful in respect to the information presented	The validity of the author's argument was called into question by some critics, who pointed out flaws in the evidence presented to support their claims.

When authors write, they're not just throwing out random ideas; they carefully construct their arguments to persuade their readers. Authors develop their arguments by:

- **Stating a Claim:** This is like the thesis statement in an essay. It's the central idea or perspective the author wants to prove or defend.
- **Providing Evidence:** Authors back up their claims with evidence. This can include facts, statistics, expert opinions, anecdotes, or real-life examples.
- **Using Reasoning:** Authors use logic to connect their evidence to their claim. They explain why their evidence supports their argument and address counterarguments or opposing viewpoints.
- **Appealing to Emotions:** Sometimes, authors use emotional language to evoke strong feelings, making their argument more persuasive.
- **Establishing Credibility:** Authors often establish their own expertise on the topic to make their argument more convincing. They may cite their own research, credentials, or experiences to show they are knowledgeable and trustworthy.

By understanding how authors develop their arguments, you can better evaluate the strength and persuasiveness of their writing. Keep these points in mind as you evaluate the effectiveness and validity of their claims. The first row has been done for you.

Aspect of Comparison	"To Save Earth, Go to Mars"	"The Impossible Dream of Terraforming Mars"
Author's perspective	Advocates for Martian colonization as a solution to Earth's problems	Presents a skeptical viewpoint on the feasibility of Martian colonization
Main Claim		

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Aspect of Comparison	"To Save Earth, Go to Mars"	"The Impossible Dream of Terraforming Mars"
Evidence Provided		
Use of Rhetorical Techniques		

Aspect of Comparison	"To Save Earth, Go to Mars"	"The Impossible Dream of Terraforming Mars"
Tone and Language		
Use of Same Information		

Exit Ticket

After completing the comparison chart and engaging in group discussions, it becomes evident that both passages present compelling arguments regarding the feasibility of colonizing Mars. While one passage advocates for the potential opportunities that Martian colonization could bring, the other takes a more skeptical stance, highlighting the numerous obstacles that must be overcome.

However, by examining the development of arguments, the use of persuasive techniques, and the interpretation of shared information, you are now equipped to critically evaluate the validity and effectiveness of these contrasting viewpoints.

With this understanding, write one to two paragraphs that explain how the authors use the same factual information for very different ends. Then offer your opinion about which author's argument is more effective and convincing. Use evidence from the passages to support your answer.

Review

Questions on reading tests will require you to evaluate the use of text structures and text features. Often, a second part of the question will test your ability to identify strong evidence that supports the impact of text structures and features in a passage.

1. **Part A:** Which text structure is primarily used in “The Impossible Dream of Terraforming Mars” to convey information about the challenges of colonizing Mars?

A. Cause and effect.
B. Chronological
C. Problem and solution
D. Compare and contrast

Part B: Which sentence from the passage best illustrates the use of the identified text structure?

A. “One of the most significant hurdles to colonizing Mars is the process of terraforming.”
B. “Even if the terraforming process were to be successful, there are still numerous other challenges that would need to be addressed.”
C. “Another issue is the lack of resources on Mars.”
D. “While the idea of colonizing Mars may be a fascinating and inspiring one, the reality is that it is unlikely to ever come to fruition.”

2. Think about the structure of the first passage. Choose one text feature to add to the passage. Explain which text feature you would add, where it would be added, and how it would benefit the reader.



3. **Part A:** Which rhetorical appeal does the author of the first passage, “To Save Earth, Go to Mars,” primarily use to persuade the reader?

- A. Ethos
- B. Pathos
- C. Logos

Part B: Explain your answer to Part A. Include evidence from the passage to support your choice.

4. Which of the following best describes the central argument of “The Impossible Dream of Terraforming Mars”?

- A. Colonizing Mars is feasible with advancements in technology and resource extraction.
- B. Colonizing Mars is an impossible dream due to the insurmountable challenges and resource scarcity.
- C. Colonizing Mars is possible, but it requires significant international collaboration and funding.
- D. Colonizing Mars is a risky endeavor, but the potential benefits outweigh the challenges.

5. Compare the strategies used by the authors of the two passages to persuade their readers about the feasibility of colonizing Mars. Consider factors such as the use of evidence, tone, rhetorical appeals, and the overall effectiveness of their arguments.

Unit 4

Essential Question

Can a simple idea bring about great change?

History is the story of change. Discoveries, inventions, conflicts, and natural events shake the status quo and initiate a new chapter in the human narrative. However, determining the exact impetus of these changes can be difficult because of the complex interplay of cause and effect.

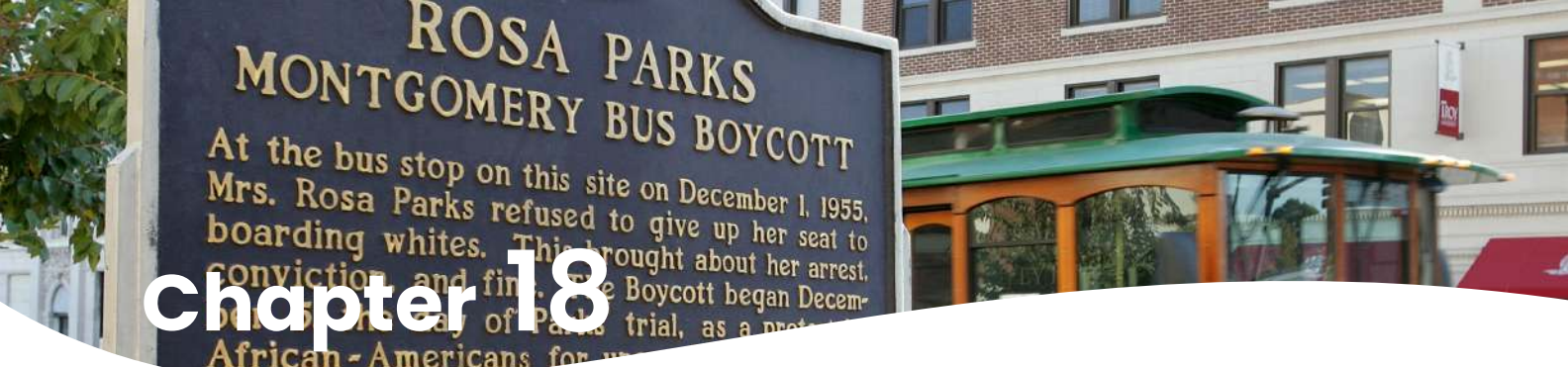
Many changes seem to originate with an idea. Religions, philosophies, and forms of government spring forth based on the writings of a few innovative thinkers. Do these ideas spread by the sheer power of their philosophy or because they are adopted by aggressive leaders and groups that are already capable of dominating the common people? And once an influential idea has taken hold, can a newer idea supplant it? Is violent force required to effect a revolution, or can a new idea spread like a virus, gradually replacing the old ways of seeing the world?

In recent years, Americans have seen the majority's opinion on issues like same-sex marriage and capital punishment gradually shift. The election of an African American president—or a female president—would have been inconceivable a few decades ago, but over time, people's conceptions have evolved, for good or for ill. No violent rebellion was required for these changes to come about; instead, millions of supporters worked for years to sway public opinion. Again the question is raised: did ideas bring about change or did people?

An aphorism attributed to anthropologist Margaret Mead states, "Never doubt that a small group of thoughtful, committed citizens can change the world." As you read the selections in this unit, you will explore how people have effected change, how they have been affected by change, and how one change often leads to others. What impact can a single, simple idea have? Can an average person make a difference? Consider these questions as you explore the texts in this unit.

GOALS

- To analyze and evaluate an author's argument, including claims and evidence
- To determine the theme or central idea of a text and analyze its development
- To analyze how a cultural experience is reflected in a text
- To reflect on how an author draws on and transforms source materials
- To determine the meaning of words and phrases
- To determine and analyze an author's point of view
- To cite thorough evidence in support of analysis



Chapter 18

Analyzing the Development of Ideas

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- analyze how the author develops a series of ideas or events.
- analyze in detail how an author's ideas are refined by sentences and paragraphs.
- evaluate whether the author's claims are supported by valid reasoning and evidence.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **claim:** a statement based on an opinion that a writer tries to prove is true.
- **evidence:** information that supports claims and reasons.
- **first person:** a type of point of view written from the writer's perspective using "I."
- **logos/logical appeal:** support for an argument that uses logic and reason as opposed to emotions and opinions.
- **memoir:** a first-person account of a writer's experience.
- **pathos/emotional appeal:** support for an argument that appeals to emotions such as pity, sympathy, or sorrow.
- **reason:** a cause, explanation, or justification that supports a claim.

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. The _____ about his childhood made me realize how fortunate the writer had been.
2. The _____ point of view narrator made me feel as if I was right in the middle of the action as I read.
3. The candidate's _____ that he was honest did not convince the voters.
4. The fact that involvement in activities in high school looks good on college applications is one good _____ to try out for the debate team.
5. Without any witnesses, there was not enough _____ to convict the woman of robbery.

6. The politician used _____ in her argument, presenting factual data and statistics to support her stance on healthcare reform.
7. The photograph of the wounded child was a great use of _____; many gave money to the charity.

Preview Concepts

How would you define the term *civil disobedience*?

Think about a video you have seen or an article you have read that inspired your passion for a cause or made you want to change an unfair practice. What was it about the video or article that made you want to take action? Did it appeal to your emotions or to logic?

Write a response below. Use the following key words to focus your writing: *inspire, develop, explain, story*.

Share your answers with a partner. In the space below, summarize your conclusions from your discussion.

Read for Understanding

The following excerpt is from *The Montgomery Bus Boycott and the Women Who Started It: The Memoir of Jo Ann Gibson Robinson*. In 1955, African Americans were not allowed to sit in the front, “whites only” section of city buses in Montgomery, Alabama. Teacher and civil rights activist Jo Ann Gibson Robinson had tried to start a protest of this policy a few years earlier but could not persuade her Women’s Political Council (WPC) to take up the cause. What she needed was an incident that would provoke a reaction from the public. When Robinson’s friend Rosa Parks refused to give up her seat, Robinson and other activists were already poised to turn her simple act into a movement that would challenge the status quo.

As you read, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

The Montgomery Bus Boycott and the Women Who Started It: The Memoir of Jo Ann Gibson Robinson

by Jo Ann Gibson Robinson and David J. Garrow

- 1 In the afternoon of Thursday, December 1, a prominent black woman named Mrs. Rosa Parks was arrested for refusing to vacate her seat for a white man. Mrs. Parks was a medium-sized, **cultured mulatto**¹ woman; a civic and religious worker; quiet, unassuming, and pleasant in manner and appearance; dignified and reserved; of high morals and a strong character. She was—and still is, for she lives to tell the story—respected in all black circles. By trade she was a seamstress, adept and competent in her work.
- 10 Tired from work, Mrs. Parks boarded a bus. The “reserved seats” were partially filled, but the seats just behind the reserved section were vacant, and Mrs. Parks sat down in one. It was during the busy evening rush

¹ **mulatto**: of mixed race, particularly having one black and one white parent. Today, this term is seldom used and considered derogatory.

Notes:

hour. More black and white passengers boarded the bus,
15 and soon all the reserved seats were occupied. The driver
demanded that Mrs. Parks get up and surrender her seat
to a white man, but she was tired from her work. Besides,
she was a woman, and the **person waiting was a man**².
She remained seated. In a few minutes, police summoned
20 by the driver appeared, placed Mrs. Parks under arrest, and
took her to jail.

It was the first time the soft-spoken, middle-aged woman
had been arrested. She maintained **decorum** and poise, and
the word of her arrest spread. Mr. E. D. Nixon, a longtime
25 **stalwart** of our **NAACP**³ branch, along with liberal white
attorney Clifford Durr and his wife Virginia, went to the
jail and obtained Mrs. Parks's release on bond. Her trial was
scheduled for Monday, December 5, 1955.

The news traveled like wildfire into every black home.
30 Telephones jangled; people congregated on street corners
and in homes and talked. But nothing was done. A numbing
helplessness seemed to paralyze everyone. Very few stayed
off the buses the rest of that day or the next. There was
fear, discontent, and uncertainty. Everyone seemed to wait
35 for someone to do something, but nobody made a move.
For that day and a half, black Americans rode the buses as
before, as if nothing had happened. They were sullen and
uncommunicative, but they rode the buses. There was a
silent, tension-filled waiting. For blacks were not talking
40 loudly in public places—they were quiet, sullen, waiting.
Just waiting!

2 **person waiting was a man:** In the 1950s, men were expected to treat women courteously, such as giving up their seat on a crowded bus.

3 **NAACP:** National Association for the Advancement of Colored People, a civil rights organization. The term "colored people" refers to African Americans, but it is no longer in common use.

Notes:

Notes:

Thursday evening came and went. Thursday night was far spent, when, at about 11:30 P.M., I sat alone in my peaceful single-family dwelling on a quiet street. I was

45 thinking about the situation. Lost in thought, I was startled by the telephone's ring. Black attorney Fred Gray, who had been out of town all day, had just gotten back and was returning the phone message I had left for him about Mrs. Parks's arrest. Attorney Gray, though a very young man,

50 had been one of my most active colleagues in our previous meetings with bus company officials and Commissioner Birmingham. A Montgomery native who had attended Alabama State and been one of my students, Fred Gray had gone on to law school in Ohio before returning to his

55 hometown to open a practice with the only other black lawyer in Montgomery, Charles Langford. Fred Gray and his wife Bernice were good friends of mine, and we talked often. In addition to being a lawyer, Gray was a trained, **ordained** minister of the gospel, actively serving as assistant

60 pastor of Holt Street Church of Christ.

Tonight his voice on the phone was very short and to the point. Fred was shocked by the news of Mrs. Parks's arrest. I informed him that I already was thinking that the WPC (Women's Political Council) should distribute thousands of notices calling

65 for all bus riders to stay off the buses on Monday, the day of Mrs. Parks's trial. "Are you ready?" he asked. Without hesitation, I assured him that we were. With that he hung up, and I went to work.

I made some notes on the back of an envelope: "The

70 Women's Political Council will not wait for Mrs. Parks's

consent to call for a **boycott**⁴ of city buses. On Friday, December 2, 1955, the women of Montgomery will call for a boycott to take place on Monday, December 5.”

Some of the WPC officers previously had discussed plans
75 for distributing thousands of notices announcing a bus boycott. Now the time had come for me to write just such a notice. I sat down and quickly drafted a message and then called a good friend and colleague, John Cannon, chairman of the business department at the college, who
80 had access to the college’s **mimeograph**⁵ equipment. When I told him that the WPC was staging a boycott and needed to run off the notices, he told me that he too had suffered embarrassment on the city buses. Like myself, he had been hurt and angry. He said that he would happily
85 assist me. Along with two of my most trusted senior students, we quickly agreed to meet almost immediately, in the middle of the night, at the college’s duplicating room. We were able to get three messages to a page, greatly reducing the number of pages that had to be
90 mimeographed in order to produce the tens of thousands of leaflets we knew would be needed. By 4 A.M. Friday, the sheets had been duplicated, cut in thirds, and bundled. Each leaflet read:

*Another **Negro**⁶ woman has been arrested and
95 thrown in jail because she refused to get up out of her seat on the bus for a white person to sit down. It is the second time since the **Claudette Colvin**⁷ case that a Negro woman has been arrested for the same*

4 **boycott**: an organized refusal to buy a good or service, in protest of the provider’s policies

5 **mimeograph**: an early copy machine

6 **Negro**: an African American. Once commonly used, the term is now considered offensive.

7 **Claudette Colvin**: a 15-year-old girl who was arrested earlier that year

Notes:

thing. This has to be stopped. Negroes have rights,
100 too, for if Negroes did not ride the buses, they could
not operate. Three-fourths of the riders are Negroes,
yet we are arrested, or have to stand over empty seats.
If we do not do something to stop these arrests, they
will continue. The next time it may be you, or your
105 daughter, or mother. This woman's case will come up
on Monday. We are, therefore, asking every Negro to
stay off the buses Monday in protest of the arrest and
trial. Don't ride the buses to work, to town, to school,
or anywhere on Monday. You can afford to stay out
110 of school for one day if you have no other way to
go except by bus. You can also afford to stay out of
town for one day. If you work, take a cab, or walk. But
please, children and grown-ups, don't ride the bus at all
on Monday. Please stay off of all buses Monday.

115 Between 4 and 7 A.M., the two students and I mapped
out distribution routes for the notices. Some of the WPC
officers previously had discussed how and where to deliver
thousands of leaflets announcing a boycott, and those
plans now stood me **in good stead**. We outlined our routes,
120 arranged the bundles in sequences, stacked them in our
cars, and arrived at my 8 A.M. class, in which both young
men were enrolled, with several minutes to spare. We
weren't even tired or hungry. Just like me, the two students
felt a sense of satisfaction at being able to contribute to the
125 cause of justice. . . .

Before Monday was half gone, Negroes had made
history. Never before had they united in such a manner.
There was open respect and admiration in the eyes of

Notes:

many whites who had looked on before, dubious and
130 amused. Even clerks in **dime stores**⁸, all white, were more
cordial. They were heard to add, after a purchase by a
black customer, "Y'all come back to see us," which was a
very unusual occurrence. The black customers held their
heads higher. They felt reborn, important for the first
135 time. A greater degree of race pride was exhibited. Many
were themselves surprised at the response of the masses,
and could not explain, if they had wanted to, what had
changed them overnight into fearless, courageous, proud
people, standing together for human dignity, civil rights,
140 and, yes, self-respect! There was a stick-togetherness that
drew them like a magnet. They showed a genuine fondness
for one another. They were really free—free inside! They
felt it! Acted it! **Manifested** it in their entire beings! They
took great pride in being black.

Notes:



8 **dime stores:** department stores with low prices

First Focus: Identifying Main Ideas

Discover

Skill Focus: In a memoir, the author is recounting true stories and events from their life experiences. The central ideas, also known as main ideas, revolve around the important events or moments that happened and how the author felt and reacted to those events. For each of those key events, the narrator will describe what happened factually. But more importantly, they will share their personal thoughts, emotions, and how they responded in that situation as they experienced it. The events themselves are important, but the central (main) ideas emerge when the narrator reveals how they felt, what they were thinking, how they reacted, and the impact or lesson from that experience. By focusing on both the objective events and the narrator's subjective personal reactions and reflections, the reader gains insight into the deeper meaning of those events in the author's life story.

Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and notice the actions that occurred and the reactions of individuals and groups in response to those actions. Underline actions taken by opposing sides to the segregation issue and write the word action next to them. Write reaction next to sentences that describe how different groups responded to these actions. Write questions you have about the text in the Notes column.

Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What main idea is supported by the details in paragraph 4?

2. Which sentence in the text of the leaflets best expresses Robinson's main idea? Why did you choose this sentence?

3. What role does Fred Gray play in the events of the memoir?

Demonstrate

Memoirs explain events from the perspective of someone who was directly involved in the action. In this case, Jo Ann Gibson Robinson describes in first person the actions taken by civil rights organizers and then the resulting reactions to these events. The following chart will help you analyze the relationships among the events in the story. First, fill in the sections that describe the actions and reactions in the excerpt. (Later you will fill in the repeated ideas and why the author repeats the ideas.)

Main Ideas in the Memoir	
Action in Paragraphs 1-3: Repeated ideas in the text: The author repeats these ideas in order to emphasize	Initial Reaction in Paragraph 4: Repeated ideas in the text: The author repeats these ideas in order to emphasize

continued on next page

Main Ideas in the Memoir	
Action in Paragraphs 5–10: Repeated ideas in the text: The author repeats these ideas in order to emphasize	Reaction in Paragraph 11: Repeated ideas in the text: The author repeats these ideas in order to emphasize

Exit Ticket

Write a summary of events in the passage. Use good transitional phrases to communicate the interaction of events.



Second Focus: Analyzing the Development of Supporting Ideas

Discover

Skill Focus: The central ideas in a memoir are the lessons about the author's life experiences. These big ideas shape the overall narrative. To fully develop and illustrate these central ideas, the author includes supporting details. These supporting details act like puzzle pieces that fit together to create a complete picture of the main ideas. Supporting details include descriptions, dialogue, thoughts and feelings, factual details, sensory details, and anecdotes. Supporting details work together to provide proof, examples, and elaboration for the overall life lessons about overcoming hardship and the importance of relationships.

As your teacher reads the selection aloud, follow along with your printed copy. Circle words and phrases that repeat similar ideas within a paragraph. Especially notice the description of people involved in the boycott. What do the repeated ideas emphasize?

Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What is an example of a key word that the author repeats in her memoir? Why is the word important?

2. List key words and phrases from the excerpt that name opposite feelings or ideas.

3. The author uses two direct quotations in the excerpt. What are they, and what does each one contribute to the memoir?

Demonstrate

In nonfiction texts, writers develop main ideas by giving examples, explaining details, defining terms, listing reasons, or in the case of this memoir, by narrating events. Each paragraph within the excerpt works together to accomplish the goal of the entire passage, and within each paragraph, words and sentences communicate the central idea of the paragraph.

You've already broken down the excerpt into actions and reactions explained by the author. Now dig a little deeper to analyze how the author communicates these actions and reactions. Authors often use repeated ideas to emphasize important details. Look back at the repeated ideas you circled during the second focus. Finish filling in the chart by adding examples of repeated ideas and finishing the sentence starters *The author repeats these ideas in order to emphasize . . .*

Exit Ticket

Think about the following questions: How does the content and the structure of the passage emphasize the role of the WPC in the bus boycott? What evidence from the text supports your answer? With a partner, discuss your answers to these questions. Summarize your discussion in the space below.

Third Focus: Evaluating Arguments

Discover

Skill Focus: As a critical reader, you must evaluate claims in argumentative writing. To evaluate claims consider the following:

- Evidence provided to support the claim.
- The logic and reasoning used to arrive at the claim.
- Any underlying assumptions that the claim is based on.
- Potential counterarguments or alternative perspectives that challenge or contradict the claim.
- The objectivity of the claim.
- Expertise of the author or source making the claim.

By carefully evaluating these factors, you can determine the strength and validity of the claims presented in argumentative writing. It is important to approach the evaluation process with an open mind, critically analyzing the evidence and reasoning while considering alternative perspectives and potential counterarguments.

Read the excerpt by Jo Ann Gibson Robinson and David J. Garrow again. Then read the following excerpt from a speech given by President Johnson on his signing of the Civil Rights Act of 1964. This act is a result of many years of hard work by civil rights activists—including Robinson and the WPC.

- In the leaflet that Jo Ann Gibson Robinson created, underline and label the central claim she makes.
- In President Johnson's speech, underline his central claim.

excerpt

The Civil Rights Act of 1964

TITLE II—INJUNCTIVE RELIEF AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN PLACES OF PUBLIC ACCOMMODATION

SEC. 201. (a) All persons shall be entitled to the full and equal enjoyment of the goods, services, facilities, and privileges, advantages, and accommodations of any place of public accommodation, as defined in this section, without discrimination or segregation on the ground of race, color, religion, or national origin.

Notes:

excerpt

Remarks upon Signing the Civil Rights Bill (July 2, 1964)

by President Lyndon B. Johnson

1 Americans of every race and color have died in battle to
protect our freedom. Americans of every race and color have
worked to build a nation of widening opportunities. Now
our generation of Americans has been called on to continue
5 the unending search for justice within our own borders.

We believe that all men are created equal. Yet many are
denied equal treatment.

We believe that all men have certain **unalienable** rights. Yet
many Americans do not enjoy those rights.

10 We believe that all men are entitled to the blessings of
liberty. Yet millions are being deprived of those blessings—
not because of their own failures, but because of the color of
their skin.

The reasons are deeply imbedded in history and tradition
15 and the nature of man. We can understand—without **rancor**
or hatred—how this all happened.

But it cannot continue. Our Constitution, the foundation
of our Republic, forbids it. The principles of our freedom
forbid it. Morality forbids it. And the law I will sign tonight
20 forbids it.

That law is the product of months of the most careful
debate and discussion. It was proposed more than one year
ago by our late and beloved President John F. Kennedy. It

Notes:

received the **bipartisan** support of more than two-thirds
25 of the Members of both the House and the Senate. An
overwhelming majority of Republicans as well as Democrats
voted for it.

It has received the thoughtful support of tens of thousands
of civic and religious leaders in all parts of this Nation. And it
30 is supported by the great majority of the American people.

The purpose of the law is simple.

It does not restrict the freedom of any American, so long
as he respects the rights of others.

It does not give special treatment to any citizen.

35 It does say the only limit to a man's hope for happiness,
and for the future of his children, shall be his own ability.

It does say that there are those who are equal before
God shall now also be equal in the polling booths, in the
classrooms, in the factories, and in hotels, restaurants, movie
40 theaters, and other places that provide service to the public.

I am taking steps to implement the law under my
constitutional obligation to "take care that the laws are
faithfully executed."

Notes:

Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

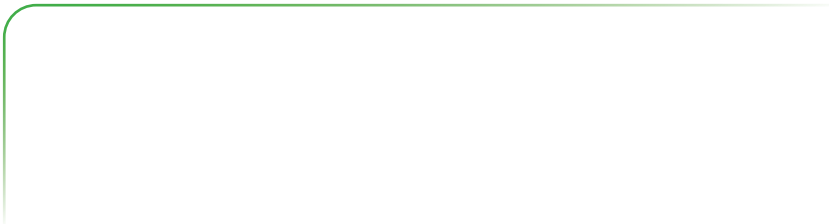
1. What words or phrases does Johnson repeat in his speech? Choose one example and analyze the importance of the word or phrase.



2. What was President Johnson trying to persuade Americans to do?



3. Are the words “you, or your daughter, or mother” an example of logos or pathos? Give a reason for your answer.



Demonstrate

Both authors want to convince their audience to take action. Both write persuasively in order to persuade their audience to act—to join together and boycott buses or to endorse a law that protects the rights of all people. Argumentative writing relies on presenting claims and developing those claims with support that appeals to logic and to emotion.

A claim is . . .

- a statement a writer is trying to prove is true.
- based upon an opinion.
- sometimes clearly stated and sometimes must be inferred.

Support for claims may include . . .

- reasons that offer a logical explanation for why the claim is true, why the proposed solution would be effective or superior to another, or why an action is worth taking.
- facts and evidence that are used to support reasons. Examples include quotations from experts, statistics, or scientific data. This is the *logos* (or logical appeal) studied in earlier chapters.
- emotional pleas to motivate (or manipulate) the audience to agree with the speaker. Personal stories are one example of emotional pleas. Appeals to emotion are also called *pathos*.

Fill in the following charts to help you identify the claim and evidence from each passage.

Jo Ann Gibson Robinson	
1. What central claim does Robinson make in the leaflet she distributed?	
2. How does she support her claim? Reasons? Facts? Quotations? Give examples.	3. Where does Robinson appeal to emotions? Give examples.

continued on next page

President Johnson		
1. What central claim does Johnson make in his speech?		
2. How does he support his claim? Reasons? Facts? Quotations? Give examples.		3. Where does Johnson appeal to emotions? Give examples.

An argument includes a claim and the evidence used to support the claim. However, all arguments are not equal. Some are better supported than others; some are more logical than others. When evaluating an argument, it is not enough to say it is “good” or “bad.” It is easy to judge an argument based on whether you agree with it, but instead, you must evaluate the parts of the argument based on identifiable criteria. One method of evaluating arguments is FELT. See the table on the next page

FELT Strategy for Analyzing Arguments

Fairness:

Is the argument fair and balanced, or does it contain bias? Bias can be detected by asking the following questions:

- Is the argument overly emotional and filled with loaded language? Using only emotional pleas makes an argument weak.
- Is the argument one-sided? Are there alternative points of view not addressed?

Evidence:

Is there sufficient evidence to be convincing or is limited evidence given?

Is the evidence valid? Does it support the claim?

- To evaluate personal experience, ask: Is this relevant? Is this biased?
- To evaluate examples, ask: Are sufficient examples given? Are the examples given important enough to be valid, such as examples from history?
- To evaluate data or statistics, ask: Are statistics interpreted correctly or are they misinterpreted or manipulated to support the author's opinion?

Logic:

Does the writer only appeal to emotions and not logic?

Are the reasons logical or faulty? Faulty reasons may attack a person's character instead of addressing arguments, restate the claim instead of providing reasons, or go off on a tangent instead of providing convincing reasons.

Tone:

Is the attitude of the writer appropriate for the content? For example, is it too serious? Is it too sarcastic or dismissive? Is it overly dramatic? (Tone can reinforce bias.)

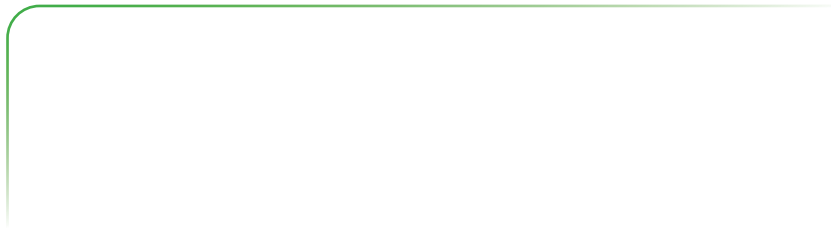


President Lyndon B. Johnson signs the 1964 Civil Rights Act

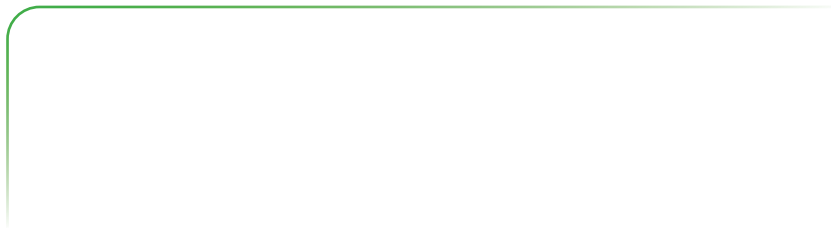
Reread the following excerpt from the pamphlet distributed by civil rights workers, focusing on the underlined sentence.

This has to be stopped. Negroes have rights, too, for if Negroes did not ride the buses, they could not operate. Three-fourths of the riders are Negroes, yet we are arrested, or have to stand over empty seats. If we do not do something to stop these arrests, they will continue. The next time it may be you, or your daughter, or mother.

1. The word *for* indicates that the writer is giving a reason why African Americans have rights. Does the phrase if Negroes did not ride the buses, they could not operate explain a reason why African Americans have rights? Why or why not? Write your answer below.

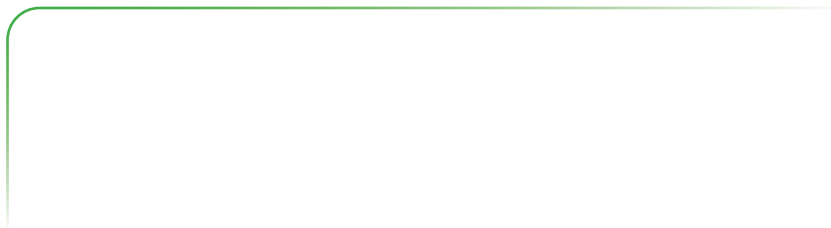


2. What reasons would you give to support the claim “Negroes have rights”? What reasons did President Johnson give?



3. Which reasons that you have listed above are the strongest? Draw a star by them.

4. Based upon the evidence that three-fourths of bus riders are African Americans and the buses could not operate if African American riders stopped riding, what implied claim is the author making about the best way to stop discrimination on buses?



Refer to the FELT chart as you write an evaluation of both texts.

Jo Ann Gibson Robinson

How effectively did Robinson support her claim in the leaflet? Evaluate it using FELT.

President Johnson

How effectively did President Johnson support his claim? Evaluate it using FELT.

Exit Ticket

Share your answers to the chart above with a partner. Then discuss the question: How do both Robinson and Johnson effectively persuade their audiences to take action?

Review

In this chapter, you practiced identifying the ways authors introduce and develop their ideas. You were asked to analyze an author's claims, including how they are refined and whether they are supported by valid reasoning. The following questions will give you practice answering questions on these skills.

1. Which of the following sentences shows the protesters' reaction to the boycott?
 - A. *Just like me, the two students felt a sense of satisfaction at being able to contribute to the cause of justice.*
 - B. *There was open respect and admiration in the eyes of many whites who had looked on before, dubious and amused.*
 - C. *Many were themselves surprised at the response of the masses, and could not explain, if they had wanted to, what had changed them overnight into fearless, courageous, proud people, standing together for human dignity, civil rights, and, yes, self-respect!*
 - D. *When I told him that the WPC was staging a boycott and needed to run off the notices, he told me that he too had suffered embarrassment on the city buses. Like myself, he had been hurt and angry.*
2. Which statement from the leaflet in *The Montgomery Bus Boycott* best represents the specific reason Robinson argues that a bus boycott will bring about a change in policy toward unfair treatment of African Americans?
 - A. *It is the second time since the Claudette Colvin case that a Negro woman has been arrested for the same thing.*
 - B. *... if Negroes did not ride the buses, they could not operate.*
 - C. *If we do not do something to stop these arrests, they will continue.*
 - D. *The next time it may be you, or your daughter, or mother.*
3. How does Jo Ann Robinson introduce her description of making flyers to promote the bus boycott?
 - A. She depicts the African American community's activities in the days following Rosa Parks's arrest.
 - B. She tells of her immediate response to the news of Parks's arrest, including her desire to stay off the bus.
 - C. She describes the previous boycott plans the Women's Political Council had made, which she put into action.
 - D. She recounts the phone call from Fred Gray, who prompted her to explain how she planned to respond.

4. Read the following excerpt from *The Montgomery Bus Boycott* and answer the question that follows.

In the afternoon of Thursday, December 1, a prominent black woman named Mrs. Rosa Parks was arrested for refusing to vacate her seat for a white man. Mrs. Parks was a medium-sized, cultured mulatto woman; a civic and religious worker; quiet, unassuming, and pleasant in manner and appearance; dignified and reserved; of high morals and a strong character. She was—and still is, for she lives to tell the story—respected in all black circles.

Based upon the description of Rosa Parks, the reader can infer that the author believes that

- A. Rosa's blameless character made her the ideal person to be the figurehead of the boycott.
- B. Rosa was not interested in changing unjust laws.
- C. White society had reason to believe that Rosa was an outsider sent to Montgomery to cause problems.
- D. Social activism is best carried out by a very assertive, vocal leader.

A close-up, low-angle shot of the Statue of Liberty's head and crown, set against a bright, cloudy sky. The statue's green patina is prominent.

Chapter 19

Understanding How Authors Advance Their Perspectives

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- cite textual evidence to support your analysis of and inferences about a text.
- analyze how authors use rhetoric to advance an opinion or perspective.
- evaluate an author's argument, assessing whether the reasoning is valid.

Academic Vocabulary

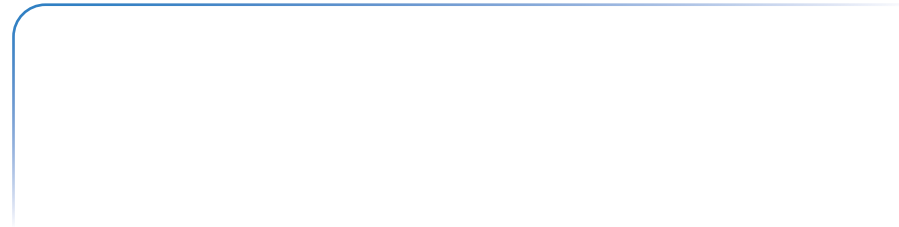
- **ethos**: appeal to ethics or morality.
- **inference**: an idea reached by “adding up” evidence or clues.
- **logos**: appeal to logic and reason.
- **pathos**: appeal to the emotions.
- **rhetoric**: the art or skill of writing or speaking effectively as a way to persuade or influence people.
- **valid reasoning**: an argument that follows logically from evidence and reasons.

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

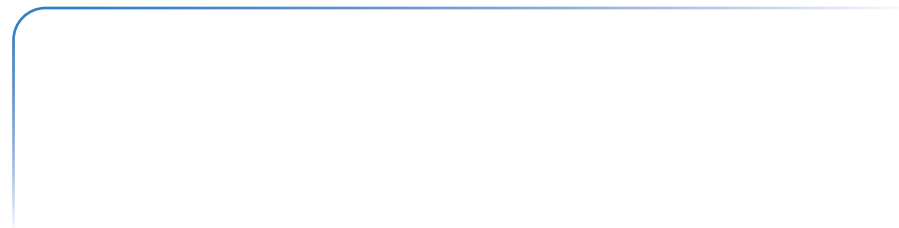
1. The store manager used records of past purchases to make a(n) _____ about what to order for the future.
2. Most parents do not accept the idea that “everyone is doing it” as _____.
3. Lincoln was famous for his memorable speeches and convincing _____ that captured his audience's attention.
4. When the candidate discovered that her opponent had a criminal record, she shifted her campaign's focus to _____, stressing her own moral character.
5. The _____ of using photographs of sick chickens stuffed into wire crates supported the vegetarians' claims.
6. In law school, my professors always stressed _____ as the path to successful defense, believing that witnesses and judges listened to logic and reason.

Preview Concepts

What do you know about Adolf Hitler and Nazi Germany? Write a short paragraph describing Hitler's beliefs and actions. Consider what you know about the role of public speeches in Hitler's rise to power.



Share your paragraph with a partner. In the space below, summarize your discussion about Hitler.



Read for Understanding

The following excerpt is from "Freedom" by E. B. White. Although he is probably best known for his children's book *Charlotte's Web*, White also wrote essays and articles for adults.

As you read, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

Freedom

by E. B. White

By 1940, Americans had been watching for years as Nazi Germany's Chancellor Adolf Hitler had used racist, antidemocratic political speeches to rouse his nation into a warlike fervor. American writer E. B. White, in his column for Harper's Magazine, responded to the Nazi philosophy by making the case for democracy.

1 . . . My first and greatest love affair was with this thing we call freedom, this lady of infinite allure, this dangerous and beautiful and sublime being who restores and supplies us all. . . .

5 But a man's free condition is of two parts: the instinctive freeness he experiences as an animal dweller on a planet, and the practical liberties he enjoys as a privileged member of human society. The latter is, of the two, more generally understood, more widely admired, 10 more violently challenged and discussed. It is the practical and apparent side of freedom. The United States, almost alone today, offers the liberties and the privileges and the tools of freedom. In this land the citizens are still invited to write plays and books, to paint their pictures, to meet 15 for discussion, to dissent as well as to agree, to **mount soapboxes**¹ in the public square, to enjoy education in

Notes:

1 **mount soapboxes:** stand on a crate in order to make a speech

Notes:

all subjects without censorship, to hold court and judge one another, to compose music, to talk politics with their neighbors without wondering whether the secret police
20 are listening, to exchange ideas as well as goods, to kid the government when it needs kidding, and to read real news of real events instead of phony news manufactured by a paid agent of the state. This is a fact and should give every person pause.

25 To be free, in a planetary sense, is to feel that you belong to earth. To be free, in a social sense, is to feel at home in a democratic framework. In Adolf Hitler, although he is a freely flowering individual, we do not detect either type of **sensibility**. From reading his book I gather that his feeling
30 for earth is not a sense of communion but a driving urge to prevail. His feeling for men is not that they co-exist, but that they are capable of being arranged and **standardized** by a superior intellect—that their existence suggests not a fulfillment of their personalities but a submersion of their
35 personalities in the common racial destiny. His very great absorption in the destiny of the German people somehow loses some of its effect when you discover, from his writings, in what vast contempt he holds *all* people. “I learned,” he wrote, “. . . to gain an insight into the unbelievably
40 primitive opinions and arguments of the people.” To him the ordinary man is a primitive, capable only of being used and led. He speaks continually of people as sheep, halfwits, and impudent fools—the same people to whom he promises the ultimate in prizes.

45 Here in America, where our society is based on belief in the individual, not contempt for him, the free principle of life has a chance of surviving. I believe that it must and will survive.

Notes:

To understand freedom is an accomplishment which all men may acquire who set their minds in that direction; and to

50 love freedom is a tendency which many Americans are born with. To live in the same room with freedom, or in the same hemisphere, is still a profoundly shaking experience for me.

One of the earliest truths (and to him most valuable) that the author of *Mein Kampf*² discovered was that it is not the

55 written word, but the spoken word, which in heated moments moves great masses of people to noble or ignoble action. The written word, unlike the spoken word, is something which every person examines privately and judges calmly by his own intellectual standards, not by what the man standing next to

60 him thinks. "I know," wrote Hitler, "that one is able to win people far more by the spoken than by the written word. . . ."

Later he adds contemptuously: "For let it be said to all knights of the pen and to all the political **dandies**³, especially of today: the greatest changes in this world have never been brought

65 about by a goose quill! No, the pen has always been reserved to motivate these changes theoretically."

Luckily I am not out to change the world—that's being done for me, and at a great clip. But I know that the free spirit of man is persistent in nature; it recurs, and has never

70 successfully been wiped out, by fire or flood. I set down the above remarks merely (in the words of Mr. Hitler) to

motivate that spirit, theoretically. Being myself a knight of the goose quill, I am under no misapprehension about "winning people"; but I am **inordinately** proud these days

75 of the quill, for it has shown itself, historically, to be the

2 **Mein Kampf**: Hitler's autobiography, *My Struggle*, which includes writing about his ideology

3 **dandies**: men who are overly concerned with fashion

hypodermic⁴ which inoculates men and keeps the germ of freedom always in circulation, so that there are individuals in every time in every land who are the carriers, the **Typhoid Marys**⁵, capable of infecting others by mere contact and
80 example. These persons are feared by every tyrant—who shows his fear by **burning the books**⁶ and destroying the individuals. A writer goes about his task today with the extra satisfaction which comes from knowing that he will be the first to have his head lopped off—even before the political
85 dandies. In my own case this is a double satisfaction, for if freedom were denied me by force of earthly circumstance, I am the same as dead and would infinitely prefer to go into **fascism**⁷ without my head than with it, having no use for it any more and not wishing to be saddled with so heavy an
90 encumbrance.

Notes:

4 **hypodermic**: needle

5 **Typhoid Marys**: people who spread ideas; named for a woman who spread the disease Typhoid

6 **burning the books**: In 1933, the German Student Union burned books thought to oppose Nazi ideology.

7 **fascism**: an extreme political ideology holding one's nation and ethnicity superior to others, led by a dictator

First Focus: Making Inferences

Discover

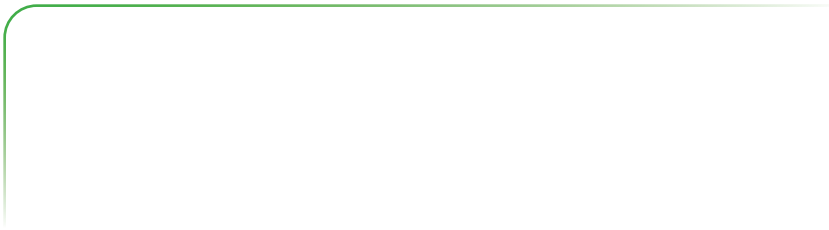
Skill Focus: As you read, consider what the author says explicitly and what he leaves for readers to infer. Remember, making inferences is not simply guessing but is based on clues in the text. You should be able to cite strong evidence in the text to support every inference you make.

Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and write at least one inference about freedom in Nazi Germany in the Notes column and underline words and phrases in the text that could be used as textual evidence to support your inferences. Remember, making inferences is not simply guessing but is based on subtle clues in the text. You should be able to cite strong evidence in the text to support every inference you make.

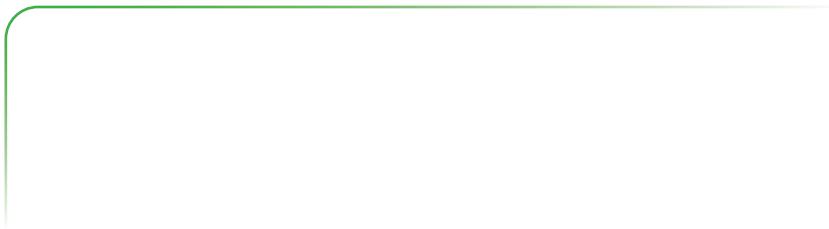
Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

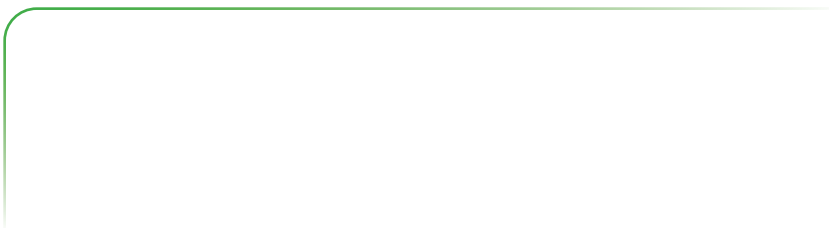
1. In your own words, describe the two parts of freedom that White discusses in this essay.



2. What words might White have used to describe Adolf Hitler based on his language in paragraph 3?



3. What distinction does White make between written and spoken language?



Demonstrate

Readers are constantly making inferences as they read. An inference is a conclusion that is not directly stated in the text. It is based on ideas in the writing and also your own background knowledge. Think about the sentence in lines 13–23 (shown below) that lists examples of how Americans practice their freedom of expression. As you read the text, what inferences did you make about life in Hitler’s Germany? Fill in the chart below with an additional text quotation and inferences.

What the Text Says	Inference About the Nature of Hitler’s Germany
1. <i>In this land the citizens are still invited to write plays and books, to paint their pictures, to meet for discussion, to dissent as well as to agree, to mount soapboxes in the public square, to enjoy education in all subjects without censorship, to hold court and judge one another, to compose music, to talk politics with their neighbors without wondering whether the secret police are listening, to exchange ideas as well as goods, to kid the government when it needs kidding, and to read real news of real events instead of phony news manufactured by a paid agent of the state.</i> (lines 13–23)	
2. <i>His feeling for men is not that they co-exist, but that they are capable of being arranged and standardized by a superior intellect . . .</i>	
3.	

continued on next page

What the Text Says	Inference About the Nature of Hitler's Germany
4.	



Exit Ticket

Write a paragraph explaining Hitler's thoughts about humans and freedom based on what E. B. White wrote about it. Refer to specific examples from the text to support your ideas.

Second Focus: Analyzing Rhetoric

Discover

Skill Focus: Writers use rhetorical devices in their writing to make it more powerful and persuasive. Rhetorical devices persuade, clarify or emphasize, grab readers' attention, appeal to emotions, add style and flair, and connect with the audience. Rhetorical devices are tools to help writers communicate their ideas more effectively and make their arguments more persuasive and memorable.

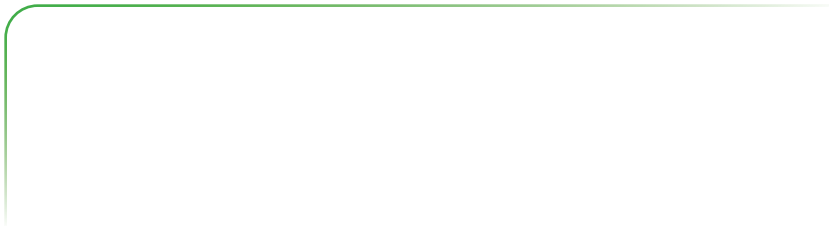
Read the excerpt again with a partner. Take turns reading one paragraph at a time. After each paragraph, the listening partner summarizes what the reader read.

As you read the passage a second time, think about how E. B. White appeals to readers using rhetoric. *Rhetoric* is the art of writing formally and effectively, especially as a way to persuade or influence people. Throughout history, gifted writers have used rhetoric to motivate people to bring change.

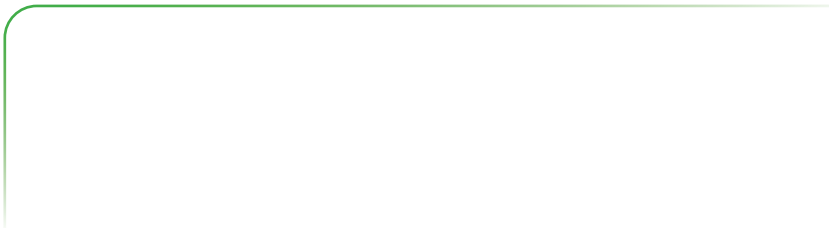
Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. Locate an example of parallel structure in the essay. What effect does it create in the sentence?



2. Where does White use Hitler's own words as evidence to support his conclusions about Hitler's beliefs? What conclusions does White make based upon this evidence?



Demonstrate

Ethos, *pathos*, and *logos* are modes of persuasion used to convince audiences. The Greek philosopher Aristotle coined these terms to describe ways that people try to persuade others to agree with them.

- Ethos, or ethical appeal, is an attempt to convince readers of the writer's credibility or trustworthiness. An author may use ethos by attacking an opponent's character or personality to make the author's own character seem honorable.
- Pathos, or emotional appeal, provokes readers' feelings. Authors use pathos to create sympathy for their cause and to convince readers to feel as they feel. Authors may try to stir positive emotions, such as patriotism or the love of family, or negative emotions, such as fear or anger.
- Logos, or logical appeal, tries to convince readers using reasoning. Authors use logos when they make claims supported by reasons and evidence. Two common logical appeals are inductive and deductive reasoning. Inductive reasoning takes specific facts and draws a larger conclusion. Deductive reasoning begins with general ideas to support a more specific conclusion.

How does E. B. White use ethos, pathos, and logos in his essay?

Use the chart below to record how White uses rhetorical techniques. For the paragraphs listed in the first column, circle the appeal he is making in the second column. (Some sections may use more than one type of appeal.) Finish the statement with details from the text that support the appeal you circled.

How does White use logos, ethos, and pathos to persuade his audience?	
Paragraphs 1 and 2 (the liberties of the United States)	This is an example of (ethos, pathos, logos) because

How does White use logos, ethos, and pathos to persuade his audience?	
Paragraph 3 (Hitler's attitudes)	This is an example of (ethos, pathos, logos) because
Paragraph 4 (America's belief in the individual)	This is an example of (ethos, pathos, logos) because
Paragraphs 5 and 6 (the power of the written word vs. the power of the spoken word)	This is an example of (ethos, pathos, logos) because

E. B. White masterly uses words as his weapons to strike against Hilter. The entire essay is a carefully crafted response to Hilter's statement that "the greatest changes in this world have never been brought about by the goose quill." Focus on the imagery and figurative language White uses to enhance his rhetoric in paragraph 6. Fill in the chart below. Consult online resources to help you understand any unfamiliar references.

Phrases from Paragraph 6	Explanation
the quill . . . is the hypodermic which inoculates men and keeps the germ of freedom always in circulation.	
there are individuals in every time in every land who are the carriers, the Typhoid Marys, capable of infecting others by mere contact and example	

Phrases from Paragraph 6	Explanation
prefer to go into fascism without my head than with it, having no use for it any more and not wishing to be saddled with so heavy an encumbrance.	

Exit Ticket

Share your answers to the charts in a class discussion.

- Use hand signals to indicate when you want to talk. Thumbs up means you want to share something new. A peace sign means you have something to add to the last person's statement.
- Share at least one bit of new information and one additional piece of information. Refer to words and phrases from the text to support your answers.
- Finish by discussing this question: What rhetorical technique best describes the essay as a whole?

Third Focus: Evaluating Reasoning

Discover

Skill Focus: When you're reading an argumentative piece, it's important to evaluate the reasoning or logic behind the arguments being made. You want to make sure that the reasoning makes sense and is valid. The reasoning should flow naturally with clear connections between each premise or piece of evidence and the conclusion. Evaluate if each reason provided holds up under scrutiny. Strong reasoning makes sense and proves the point step-by-step.

Read “Freedom” again. Then read the following passage. As you read the passages, consider the following questions.

- What argument does E. B. White make in “Freedom”? What reasoning supports it?
- How does Machiavelli claim princes should conduct their affairs? What reasoning does he use to justify that behavior?
- How do Adolf Hitler’s beliefs and actions, as described by E. B. White, reflect the philosophy of *The Prince*?

from

The Prince

by Niccolò Machiavelli

Niccolò Machiavelli was a diplomat and politician in 16th-century Florence, Italy. When the Florentine republic was overthrown by a monarch, he was imprisoned and tortured. After his release, he retired from politics and devoted himself to writing. It was during this retirement that he wrote his most famous work of political theory, The Prince. The work takes the form of a letter instructing a Florentine prince in the ways to gain and maintain power—through whatever means necessary. In fact, the term “Machiavellian” has come to describe those who are unscrupulous in the pursuit of power.

XVIII

How princes should honor their word

- 1 Everyone realizes how praiseworthy it is for a prince to honor his word and to be straightforward rather than crafty in his dealings; nonetheless contemporary experience shows that

Notes:

princes who have achieved great things have been those who
5 have given their word lightly, who have known how to trick
men with their cunning, and who, in the end, have overcome
those abiding by honest principles.

You must understand, therefore, that there are two ways
of fighting: by law or by force. The first way is natural to
10 men, and the second to beasts. But as the first way often
proves inadequate one must needs have recourse to the
second. So a prince must understand how to make a nice use
of the beast and the man. The ancient writers taught princes
about this by an **allegory**⁸, when they described how Achilles
15 and many other princes of the ancient world were sent to
be brought up by Chiron, the centaur, so that he might train
them his way. All the allegory means, in making the teacher
half beast and half man, is that a prince must know how
to act according to the nature of both, and that he cannot
20 survive otherwise.

So, as a prince is forced to know how to act like a beast,
he must learn from the fox and the lion; because the lion
is defenseless against traps and a fox is defenseless against
wolves. Therefore one must be a fox in order to recognize
25 traps, and a lion to frighten off wolves. Those who simply
act like lions are stupid. So it follows that a **prudent** ruler
cannot, and must not, honor his word when it places him at
a disadvantage and when the reasons for which he made his
promise no longer exist. If all men were good, this **precept**⁹
30 would not be good; keep their word to you, you need not
keep your word to them. And no prince ever lacked good
excuses to color his bad faith. One could give **innumerable**¹⁰

8 **allegory**: a story with a hidden meaning, in which the characters and the conflict symbolize ideas about human life

9 **precept**: a moral rule

10 **innumerable**: countless

Notes:

modern instances of this, showing how many pacts and promises have been made null and void by the bad faith of
35 princes: those who have known best how to imitate the fox have come off best. But one must know how to color one's actions and to be a great liar and deceiver. Men are so simple, and so much creatures of circumstance, that the deceiver will always find someone ready to be deceived. . . .

XXIII

How flatterers must be shunned

40 There is one important subject I do not want to pass over, the mistake which princes can only with difficulty avoid making if they are not extremely prudent or do not choose their ministers well. I am referring to flatterers, who swarm in the courts. Men are so happily absorbed in their own affairs and
45 indulge in such self-deception that it is difficult for them not to fall victim to this plague; and some efforts to protect oneself from flatterers involve the risk of becoming despised. This is because the only way to safeguard yourself against flatterers is by letting people understand that you are not offended by the
50 truth; but if everyone can speak the truth to you then you lose respect. So a shrewd prince should adopt a middle way, choosing wise men for his government and allowing only those the freedom to speak the truth to him, and then only concerning matters on which he asks their opinion, and nothing else. But
55 he should also question them thoroughly and listen to what they say; then he should make up his own mind, by himself. And his attitude towards his **councils** and towards each one of his advisers should be such that they will recognize that the more freely they speak out the more acceptable they will be.
60 Apart from these, the prince should heed no one; he should

Notes:

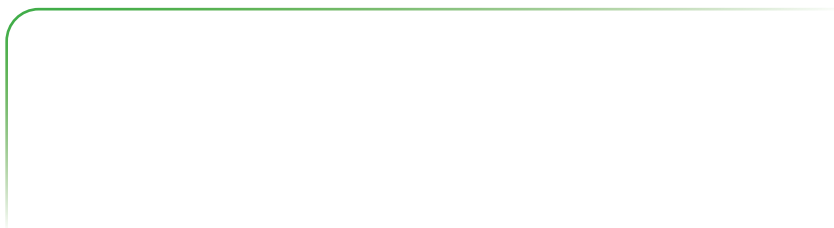
put the policy agreed upon into effect straight away, and he should adhere to it rigidly. Anyone who does not do this is ruined by flatterers or is constantly changing his mind because of conflicting advice: as a result he is held in low **esteem**.



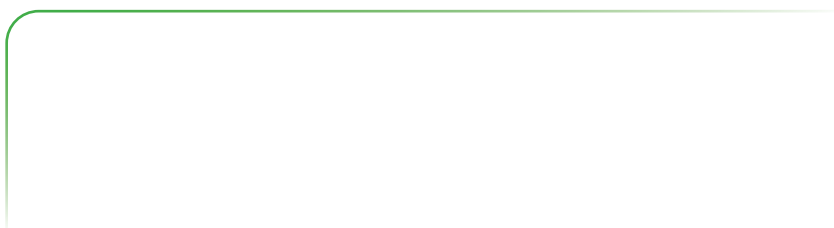
Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

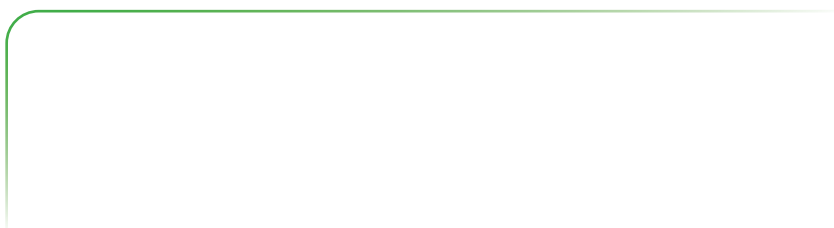
1. According to Machiavelli, what are the two ways that princes fight for power? Which way is more important?



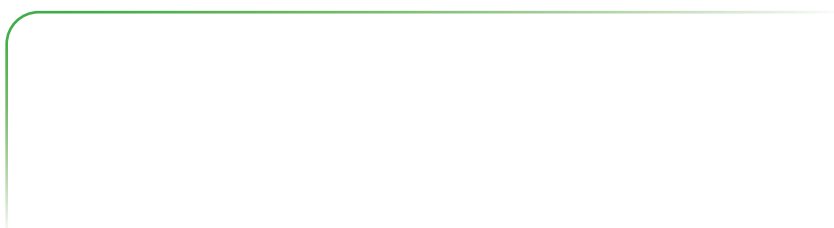
2. Why should flatterers be shunned?



3. Do you agree with any of Machiavelli's ideas? Which one?



4. What arguments might you offer in support of and/or against the idea that “a prince must understand how to make nice use of the beast and the man” (lines 12–13)?

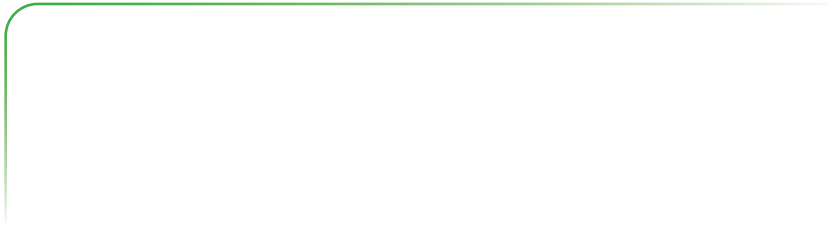


Demonstrate

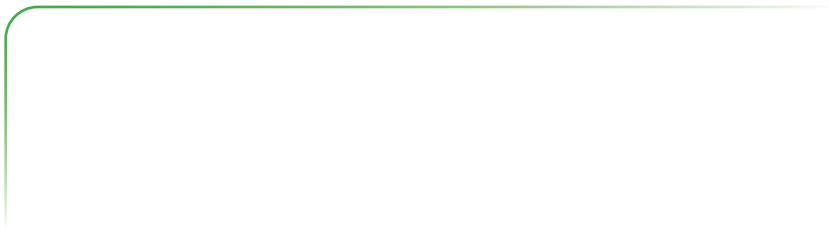
Both authors make a case for particular forms of leadership. White advocates for a democratic system that values freedom of the individual. Machiavelli argues for a strong central leader who will do whatever it takes to maintain power over his subjects. To evaluate these arguments, it is necessary to identify the reasoning the authors employ. In other words, you must ask, “Why should I agree with this?”

Finish the sentence starters and answer the questions below to help you evaluate the reasoning in each passage.

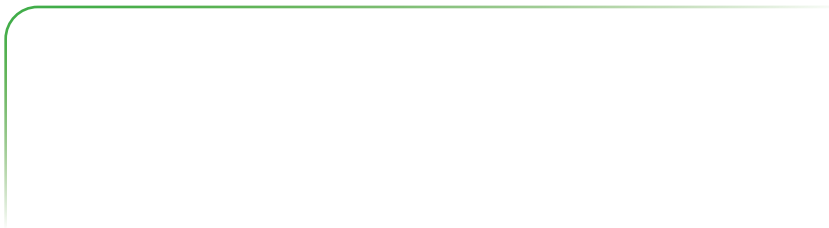
1. In “Freedom,” White argues that Hitler is wrong about the power of the written word because



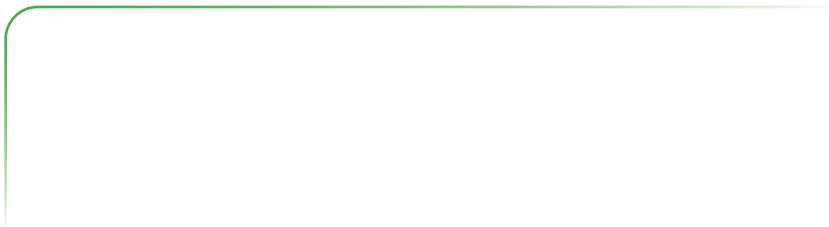
2. Evaluate: Is this reasoning valid? Why or why not?



3. Machiavelli argues princes should not keep their word because



4. Evaluate: Is this reasoning valid? Why or why not?



Exit Ticket

Explain the central argument of “Freedom” and explain White’s reasoning. Do you agree with White’s argument? Do you find the reasoning valid? Do you find the writing convincing? Why or why not?

Review

In this chapter, you practiced citing strong evidence to support your inferences, determining how authors use rhetoric to advance their viewpoints, and evaluating the reasoning behind authors' arguments. Questions about how authors influence their readers might look like this:

1. Which of these statements from "Freedom" is the best example of pathos?
 - A. *My first and greatest love affair was with this thing we call freedom . . .*
 - B. *In this land the citizens are still invited . . . to meet for discussion, to dissent as well as to agree, to mount soapboxes in the public square, to enjoy education in all subjects without censorship . . .*
 - C. *From reading his book I gather that his feeling for earth is not a sense of communion but a driving urge to prevail.*
 - D. *I . . . would infinitely prefer to go into fascism without my head than with it, having no use for it any more and not wishing to be saddled with so heavy an encumbrance.*
2. Read this excerpt from *The Prince* and the questions that follow.

So, as a prince is forced to know how to act like a beast, he must learn from the fox and the lion; because the lion is defenseless against traps and a fox is defenseless against wolves. Therefore one must be a fox in order to recognize traps, and a lion to frighten off wolves. Those who simply act like lions are stupid. So it follows that a prudent ruler cannot, and must not, honor his word when it places him at a disadvantage and when the reasons for which he made his promise no longer exist.

Part A: What inference can best be drawn from this passage?

- A. A prince must be clever enough to avoid being manipulated and strong enough to fight off enemies.
- B. A prince can only rule through trickery and fear, not through honor and fairness.
- C. A prince should be more like a fox than a lion, because strategy is greater than power.
- D. A prince will be successful if he is crazy like a fox and roars like a lion.

Part B: Underline a line from the text that supports your answer to Part A.

3. Which of the following best describes Machiavelli's main idea in Chapter XXIII, "How Flatterers Must Be Shunned"?
- A. Advisors may secretly advance their own agenda by praising the prince.
 - B. Rulers should have a few wise advisors whom they listen to and ignore all others.
 - C. People tend to despise leaders who surround themselves with advisors who only flatter.
 - D. Leaders who receive poor advice are unable to make up their minds and thus appear weak.
4. Read this sentence from "Freedom" and then complete the task that follows.

A writer goes about his task today with the extra satisfaction which comes from knowing that he will be the first to have his head lopped off—even before the political dandies.

One reader has inferred that the writer feels satisfaction because his work undermines fascism even if he dies. Choose the statement from the passage that best supports this conclusion.

- A. *The written word, unlike the spoken word, is something which every person examines privately and judges calmly by his own intellectual standards, not by what the man standing next to him thinks.*
- B. *For let it be said to all knights of the pen and to all the political dandies, especially of today: the greatest changes in this world have never been brought about by a good quill!*
- C. *But I know that the free spirit of man is persistent in nature; it recurs, and has never successfully been wiped out, by fire or flood.*
- D. *. . . I am inordinately proud these days of the quill, for it has shown itself, historically, to be the hypodermic which inoculates men and keeps the germ of freedom always in circulation. . . .*



Chapter 20

Recognizing Universal Themes Across Cultures

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- determine the theme of a text, including its development over the course of the text.
- analyze a cultural experience reflected in a work from outside the United States.
- reflect on how an author draws on and transforms source material in a specific work.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **allusion:** a brief and direct reference to a person, place, thing or idea from literature or history.
- **characterization:** the process by which an author reveals a character.
- **conflict:** the struggle between two opposing forces in a piece of literature.
- **cultural experience:** an experience that engages a person in and reveals a particular culture.
- **culture:** the collective arts, beliefs, customs, and general way of life of a community or society.
- **moral:** a message or lesson that is explicitly stated in a piece of literature, usually at the end of a fable or tale.
- **theme:** the central message, lesson, or insight imparted by a piece of literature.
- **topic:** the subject of a piece of writing.

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. The two poems are nearly opposite in their structures but their _____ both involve showing strength in the face of hardship.
2. My experience while volunteering at the Food Bank is the _____ of my speech.
3. The _____ between the two armies was resolved in one great battle.
4. The author's skillful _____ brought the protagonist to life through vivid descriptions of her physical mannerisms, internal thoughts, and emotional struggles.
5. The _____ of the story is "Haste makes waste."

6. The _____ of Japan varies dramatically from that of Mexico.
7. The city's museums, markets, and mosques offer an authentic _____ for visitors.
8. In her novel, the author made a clever _____ to Greek mythology by naming her protagonist "Persephone."

Preview Concepts

People read literature from around the world and from time periods throughout history and yet find truths that speak to them. What makes a story universal?

Think about a movie you have seen, or a book you have read, that is set in a distant place or an unfamiliar culture, such as *The Kite Runner* or *Avatar*. What appealed to you about the characters or the situation? How were you able to identify with the story despite the foreign setting?

Share your answers with a partner. Focus on the messages and elements that make a story resonate beyond the culture it depicts.

Read for Understanding

The following excerpt is from *Things Fall Apart* by Chinua Achebe. Achebe was a Nigerian writer and scholar from the Igbo clan. His novels focus on the Igbo people and their culture. *Things Fall Apart*, his first and most famous novel, takes place in pre-colonial Nigeria, just before Great Britain takes control. The novel is the story of a young man, Okonkwo, who wants to make his way in the world. His father, whom Okonkwo considered softhearted and lazy, has recently died, leaving the family deeply in debt.

As you read, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

Things Fall Apart

by Chinua Achebe

Chapter 3

- 1 With a father like Unoka, Okonkwo did not have
the start in life which many young men had. He neither
inherited a barn nor a title, nor even a young wife.
But in spite of these disadvantages, he had begun
5 even in his father's lifetime to lay the foundations of a
prosperous future. It was slow and painful. But he threw
himself into it like one possessed. And indeed he was
possessed by the fear of his father's contemptible life and
shameful death.
10 There was a wealthy man in Okonkwo's village who had
three huge barns, nine wives and thirty children. His name
was Nwakibie and he had taken the highest but one title
which a man could take in the clan. It was for this man that
Okonkwo worked to earn his first seed yams. . . .
15 "I have come to you for help," he said. "Perhaps you can
already guess what it is. I have cleared a farm but have no

Notes:

Notes:

yams to sow. I know what it is to ask a man to trust another with his yams, especially these days when young men are afraid of hard work. I am not afraid of work. The lizard that

20 jumped from the high **iroko** tree to the ground said he would praise himself if no one else did. I began to fend for myself at an age when most people still suck at their mothers' breasts. If you give me some yam seeds I shall not fail you."

Nwakibie cleared his throat. "It pleases me to see a young
25 man like you these days when our youth has gone so soft.

Many young men have come to me to ask for yams but I have refused because I knew they would just dump them in the earth and leave them to be choked by weeds. When I say no to them they think I am hard hearted. But it is not so. Eneke

30 the bird says that since men have learned to shoot without missing, he has learned to fly without perching. I have learned to be stingy with my yams. But I can trust you. I know it as I look at you. As our fathers said, you can tell a ripe corn by its look. I shall give you twice four hundred yams.

35 Go ahead and prepare your farm."

Okonkwo thanked him again and again and went home feeling happy. He knew that Nwakibie would not refuse him, but he had not expected he would be so generous. He had not hoped to get more than four hundred seeds. He would
40 now have to make a bigger farm. He hoped to get another four hundred yams from one of his father's friends at Isiuza.

Share-cropping¹ was a very slow way of building up a barn of one's own. After all the toil one only got a third of the harvest. But for a young man whose father had no
45 yams, there was no other way. And what made it worse in Okonkwo's case was that he had to support his mother and

¹ **share-cropping:** farming on rented land, paying the landowner in crops

two sisters from his **meager** harvest. And supporting his mother also meant supporting his father. She could not be expected to cook and eat while her husband starved. And so

50 at a very early age when he was striving desperately to build a barn through share-cropping Okonkwo was also fending for his father's house. It was like pouring grains of corn into a bag full of holes. His mother and sisters worked hard enough, but they grew women's crops, like coco-yams, beans

55 and cassava. Yam, the king of crops, was a man's crop.

The year that Okonkwo took eight hundred seed-yams from Nwakibie was the worst year in living memory. Nothing happened at its proper time; it was either too early or too late. It seemed as if the world had gone mad. The first rains

60 were late, and, when they came, lasted only a brief moment. The blazing sun returned, more fierce than it had ever been known, and scorched all the green that had appeared with the rains. The earth burned like hot coals and roasted all the yams that had been sown. Like all good farmers,

65 Okonkwo had begun to **sow** with the first rains. He had sown four hundred seeds when the rains dried up and the heat returned. He watched the sky all day for signs of rain clouds and lay awake all night. In the morning he went back to his farm and saw the withering **tendrils**. He had tried to

70 protect them from the smoldering earth by making rings of thick **sisal**² leaves around them. But by the end of the day the sisal rings were burned dry and gray. He changed them every day, and prayed that the rain might fall in the night. But the drought continued for eight market weeks and the yams

75 were killed.

Notes:

2 **sisal**: a plant with large, fleshy leaves, grown to make fabric

Some farmers had not planted their yams yet. They were the lazy easy-going ones who always put off clearing their farms as long as they could. This year they were the wise ones. They sympathized with their neighbors with much shaking of the head, but inwardly they were happy for what they took to be their own **foresight**.

Okonkwo planted what was left of his seed-yams when the rains finally returned. He had one **consolation**. The yams he had sown before the drought were his own, the harvest of the previous year. He still had the eight hundred from Nwakibie and the four hundred from his father's friend. So he would make a fresh start.

Notes:



First Focus: Identifying Theme

Discover

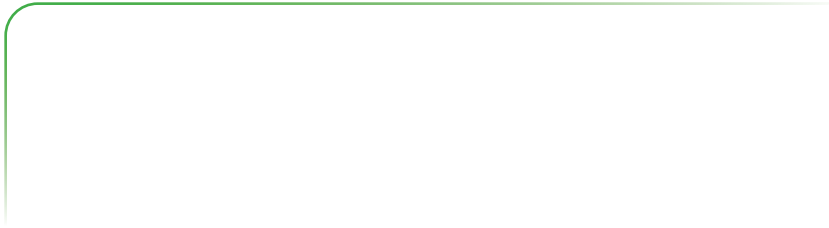
Skill Focus: The theme is the central insight, truth, or commentary about life that is woven through all the narrative elements. By analyzing the plot, characters, conflict, and symbols, you can determine that unifying thematic message or concept.

Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and consider how Okonkwo's past relationship with his father affects his current attitudes and actions. Underline phrases that show those effects, directly or indirectly.

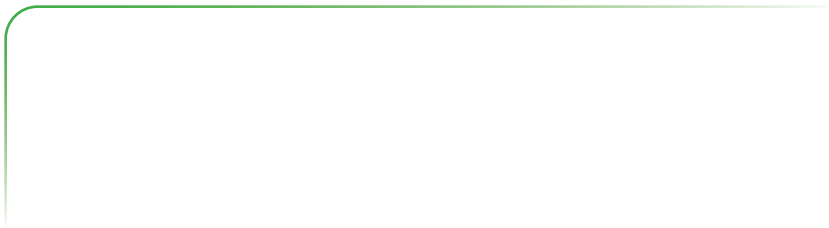
Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What words would you use to describe Okonkwo based on this excerpt?



2. What motivates Okonkwo's choices?



Demonstrate

What is theme?

Theme is

- the central, underlying, controlling insight of a work of literature. It can be put into a sentence.
- the writer's message—their view of the world or an observation about human nature.

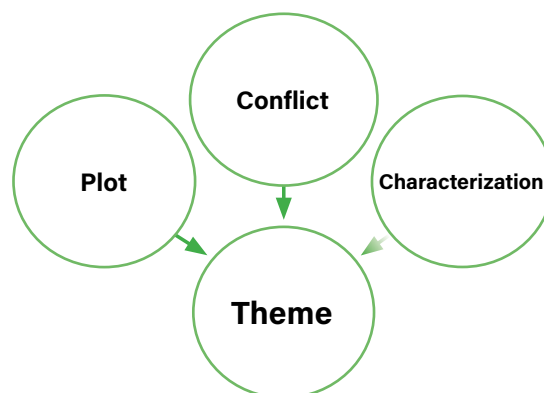
Theme is *not*

- the topic. Themes may comment on subjects such as loyalty, family, or violence, but the topic alone is not the theme.
- a summary of the setting and plot. Understanding what happens is only the first step to determining the theme.
- the author's purpose. Authors may write to entertain, to inform, or even to teach, but theme is separate from purpose. It can be stated without reference to the author.
- the moral. Themes are not explicit or as prescriptive as morals. Themes typically reflect how things are, not how they should be.
- the conflict or problem. Elements of the plot are used to illustrate the theme and to bring the author's ideas to light.

Use these steps to determine theme:

1. Summarize the plot. Write a short description of the exposition (beginning events/characters), the rising action, the climax, the falling action, and the resolution (how the conflict resolves). Consider how cultural or historical settings influence the plot.
2. Decide what the central conflict is. What central problem or obstacle is the main character trying to overcome? How does the conflict resolve? In success or failure?
3. Think about how the main character grows or changes throughout the story. The theme is often revealed through changes in the main character over the course of the story. Consider what lessons the character learned or how their thinking about life changed. In some stories, theme arises based on a lesson the character *failed* to learn.
4. Look for repeated ideas throughout the work.

Remember, all of the above must be supported by evidence from the text.



Fill in the second column of the chart to *continued on next page* determine the theme or message of the story. Some sentence starters are included for you.

Steps to Finding Theme	Your Response
1. Summarize the plot. Write a short description of the exposition and the rising action. (This excerpt doesn't include the climax or resolution.) How does the setting influence the plot, conflict and characterization?	<i>Things Fall Apart</i> is the story of
2. Decide what the central conflict is. What is the main problem or obstacle the character(s) is trying to overcome?	Okonkwo wants Okonkwo's main problem is He feels

continued on next page

Steps to Finding Theme	Your Response
3. Does the main character, Okonkwo, change or grow during the story? If so, how? If not, why not?	
4. What repeated words or ideas do you see?	
Review your responses to numbers 1–4 above. Then finish the following sentence. The theme of this excerpt from <i>Things Fall Apart</i> is	

Exit Ticket

With a partner, share theme statements. Are they similar or different?
 Respectfully explain reasons for your answer. Be open to changing your theme statement based upon your partner's evidence.

Second Focus: Analyzing a Cultural Experience

Discover

Skill Focus: An author's cultural background and experiences influence their writing. The beliefs, traditions, values, and perspectives of their culture often come through in their stories, characters, and writing style. Their experiences as an insider to that culture provide insight, details, and perspectives you may not find from an outsider's view. Paying attention to these cultural reflections can help you better understand the author's intentions and the deeper symbolism in their writing.

Listen as your teacher reads the selection aloud.

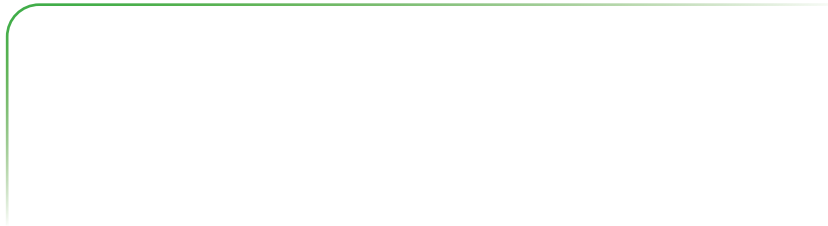
Underline examples of sayings that communicate truths about life, or proverbs. Consider this question:

- What do you learn about the values of the Igbo people from the story?

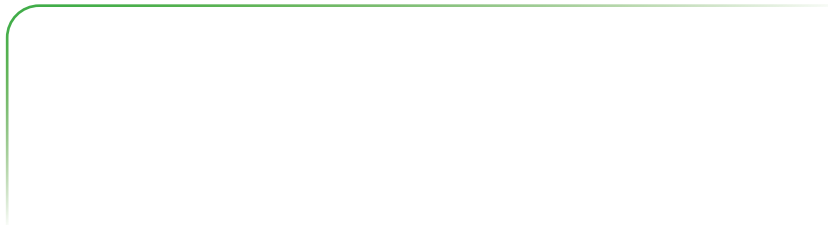
Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What may be the reason behind the distinction between “women’s crops” and “men’s crops”?



2. Is Okonkwo a good farmer? Why or why not?



3. What does Okonkwo learn?

Demonstrate

Culture is a combination of many aspects of a people's life. It includes their customs, their social roles, and their values and traditions. A character's culture is reflected in their attitudes toward men, women, family members, work, and play. Culture also influences their actions and values. Ultimately, a writer's culture influences his perspective and the themes he communicates through his writing.

Look for elements of the Igbo cultural experience in the excerpt and record them in the chart below. Refer to specific details in the text to support your answers.

Igbo Cultural Experience in <i>Things Fall Apart</i>	
Marriage and family	Men can inherit wives from their fathers. (lines 2–3) Wealthy men can have many wives and children. (lines 10–11)
Social status among members in the tribe	
Farming practices and attitudes toward work	

Igbo Cultural Experience in <i>Things Fall Apart</i>	
Use of Igbo proverbs	1. <i>The lizard that jumped from the high iroko tree . . .</i> (lines 19–20) means: 2. <i>. . . since men have learned to shoot without missing, he has learned to fly without perching.</i> (lines 30–31) means: 3. What does the use of proverbs say about the Igbo culture?

Exit Ticket

Use your answers to the chart to write a paragraph about the Igbo culture as reflected in *Things Fall Apart*. Explain how the aspects of culture affect Okonkwo and shape the characters and the conflict.

Third Focus: Analyzing How a Text Transforms Source Material

Discover

Skill Focus: Authors often use allusions, which are brief references to famous people, places, events, or other works of literature or art, to add multiple layers of meaning to their writing. Allusions create vivid imagery, establish connections, add symbolic meaning, enhance themes, demonstrate the author's own education and expertise, and engage the reader. In just a brief allusion, the author can easily communicate multiple layers of richness and significance. Identifying and interpreting allusions adds to the overall depth and meaning of the work.

Read the excerpt from *Things Fall Apart* again. Then read the following poem, from which Achebe drew the title of his novel. As you read the passages, think about the following questions:

- Later in the novel, Okonkwo's life is disrupted by the British takeover of Nigeria. How might the episode with the ruined yam crop relate to these future events in the novel? How might the events in Okonkwo's life reflect ideas in the poem?
- Preview the poem by reading the title and skimming the structure. Make predictions about the topic and the style. As you read, correct or confirm your predictions. Consider these questions: *What references does Yeats make to biblical and classical mythology? How does he transform these ideas to create his own vision?*

The Second Coming

by William Butler Yeats

Irish poet William Butler Yeats wrote "The Second Coming" in 1919, just months after the end of World War I. Additionally, the Irish War of Independence had just begun. Yeats was a mystic who believed that history was cyclical and that he was living near the end of a 2,000-year cycle.

1 Turning and turning in the widening gyre³

The falcon cannot hear the falconer;

Things fall apart; the centre cannot hold;

Mere **anarchy** is loosed upon the world,

³ **gyre:** circular or spiral motion

Notes:

- 5 The blood-dimmed tide is loosed, and everywhere
The ceremony of innocence is drowned;
The best lack all conviction, while the worst
Are full of passionate intensity
.
- Surely some **revelation** is at hand;
- 10 Surely the **Second Coming**⁴ is at hand.
The Second Coming! Hardly are those words out
When a vast image out of ***Spiritus Mundi***⁵
Troubles my sight: somewhere in sands of the desert
A shape with **lion body and the head of a man**⁶,
- 15 A gaze blank and pitiless as the sun,
Is moving its slow thighs, while all about it
Reel shadows of the indignant desert birds.
The darkness drops again; but now I know
That twenty centuries of stony sleep
- 20 Were **vexed** to nightmare by a rocking cradle,
And what rough beast, its hour come round at last,
Slouches towards **Bethlehem**⁷ to be born?

Notes:

4 **Second Coming:** according to Christian theology, the return of Jesus Christ at the end of the world

5 **Spiritus Mundi:** "the spirit of the world" that Yeats believed held all human memories and inspired artists and writers

6 **lion body and the head of a man:** the sphinx, a mythological creature characterized as powerful and merciless

7 **Bethlehem:** city of Jesus' birth

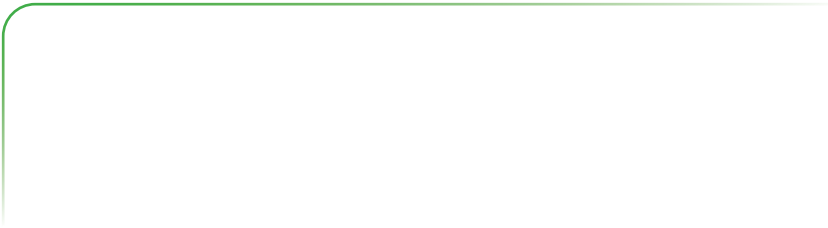
Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What do you picture when you read the phrase “the widening gyre” in line 1?



2. Which line of “The Second Coming” do you consider the most powerful? Why?



3. What do you think the “rocking cradle” refers to in line 20?



Demonstrate

Authors are also readers, familiar with important writers who have come before them and fascinated with the power of timeless images and themes. They often base their works on earlier stories, plays, and poems or enrich their own ideas with allusions to great literature. An *allusion* is a reference to a person, place, thing, or idea of historical, cultural, literary, or political significance. Some of the most common sources used in Western literature include Greek mythology, William Shakespeare's plays, and the Bible.

Some readers may skip over allusions they don't understand. However, taking the time to understand what allusions are referring to will help you better understand the multilevels of meaning the writer wishes to convey. Use the internet to quickly look up the character or situation being alluded to. This will deepen your understanding of literature.

In the chart on the next page, research and identify the sources of the allusions in "The Second Coming." For example, it might be a reference to a book, myth, or historical figure. Then describe what new meaning the ideas create.



The Great Sphinx of Giza.

Allusion and Source	Meaning
<i>Surely some revelation is at hand . . . the Second Coming . . .</i> Source:	
<i>A shape with lion body and the head of a man . . .</i> Source:	
<i>Slouches towards Bethlehem to be born?</i> Source:	

1. Does the poem follow any traditional pattern of meter? of rhyme? Analyze the poet's choices, Do you find his technique effective and appropriate?

2. Where does Yeats use ambiguity in the poem? In other words, which words and phrases seem especially mysterious or vague? How does this ambiguity contribute to the theme of the poem?

Universal Themes

Chinua Achebe's allusion to Yeats's "The Second Coming" indicates that the two works share universal themes. A universal theme is a central idea or message that can be found in stories, movies, and other works of art from all around the world and throughout history. It's a concept that people everywhere can relate to, regardless of their culture or background. Universal themes explore the common experiences, emotions, and challenges faced by human beings, such as love, friendship, growing up, facing fears, or dealing with loss. Perhaps Achebe read Yeats's poem and connected his own experiences with Yeats's. By recognizing universal themes, you can understand and appreciate stories from diverse perspectives and realize that all humans share similar hopes, dreams, and struggles.

3. What universal themes do you see in both works in this chapter? What universal themes are the authors communicating?

Exit Ticket

- 1 Share your answers to the graphic organizer with a partner. Discuss how Yeats transforms the meanings of the works alluded to in “The Second Coming.” Answer the question: What is the main idea of “The Second Coming”?
- 2 Write two paragraphs explaining why Chinua Achebe named his novel after a line from the poem “The Second Coming.” Use evidence from both selections to support your conclusions.

Review

In this chapter, you practiced determining the theme of a text, analyzing cultural experiences, and reflecting on authors' use of source materials. When you take assessments, you will be tested on your ability to make connections and recognize universal truths about human nature. Here is an example of this type of question.

1. Read this description of the theme of "The Second Coming" and the question that follows.

Humanity has lost its way in the world.

Which pair of lines from the poem best supports the theme?

- A. *Turning and turning in the widening gyre*
The falcon cannot hear the falconer
 - B. *The blood-dimmed tide is loosed, and everywhere*
The ceremony of innocence is drowned
 - C. *The best lack all conviction, while the worst*
Are full of passionate intensity.
 - D. *And what rough beast, its hour come round at last,*
Slouches towards Bethlehem to be born?
2. Read these sentences from *Things Fall Apart* and the directions that follow.

I am not afraid of work. The lizard that jumped from the high iroko tree to the ground said he would praise himself if no one else did.

Both Okonkwo and Nwakibie refer to proverbs when they speak. What aspect of Igbo culture does this custom most likely demonstrate?

 - A. They prove their manhood through mastery of stories.
 - B. The young respect the old by speaking formally.
 - C. They refer to their folklore to show they are wise.
 - D. The use of adages displays their religious devotion.
 3. In "The Second Coming," Yeats refers to biblical ideas of the end of the world, in which Jesus is predicted to return, destroy the forces of evil, and establish peace. How does Yeats transform this idea by introducing the image of the Sphinx?
 - A. He believes that the end has already come and gone.
 - B. He imagines that Jesus will have to fight the Sphinx.
 - C. He suggests the world will end in disaster, not salvation.
 - D. He feels that good and evil cannot be distinguished.

4. In the excerpt from *Things Fall Apart*, the author introduces one of the major themes by saying that Okonkwo was “possessed by the fear of his father’s contemptible life and shameful death.” Which of the following sentences from the excerpt best refines this theme?
- A. *As our fathers said, you can tell a ripe corn by its look.*
 - B. *But for a young man whose father had no yams, there was no other way.*
 - C. *And so at a very early age when he was striving desperately to build a barn through share-cropping Okonkwo was also fending for his father’s house.*
 - D. *He watched the sky all day for signs of rain clouds and lay awake all night.*
5. “The Second Coming” is generally thought to be inspired by the events of World War I and the Irish War of Independence. Which line from the poem best supports that conclusion?
- A. *Things fall apart; the centre cannot hold*
 - B. *The blood-dimmed tide is loosed, and everywhere
the ceremony of innocence is drowned*
 - C. *... somewhere in sands of the desert
with lion body and the head of a man*
 - D. *... twenty centuries of stony sleep
Were vexed to nightmare by a rocking cradle*
6. The title of *Things Fall Apart* comes from a line in Yeats’s “The Second Coming.” Which sentence from the novel best demonstrates the connection between the novel and the source material?
- A. *But in spite of these disadvantages, he had begun even in his father’s lifetime to lay the foundations of a prosperous future.*
 - B. *“Many young men have come to me to ask for yams but I have refused because I knew they would just dump them in the earth and leave them to be choked by weeds.”*
 - C. *It was like pouring grains of corn into a bag full of holes.*
 - D. *It seemed as if the world had gone mad.*



Chapter 21

Understanding an Author's Perspective

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in a text.
- determine how organizational patterns communicate the main ideas within a text.
- determine an author's perspective in a text and analyze how the author advances that perspective.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

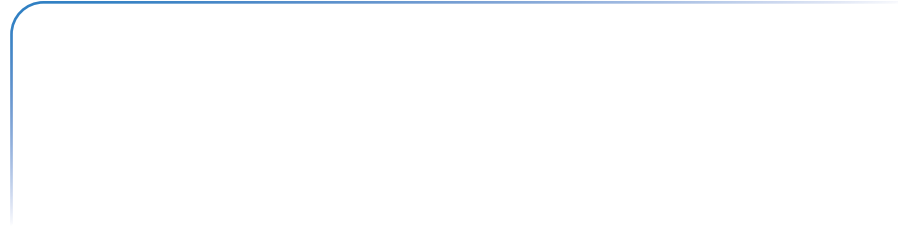
- **affixes:** a word part added to a root, stem, or word that changes the word's meaning.
- **main idea:** central thought of a text.
- **narrative:** an account that focuses on events.
- **organizational patterns:** the ways in which authors develop ideas in their writing.
- **prefixes:** affixes added to the beginning of a root, stem, or word.
- **suffixes:** affixes added to the end of a root, stem, or word.

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

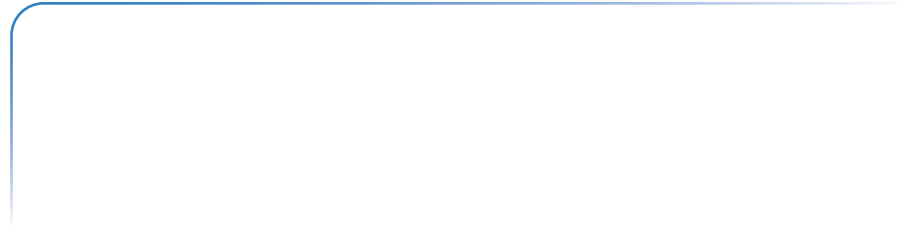
1. _____, which can be added to the beginning or the end of a word, often change the meaning and the part of speech of the word.
2. The _____ *pre-* means "before," as in the word *prehistoric*, which means "before history."
3. To make a regular verb past tense, just add the _____ *-ed*, such as *walk* (present tense) and *walked* (past tense).
4. He wrote the _____ of his life in his diary.
5. The author chose a chronological _____ for her historical novel because it was important to present events in order.
6. In literacy classes, identifying the _____ of a passage is crucial for students to comprehend the central message and develop their critical reading skills.

Preview Concepts

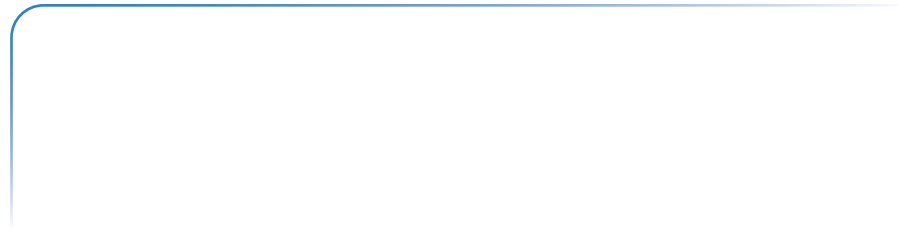
Snapchat. X. WhatsApp. Instagram. These are just a few of the social media sites and apps that hundreds of millions of people use every day. But how would you define the term *social media*? How did you arrive at that meaning?



How do social media users communicate their perspectives on social issues or current events? Think about how they use both words and visuals to share their opinion.



Compare your answers to the questions above with other members of your class. Add any good ideas from your classmates to your list.



Read for Understanding

The following excerpt is from *The Facebook Effect: The Inside Story of the Company That Is Connecting the World* by David Kirkpatrick. This selection discusses the way people began using social media to organize and protest against a violent group that seeks to overthrow the Colombian government.

As you read, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

excerpt

The Facebook Effect: The Inside Story of the Company That Is Connecting the World

by David Kirkpatrick

Technology journalist David Kirkpatrick received cooperation from the company's executives, including founder Mark Zuckerberg, when he began writing the history of Facebook, from its creation to its impact in the wider world. It is with that impact that Kirkpatrick opens the prologue to his book.

Prologue

1 Oscar Morales was fed up. It was holiday time in his hometown of Barranquilla, Colombia, just after the 2008 new year. The gentle-spirited civil engineer with a gift for computers was spending his days at the **bucolic** nearby
5 beaches with his extended family. But despite the holidays, like much of the country his thoughts were dark, and occupied with the suffering of a little boy named Emmanuel.

Emmanuel was the four-year-old son of Clara Rojas, who had been a **hostage** in the jungles of Colombia for six years.
10 Her son had been born while she was held by the **guerrillas**⁸ of the Revolutionary Armed Forces of Colombia, known by its Spanish initials, FARC. FARC held a total of seven hundred hostages, including Colombian presidential candidate Ingrid Betancourt, kidnapped along with Rojas during the

8 **guerrillas**: Spanish for "warriors"; an independent group of fighters, not a national army

Notes:

15 2002 campaign.

Sympathy and sadness about the plight of FARC's hostages was an ever-present fact in contemporary Colombia, as was fear about what the powerful and murderous revolutionary army might do next to disrupt the country. But the case of Emmanuel had lately acquired outsized prominence in the popular press. For some time President Hugo Chavez of neighboring Venezuela had been attempting to negotiate with FARC about releasing Betancourt and others. Then abruptly in late December the guerrillas announced that they would soon turn over Rojas, her son Emmanuel, and another hostage to Chavez. In a nation exhausted from a decades-long battle with the violent guerrillas, this was a rare piece of good news. "People were longing for a gift, for a miracle," says Morales, thirty-two. "And Emmanuel was a symbol. The whole country was feeling the promise: 'Please let Emmanuel get his freedom. We would like that as a Christmas present from FARC.'"

But as the new year arrived, Emmanuel still hadn't been freed. . . .

Morales wanted desperately to do something. So he turned to Facebook. Though the service wasn't yet even translated into Spanish, Morales spoke fluent English, as do many educated Colombians, and had been maintaining a profile there for over a year, posting his own information in Spanish and connecting with old college and high school friends. Spending time on Facebook was already a daily ritual for him.

In Facebook's search box he typed the four letters "FARC" and hit enter. There were no results. No groups. No activism. No outrage. Groups devoted to almost everything under the

Notes:

sun were common on Facebook. But when it came to FARC,
45 the citizens of Colombia had become used to being angry but
cowed. In effect, the entire country had been taken hostage,
and this had been going on for decades.

Morales spent a day asking himself if he was willing to go
public on Facebook. He decided to take the plunge,
50 and on the 4th created a group against FARC. “It was like a
therapy,” he says. “I had to express my anger.” He wrote a
short description of the group’s simple purpose—to stand
up against FARC. A self-confessed “computer addict,”
Morales was skilled at graphics tools, so he designed a logo
55 in the form of a vertical version of the Colombian flag. He
overlaid it with four simple pleas in capitals running down
the page, each one slightly larger than the last—NO MORE
KIDNAPPINGS, NO MORE LIES, NO MORE KILLINGS, NO
MORE FARC. “I was trying to scream like if I was in a crowd,”
60 he explains. “The time had come to fight FARC. What had
happened was unbearable.”

But what should he call his group? On Facebook it’s
conventional to give groups names like “I bet I can’t find one
million people who hate George Bush.” But Morales didn’t
65 like such titles. They were **juvenile**. This was not a contest.
This was serious. Yet he liked the idea of a million. A famous
Spanish song is called “One Million Friends.” One million
people against FARC? The word *voices* sounded more literary.
One million voices against FARC—Un Millón de Voces Contra
70 Las FARC. That was it. . . .

A Facebook group has a “wall,” where members can post
thoughts, as well as discussion forums that allow organized,
long-lasting conversations among many members. Morales

Notes:

soon bonded with several people who were posting there

75 with special **vigor**. They exchanged instant messaging and
Skype addresses and cell-phone numbers so they could
continue their conversations offline.

As more and more Colombians joined the group, members
started talking not only about how mad they were about

80 FARC, but what they ought to do about it. On January 6, just
the second full day, a consensus on the page was emerging
that the burgeoning group should go public. By the time it
hit eight thousand members, people were posting on the
discussion board, over and over, "Let's DO something." . . .

85 So Morales created an event called the National March
against FARC. He and his co-organizers, several of them
already as consumed by the project as he was, immediately
got **pushback** from unexpected quarters. Members in Miami,
Buenos Aires, Madrid, Los Angeles, Paris, and elsewhere
90 argued that it should be a global demonstration. Morales
didn't even realize people living outside Colombia had joined
the group. These Colombian émigrés were on Facebook partly
to stay in touch with things back at home. They wanted to be
involved in this movement, too. So it became a global march.

95 What ensued was one of the most extraordinary
examples of digitally fueled activism the world has ever
seen. On February 4, about 10 million people marched
against FARC in hundreds of cities in Colombia according
to Colombian press estimates. As many as 2 million more
100 marched in cities around the world. The movement that
began with an impassioned midnight Facebook post in one
frustrated young man's bedroom led to one of the largest
demonstrations ever, anywhere in the world. . . .

Notes:

But what remains remarkable is the way so many
105 Colombians on Facebook signed up on the group under their
real names. By the day of the march there were 350,000.
Despite decades of fear and intimidation, Facebook gave
Colombia's young people an easy, digital way to feel comfort
in numbers to declare their disgust.

110 Even after news about the march had become a daily
drumbeat in the press and the website had turned into a key
promotional tool, Facebook remained central. "Facebook was
our headquarters," says Morales. "It was the newspaper. It
was the central command. It was the laboratory—everything.
115 Facebook was all that, right up until the last day."

Morales himself had volunteered to coordinate the local
demonstration in Barranquilla. He expected about 50,000
people to show up. In fact 300,000 did, about 15 percent of
the city's population. They filled more than ten city blocks.
120 At exactly noon, Morales read a statement that the group
had jointly agreed upon. It was broadcast on television all
over Latin America. Demonstrators gathered even in remote
places like Dubai, Sydney, and Tokyo. On local TV news, one
woman was interviewed in the crush of the Bogotá march.
125 Had she been personally injured by FARC, the interviewer
asked? "Yes, because I am Colombian," she replied. Morales
and his group members had tapped into frustrations deep in
the collective national psyche.

While pressure from President Uribe has played a major
130 role in weakening FARC, the demonstrations seem to have
struck their own blow. In a sign that the guerrillas were
acutely aware of the **impending** march, on the Saturday
before it took place they announced that they would release

Notes:

three hostages, all former Colombian congressmen, as a
135 “humanitarian” gesture. Ingrid Betancourt and fourteen
other hostages were rescued in a commando operation by
the Colombian army in July 2008. In interviews she recalled
listening to a radio in the jungle on February 4, surrounded
by her FARC captors. She said she was deeply moved when
140 she heard the demonstrators chanting in unison, “No more
FARC! Freedom! Freedom!” Then the guerrillas couldn’t stand
it and turned off the radio. Oscar Morales is telling me about
this in a coffee shop in Manhattan in late 2008. As he does,
his voice catches. Tears well up. His group and the subsequent
145 demonstration made him into a national and international
celebrity. But the conviction and concern that fueled his
creation of *Un Millón de Voces Contra Las FARC* remains alive.
Today he devotes his entire life to the anti-FARC crusade.

Though Facebook was not designed as a political tool,
150 its creators observed early on that it had peculiar potential.
During the first few weeks after it was created at Harvard
University in 2004, students began broadcasting their
political opinions by replacing their profile picture with a
block of text that included a political statement. “People
155 were using it back then to protest whatever was important,”
says Facebook co-founder Dustin Moskovitz. “Even if they
were just upset about a minor issue with the school.” People
from the beginning **intuitively** realized that if this service
was intended as a way for them to reflect online their
160 genuine identity, then an element of that identity was their
views and passions about the issues of the day.

Notes:

"The Colombia thing," says Mark Zuckerberg, Facebook's founder, "is a very early indicator that governance is changing—[and of how] powerful political organizations
165 can form. These things can really affect people's liberties and freedom, which is kind of the point of government. . . . In fifteen years maybe there will be things like what happened in Colombia almost every day."



First Focus: Defining Key Terms

Discover

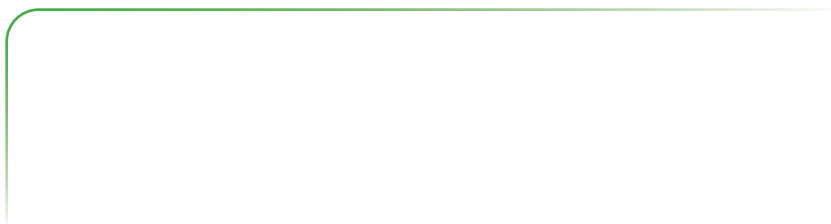
Skill Focus: As you read informational text, you will often encounter certain unfamiliar words or phrases related to the main topic. Knowing the precise meanings of these key terms is crucial for fully understanding what the essay is trying to explain. The key terms are like a special code that unlocks comprehension. Pay close attention to any words that seem important or that get repeated. Understanding the key terms provides you with a solid foundation to then comprehend all the supporting details and evidence in the essay. Knowing the key terms leads to deeper understanding!

Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and circle unfamiliar or confusing words. As you read, write questions you have in the Notes column. Underline one or two sentences that express the purpose of the passage.

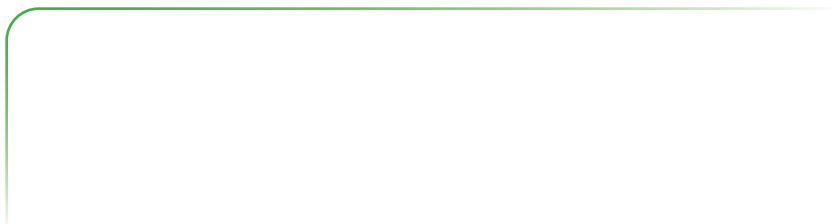
Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What words and phrases does the author use to express Morales's disdain for the guerrillas of the Revolutionary Army?



2. Analyze the meaning and effect of the figurative phrase “struck their own blow” as it applies to the global demonstrations against FARC.



3. How did “the Columbia thing” change Mark Zuckerberg’s idea of what his invention might offer the world?

Demonstrate

This passage has many unfamiliar words. They may come from the world of technology or of politics, or they may simply be the words used in formal writing. When you read a passage with unfamiliar words, try to focus on the new terms that will best help you understand the main idea of the passage. You may not have time to look up all the unfamiliar words.

Remember to use affixes to help you determine word meanings. Here is a reminder of some common prefixes and suffixes:

- in-*: not; into, toward

un-: not, no

con-: opposite of; against
- ism*: a practice, system, or philosophy

-ist: person or member

-ian: one who is

Fill in the following chart, first with your own definition and then with a dictionary definition. Complete the last two rows by finding two other words from the passage that are unfamiliar to you. Context clues are filled in for the word *activism*.

Word	What I think it means from the context and my own background knowledge	Dictionary Definition
activism (line 42)	activism—root word <i>active</i> means “doing things”; suffix <i>-ism</i> means “practice or system” activism—doing things as part of an political philosophy	

continued on next page

Word	What I think it means from the context and my own background knowledge	Dictionary Definition
consensus (line 81)		
émigrés (line 92)		
ensued (line 95)		
intimidation (line 107)		
humanitarian (line 135)		

Word	What I think it means from the context and my own background knowledge	Dictionary Definition

Exit Ticket

With a partner, share your answers to the definitions chart. Discuss the following questions:

1. How does the author's word choice affect the tone of the text as a whole?
2. What words and phrases indicate the author's point of view about FARC and about Facebook?

Second Focus: Determining Main Idea

Discover

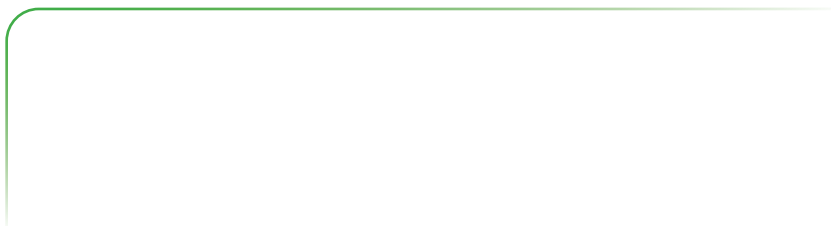
Skill Focus: The main ideas, also known as the central ideas, are the most important points or key concepts the author wants you to learn and understand. They are the big takeaways. Similar to how your teacher shares an objective or an essential question at the start of a lesson, an informative essay has main ideas that are at the core of the essay. All the details and examples in the essay connect back and develop those main ideas. You can spot the central ideas by looking for the subjects or topics that are repeated throughout multiple paragraphs or sections. They are the broad, overarching concepts the author keeps coming back to.

Listen as your teacher reads the selection aloud. Underline one sentence in each paragraph that you think communicates the central idea of that paragraph.

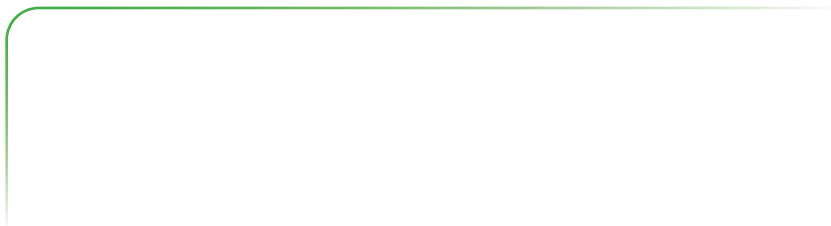
Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. Why do you think Kirkpatrick included the quotation by the interviewed woman in line 126?



2. Has Zuckerberg's prediction that "things like what happened in Columbia" will begin to "happen every day" come true? Find at least one more example.



3. What large idea is illuminated by “the Columbia thing” as recounted by Kirkpatrick?

Demonstrate

As you know, the main idea is a statement that describes not only the topic of a text but also reflects the author’s perspective about the topic. The topic of this excerpt is Oscar Morales’s resistance to FARC.

Describing lines 1–70 of the prologue, a main idea statement might say,

- “Oscar Morales created a Facebook group opposed to FARC that led to major demonstrations throughout Colombia and the release of many citizens held hostage by FARC.”

But the prologue does not end with the story of Oscar Morales. It goes on to bring the discussion back to Facebook itself. In the space below, write the main idea for the final two paragraphs (lines 149–168) of the prologue.

How does the organization of the two sections for which you just wrote main idea statements differ? The section before the final two paragraphs tells a story. It is narrative.

1. Why does the author begin his book with a story? How does it help him communicate the main idea of the book?

2. How are the final two paragraphs organized? Do they tell a story, describe details, or make an argument?

3. What lines from the text support your conclusions?

Exit Ticket

How does the structure of the prologue communicate the changing central idea of the sections of text? Write a paragraph in which you address this question. Refer to specific sentences to explain the organizational patterns and the main ideas of the text.

Third Focus: Determining Author's Perspective

Discover

Skill Focus: The term *author's perspective* refers to the viewpoint, stance, or position from which an author presents information, ideas, or a narrative. A reader can infer an author's perspective by paying close attention to several key elements in the writing:

- **Word Choice:** The specific language and terms an author uses can reveal their attitudes, assumptions, and potential biases on the subject matter.
- **Tone:** The tone (serious, humorous, sarcastic, formal, etc.) provides clues about the author's viewpoint.
- **What's Emphasized:** The ideas, facts, or details the author chooses to focus on or reiterate indicate what they find most important from their perspective.
- **What's Omitted:** The topics, arguments, or counterpoints the author leaves out can imply their blindspots or agendas.
- **Analogies/Comparisons:** The analogies and comparisons an author draws can reflect their perspective.
- **Sources/Evidence:** The authorities and sources an author cites or ignores can suggest their viewpoint.
- **Emotional Language:** The presence of emotional descriptors, judgments, or loaded language signals where an author's perspectives lie.
- **Personal Anecdotes:** The personal stories, backgrounds, or viewpoints authors reveal shape their interpretations.

By synthesizing these factors throughout the full text, an attentive reader can start to map out the particular personal, cultural, and philosophical perspectives guiding and limiting the author's portrayal of the subject matter.

Read the passage aloud with a partner. Think about why the author is using this story as the prologue to a book about the development of Facebook as a company and as an internet platform.

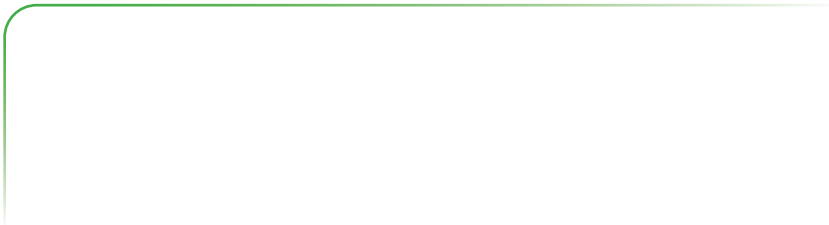
Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

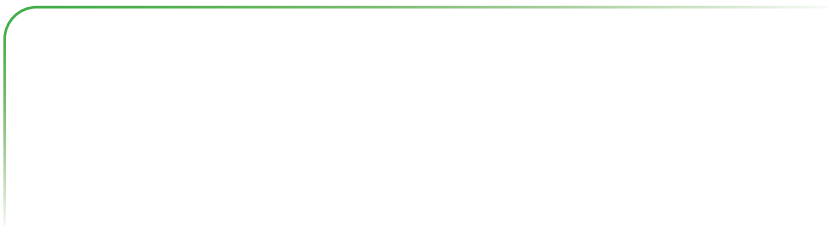
1. Explore your own perspective about Facebook so that you can compare and contrast it with that of Zuckerberg, Morales, and Kirkpatrick.



2. “Facebook creates communities.” Do you agree with this statement? Why or why not? Use details from the text to support your answer.



3. Do you agree with the perspective that examples of “digitally fueled activism” (paragraph 11) will be the norm of the future? Why or why not?



Demonstrate

This passage describes events from recent history. However, the author has an underlying opinion about the value of Facebook. Although he doesn't come right out and say what he thinks, the reader can infer the writer's opinion, or his perspective, about Facebook and its role in the events he describes.

Infer the perspective of the passage by considering the

- positive details the writer includes.
- negative details the writer includes.
- words the writer chooses and the emotions they imply.

Return to the passage and note each time the author mentions or describes Facebook. Briefly summarize those details or descriptions in the chart on the next page.

Descriptions of Facebook	
Positive	Negative
—spending time on it was a daily ritual —groups devoted to a wide variety of subjects	—was not yet translated into Spanish —groups often have juvenile titles

Exit Ticket

Based on the details and descriptions that you have recorded in the chart, explain the author's purpose and perspective. Support your conclusions with evidence from the text.

Review

In this chapter, you practiced determining word meanings and central ideas. You were asked to determine an author's perspective based on organization and word choice. When you take assessments, you will be tested on your ability to discern why authors write and how they feel about their subjects.

1. Which statement from *The Facebook Effect* best demonstrates the author's perspective about Facebook?
 - A. *Spending time on Facebook was already a daily ritual for him.*
 - B. *On Facebook it's conventional to give groups names like "I bet I can find one million people who hate George Bush."*
 - C. *What ensued was one of the most extraordinary examples of digitally fueled activism the world has ever seen.*
 - D. *Though Facebook was not designed as a political tool, its creators observed early on that it had peculiar potential.*
2. Which event from the passage is most important to developing the main idea of the prologue?
 - A. Colombians were upset that Emmanuel Rojas, a sick little boy, was being held hostage by FARC.
 - B. Oscar Morales created the Facebook group One Million Voices Against FARC.
 - C. FARC announced the release of three prominent hostages in anticipation of the protest march and others were rescued just months after the march.
 - D. Facebook co-founder Mark Zuckerberg believes that in fifteen years the social media platform will effect social change like it did in Colombia every day.

3. Read this sentence from *The Facebook Effect* and answer the question that follows.

Morales and his group members had tapped into frustrations deep in the collective national psyche.

Which of the following best explains the meaning of the expression "the collective national psyche"?

- A. the most treasured ideas of a country
- B. the government's official position on an issue
- C. the shared thoughts and feelings of a people
- D. the greatest problems affecting a region

4. Read this sentence from *The Facebook Effect* and answer the question that follows.

His group and the subsequent demonstration made him into a national and international celebrity.

The word *subsequent* most nearly means

- A. later.
 - B. lesser.
 - C. underground.
 - D. successful.
5. Read this sentence from the passage and answer the question that follows.

Sympathy and sadness about the plight of FARC's hostages was an ever-present fact in contemporary Colombia, as was fear about what the powerful and murderous revolutionary army might do next to disrupt the country.

Part A: What does this statement reveal about David Kirkpatrick's perspective?

- A. He wants to present information about FARC in an objective way.
- B. He agrees with FARC's goals but opposes their violent tactics.
- C. He worries how FARC might retaliate against him for criticizing them.
- D. He feels FARC is a dangerous group with no regard for the lives of fellow Colombians.

Part B: Write two examples of words or phrases in the excerpt that support your answer to Part A.





Chapter 22

Analyzing Varying Accounts of a Subject

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- cite thorough text evidence to support analysis of what the text says.
- analyze how the author organizes a complex set of information.
- analyze in detail how an author's ideas are developed by particular sentences or paragraphs.

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **cause and effect:** organizational pattern that shows how one thing leads to or causes a result or effect.
- **chronological (time) order:** organizational pattern that recounts facts, events, or details in the order in which they occurred in time.
- **comparison and contrast:** organizational pattern that shows similarities and differences between people, things, or ideas.
- **description:** organizational pattern in which information is developed by explaining features, characteristics, or examples.
- **problem and solution:** organizational pattern that defines certain problems and how they might be solved.
- **sequential order:** organizational pattern that describes a process, step by step, from beginning to end.

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

1. To explain the process used to dry fresh flowers, describe each step in _____.
2. The biography was written in _____, beginning with the author's birth in South Africa.
3. To describe both organic and commercial farms and how they are alike and different, you will likely use _____.
4. The author's vivid _____ of the misty forest transported readers into a world of shadowy trees and damp, moss-covered ground.

5. When Manuel wrote about overfishing and the serious results of this practice, he used _____ organization.
6. When Edris wrote a report about the world's clean water crisis and what we can do to get ahead of this issue, he used a _____ organization.

Preview Concepts

What is the best way to present complex ideas? Writers must find clear ways to explain technical subjects and clusters of events where many causes and effects can be difficult to distinguish. Complex texts use a variety of organizational patterns to convey different aspects of an issue. What are some of the ways to organize information? Make a list below.

Discuss with a partner how you might organize an article about the invention and popularization of the telephone and how it works. In the space below, create a rough outline that addresses the following questions:

- How would you begin the article and draw readers in?
- How would you incorporate technical information about the science of phones alongside the events that preceded and followed the creation?
- How much space would you devote to biographical details about the inventor?

Read for Understanding

The article in this chapter discusses how inventor Dean Kamen came to create a machine that inexpensively purifies polluted water. As you read the following article, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

Pure Genius: How Dean Kamen's Invention Could Bring Clean Water to Millions

by Tom Foster

This article appeared in the June 16, 2014, issue of Popular Science magazine. Since then, Dean Kamen has been the subject of a documentary, SlingShot, and his company has begun selling its mind-controlled robotic “Luke Arm” for use by amputees.

1 At first glance, the bright red shipping container that sits by the side of the road in a slum outside **Johannesburg**⁹ doesn't look like something that could transform hundreds of lives.

Two sliding doors open to reveal a small shop counter,
5 behind which sit rows of canned food, toilet paper, cooking oil, and first-aid supplies. Solar panels on the roof power wireless Internet and a television, for the occasional soccer game. And two faucets dispense free purified drinking water to anyone who wants it.

10 Created primarily by Coca-Cola and Deka Research and Development, the New Hampshire company founded by inventor Dean Kamen, the container is meant to be a kind of “downtown in a box”: a web-connected **bodega**¹⁰-cum-community center that can be dropped into underdeveloped
15 villages all over the world. Coke calls it an Ekocenter. It's a **pithy** name, but it masks the transformative technology hidden within the container.

Inside the big red box sits a smaller one, about the size

⁹ **Johannesburg**: capital of South Africa

¹⁰ **bodega**: neighborhood store

Notes:

of a dorm fridge, called a SlingShot. It was developed
20 by Kamen, the mastermind behind dozens of medical-
equipment inventions and, most famously, the Segway
personal transportation device. Kamen is the closest thing to
a modern-day Thomas Edison. He holds hundreds of patents,
and his creations have improved countless lives. His current
25 projects include a robotic **prosthetic** arm for **DARPA**¹¹ and a
Stirling engine that generates affordable electricity by using
“anything that burns” for fuel. The SlingShot, more than
10 years in the making, could have a bigger impact than all
of his other inventions combined.

30 Using a process called vapor compression **distillation**, a
single SlingShot can purify more than 250,000 liters of water
per year, enough to satisfy the needs of about 300 people.
And it can do so with any water source—sewage, seawater,
chemical waste—no matter how dirty.

35 For communities that lack clean water, the benefit is
obvious, but to realize that potential, the SlingShot needs to
reach them first. Which is where Coke comes in: The company
is not just a soft-drink peddler; it is arguably the largest,
most sophisticated distribution system in the world. That’s
40 important because the scale of the water crisis the world
faces is **unprecedented**.

Water seems so abundant it’s easy to forget how many
people don’t have a clean source of it. According to the
World Health Organization, nearly a billion people lack ready
45 access to safe drinking water, and hundreds of thousands die
every year as a result. Many more fall terribly ill.

Plenty of water-purification tools exist, of course—chlorine

Notes:

11 **DARPA:** Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency, part of the U.S. Defense Department that develops new technology

tablets, reverse-**osmosis** plants—but they all have drawbacks.

Either they're not adequately portable; they require

50 replacement parts that can be hard to come by; or, most
vexing of all, they remove only certain kinds of impurities,
leaving others to poison the unwitting.

Kamen calls the global water crisis a “Goliath” of a
problem, which suggests that he is David. He offers a quick

55 refresher on biblical lore: David, it bears remembering,
defeated Goliath with a SlingShot.

“In my life, nothing is ever simple or easy,” Kamen says.

“I didn’t wake up one day and say, ‘Wow, there’s a global water
problem. I think I’ll work on that.’” . . .

60 When we first sat down, I asked Kamen a simple question:
How did you get interested in the water crisis? The answer

Notes:



Paul Lazarus and Dean Kamen with the Ghana prototype and the the Alpha model.

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turned into a highlights tour of his career, before he became famous or wealthy. Kamen is a natural storyteller, and his narrative unspools at high speed. Now 63, he grew up in Long
65 Island, New York, and he ended up leaving college to start his first company, AutoSyringe, in 1976, to address a problem he'd heard about from his brother, a medical student: Certain patients needed such frequent treatment that trips to the hospital prevented them from living productive lives. Kamen's
70 solution was the world's first wearable infusion pump, which administered doses of medication automatically. It was a hit, and Kamen sold AutoSyringe to Baxter International, a health-care company. He was just 30 years old.

Suddenly a millionaire, Kamen moved to Manchester and
75 started Deko (derived from his first and last names). With a few exceptions, such as the now **ubiquitous** Segway, much of the company's work has focused on medical innovations that solve lifestyle problems. One such project, begun 20-some years ago, was a machine to reinvent **dialysis**¹² for patients
80 with failing kidneys. . . .

Called HomeChoice, Kamen's design was small enough to fit on patients' nightstands and quiet enough that they could sleep while it worked. The [dialysis] machine required a lot of purified water, however—many gallons a day per
85 patient—and that wasn't cost-effective. Kamen's instinct: Invent a medical-grade water purifier, so that patients could use water from their faucets as the base for their dialysis solution. He knew that existing **purification** systems, mostly based on filtration, weren't exacting enough to meet his needs,
90 so he looked to **distillation**¹³. In Kamen's eyes, distillation was

Notes:

12 **dialysis**: chemically purifying blood

13 **distillation**: purifying a liquid by heating and cooling

Notes:

magical in its simplicity. “The sun will evaporate the water out of an open **latrine**¹⁴, and it will leave behind all of the **bioburden, Cryptosporidium, and Giardia**¹⁵,” he says. “It will even separate the water from the **arsenic and hexavalent chromium**¹⁶ in a chemical waste site.”

As is so often the case, innovation, when it strikes, is an obvious-in-**retrospect** connection between seemingly disparate ideas. Kamen's unique brand of genius is that he can recognize those connections and see their potential where others can't.

But fitting one of the planet's most elegant systems into a home appliance is not without its challenges. For his distillation machine to work, it would need to boil many gallons of water per hour, and that would require more energy than everything else in a typical U.S. home combined.

So Kamen and his engineers **exploited** another basic scientific principle. To vaporize, water must get hot, and to do that, it absorbs energy. When the vapor condenses back into liquid, that energy gets released. If the team could recycle it, Kamen reasoned, they'd have a much more efficient process. They designed a “counterflow heat exchanger” that would run cool incoming liquid past superheated distilled water that had been vaporized and compressed. The difference in temperature would simultaneously cool the outgoing water and flash-boil the incoming liquid. All they would need is enough energy to get some water boiling and a little extra energy to power a compressor.

Kamen leans forward and grins as he ties the first chapter of his story together. “We said, ‘Wait, we can build a device

¹⁴ **latrine**: a pit into which human waste is emptied when plumbing is not available

¹⁵ **bioburden, Cryptosporidium, and Giardia**: bacteria and parasites that cause diseases

¹⁶ **arsenic and hexavalent chromium**: toxic metals

Notes:

120 that could take any input water, whether it's got bioburden,
organics, inorganics, chrome . . . and we can make pure
water come out? We can put it in somebody's house and
make a supply of water for injection that would meet
the **U.S. Pharmacopeial standard**¹⁷, on less power than a
125 handheld hair dryer, and we could make a thousand liters a
day?' " Imagine how valuable that could be.

As the plan for his water purifier took shape, Kamen
found himself thinking a lot about disaster relief. Whenever
an earthquake or tsunami struck, aid organizations would
130 request clean water before anything else because local
supplies were tainted with sewage or chemicals. Kamen
thought, "I've been trying to make a box small enough
that you could carry it around for mobile dialysis, and it
makes 250 gallons a day—that would be enough for a
135 hundred people in a crisis." More to the point, why not use
the machine to help entire villages, or even nations, with
persistent water needs?

"There are nearly a billion people in the world that get
up every morning and their primary goal is to find water,"
140 Kamen says. "Many travel great distances to find water that
won't kill them. And sadly, hundreds of thousands of times a
year it does kill, mostly kids." With Kamen's purifier, people
could just stick a hose in their dirty laundry water, a polluted
river, or even their own toilet pit, and crystal-clear, microbe-
145 free water would stream out of the machine.

The question was how to get the purifiers mass-produced
and into the hands of those who needed them. . . . The
medical and pharmaceutical companies Kamen had worked

17 **U.S. Pharmacopeial standard:** a nonprofit organization that sets standards for the purity of drugs

with over the years weren't much better positioned to help.

150 They had infrastructure in developed nations but not in the
100-odd countries where he hoped to see the technology
deployed.

Frustrated, Kamen had another obvious-in-retrospect
insight. "You talk to people that travel a lot and they say,

155 'If there's one thing you can buy anywhere in the world,
it's a Coke.' You know the joke: A guy takes three weeks
climbing to the top of Mount Everest; he gets to the top and
buys himself a Coke. So I thought, Coke is something you
drink, and they have coolers that are about the size of our
160 machine, and they have bottling partnerships around the
world. I'm going to go and try to convince them to do this."

Coke's response to Kamen's unorthodox overture: Glad
to hear from you, but how about doing another project
first? That was in 2005, and one of the company's challenges

165 at the time was to develop a better soda fountain. Kamen
teamed up with Nilang Patel, the former head of Coke's
research lab. Drawing from medical equipment Kamen
had developed to precisely administer **insulin and**
chemotherapy¹⁸ drugs, they created the Freestyle. The
170 freestanding dispenser combines concentrated ingredients
stored in small cartridges (as opposed to five-gallon bags of
syrup) with carbonated water and sweeteners to create as
many as 100 different drinks.

By 2009, the Freestyle was in production, and Kamen

175 reminded Coke about the handshake deal to pursue what he
was by then calling the SlingShot. In the interim, though, Coke
had gotten a new CEO and chairman, Muhtar Kent. Kamen
feared he'd have to "grovel and beg" for support, but, he says,

Notes:

18 **insulin and chemotherapy:** diabetes and cancer treatments

“within a couple of minutes of meeting Muhtar, I realized he’s
180 not like an accounting guy; he’s a big-picture, global thinker.

“‘Dean,’ he says to me, ‘if we can make the water, why
can’t we do other things too?’” Providing clean water could
be the cornerstone of what’s known as a bottom-of-the-
pyramid strategy for developing markets. By providing the
185 poorest people in the world with new technologies, services,
and opportunities, a company can help lift them out of
poverty and transform them into **viable** customers. Hence,
the Ekocenter concept took shape as a companion to the
water purifier, at least in some markets.

190 “We believe Coca-Cola’s business can only be as healthy
as the community it is part of, so the well-being of the
community is important to our long-term strategy,” says
Derk Hendriksen, the general manager of the Ekocenter
program. Notably, the company won’t directly profit from
195 the program; each “downtown in a box” will operate as a
standalone business run by a local entrepreneur, typically a
woman, selected and trained by Coke. (That the soda giant
enjoys an image boost in the process goes without saying.)

In 2011, Coke and Deka sent 15 SlingShots to **Ghana**¹⁹ for a
200 six-month field test where they provided clean water to five
rural schools. In fall 2013, Coke and its partners announced a
goal to place up to 2,000 units (either standalone SlingShots
or Ekocenters) around Africa, Asia, and Latin America by the
end of 2015. “The commitment we made is to provide 500
205 million liters of safe drinking water to communities in need
on a yearly basis,” Hendriksen says. That would translate into
improving the lives of 500,000 people a year.

Notes:

¹⁹ **Ghana:** a country in West Africa

First Focus: Citing Text Evidence

Discover

Skills Focus: Details from a reading passage that explain or support your own conclusions about a text are known as *textual evidence*. Textual evidence includes words and phrases found in the passage that provide proof for your own opinions about the text. Citing evidence makes your answers convincing and valid.

Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and underline key details that explain how the machine works and mark any information that is confusing with a question mark (?).

Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. Why did Coca-Cola offer the best means of distributing Kamen's water purification systems?

2. What did Kamen do for Coca-Cola™ between 2005 and 2009 and how did it contribute to his success?

3. What evidence supports the idea that Ekocenters can benefit rural villages?

Demonstrate

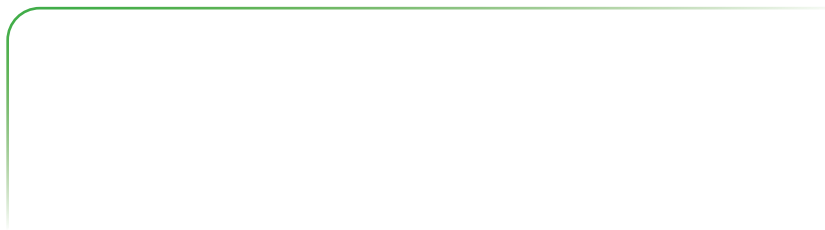
When citing textual evidence, you may include a paraphrase or a direct quotation enclosed in quotation marks. It is also helpful to include a paragraph or line number. Study the following examples. Underline where the writer uses textual evidence.

Kamen became determined to develop the SlingShot in order to prevent deaths from tainted water. He says that more than a billion people struggle to find safe water every day (lines 138–139).

In lines 140–142, Kamen points out, “Many [people] travel great distances to find water that won’t kill them. And sadly, hundreds of thousands of times a year it does kill, mostly kids.”

Notice that these examples cite more than one piece of evidence from the text to create a thorough response. Use at least two pieces of text evidence to answer the next question.

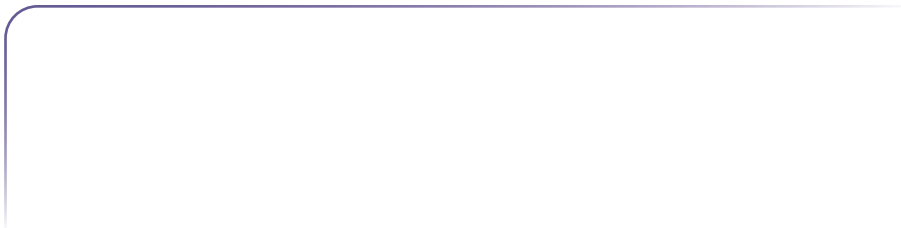
1. According to the text, how does the SlingShot purify water?



Exit Ticket

Work with a partner to answer the following question. Be prepared to share your answer with the entire class.

- What part did Coca-Cola play in the development and distribution of the SlingShot? Include three details from the text in your answer.



Second Focus: Analyzing Organization

Discover

Skill Focus: When writing an essay, authors have different options for how to organize and structure their ideas. They can choose to use one primary text structure throughout, or they can combine and shift between multiple structures. Using varied structures allows the author to communicate concepts in the way that makes most sense for each part of the essay.

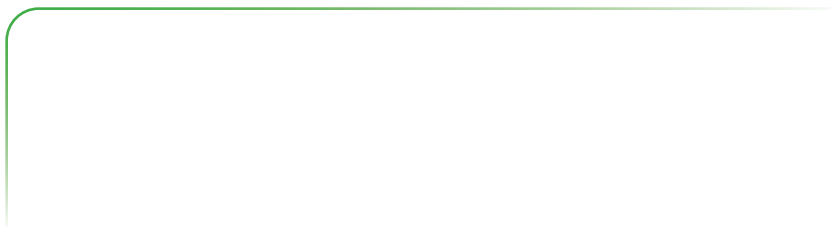
Reread the excerpt aloud with a partner. In the Notes column, write the structure of each paragraph. Here are some common structures used in writing:

- cause and effect
- comparison/contrast
- problem/solution
- listing/enumeration
- spatial/description
- chronological (time) order
- order of importance
- sequential (steps) order
- generalization/example

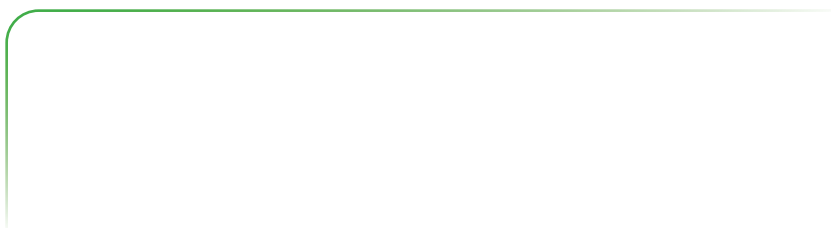
Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. What does the phrase “When we first sat down” in line 60 signal about the organization of this part of the essay?



2. In line 64, what does the word *unspools* suggest about the chronology that Kamen tells?



3. Why do you think Kamen and the author use the phrase “less power than a handheld hair dryer” to support their claim?

Demonstrate

Sometimes a single organizational structure controls an entire text. Authors may start at the beginning of a story and move forward through time, or they may explain a problem and show how it was or should be solved. But much writing utilizes a combination of structures to present different facets of the subject in an engaging way.

Understanding the different text structures used in writing can improve your reading comprehension. When you can identify patterns such as cause and effect, compare and contrast, chronological order, problems and solutions, and descriptions, you can get a better grasp of what the author is trying to convey. Each structure has a purpose and uses certain language that provides clues to important information. For example, if you see words such as *dilemma* and *solution*, you know to look for a problem and solution structure. Being aware of these text structures allows you to anticipate what is coming next and identify central ideas. It also assists you in organizing the details of the text in your mind. Learning to recognize the various text structures will boost your understanding as you read different kinds of texts. Study the following table.

Text Structure	Purpose	Look for these words
Cause and Effect	- Shows how one thing leads to or causes another. - Answers: "Why did this happen?"	<i>because, since, therefore, consequently, as a result, thus, due to, for this reason</i>
Compare and Contrast	Highlights how two or more things are similar and different.	<i>similarly, on the other hand, however, while, although, unlike, alike, comparatively, conversely, but, different from, in contrast</i>

continued on next page

Text Structure	Purpose	Look for these words
Sequential	Information is presented as a series of instructions or steps in a process.	<i>first, second, third, at once, after, before, during, finally, following, last, next</i>
Chronological	Facts, events, or details are presented in the order in which they occurred in time.	<i>On, at (date or time), before, earlier, eventually, following, next, not long after, now, presently, previously, prior to, then, recently, simultaneously, soon, until, when</i>
Description	Provides details or examples to explain a person, place, or event.	<i>for example, to illustrate, such as, includes, in particular, characteristics of, details, for instance</i>
Problem and Solution	States a problem and proposes one or more solutions.	<i>dilemma is, challenge is, therefore, consequently, as a result, proposed solution, potential solution</i>

“Pure Genius” delivers information about Dean Kamen’s career, the development and operation of the SlingShot, and the effects of the water crisis in developing countries. There is no simple way to present all of these ideas, so the author uses a variety of structures in different sections of the text, choosing the best structure to fit his changing purpose.

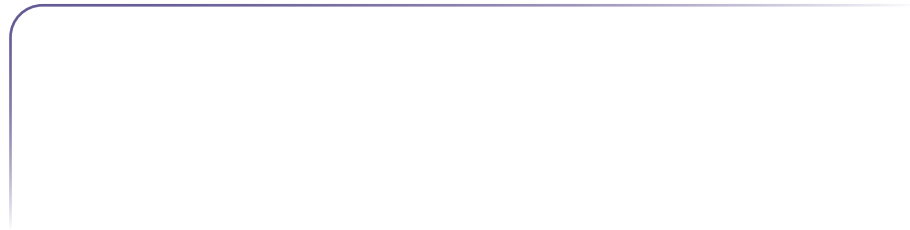
Use the following chart to record the organizational structure and a description of how it is used in each section. The first row has been completed for you. Note that the paragraphs within a section may have individual structures that are different from the overall organization of the section.

Section	Text Structure
Paragraphs 1–4	description/spatial—from the outside in, the text describes Ekocenter, who invented it, and how it works
Paragraphs 5–9	problem/solution—

Section	Text Structure
Paragraphs 10–11	chronological order—
Paragraphs 12–13	
Paragraphs 14–18	
Paragraphs 19–24	

Exit Ticket

Write a paragraph to explain why the author begins the article with several paragraphs of description. What purpose does this introduction serve?



Third Focus: Analyzing Multimodal Accounts of a Subject

Discover

Skill Focus: To analyze an informational essay and a documentary on the same subject, consider the following.

Purpose and Perspective:

- Consider the purpose behind each piece—is the article meant to inform/report objectively, while the documentary may aim to persuade or take a stance?
- Examine the perspective or bias expressed through each medium. How do the viewpoints, voices, and lenses differ?

Use of Evidence:

- Look at the types of evidence used. An article may rely more heavily on expert quotes, statistics, and studies. A documentary can show more first-hand footage, interviews, and real-world examples.
- Evaluate the depth, breadth, and reliability of evidence presented in each piece.

Structure and Style:

- Compare the overall structure and narrative technique. An article is likely structured more straightforwardly, while a documentary may employ a dramatic chronological storyline.
- Contrast the styles used to convey information—descriptive language in an article versus impactful visuals and audio/video elements in a documentary.

Access to Information:

- Assess what key facts, ideas, or insights each piece provides access to. An article may cover core details, whereas richer context/human experiences often come through in a documentary.
- Consider what limitations each medium has in fully covering the complexities of the subject.

Overall Impact:

- Reflect on how each piece made you think or feel about the topic. An article aims for clarity, while a documentary may create more emotional resonance.
- Which piece did you find more engaging, convincing, or illuminating overall regarding the subject matter?

By analyzing factors such as purpose, evidence, storytelling techniques, and overall impact, you can draw insightful comparisons between how the same subject is explored through the medium of a written article versus a visual documentary format.

As you read the article again, think about how Dean Kamen and the SlingShot are presented in the article. Underline words or phrases that help the reader infer the author's perspective or opinion of Dean Kamen and the Coca-Cola Company.

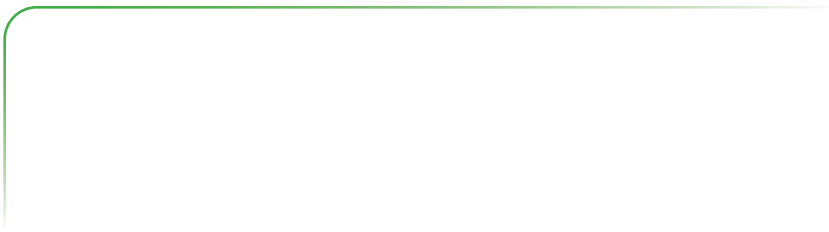
Next, watch a clip from the documentary *SlingShot* (2014). This movie details Dean Kamen's efforts to develop his water purification machine. As you watch, think about the following questions.

- What details about the video let you know that it's a documentary?
- How does the video clarify or elaborate on the ideas in the article?

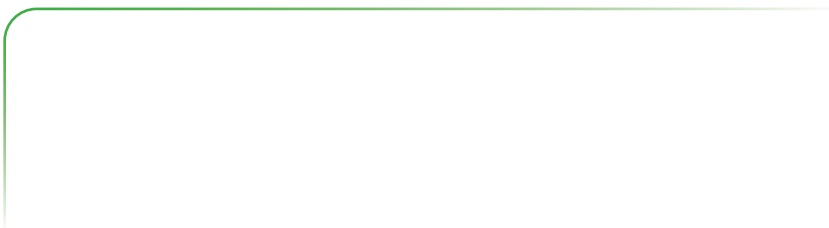
Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. How does the film depict Dean Kamen? Do you think this is valid? Why or why not?



2. Some critics of *SlingShot* have suggested that the film is simply a long infomercial that promotes a product. Do you agree or disagree? Defend your answer with several reasons.



Demonstrate

People today get information from a variety of media, including print books and magazines, websites, local and national news programs, and feature-length documentaries. Each of these genres of mass media uses unique techniques to communicate. For example, the documentary you watched relied upon interviews to provide information from Kamen and his family. Documentary

films also rely on emotion-provoking visuals, captions over pictures, and animated images and visuals.

The article and the documentary in content and in the way they communicate the content, because writers and directors have different tools available to them. Fill in the following chart to help you analyze how the documentary communicates key ideas.

Scene from Documentary	Type of Rhetorical Appeal and Explanation/Evidence from the Film	Did you find this effective? Why?
Visuals of the technology used by the SlingShot to filter water		
Personal details about Kamen's life		

Scene from Documentary	Type of Rhetorical Appeal and Explanation/Evidence from the Film	Did you find this effective? Why?
Statistics about poor water and images of sick children interposed with Kamen brushing his teeth and using water in his home		
Images of Kamen flying his helicopter to work		

Fill in the following chart to compare and contrast the article and the video.

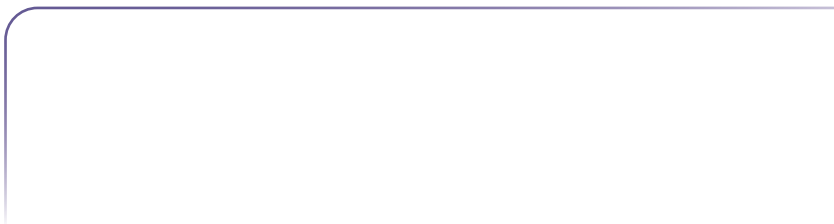
	Details Emphasized in "Pure Genius"	Details Emphasized in "SlingShot"
The problem of a lack of clean water		

	Details Emphasized in "Pure Genius"	Details Emphasized in "SlingShot"
How SlingShot distills water		
Kamen as an inventor		
Kamen's personal story		

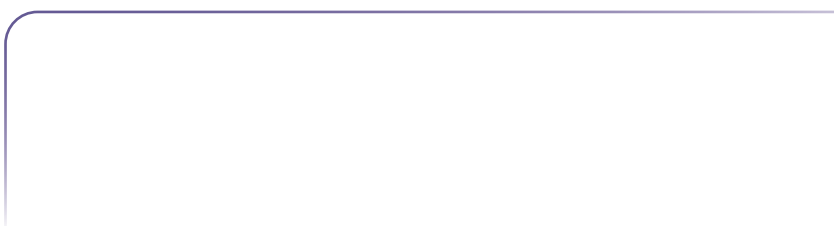
Exit Ticket

1 With a partner, use your responses in the charts on the previous pages to discuss the following questions. Take notes on your discussion in the space below.

1. What details does the article emphasize? What details does the documentary emphasize?



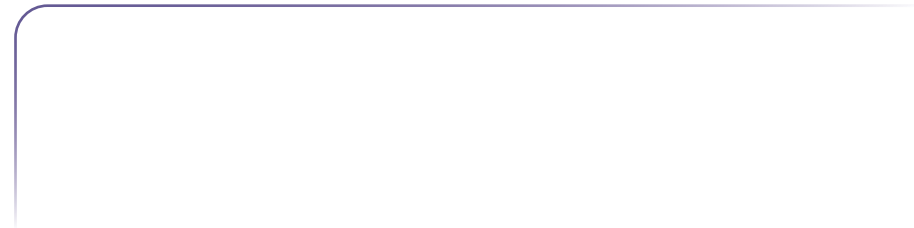
2. In general, what forms of rhetoric does the article appeal to? What forms does the documentary appeal to?



3. Does the article's perspective of the SlingShot and Kamen differ from the video? How are they similar?



2 Use your notes from your discussion to write two or three paragraphs analyzing how the documentary and the article emphasize different elements of Kamen and his invention. Include an evaluation about the effectiveness of the rhetoric used by each.



Review

In this chapter, you practiced citing thorough text evidence to support your analysis of the text. You were also asked to examine the way authors structure texts to develop their ideas. Here are some examples of how these skills might be tested on standardized tests.

1. Read this excerpt.

In 2011, Coke and Deka sent 15 SlingShots to Ghana for a six-month field test where they provided clean water to five rural schools. In fall 2013, Coke and its partners announced a goal to place up to 2,000 units (either standalone SlingShots or Ekocenters) around Africa, Asia, and Latin America by the end of 2015. “The commitment we made is to provide 500 million liters of safe drinking water to communities in need on a yearly basis,” Hendriksen says. That would translate into improving the lives of 500,000 people a year.

Which of the following statements best describes the structure of this paragraph?

- A. It details the steps being taken to solve a problem.
 - B. It details reasons given for taking a course of action.
 - C. It compares the current situation with future goals.
 - D. It demonstrates the effects of a problem.
2. One reader has concluded that the SlingShot could have a bigger impact than Kamen’s other inventions because it will likely help more people. Which evidence best supports this idea?
 - A. *Using a process called vapor compression distillation, a single SlingShot can purify more than 250,000 liters of water per year, enough to satisfy the needs of about 300 people.*
 - B. *According to the World Health Organization, nearly a billion people lack ready access to safe drinking water, and hundreds of thousands die every year as a result.*
 - C. *‘The commitment we made is to provide 500 million liters of safe drinking water to communities in need on a yearly basis,’ Hendriksen says. That would translate into improving the lives of 500,000 people a year.*
 - D. *‘Fifty percent of all the people in the developing world suffer from waterborne pathogens,’ he says. ‘We’d empty half the beds in all the hospitals in the world if we just gave people clean water.’*

3. In lines 35–41, the author introduces the problem of getting SlingShot to the locations where it is most needed. How does he further develop this problem?
- A. In the same paragraph, he explains that this “is where Coke comes in” because it has a large distribution system.
 - B. In lines 146–152 he recounts Deka’s efforts to find an organization to distribute the device.
 - C. In lines 162–189, he details Kamen’s negotiation and work with Coca-Cola that led to the Ekocenter.
 - D. In lines 199–207, he lists the regions where the Ekocenter has been and will be introduced.
4. Which of the following best describes the structure of lines 127–198 of “Pure Genius”?
- A. cause and effect
 - B. chronology
 - C. description
 - D. problem and solution

5. Read the following paragraph and then answer the question that follows.

Inside the big red box sits a smaller one, about the size of a dorm fridge, called a SlingShot. It was developed by Kamen, the mastermind behind dozens of medical-equipment inventions and, most famously, the Segway personal transportation device. Kamen is the closest thing to a modern-day Thomas Edison. He holds hundreds of patents, and his creations have improved countless lives. His current projects include a robotic prosthetic arm for DARPA and a Stirling engine that generates affordable electricity by using “anything that burns” for fuel. The SlingShot, more than 10 years in the making, could have a bigger impact than all of his other inventions combined.

In this paragraph, how does the author develop the idea that Dean Kamen is an innovative inventor?

- A. by describing projects Kamen was currently working on
 - B. by recounting the history of Kamen’s career successes
 - C. by describing Kamen’s inspiration, Thomas Edison
 - D. by explaining the science that makes Kamen’s devices work
6. In comparison with the article “Pure Genius,” the documentary *SlingShot* is more concerned with
- A. explaining Kamen’s partnership with Coca-Cola.
 - B. detailing logical reasons for solving the world’s water crisis.
 - C. sharing the personal struggles Kamen has faced.
 - D. explaining how the SlingShot purifies water.



Chapter 23

Interpreting Dramatic Conventions

Chapter Goals

In this chapter you will:

- determine an author's message
- consider how an author develops character through dialogue and setting
- analyze the functions of soliloquies and asides

Academic Vocabulary

The following terms are academic vocabulary that you will be studying and using as you explore the selection in this chapter. Read the terms and their definitions.

- **aside:** *remarks made by a character that are intended only for the audience and not the other characters.*
- **dramatic irony:** *situation produced when the audience knows critical information about the story that a character does not know.*
- **soliloquy:** *the act of speaking one's thoughts aloud to oneself, often used as a dramatic device in theatre.*
- **theme:** the underlying message or big idea of a talk, book, film, or other work
- **universal theme:** a message that applies to anyone, anywhere, regardless of cultural differences

Use the correct academic vocabulary term to complete the following sentences.

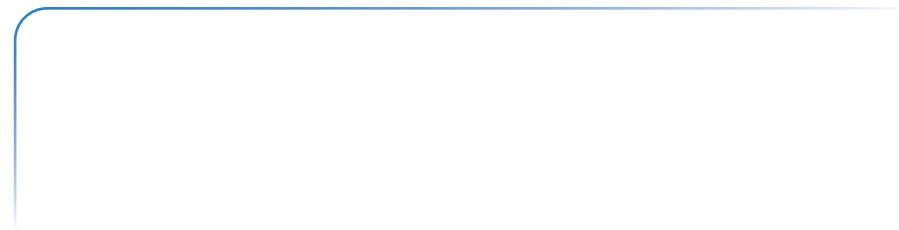
1. Because of _____ in the short story, the reader knows the boy's grandfather will disown him for his foolish actions, but the boy is clueless at first.
2. One of the _____ of *Romeo and Juliet* is that love transcends all barriers and expectations.
3. The king's _____ in the first act showed his anger to the audience, while the other characters remained unaware.
4. The young woman's _____ revealed her worries about her father's health, though she didn't tell her father.
5. Although I had never experienced life in South Africa in the 1970s, I could still relate to the book's _____ about the challenges of growing up.

Preview Concepts

This unit's Essential Question is *Can a simple idea bring about great change?* Usually, the phrase “great change” refers to big-picture changes—for example, changes to political systems, economic systems, nations and their governments, and so on.

But does a great change need to be a large one? Can a personal change count as a great change too?

Describe one important personal change you have undergone in your life. Did that personal change also transform how you interacted with the rest of the world—your family, your friends, your school, and so on? If so, how? Write your response below.



Read for Understanding

The following excerpt is from *The Post Office, Act One*. This play, written in 1912 by the Bengali author Rabindranath Tagore, is about an orphan boy named Amal with an incurable disease. His doctor forbids him to go outside, as that only makes him sicker. Despite his illness and restricted life, however, Amal is good-spirited, imaginative, and curious about the world.

As you read, think about key ideas. What is this mostly about? Which ideas are most important? What words or phrases stand out as important? Note anything confusing or that you have questions about.

from *The Post Office, Act One*

by Rabindranath Tagore

1 **MADHAV's house**

MADHAV DUTTA. What a mess I'm in. Before he came, he meant nothing to me—I had no worries. Then he came here out of nowhere and filled my entire home; if he leaves me
5 now, this house will no longer seem like my home. Doctor, do you think he will—

DOCTOR. If the child is **fated** for long life, then he shall have it, but it is written in the *Ayurveda*²⁰ that—

MADHAV. What? Please tell me!

10 **DOCTOR.** The scriptures say, "**Bile and fever, palsy and phlegm**²¹ all—"

MADHAV. Stop, stop, please don't recite those *slokas*; they just make me more anxious. Tell me instead what must be done.

15 **DOCTOR** (*taking snuff*). Great care must be observed.

MADHAV. That I know, but what kind of care? You must tell me.

20 **Ayurveda:** an ancient system of medicine recorded in the Vedas, the oldest writings of India

21 **Bile and fever, palsy and phlegm:** The doctor is referring to symptoms of disease. Bile is a greenish-brown fluid made by the liver; palsy refers to both paralysis and tremors; phlegm is a mucus produced by the lungs and comes up during coughs.

Notes:

DOCTOR. I have told you before: On no account should he be allowed out-of-doors.

20 **MADHAV.** But he's so young! To keep him inside all day is really cruel.

DOCTOR. What choice do you have? The autumn sun and wind are both like **venom** to the boy, for as the scriptures say, "In epilepsy, fever, or wheezing fit; in jaundice or in
25 swelling—"

MADHAV. Enough, that's enough scripture. So we have to shut him indoors—is there really no other cure?

DOCTOR. None at all, for in the wind and the sun—

MADHAV. Oh **cease** with your "this, that, and the
30 other." Please, stop it—just tell me what I have to do. Your **remedies** are so harsh. The poor boy is already putting up with a lot without complaining—but it breaks my heart to see how your prescription makes him suffer further.

DOCTOR. The greater the suffering, the happier the
35 outcome. As the great sage Chyabana says, "In medication as in good **counsel**, the bitterest remedy brings the speediest results." Well, I must be going, Mr. Dutta.
(*He goes.*)

(THAKURDA enters.)

40 **MADHAV.** Oh no, Thakurda's back! Looks like trouble.

THAKURDA. Why? Why should a fellow like me scare you?

MADHAV. Because you make children run wild.

THAKURDA. You are not a boy, you have no child in your house, and you are past the age for running away—
45 why do you worry?

MADHAV. Because I have brought a child to the house.

THAKURDA. Indeed!

Notes:

MADHAV. My wife wanted to adopt a boy.

THAKURDA. I've known that for a long time, but I
50 thought you didn't want to.

MADHAV. You know, I was making a lot of money by
hard work, and I used to think how terrible it would be
if some boy turned up and wasted all my money without
any effort. But this one has somehow charmed me so much
55 that—

THAKURDA. —that no wealth is too much for him. And
you now feel that the more you spend, the merrier your
money's fate.

MADHAV. Before, I was addicted to making money—I
60 couldn't help myself. But now my reward is the knowledge
that whatever I earn will be his.

THAKURDA. And where did you find him?

MADHAV. He's a sort of nephew of my wife through some
village connection. He lost his mother very early, poor boy.
65 And just recently, he lost his father, too.

THAKURDA. How sad! Maybe I could be of some help to him.

MADHAV. The doctor says that he is so sick with fever
that there isn't much hope. Now the only cure is somehow
to keep him inside, away from the autumn sunshine and
70 breezes. But you always come along and gaily lead children
outside—that's why you scare me.

THAKURDA. Yes, I admit it, I have become a free spirit,
like the autumn sun and wind. But I also know how to play
games indoors. Let me finish a few errands of mine, then I
75 will make friends with this boy of yours.

(He goes.)

(AMAL enters.)

Notes:

AMAL. Uncle!

MADHAV. What is it, Amal?

80 **AMAL.** Can't I even go out into the courtyard?

MADHAV. No, Amal.

AMAL. Look, over there, where Auntie is grinding **lentils**, there's a squirrel, balancing on its tail and munching the broken bits between its paws—can't I please go and see?

85 **MADHAV.** No, my son.

AMAL. I wish I could be a squirrel—Uncle, why can't I go out?

MADHAV. The doctor says that if you go out, you will get ill.

90 **AMAL.** How does the doctor know that?

MADHAV. What do you mean, Amal? Of course he knows! He has read so many huge old books.

AMAL. Does reading make you know everything?

MADHAV. Of course! Don't you know?

95 **AMAL** (*with a sigh*). I have not read a single book, so I guess I don't know anything.

Notes:

First Focus: Determining Themes

Discover

Skill Focus: In a play, authors can share their message or convey their intended themes and ideas through various techniques, including setting, dialogue, character development, and the conflicts and resolutions of the events of the plot. When determining the theme of a play, pay close attention to the struggles of the main character and how they respond to these struggles.

People who know Tagore's writings consider *The Post Office* to be one of his greatest works. Audiences find the play easy to follow and enjoyable, but it also explores many themes about what makes for a meaningful and rich life.

The Post Office begins with a conversation between Madhav Dutta, who is Amal's uncle, and Amal's doctor. Now that you have a general understanding of the selection, return to the excerpt and identify dialogue that expresses a message about what is fulfilling in life. Underline that dialogue. In the Notes column, restate that message in your own words.

Discuss: Whole Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. Why is Madhav irritated at the Doctor?

2. How does the introduction of Thakurda introduce hope into the play?

3. What do we learn about Amal at the end of this excerpt? How might this be significant in the play?

Demonstrate

Theme is the underlying message or big idea of a story, book, film, or other work of literature. A theme should be able to be expressed in a single sentence. A universal theme is one that applies to anyone, anywhere, regardless of cultural differences. Some themes are directly stated by one of the characters. For example, in *Romeo and Juliet*, Friar Laurence states an important theme of the play when he says, “These violent delights have violent ends.” When in *To Kill a Mockingbird*, Atticus tells Scout, “You never really understand a person until you consider things from his point of view . . . until you climb into his skin and walk around in it,” readers understand that he has just revealed an important message of the novel.

However, other times, themes can be challenging for readers to determine. Instead of expressing a message directly, an author might imply the theme through the characters’ interactions and responses to events. To determine an implied theme, analyze key elements of the text, including conflict, character interactions, and how the conflict resolves.

Exit Ticket

1 In a group of three or four, discuss the themes that are developed in *The Post Office*. Use the following questions to help you determine the theme.

- With what is Madhav struggling?
- How has Madhav changed since Amal came to stay?
- With what is Amal struggling?
- What do you learn from Madhav's interaction with Amal?

Based on your answers to the questions above, what can you infer about the themes of the play? Try to state the themes in a complete sentence.

2 Based on your group discussion, write a short paragraph that makes a clear claim about a message the author expresses to his audience. Use evidence from the play to support your claim.

Second Focus: Analyzing How Authors Develop Characters

Discover

Skill Focus: Playwrights create interesting, multi-dimensional characters that advance the plot and serve as messengers for the themes of the play. In addition to dialogue, playwrights develop their characters through stage directions, how the characters interact with other characters, how the characters grow or change throughout the play, and what the characters say directly through monologues or soliloquies.

Despite his illness and restricted life, Amal is good-spirited, imaginative, and curious about the world beyond his village. Because he is not allowed to go outside, Amal spends his days at his window, chatting with and asking questions of anyone who walks by. By doing so, he makes many friends and learns about a world he cannot experience directly.

At the start of this excerpt, Amal has just finished speaking with a passing food seller and is singing to himself. Soon he will meet two new characters: a Watchman, who is like a policeman, and a Headman, who has some authority in the village.

Reread the first excerpt. Then as you read the following, look for dialogue that reveals what the characters are like. In the Notes column, write notes explaining what the dialogue shows about the characters.

from The Post Office, Act One

by Rabindranath Tagore

- 1 **AMAL.** (*chanting*). **Dai²²**, *dai*, good *dai*! *Dai* from the dairies
beside the Shamli River in the Panchmura Hills. *Dai—dai*!
Every dawn the dairywomen milk the cows under the trees,
and every evening they set the *dai*—and what *dai* it is! *Dai*,
5 *dai*, *dai-i*, delicious *dai*! Ah, look, there's the watchman doing
his rounds. Watchman, oh Watchman, won't you come and
listen to me for just a minute?
(**WATCHMAN** enters.)
WATCHMAN. What's all this shouting for? Aren't you
10 afraid of me?

22 **dai:** a Bengali word for curds. A curd is a soft, white substance made when milk sours, and is the basis for cheese.

Notes:

Notes:

AMAL. Why should I be afraid of you?

WATCHMAN. What if I arrest you, take you away?

AMAL. Where will you take me? Far away, over the hills?

WATCHMAN. I might take you straight to the **Raja**²³!

15 **AMAL.** To the Raja! Would you really?! But the doctor has forbidden me to go out. No one can take me anywhere. I must just sit here all day and night.

WATCHMAN. Doctor's orders? Ah, I can see your face is quite pale. There are dark rings under your eyes. The veins
20 are sticking out in both of your arms.

AMAL. Are you going to sound your gong?

WATCHMAN. The time is not yet right.

AMAL. Some people say, "time flies," while others say that "time is not yet ripe." But if you strike your gong, won't the
25 time be right?

WATCHMAN. How so? I sound the gong only when the time is right.

AMAL. I do like your gong. I love listening to it, especially at noon after everyone's eaten and my uncle has gone
30 out somewhere to work and Auntie dozes off reading the **Ramayana**²⁴, and our small dog curls up into its tail in some shadow of the courtyard—then I hear your gong strike, *dhong, dhong, dhong dhong dhong*! But why do you strike it?

WATCHMAN. It tells everyone that time does not stand
35 still, that time always moves onward.

AMAL. Where is time going? To what land?

WATCHMAN. Nobody knows that.

AMAL. You mean nobody's been there? I would love to run away with time to this land that nobody knows.

23 **raja:** a Bengali word meaning "king" or "prince"

24 **Ramayana:** one of two ancient epics of India, the other being the Mahabharata

40 **WATCHMAN.** All of us will go there one day, young man.
AMAL. Me, too?
WATCHMAN. Of course.
AMAL. But the doctor has forbidden me to go out.
WATCHMAN. Someday perhaps the doctor will hold your
45 hand and take you there.
AMAL. No, you don't know him, all he does is keep me
locked up here.
WATCHMAN. But there is a greater doctor than he, a
doctor who can set you free.
50 **AMAL.** When will this Great Doctor come for me? I'm so
tired of staying here.
WATCHMAN. Shouldn't say such things, son.
AMAL. But I have to sit here all the time never going out,
doing as I am told, and when your gong goes *dhong dhong*
55 *dhong* I feel so frustrated. Watchman—?
WATCHMAN. What is it?
AMAL. Over there, across the road, that big house with a flag
on top, with lots of people going in and out of it—what is it?
WATCHMAN. It's the new post office.
60 **AMAL.** Post office? Whose post office?
WATCHMAN. The **Raja's**, of course—who else could have a
post office? (*Aside*) He's a strange boy.
AMAL. Do letters come to the post office from the Raja
himself?
65 **WATCHMAN.** Yes, of course. Someday, there may even be a
letter addressed to you.
AMAL. A letter with my name on it? But I am only a child.
WATCHMAN. The Raja sends his littlest letters to children.
AMAL. Really? When will I get my letter? And how do you

Notes:

70 know that he's going to write to me?

WATCHMAN. Why else would he bother to set up a post office with a splendid golden flag outside your open window?
(*Aside*) But I rather like the boy.

AMAL. When the Raja's letter comes, who will give it to me?

75 **WATCHMAN.** The Raja has many messengers—surely you have seen them running about with gold badges pinned to their chests?

AMAL. Where do they go?

WATCHMAN. From door to door, country to country.

80 (*Aside*) The boy's questions really are amusing.

AMAL. When I grow up, I want to be a Raja's messenger.

WATCHMAN. Ha, ha, ha! A Raja's messenger! Now there's a responsible job. Come rain, come shine, among rich, among poor, wherever you are you must deliver your letters—it's a
85 tremendous job!

AMAL. Why are you smiling that way? It's the best job there could be. Oh, I don't mean that your job isn't good, too—you strike your gong during the heat of noon, *dhong dhong dhong*, and also in the dead of night—sometimes I
90 suddenly wake up and find that the lamp has gone out and I hear a deep, dark *dhong dhong dhong*!

WATCHMAN. Uh-oh, here comes the big boss—time to run. If he catches me chatting with you, he's sure to cause trouble.

AMAL. Where's the boss, which one is he?

95 **WATCHMAN.** Over there, way down the road. Don't you see his big umbrella—the one made of palm leaves—bobbing up and down?

AMAL. Has the boss been **appointed** by the Raja?

WATCHMAN. Oh, no—he's been appointed by himself. But

Notes:

100 if you don't obey him, he'll cause endless difficulties—that's why people are afraid of him. Our Headman's entire job seems to be troublemaking, for everyone. So that's enough talk for today, time to leave. I'll be back tomorrow morning to bring you the news of the town.

105 (*He goes.*)

AMAL. If I receive a letter every day from the Raja, that would be wonderful. I'll sit here by the window and read them. Oh, but I don't know how to read. I wonder who could read them for me? Auntie reads *Ramayana*. Maybe she can
110 read the Raja's writing. If nobody can read the letters, I'll keep them and read them all later, when I grow up. But what if the Raja's messengers don't know about me? Mr. Headman, oh dear Mr. Headman, could I talk to you for a minute?

HEADMAN. Who's this? **Bellowing** at me in the road!
115 Who's this monkey?

AMAL. You are the Headman. I hear that everyone pays attention to you.

HEADMAN (*flattered*). Yes, yes, they do. They do, or else.

AMAL. Do the Raja's messengers listen to you, too?

120 **HEADMAN.** Of course! Would they dare to ignore me?

AMAL. Will you tell the messengers that my name is Amal, and that I am always here, sitting by the window?

HEADMAN. Why should I do that?

AMAL. In case there is a letter addressed to me.

125 **HEADMAN.** A letter for you! Who would write you a letter?

AMAL. If the Raja writes to me then—

HEADMAN. Well now, aren't you a mighty fellow! Ho, ho, ho! So the Raja will write to you, will he? Of course he will, for you are his dear friend. In fact, he's getting sadder by the day
130 because he's not seen you lately, so I hear. Well, your waiting's

Notes:

almost over; I bet that your letter will come any day now.

AMAL. Mr. Headman, why is your voice so harsh? Are you angry with me?

HEADMAN. Goodness me. Why should I be angry with
135 you? Could I be so bold? After all, you are a **correspondent**
of the Raja. (*Aside*) I can see that Madhav Dutta thinks he
can drop the names of rajas and **maharajas**²⁵, just because
he has made a little money. We'll soon see that he gets his
comeuppance—Yes, my lad, you'll soon get a royal letter at
140 your house, I shall see to it myself.

AMAL. No, no, please, you don't have to go to any trouble for me.

HEADMAN. And why not? I will tell our Raja about you, and
I am sure he will not keep you waiting long. In fact, I bet he
145 will send a footman at once to hear your news. (*Aside*) Really,
Madhav Dutta's arrogance is too much. Just as soon as this
reaches the ears of the Raja, there'll be trouble, that's for sure.
(*He goes.*)

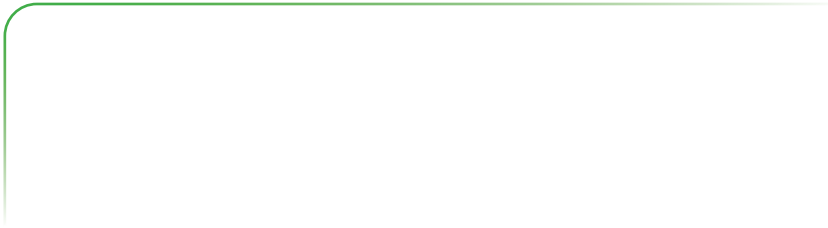
Notes:

25 **maharaja**: a Bengali word meaning "great king"

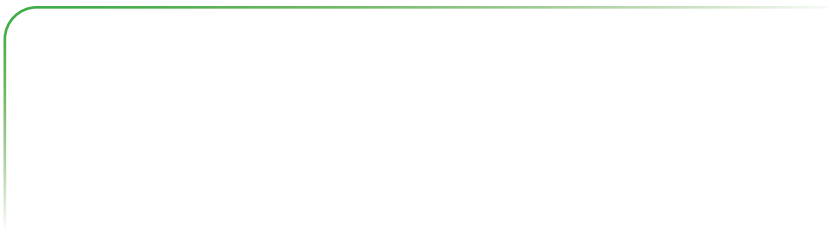
Discuss: Small Group

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

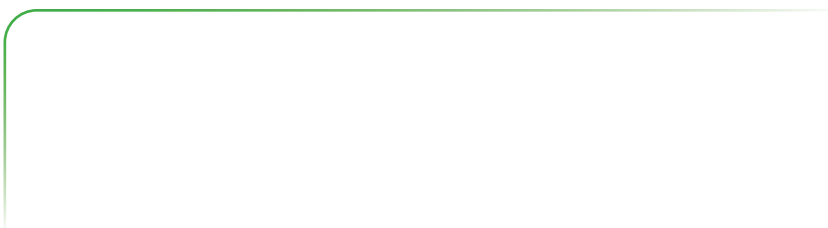
1. Who is the Great Doctor?



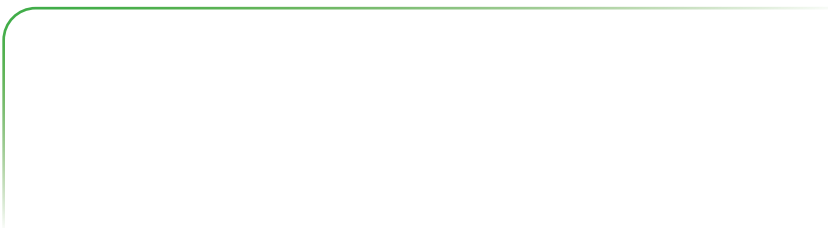
2. How likely is it that the Raja would know about Amal but the Raja's messengers would not? What does that say about Amal's thought process?



3. How would you describe the Headman?



4. What does the Watchman's conversation with Amal reveal about his feelings toward him? Use paraphrasing or direct quotations from the text to support your answer.



5. What does the Headman's conversation with Amal reveal about his feelings and intentions toward him and his father, Madhav Dutta? Use paraphrasing or direct quotations from the text to support your answer.



Demonstrate

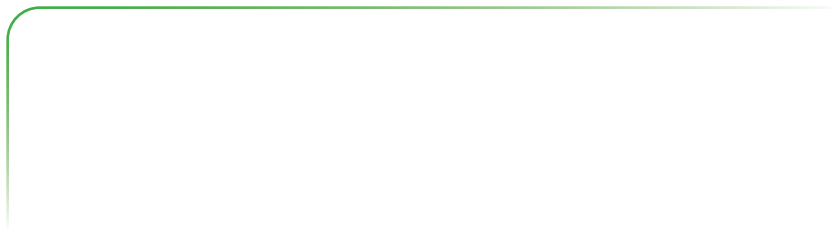
Authors of narratives *develop* their characters. This means that authors build a sense of who characters are—their personalities, their likes and dislikes, how they react to events—as the narrative unfolds. Authors of prose, such as short stories and novels, develop characters through dialogue and description.

The Post Office is a play. What can a playwright use to develop the characters for an audience?

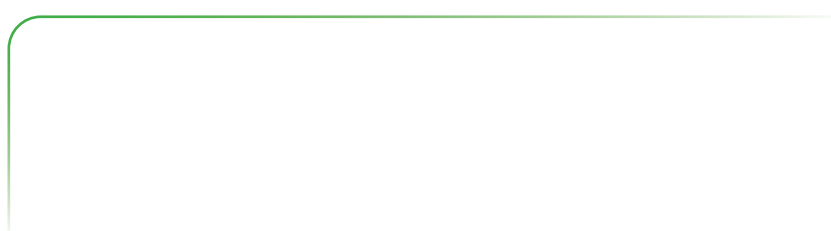
Characters develop within a setting, or the time and location in which a story takes place. Some settings are extremely specific—for example, during the Battle of Gettysburg (July 1–3, 1863) during the American Civil War. More often, however, the settings are less specific.

Answer the following questions about the setting of *The Post Office*.

1. What country does the play take place in?



2. When does the play take place?



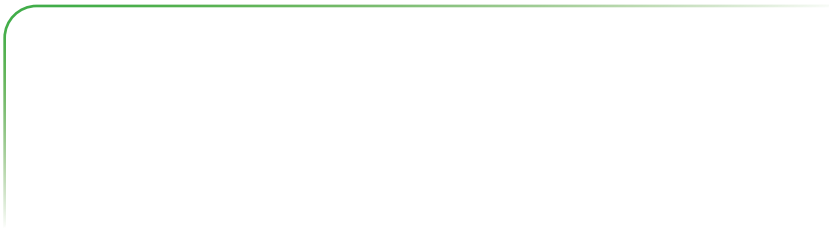
3. Is the setting rural, urban, or somewhere in-between?



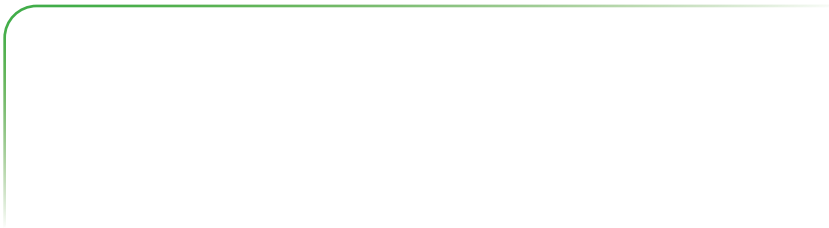
4. Do the surroundings seem modern (with electricity) or premodern?



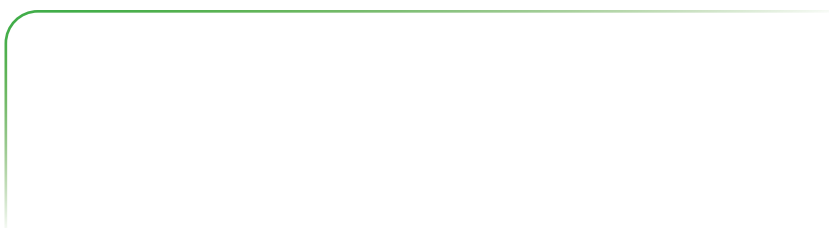
5. How wealthy do people in the setting seem to be?



6. Is everyone in a hurry, or do people have time to talk?



7. Write down anything else about the setting that seems relevant to you.



Exit Ticket

Discuss the following with a partner. Record notes from your discussion below.

- Briefly describe the personalities of Amal, the Watchman, and the Headman.
- Based on your notes in the Notes column, identify specific moments of dialogue the playwright uses to develop these characters.
- Finally, discuss how the setting helps make such dialogue (and therefore the character development) possible in the first place.

Third Focus: Analyzing Soliloquies and Asides

Discover

Skill Focus: Playwrights can develop characters through what those characters say to each other. Sometimes, however, a playwright will have characters speak only to themselves. It is during these moments when characters speak to themselves that the audience can learn things about the character that nobody on stage knows.

Playwrights can develop characters through what those characters say to each other. Sometimes, however, a playwright will have characters speak only to themselves. It is during these moments, when characters speak to themselves, that the audience can learn things about the character that nobody on stage knows.

Reread the excerpt from the Second Focus section. Look for dialogue in which characters speak only to themselves. When you notice such moments, draw boxes around them. In the Notes column, write down what the audience learns about the character from such dialogue.

Discuss: Turn and Talk

Write your answers to the discussion questions below.

1. Amal's innocence, curiosity, and enthusiasm endear him to readers. Many novels, plays, and movies include similar likeable young characters. Identify a young character from another source and explain their popularity. Be sure to include the title of the work, the character's name, and specific details from the work.

2. A common proverb is "The apple does not fall far from the tree." How might this phrase apply to the Headman's perceptions of Amal, and how does this create suspense in the play?

Demonstrate

In plays, when characters speak only to themselves and at length, they are giving a *soliloquy*. The word *soliloquy* comes from the Latin roots *solo* (“to oneself”) and *loquor* (“talk”). During a soliloquy, a character is not speaking to other characters or the audience. Instead, the character is speaking only to himself.

The main function of a soliloquy is to let the audience know a character’s inner thoughts and feelings. Soliloquies can be long enough to let characters express complex ideas and emotions, analyze problems and solutions, and ponder weighty matters such as life, death, and even the nature of reality. Such reflections can give audiences insights into the themes of plays.

In some dramas, characters also speak *asides*, which are short statements that only the audience hears. Typically, asides express a character’s private thoughts. Such private thoughts often contradict how that character is speaking or acting toward other characters.

Playwrights can use soliloquies and asides to produce *dramatic irony*, which occurs when the audience and some characters have knowledge that other characters do not. One function of dramatic irony is to intensify the feelings of the audience toward specific characters. In *The Post Office*, for example, Amal believes the Raja will write him letters. The audience believes, however, that a person as important as the Raja is unlikely to care about a sick boy. The playwright likely intended such irony to make the audience feel sympathy toward Amal.

The chart that follows presents a soliloquy and three asides from *The Post Office*. What does each excerpt tell the audience about the character who speaks it?

Character	Excerpt from the text	What does the excerpt tell the audience about the character speaking it?
Amal	If I receive a letter every day from the Raja, that would be wonderful. I’ll sit here by the window and read them. Oh, but I don’t know how to read. I wonder who could read them for me? Auntie reads Ramayana. Maybe she can read the Raja’s writing. If nobody can read the letters, I’ll keep them and read them all later, when I grow up. But what if the Raja’s messengers don’t know about me? Mr. Headman, oh dear Mr. Headman, could I talk to you for a minute? (lines 106–114)	

Character	Excerpt from the text	What does the excerpt tell the audience about the character speaking it?
Watchman	The Raja's, of course—who else could have a post office? (Aside) He's a strange boy. (lines 61–62) Why else would he bother to set up a post office with a splendid golden flag outside your open window? (Aside) But I rather like the boy. (lines 71–73)	
Headman	Goodness me. Why should I be angry with you? Could I be so bold? After all, you are a correspondent of the Raja. (Aside) I can see that Madhav Dutta thinks he can drop the names of rajas and maharajas, just because he has made a little money. We'll soon see that he gets his comeuppance—Yes, my lad, you'll soon get a royal letter at your house, I shall see to it myself. (lines 134–140)	

Exit Ticket

- 1 In a group of three or four, discuss how soliloquies and asides are alike and different. Use examples from *The Post Office* as evidence to support your points.
- 2 Based on your conversation, write a paragraph comparing and contrasting soliloquies and asides.

Review

In this chapter, you determined an author's message, studied how the author developed characters, and analyzed the functions of soliloquies and asides. When you take reading assessments, you may be asked questions about such topics and will be asked to support your answers with textual evidence. Here are some examples of these types of questions.

1. Read the following excerpt from *The Post Office*.

AMAL. Look, over there, where Auntie is grinding lentils, there's a squirrel, balancing on its tail and munching the broken bits between its paws—can't I please go and see?

MADHAV. No, my son.

What does this dialogue most clearly show about Amal?

- A. He loves squirrels.
 - B. He feels discouraged.
 - C. He carefully observes the world.
 - D. He wants to explore beyond his village.
2. **Part A:** What is one message of *The Post Office* that the playwright wants to express to the audience?
 - A. The concerns of the wealthy are not so different from the concerns of the poor.
 - B. Imagining the world is never as fulfilling as truly living in it.
 - C. Be careful who you trust, as they might betray you.
 - D. Loving other people brings the risk of pain.

Part B: Which excerpt from the play supports the correct answer to Part A?

- A. **MADHAV.** What a mess I'm in. Before he came, he meant nothing to me—I had no worries. Then he came here out of nowhere and filled my entire home; if he leaves me now, this house will no longer seem like my home.
- B. **THAKURDA.** You are not a boy, you have no child in your house, and you are past the age for running away—why do you worry?
- C. **AMAL.** You mean nobody's been there? I would love to run away with time to this land that nobody knows.
- D. **HEADMAN.** Goodness me. Why should I be angry with you? Could I be so bold? After all, you are a correspondent of the Raja. (*Aside*) I can see that Madhav Dutta thinks he can drop the names of rajas and maharajas, just because he has made a little money. We'll soon see that he gets his comeuppance—

3. Read the soliloquy below.

AMAL. If I receive a letter every day from the Raja, that would be wonderful. I'll sit here by the window and read them. Oh, but I don't know how to read. I wonder who could read them for me? Auntie reads *Ramayana*. Maybe she can read the Raja's writing. If nobody can read the letters, I'll keep them and read them all later, when I grow up. But what if the Raja's messengers don't know about me?

Which of the following does the soliloquy NOT teach the audience about Amal?

- A. Amal is hopeful about his future.
 - B. Amal is resourceful in getting what he wants.
 - C. Amal is learning that one's wishes do not always come true.
 - D. Amal is optimistic enough to believe the Raja knows about him.
4. Read lines 131–140 from *The Post Office*.

AMAL. Mr. Headman, why is your voice so harsh? Are you angry with me?

HEADMAN. Goodness me. Why should I be angry with you? Could I be so bold? After all, you are a correspondent of the Raja. (*Aside*) I can see that Madhav Dutta thinks he can drop the names of rajas and maharajas, just because he has made a little money. We'll soon see that he gets his comeuppance—Yes, my lad, you'll soon get a royal letter at your house, I shall see to it myself.

Part A: What does the audience learn about the Headman from his aside?

- A. He speaks to people nobody can see.
- B. He is jealous that Amal knows the Raja.
- C. He is unaware that Amal is joking about knowing the Raja.
- D. He has bad intentions toward both Madhav Dutta and Amal.

Part B: The playwright **most likely** intended that the aside would make the audience feel—

- A. pity for Amal.
- B. anger toward Amal.
- C. concern for the Headman.
- D. contempt toward the Headman.

Academic Vocabulary

affixes: word parts added to a root, stem, or word that change the word's meaning.

allegory: a story, poem, or picture that can be interpreted to reveal a hidden symbolic meaning, usually moral or political.

allusion: a brief reference to a person, place, thing, or idea from literature or history.

analogy: a comparison of two things, typically on the basis of their structure and for the purpose of explanation or clarification.

anaphora: a rhetorical technique in which a word or phrase is repeated at the beginning of two or more successive sentences or clauses.

anecdote: a short account of an event or incident that is told in an interesting or amusing way.

antithesis: the rhetorical contrast of ideas by means of parallel arrangements of words, clauses, or sentences.

aphorism: a statement of truth or wisdom expressed in a concise and witty manner.

argument: a coherent series of reasons, statements, or facts intended to support or establish an opinion.

aside: remarks made by a character that are intended only for the audience and not the other characters.

asyndeton: figure of speech in which conjunctions are intentionally omitted between words, phrases, or clauses, often to create a more emphatic or rhythmic effect.

author's perspective: the author's attitude toward a topic or subject.

balanced presentation: giving evidence to support both sides of an issue in order to fairly present the issue.

bias: cause to feel or show inclination or prejudice for or against someone or something.

cause and effect: organizational pattern that shows how one thing leads to or causes a result or effect.

character: a person, animal, or figure represented in a literary work.

character development: ways in which an author reveals the personality of a character.

characterization: the process by which an author reveals a character by revealing the character's words, thoughts, actions, and/or effect on others.

chronological (time) order: organizational pattern that recounts facts, events, or details in the order in which they occurred in time.

claim: a statement based on an opinion that a writer tries to prove is true.

coming-of-age story: a story in which a young main character faces a struggle that causes him or her to mature or become an adult.

comparison and contrast: organization pattern that shows how two or more topics are alike and how they are different.

conflict: the struggle between two opposing forces in a piece of literature.

connotation: implied meaning of a word; emotional tone of a word.

cultural experience: an experience that engages a person in and reveals a particular culture.

culture: the collective arts, beliefs, customs, and general way of life of a community or society.

description: organizational pattern in which information is developed by explaining features, characteristics, or examples.

dialogue: words spoken among characters in a text, play, or film.

diction: author's choice of words to create the tone and mood of a text.

dramatic irony: situation produced when the audience knows critical information about the story that a character does not know.

dysphemism: the use of a negative or unpleasant term to express a pleasant or neutral idea.

epiphany: a moment of sudden realization or insight.

ethos: an appeal to credibility, ethics, or moral principles.

evaluate: to carefully judge the reliability and validity of a source.

evidence: source-based information including facts, figures, and details used to support the writer's central idea or claim.

fallacious reasoning: the use of invalid or otherwise faulty logic in the construction of an argument.

figurative language: language expressing one thing in terms normally denoting another; ideas are expressed in a non-literal or imaginative way.

figure of speech: any expressive use of language, such as metaphor, simile, or personification, in which words are used in a non-literal sense; imagery.

first person: a type of point of view written from the writer's perspective using "I."

frame story: a story set within a story. The first story often sets the context for how the reader should interpret the second story.

hyperbole: exaggerated statements used for effect and not meant to be taken literally.

idiom: a commonly used expression that has a figurative meaning different from its literal meaning.

imagery: vivid, descriptive language that helps a reader picture sensory details in a literary work.

inference: an idea reached by "adding up" evidence or clues.

juxtaposition: placing two things together or side by side for comparison and contrast.

logical reasoning: pertaining to rational reasons as opposed to emotional appeals.

logos: an appeal that relies on logic or reason.

main idea: central thought of a text.

meiosis: an understatement or downplaying of something for humorous effect.

memoir: a first-person account of a writer's experience.

metaphor: a figurative comparison between two unlike people, objects, or things in which one thing is said to be the other.

metonymy: a word, name, or expression used as a substitute for something else with which it is closely associated.

moral: a message or lesson that is explicitly stated in a piece of literature, usually at the end of a fable or tale.

narrative: a spoken or written account of a series of connected events.

narrative nonfiction: nonfiction writing that uses storytelling devices like dialogue, pacing, description, reflection, and multiple plot lines to get readers emotionally invested in the text.

oral tradition: culture and history that is passed from generation to generation in spoken, not written, format.

organizational patterns: the ways in which authors develop ideas in their writing.

pathos: a persuasive appeal that evokes an audience's emotions.

plot: the plan or main story of a dramatic or literary work.

point of view: a narrator's position in relation to the story they are telling. Texts are mostly written in the first- or third-person point of view (using the pronoun *I* or *he/she/they*, respectively) and less frequently in the second person (using *you*).

prefixes: affixes added to the beginning of a root, stem, or word.

problem and solution: organization pattern that defines certain problems and how they might be solved.

purpose: a writer's reason or goal for writing.

reason: a cause, explanation, or justification that supports a claim.

reflection: thoughts or opinions that are provided in writing.

revise: to "re-see" a piece of writing and to make editorial changes to improve its quality.

rhetoric: 1. the ability to use language effectively; persuade. 2. language that is not honest, sincere, or meaningful.

rhetorical device: use of language that is intended to have an impact on the reader or listener, often to evoke emotions or actions.

satire: the use of humor, irony, exaggeration, or ridicule to expose and criticize people's stupidity or vices, particularly in the context of politics and other topical issues.

sensory details: language that appeals to one of the five senses.

sentence structure: the way words are arranged in sentences grammatically, including the placement of nouns and verbs.

sequential order: organization pattern that describes a process step by step, from beginning to end.

setting: the time, place, and circumstances in which a story occurs or develops.

simile: a figurative comparison of two unlike things that uses “like” or “as.”

soliloquy: the act of speaking one’s thoughts aloud to oneself, often used as a dramatic device in theatre.

source material: an original or previously written text on which another text is based.

structure: how a text is organized, which usually involves a logical strategy.

style: the way in which the author uses word choice, sentence structure, figurative language, and the arrangement of sentences and ideas to create their own unique way of writing.

subtopic: a specific aspect of a broader topic.

suffixes: affixes added to the end of a root, stem, or word.

summarize: to briefly explain the main points of a text.

supporting details: details that contribute to, uphold, or prove the central ideas of a text.

symbolism: a type of figurative language in which an object, person, or event in a literary text represents something else.

synecdoche: a part is used to represent a whole or a whole used to represent a part.

syntax: the way a writer arranges words, phrases, and clauses to form sentences.

synthesize: to gather information from various sources and combine them to form a cohesive argument or understanding of a topic.

text features: the components of a story or article that are not the main body of text, including the table of contents, headings, bold words, sidebars, and pictures and captions.

text structure: the method of organization used in a text.

textual evidence: facts, examples, data, and other details that support a conclusion about a text.

theme: the central message or underlying insight imparted by a text.

tone: a writer’s attitude toward the subject or audience, conveyed through word choice, sentence structure, point of view, and details.

topic: the subject of a piece of writing.

transition: a word or phrase that connects one idea to the next.

treatise: a written work dealing formally and systematically with a subject.

valid: truthful with respect to the information presented.

valid reasoning: an argument that follows logically from evidence and reasons.

verb tense: form of a verb that indicates when the action is happening.

warrant: an explanation of why or how data supports a claim; the underlying assumption that connects data to a claim.

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